

BESM

EXTRAS

FOURTH EDITION

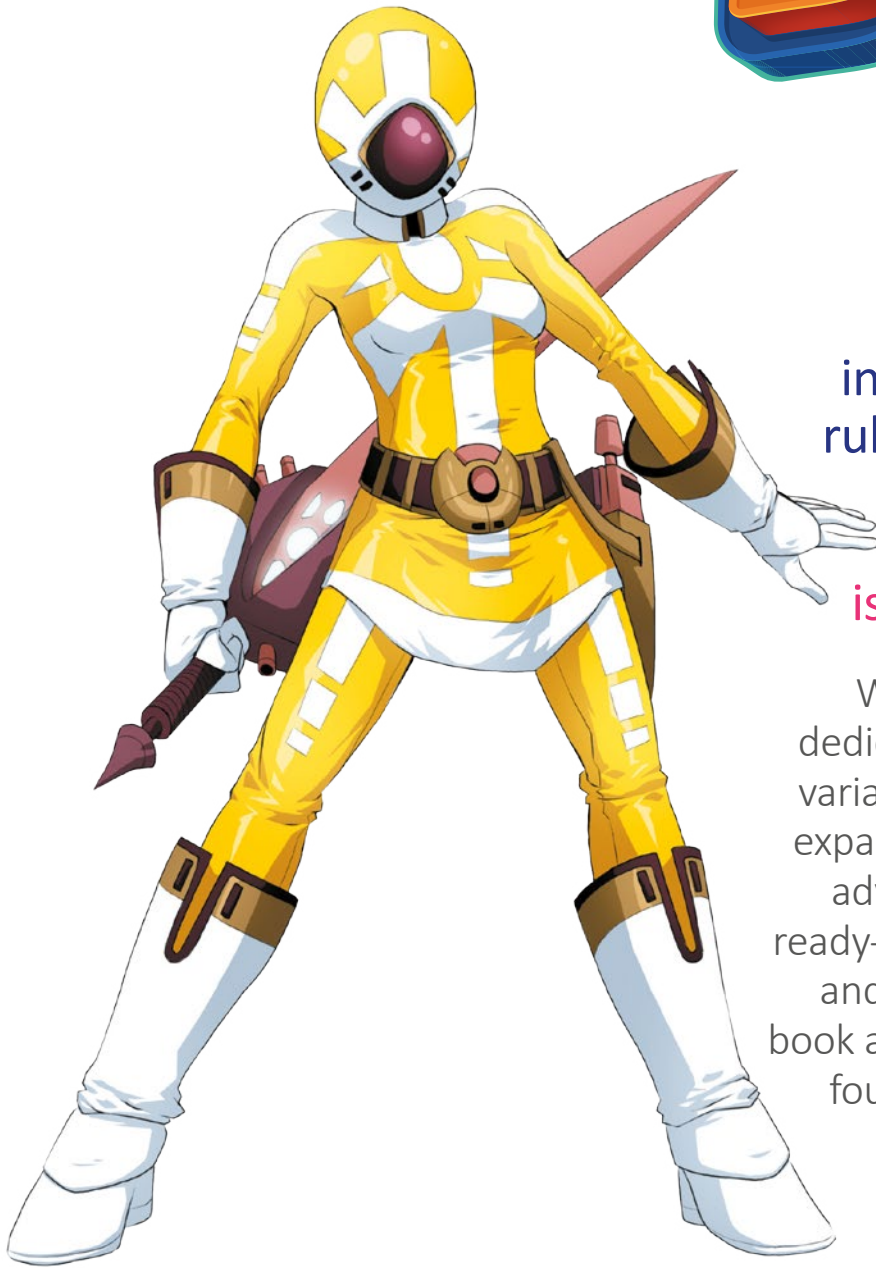


RULE EXPANSIONS AND CHARACTER OPTIONS

BESM

EXTRAS

FOURTH EDITION



In the myriad realms of imagination, there are an infinite number of expanded rules waiting to be unleashed

BESM EXTRAS
is the key to unlocking them

We proudly present an entire book dedicated to BESM Fourth Edition rule variations, extended game mechanics, expanded optional guidelines, creative adventuring elements, and plenty of ready-to-use examples – spells, powers, and items. Along with the BESM core book and BESM Naked, BESM Extras is a foundational pillar for the game line.

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BESM

EXTRAS

FOURTH EDITION

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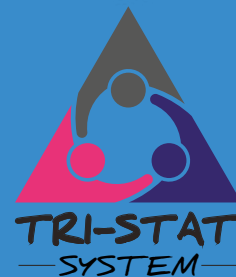
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While designing BESM Fourth Edition for its relaunch, I had a philosophy in mind that I believed would be vital to the game line's success: keep it simple and approachable. The foundational core rules needed to reflect the very best that anime and manga role-playing had to offer. To meet this immense expectation, I couldn't burden BESM with too many rules. The Tri-Stat System became larger and more complex as it moved from BESM 1e, to BESM 2e, to Silver Age Sentinels, to Tri-Stat dX, to BESM 3e – and I wanted BESM 4e to break this trend. The character options during creation would remain comprehensive, but I would streamline the game rules and only include what was essential to tell great stories.

This would leave many details out of BESM Fourth Edition, though, and I knew that a sizeable portion of gamers liked the extra crunch that more precise rules offered. Not just from a power-gamer perspective, of course, but also with an eye towards more dramatic narratives. What if a character wanted to push the magic potion out of the wizard's hand with a telekinetic blast? Or sit motionless on the hilltop for many minutes, staring through the laser rifle scope, to ensure their target wouldn't get the opportunity to complete the demonic summoning ritual? Or hold their Initiative action until the entire team was ready to combine their elemental attacks into one overwhelming effort? The BESM Fourth Edition core rules are sufficiently robust to allow for such actions – but wouldn't it be better if gaming groups had a set of rules to make this process easier?

BESM Extras was my solution to ensuring simplicity while retaining flexibility.

I don't consider BESM Extras to be a role-playing game expansion in the traditional sense. Rather, I see it more as a second core rulebook companion that was bundled as its own individual product; BESM 4B, if you will. Inside these pages you will find a wealth of extra rules and details for your anime and manga adventures that can be categorised into several primary areas:

Extended Choices – Additional Enhancements and Limiters for Attributes; new Defects; mechanical tweaks to existing offerings; expansions on the numbers of Levels and Ranks; etc.

Core Enhancements – Baseline values to reflect shock (for gritty games) and mental sanity (for horror games).

Alternative Offerings – The opportunity to use distinct individual Skills rather than bundled Skill Groups, including opportunities to vary Skill costs by genre.

Expanded Mechanics – Tactical actions; diverse combat manoeuvres; grappling mechanics; enhanced defence rules; guidance for using Attributes in combat; pushing powers; combined attacks; morale checks for NPCs; innovative rules that address mass combat on the battlefield and social combat at gala events; non-combat damage; expanded injury details.

Optional Rules – Critical hits and failures; margins of success; knockback; range penalties; alternate Stat costs; standardised character creation assignments; dynamic Initiative; giving players access to retroactive continuity or “retcon”; variable damage; running BESM as a diceless game.

Power Applications – Power Packs, which are groupings of Limiters and Enhancements; Power Bundles, which are pre-built collections of Attributes that are analogous to magical spells or spell-like effects.

Adventuring Elements – Poisons; disease; opponent Threat Scores; high-level character guidance; artificial intelligence considerations; firearm and vehicle customisation.

Creative Examples – Adventuring gear; items of power; mecha and vehicles; protective devices; weapons.

There is an enormous amount of gamer resources presented in BESM Extras, which ensures that there's something for everyone in this companion volume. Take as much as you like for your adventures, modify aspects to better suit the campaign needs for your group, use the examples to help you build your own alternatives, and discard the rest.

Thank you so much for once again granting me a seat at your gaming table.



Mark MacKinnon
August 2020

TABLE OF CONTENTS

CHAPTER 1: CORE GAME FRAMEWORK 4

Broadening Your Game	5
Attributes	5
Defects	11
Enhancements	12
Limiters	12
Reversed Modifiers	14
Shock Value	14
Sanity Points	15
Table-01: Sanity Rolls.....	15
Table-02: Sanity Spirals.....	16
Template Modification Math	17

CHAPTER 2: SKILLS 18

Beyond Skill Groups	19
Skill Ranks	19
Genius Skills	20
Skill Specialisations	20
Skill Entries	20
Varying Skill Costs by Genre	30
Table-03a: Modern Genre	31
Table-03b: Fantasy & Future Genres..	32
Table-03c: Historical Genre.....	33

CHAPTER 3: EXPANDED MECHANICS 34

Enhancing Your Rules	35
Tactical Actions	35
Aim	35
Wait for an Opening.....	35
Total Defence	35
Combat Flowchart	36
Combat Manoeuvres	35
Readying (Hold Actions).....	35
Attacks with Two Weapons	37
Called Shots	37
Multiple Targets with One Attack.....	40
Striking to Wound.....	40
Total Attack.....	40
Surprise Attack.....	40
Touching a Target.....	40
Grappling	40
Grappling Manoeuvres	41
Other Grappling Events.....	41
Expanded Combat Modifiers	43
Movement Attack Penalties	43
Firing From Moving Vehicles	43
Firing Weapons While Mounted	43
Attacking Moving Targets.....	43
Combat Roll Modifiers	43
Expanded Defence Rules	43
Defending with a Shield	43
Defending Others	44
Defending Against Multiple Attacks ..	44
No Need to Defend	44
Hedging Defence Rolls to Set TN.....	44

Using Attributes Defensively.....	44
Using Attributes in Combat	45
Offensive Use of Non-Weapons.....	45
Attribute vs. Attribute	45
Opposing Attribute Types	46
Table-04: Opposing Attribute Types..	46
Dynamic vs. Normal Powers	48
Pushing Your Powers	48
NPC Hedging	49
Combined Attacks	49
Multiple Edges and Obstacles	50
Morale for NPCs	51
Mass Combat	52
Social Combat	54
Table-05: Social Damage.....	55

CHAPTER 4: OPTIONAL RULES 56

Changing the Base	57
Critical Hits	57
Critical Failures	57
Table-06: Critical Failure.....	58
Margin of Success	58
Table-07: Margin of Success.....	58
Knockback	58
Range Penalties	59
Table-08: Range Penalties.....	59
Alternate Stat Costs	60
Table-09: Alternate Stat Costs	60
Alternate Attribute Costs	60
Fixed Attribute and Defect Levels ..	61
Table-10: Fixed Assignments	61
Player Retcon	61
Dynamic Initiative	62
Spreading Actions Across Initiative ...	62
Absolutes in BESM	63
Consolidated Combat Modifiers	63
Table-11: Defence Roll Modifiers	63
Table-12: Attack Roll Modifiers.....	64

CHAPTER 5: EXPLORING DAMAGE 66

Examining the Pain	67
Variable Damage Options	67
Modifying the Damage Multiplier.....	67
Modifying the Total Damage	67
Non-Combat Damage	68
Impact Damage	68
Crashing.....	68
Falling	68
Table-13: Impact Damage.....	68
Expanded Injury Rules	68
Shock	68
Knockout	69
Serious Injury	69
Wound Difficulty Penalties	69
Catastrophic Damage	69
Lethal to Stun Damage.....	69
Environmental Damage	70
Pain and Health Points	71
Enhanced Recovery	71

CHAPTER 6: PACKS AND BUNDLES 72

Power Packs	73
Crystallist Power Pack.....	74
Divine Power Pack	74
Psi Power Pack	74
Ritualist Power Pack	75
Shamanist Power Pack	75
Wizardry Power Pack.....	75
Power Bundles	76
Conjuration Bundles.....	76
Evocation Bundles	77
Perception Bundles	80
Spirit Bundles	83
Technology Bundles	84
Transformation Bundles.....	85

CHAPTER 7: ADVENTURING ELEMENTS 88

Adding Campaign Colour	89
Poisons	89
Disease	89
Deprivation	90
Table-14: Deprivation.....	90
Threat Scores for Opponents	91
Going Big	92
Artificial Intelligences	93
Firearms	94
Firearm Laws.....	95
Customising Firearms.....	99
Types of Ammunition.....	101
Vehicles	102
Customising Vehicles.....	103
Engagement Bonus	106
How Do I?	108

CHAPTER 8: ITEMS AND WEAPONS 110

Gear, Mecha, Devices, and More ..	111
Adventuring Gear	111
Daily Devices	116
Items of Power	118
Mecha and Vehicles	122
Protective Devices	126
Weapons	130

CHAPTER 9: DICELESS BESM 134

The Story's The Thing	135
Resolving Actions.....	135
Diceless Combat	135
Table-15: Diceless Combat Margins..	137
Diceless Example of Combat	138

INDEX 140



CHAPTER 1 CORE GAME FRAMEWORK

01: CORE FRAMEWORK

BROADENING YOUR GAME

Welcome to BESM Extras – the ultimate resource for rules variations, extended game mechanics, expanded optional guidelines, and plenty of ready-to-use examples.

BESM Fourth Edition presents a comprehensive collection of essential core character options, including 86 Attributes, 130 Enhancements and Limiters, and 36 Defects. This chapter expands that list by including additional options that can enhance your gameplay. Several of the alternatives can be assigned to any character, and the text indicates which others should only be applied when your game adventures incorporate specific optional rules that are detailed in later chapters.

As with all things BESM, the GM and player group can decide together which elements to use and which to ignore.

ATTRIBUTES

These entries are either new introductions to BESM that pair with optional game rules, or expansions that add a variety of choices to existing Attributes.

ABSORPTION

Attribute Cost: 5 Points/Level
Relevant Stat: Body

Additional modification is available for the Attribute.

► ENHANCEMENT

SYNERGISTIC

Damage can both be absorbed by this Attribute and converted by the character's Conversion Attribute (BESM4, page 86) at the same time.

► LIMITER

CAPPED

The character's Health or Energy Point total can never exceed its normal maximum value through the Absorption of damage.

ARMOUR

Attribute Cost: 2 Points/Level
Relevant Stat: —

Additional modification is available for the Attribute.

► LIMITER

GAP

The Armour has one or more small, unprotected gaps that can be targeted by a Called Shot (page 37) to either reduce its effectiveness by half (attacker suffers a minor obstacle on their roll) or ignore the Armour Rating completely (attacker suffers a major obstacle on their roll). This is a variation of the Localised Limiter (BESM4, page 151) specific to the Armour Attribute.

COMBAT TECHNIQUE

Attribute Cost: 1 Point/Level
Relevant Stat: —

Additional options are available for the Attribute if your game uses the various expanded game mechanics in BESM Extras.

BLACKOUT

Only assign this Technique in games using the Shock Value optional rule (page 14). The character has a talent for knocking their opponents unconscious when inflicting Stun damage (BESM4, page 141) and exceeding the target's Shock Value (page 14). Targets suffer minor obstacles to their Soul Stat rolls during Shock checks made as a result of such Stun attacks.

CRITICAL STRIKE

Using the optional critical hit rules (page 57), an attack is considered a critical hit if the attack roll exceeds the defence roll by a margin of 12 (for double damage) or 18 (for triple damage). This Technique increases final critical hit damage to triple damage or quadruple damage, respectively. Additionally, if the character's attack roll produces double sixes (a "natural 12") – but does not exceed the defence roll by a margin of at least 12 – the attack still inflicts double damage.

DEAD EYE

The character is adept at attacking fast-moving targets (page 43) and receives reduced penalties. Attacks suffering minor obstacles are made without penalty; attacks suffering major obstacles are instead reduced to minor obstacles. The edges that defenders gain on their defence rolls are not affected, though.

ENHANCED KNOCKBACK

Only assign this Technique in games using the Knockback optional rule (page 58). The character is proficient at staggering opponents in battle, and adds twice their Attack Combat Value, in metres, to the knockback distance inflicted upon the target of a successful hit.

FAR SHOT

The character excels at making ranged attacks at distances beyond an attack's effective range (page 59) and receives reduced penalties. Attacks suffering minor obstacles are made without penalty; attacks suffering major obstacles are instead reduced to minor obstacles.

HARDBOILED

Only assign this Technique in games using the Shock Value optional rule (page 14). The character is a survivor who can push their body beyond normal limits. For each Hardboiled assignment, increase the character's Shock Value by 10 (max of one-half Health Points.)

MULTIPLE TARGETS

The character is skilled at attacking multiple targets with a single action (page 40) and receives reduced penalties. Attacks suffering minor obstacles are made without penalty; attacks suffering major obstacles are instead reduced to minor obstacles. The edges that defenders gain on their defence rolls are not affected, though.

PRECISE AIM

The character shines when attempting attacks that require pinpoint accuracy and precision, and therefore receives reduced penalties. This includes making a called shot (page 37 – disarming, reducing or bypassing armour, striking a vital spot or weak point, etc.) or when attempting a special move or trick shot, such as carving an initial on someone's body or ricocheting an arrow off a wall to shoot a target around a corner. Attacks suffering minor obstacles are made without penalty; attacks suffering major obstacles are instead reduced to minor obstacles. Also, when the character uses tactical actions (page 35) in combat, they receive major edges on their associated attack rolls instead of minor edges.

RUSH ATTACK

The character can make aggressive rushing, leaping, or diving attacks in melee combat, delivering additional damage due to momentum. Any time the character has a higher Initiative than their opponent and is free to move, they may attempt a rush attack. If the attack roll is successful, the character gets an extra +1 to their Damage Multiplier when determining damage inflicted. If the character fails to hit, however, they are off balance and suffer a minor obstacle to all defence rolls until their turn to act in the following round.

STEADY HAND

The character can attack with ease while moving quickly, or is otherwise engaged in complex stunts (page 43) and receives reduced penalties. Attacks suffering minor obstacles are made without penalty; attacks suffering major obstacles are instead reduced to minor obstacles. A character with Steady Hand can also use tactical actions while in motion.

TWO WEAPONS

The character can fight effectively with two melee or ranged weapons at once against the same or different targets (page 37) – provided both weapons are designed for one-handed use – and consequently receives reduced penalties. Attacks suffering minor obstacles are made without penalty; attacks suffering major obstacles are instead reduced to minor obstacles.

Alternatively, the character may defend with two melee weapons when fighting multiple opponents. They are treated as having one Level of the Extra Defences Attribute (see below), but suffer minor obstacles on any attack rolls made in the same round.

The character can only use one of these two-weapon combat options each round, with any bonuses and penalties applying for the entire round.

CONVERSION

Attribute Cost: 3 Points/Level
Relevant Stat: Body

Additional modification is available for the Attribute.

► ENHANCEMENT**ESCALATE**

Counts as 2 Enhancements (Attribute effectiveness reduced by 2 Levels). Even attack damage that has been blocked by the character's Armour or Force Field Attributes can be converted into temporary Character Points.

EXTRA DEFENCES

Attribute Cost: 2 Points/Level
Relevant Stat: Mind

Only assign this Attribute in games using the Defending Against Multiple Attacks optional rule (page 44).

This Attribute reflects the character's ability to use every defensive combat situation to their advantage. Each round, the character may make one or more additional defensive actions. Penalties only apply after the extra defences are used. For example, penalties start applying only on the fifth defence for a character with Level 3 Extra Defences.

- Level 1 Gains 1 additional defence each round
- Level 2 Gains 2 additional defences each round
- Level 3 Gains 3 additional defences each round
- Level 4 Gains 4 additional defences each round
- Level 5 Gains 5 additional defences each round
- Level 6 Gains 6 additional defences each round

FORCE FIELD

Attribute Cost: 4 Points/Level
Relevant Stat: Body

Additional modification is available for the Attribute.

► ENHANCEMENT

AIR-TIGHT

The field prevents the passage of air molecules and is a beneficial defence against toxic gas and pathogens.

► LIMITER

IMPACTING

Only assign this Limiter in games using the Knockback optional rule (page 58). Whenever the character is hit with an impacting physical attack, they can feel its kinetic energy even though they may not receive any damage. Consequently, the character is affected by the attack's full Knockback value, before damage is reduced by the Force Field's Armour Rating.

IMMOVABLE

Attribute Cost: 1 Point/Level
Relevant Stat: Body

Only assign this Attribute in games using the Knockback optional rule (page 58).

Characters with this Attribute absorb physical impacts better than the average person, reducing the distance by which they are knocked back from impact attacks and forceful blows. If Immovable reduces a successful attack's Knockback distance to zero or below, the character has successfully shrugged off the forceful kinetic energy of the attack – but the attack still inflicts damage as normal.

- Level 1 Knockback distance reduced by 10 metres
- Level 2 Knockback distance reduced by 20 metres
- Level 3 Knockback distance reduced by 30 metres
- Level 4 Knockback distance reduced by 40 metres
- Level 5 Knockback distance reduced by 50 metres
- Level 6 Knockback distance reduced by 60 metres



MERGE

Attribute Cost: 4 Points/Level
Relevant Stat: —

Additional modification is available for the Attribute.

► **LIMITER****PROPORTIONAL DAMAGE**

If damaged Items combine into a new form with the Merge Attribute, some existing damage carries over to the new combined Item. Determine the normal, undamaged Health Point combined totals of all the individual Items prior to the merge. Then divide the sum of each Items' current (damaged) Health Points by that undamaged baseline to calculate the starting Health Points percentage. Finally, multiply the combined Item's normal Health Points (which is usually equal to the Item's Armour Rating, unless modified by Attributes or Defects) by that starting percentage to calculate the combined Item's starting Health Point total.

When a merged Item that was damaged while merged separates into the individual Items once again, divide the current (damaged) Health Points of the combined Item by its normal undamaged Health Points total to calculate the ending Health Points percentage. Multiply this ending total by each Item's individual, normal undamaged Health Points to determine their uncombined health status.

For example: A damaged jet (30 Health Points remaining from 60) and a damaged battleship (70 Health Points remaining from 140) merge into a battle-jet. The players originally constructed the combined battle-jet to have 120 Health Points normally. However, since both Items were damaged before combining, the merged battle-jet's new Health Point total is actually 60 ($30+70=100$; $60+140=200$; $100\div200=0.5$ or 50%; 50% of $120=60$).

After a gruelling combat against a superior mecha force in which massive amounts of damage were applied to both teams, assume the merged battle-jet has only 30 Health Points remaining. When the battle-jet separates, the individual mecha Items will each only have 25% remaining of their starting Health Point totals ($30\div120=0.25$). Consequently, the unmerged jet has been reduced to only 15 Health Points ($60\times0.25=15$) while the battleship has been reduced to only 35 Health Points ($140\times0.25=35$).

PLANT CONTROL

Attribute Cost: 1 Point/Level
Relevant Stat: Mind

Additional modification is available for the Attribute.

► **LIMITER****GROUP**

The character's control is restricted to a broad plant group, such as trees, grasses, weeds, bushes, flowers, mosses, vegetables, ferns, vines, seaweed, etc.

SPECIES

Counts as 2 Limiters (Attribute effectiveness increased by 2 Levels). The character's control is restricted to a specific type of plant, such as oak trees, wheat, dandelions, raspberry bushes, club moss, carrots, etc.

POWER FLUX

Attribute Cost: 10 Points/Level
Relevant Stat: Variable

Additional modification is available for the Attribute.

► **LIMITER****SKILL FLUX**

Only assign this version of Power Flux in games using specific Skills (see below) instead of Skill Groups.

The character can only reassign Flux Points within their repertoire of Skills and associated Specialisations (one Flux Point is equivalent to one Skill Point). It can represent someone with the paranormal ability or super-eidetic memory, or someone who can download or absorb knowledge from an external source such as spirits of the dead or programs on networks.

SKILLS

Attribute Cost: 1 Point/Level
Relevant Stat: Body, Mind, or Soul

Only assign this Attribute in games using specific Skills instead of Skill Groups (BESM4, page 120).

A Skill represents training or natural talent in a particular specific field, with the exception of actual weapons handling or unarmed combat, which is covered by other Attributes. There are many different Skills, each of them considered their own sub-Attribute rated in Ranks from 1 through 6. Acquiring multiple Skills is the ideal method for creating a versatile character. See page 19 for more details.

► SKILL COSTS

Each Level of this Attribute provides 10 Skill Points with which to acquire specific Skills. The Skill Point cost per Rank for each Skill is dependent on its anticipated general utility in the game. There are three classes of Skills, with different costs (from 1 to 3 Skill Points/Rank):

FRAMEWORK SKILLS (1 POINT/RANK)

These Skills only occasionally have a significant impact on an adventure, but are important for a character's background. In a typical game, Skills such as Domestic Arts, Languages, or Sports would be an example of a Framework Skill.

ADVENTURE SKILLS (2 POINTS/RANK)

These Skills are often used in many sessions. In a typical game, Skills such as Driving, Mechanics, and Street Sense are examples of Adventure Skills.

GENRE SKILLS (3 POINTS/RANK)

These Skills are vital to the focus of many storylines. In a typical game, Skills such as Acrobatics, Persuasion, and Stealth would be Genre Skills.

Table-03: Genre Skill Costs gives standard baseline multi-genre Point cost per Rank requirements for a wide range of Skills, though the Rank costs can vary in other genres as well. See page 30 for more details.

Level 1	10 Skill Points to acquire Skill Ranks
Level 2	20 Skill Points to acquire Skill Ranks
Level 3	30 Skill Points to acquire Skill Ranks
Level 4	40 Skill Points to acquire Skill Ranks
Level 5	50 Skill Points to acquire Skill Ranks
Level 6	60 Skill Points to acquire Skill Ranks

SKILLS VS. GROUPS

The decision whether your gaming group should use the Skill Groups as presented in the BESM core rules or switch to specific individual Skills instead depends entirely on your gaming style. Some players prefer the more granular approach afforded by individual Skills, especially for low-powered games in which ability differentiation is not as easily achieved through Attributes. Other players don't want to deal with the minutiae of a massive Skill list and instead prefer the wider application of talent and knowledge that Skill Groups provide. Less-experienced players will most likely have an easier time navigating the base Skill Groups.

SOCIAL MASTERY

Attribute Cost: 1 Point/Level
Relevant Stat: —

Only assign this Attribute in games using the expanded Social Combat game mechanics (page 54).

The character is experienced in a wide range of social engagements, and is adept at verbal sparring and rhetorical takedowns. Note that characters with high Mind and Soul Stats may be linguistically agile even without this Attribute, since the Social Combat Value (and thus Society Points) are derived from these Stats.

Level 1	Social Combat Value increases by 2
Level 2	Social Combat Value increases by 4
Level 3	Social Combat Value increases by 6
Level 4	Social Combat Value increases by 8
Level 5	Social Combat Value increases by 10
Level 6	Social Combat Value increases by 12

TELEPORT

Attribute Cost: 3 Points/Level
Relevant Stat: Mind

Additional modification is available for the Attribute.

► ENHANCEMENT

BLIND

The character can also translocate to unknown (and slightly less specific) destinations, such as "about 100 metres up" or "to the other side of the door". Normally, the character will not Teleport into any situation that could result in immediate death, though — such as rematerialising inside a wall.

UNASSAILABLE

Attribute Cost: 1 Point/Level
Relevant Stat: —

Only assign this Attribute in games using the Sanity Points optional rule (page 15).

Possessing this Attribute increases the Sanity Points of the character, allowing them to withstand the horrors of traumatic events. Note that characters with high Mind and Soul Stats may be spiritually resistant even without this Attribute, since Sanity Points are derived from these Stats.

Level 1	Sanity Points increase by 2
Level 2	Sanity Points increase by 4
Level 3	Sanity Points increase by 6
Level 4	Sanity Points increase by 8
Level 5	Sanity Points increase by 10
Level 6	Sanity Points increase by 12

01: CORE FRAMEWORK

WEAPON

Attribute Cost: 2 Points/Level

Relevant Stat: —

As an alternative rule, gaming groups may consider reducing Character Point costs when a character or Item has multiple Weapon Attributes. Furthermore, additional modification is available for the Attribute.

ALTERNATE ATTACKS

A character or Item may be assigned more than one Weapon Attribute. Since only one Weapon can be used in for a specific action, the gaming group may jointly decide that the Point cost of extra alternate, secondary Weapons should be reduced. Having two distinct alternate Weapon attacks is different than a Weapon that can used multiple types of ammunition (see the Alt-Munition Limiter in BESM4, page 142).

For this optional guideline, create each Weapon Attribute a character or Item has normally – then halve the Level cost to 1 Point/Level of all but the most expensive primary Weapon (or all but one of the most expensive, if several have identical costs). For example, Kaede the Witch has Weapon Level 5 “Lightning Bolt” with the Range 1 Enhancement and the Deplete 3 Limiter (effective Level 7) for a total cost of 10 Character Points. She also has Weapon Level 4 “Hand of Death” (with no modifiers), which normally costs 8 Character Points (2 Points/Level). The Hand of Death only costs half this normal amount at 1 Point/Level – 4 Points total, since it is a less-expensive secondary Weapon.

Each character and each of their Items are considered separate for this rule. Thus, if Kaede also had a sword and a magic wand, each containing Weapon Attributes, they would not receive the alternate attack discount, since each is a separate Item (and can be used separately, albeit at a penalty, using the Two Weapons rules, page 37). If an Item itself had multiple Weapon Attributes, however – such as a wand capable of several distinct attacks – then all but the most costly Weapon Attribute contained in that Item would be eligible for such a discount. And then as normal, the total Attribute cost (including discounted secondary Weapon Attributes) would be halved when determining the final Character Point cost of the Item.

Multiple Weapons Attributes assigned to an Item (such as a vehicle or location) with several crew members are usually assigned the Helper Enhancement. This allows passengers to simultaneously fire the Weapon instead of the driver or pilot. Weapons designated with the Helper Enhancement, whether primary Weapons (most costly) or secondary Weapon (less costly), are never considered when determining alternate attack discounts; ignore their presence completely.

► ENHANCEMENT

KNOCKBACK

Only assign this Enhancement in games using the Knockback optional rule (page 58). The attack impacts the target forcefully, knocking them back one metre for every point of damage inflicted. The Armour Attribute is ignored when determining Knockback distance; Force Fields without the Impacting Limiter do reduce Knockback, however. This Enhancement is primarily for Weapons with high kinetic energy, and is not typically assigned to slashing, piercing, or other non-impacting attacks. The Weapon’s final Knockback distance is doubled each time this Enhancement is assigned – after all modifiers are considered (such as the Enhanced Knockback Combat Technique, page 5, and numerous damage modifiers).



DEFECTS

BESM Extras introduces three new Defects: one for reduced aptitude during combative social engagements, one for characters who do not heal normally, and one associated with Sanity Point reduction.

DEMURE

A Lesser Defect. Only assign this Defect in games using the expanded Social Combat game mechanics (page 54). The character is more susceptible to shame and embarrassment during hostile social engagements than their Mind and Soul Stats otherwise suggest. With the reduction of Social Combat Value, the character's Society Points are similarly decreased.

-1 Point	Social Combat Value decreases by 2
-2 Points	Social Combat Value decreases by 4
-3 Points	Social Combat Value decreases by 6

NO HEALING

A Greater Defect. The character does not regain lost Health Points through normal recovery rules (BESM4, page 195). Rather, the player and GM will work together to determine the conditions under which Health Points are returned and how quickly they recover. Examples of such special conditions include: bathing in a specific rejuvenation pool, returning to the mechanic shop for repair, undertaking specific purification rites, meditating to unleash the character's consciousness, eating a special plant or animal, engaging in a particular physical activity, etc.

This Defect is most appropriate for non-biological lifeforms that are repaired instead of healed, but may also apply to flesh-and-bone characters that must undertake specific steps before healing from injury.

-2 Point	The healing conditions and recovery rate impose a slight disadvantage
-4 Points	The healing conditions and recovery rate impose a moderate disadvantage
-6 Points	The healing conditions and recovery rate impose a severe disadvantage

UNSETTLED

A Lesser Defect. Only assign this Defect in games using the Sanity Points optional rule (page 15). The character is more susceptible to experiencing trauma from horrific events than their Mind and Soul Stats would otherwise suggest.

-1 Point	Sanity Points are decreased by 2
-2 Points	Sanity Points are decreased by 4
-3 Points	Sanity Points are decreased by 6

PHYSICAL VS. SOCIAL DEFECTS

In an effects-based RPG system like the Tri-Stat System used in BESM, the intended outcome of what players and GMs are trying to achieve is more important than the precise name by which the powers are called. For example, the Change State Attribute at Level 6 allows a character to become incorporeal. This could be assigned to indicate the ability to shift the character's body into the astral plane, which isn't precisely incorporeal – but carries the same game effect. In this situation, the naming is irrelevant.

But labels do matter and words have power. Consequently, it is vital to carefully consider the implications on your player group when slotting certain character disadvantages into Defects.

For example, post traumatic stress disorder (PTSD) and depression (amongst many other examples) are real-life struggles that may be expressed through both psychological and physical components. Would characters with PTSD have the Social Fault Defect or Physical Impairment Defect—or something else entirely? Even breaking down the Defect label into "Social" and "Fault" may imply aspects that are offensive or hurtful to some players who have experience with PTSD – a disorder that is very real and physical, and isn't a person's "fault". Many similar psychological vs. physical examples (sometimes framed as "nature vs. nurture" developments) can be found across a wide spectrum of real-life challenges, such as chemical and social addictions, societal stigmas, mental health challenges, and more. For such character disadvantages, there isn't one specific way that they should be applied.

When in doubt, always choose the option that avoids harm and conflict. If it's difficult to see a resolution to an issue in your gaming group – and it perhaps has the potential to adversely affect the comfort of one or more players – it is always best to put the matter aside and not integrate those character ideas into the game.

As a universal role-playing game system, BESM won't get it all right. With careful consideration of labels in your game group, though, such character aspects can be addressed with non-judgemental compassion.

ENHANCEMENTS

In BESM4 (page 145), the effects of four standard Enhancements – Area, Duration, Range, and Targets – are described up to 6 Assignments. Should your game adventures require greater ranges due to the heightened character power levels, they have been included below.

AREA

7 Assignments	Affects a country-sized Area (1,000 km radius)
8 Assignments	Affects a planet-sized Area (10,000 km radius)
9 Assignments	Affects an orbital-sized Area (100,000 km radius)
10 Assignments	Affects an Area the size of a large lunar distance (1M km radius; the space between a planet and its moons)
11+ Assignments	Previous Area x10

DURATION

7 Assignments	Remains in effect for 1 year (or 1 week for Weapons)
8 Assignments	Remains in effect for 10 years (or 1 month for Weapons)
9 Assignments	Remains in effect for 100 years (or 1 year for Weapons)
10 Assignments	Permanent (GM permission); or remains in effect for 1,000 years (or 10 years for Weapons)
11+ Assignments	Previous Weapon Duration x10 (no further progression needed for non-Weapons, since those durations are already permanent)

RANGE

7 Assignments	Country-sized Range (1,000 km)
8 Assignments	Planet-sized Range (10,000 km)
9 Assignments	Orbital-sized Range (100,000 km)
10 Assignments	Lunar distance-sized Range (1M km)
11+ Assignments	Previous Range x10

TARGETS

7 Assignments	Affect up to 250 Targets at once
8 Assignments	Affect up to 500 Targets at once
9 Assignments	Affect up to 1,000 Targets at once
10 Assignments	Affect up to 2,500 Targets at once
11+ Assignments	Previous Targets x2 or x2.5

EFFECTIVE GAME DURATION

For most fast-paced RPG scenarios, the impact of an Attribute with a Duration Enhancement of one month, week, or even day may have the same game effectiveness as one that is permanent. To reflect this game reality and to keep Attribute costs reasonable for ones that are intended to be “permanent”, the GM may allow 3-5 Duration assignments to indicate permanence rather than requiring Duration to be assigned 10 times.

LIMITERS

BESM4's Unique Limiter is best suited to address a wide variety of specific restrictions on an Attribute's use, though BESM Extras introduces one intriguing new entry that can be assigned either as a Limiter or an Enhancement, depending on the Attribute.

ACCELERATION

The base effect of many Attributes – such as Illusion, Metamorphosis, Transfer, and more – remain in effect for one minute or dramatic scene, as outlined in their descriptions. The Acceleration Limiter can be assigned, with GM permission, to shorten this effective time as most appropriate for the Attribute and player's vision for the character.

ACCELERATION AS AN ENHANCEMENT

Although shortening an Attribute's described one minute time limit is usually a drawback, it can instead act as an advantage for Power Flux and Power Variation Attributes. In these instances, Flux Points or Character Points can only be reassigned every minute, and so reducing this waiting time is beneficial to the character. Consequently, Acceleration can be assigned as an Enhancement to these two Attributes rather than a Limiter (with GM permission, of course).

0 Assignments	Remains in effect as long as the Attribute description indicates (which is usually one minute or dramatic scene)
1 Assignment	Remains in effect for 30 seconds (10 rounds)
2 Assignments	Remains in effect for 5 rounds
3 Assignments	Remains in effect for 2 rounds
4 Assignments	Remains in effect for 1 round
5 Assignments	Remains in effect for 1-2 seconds
6 Assignments	The effect is instantaneous or has no significant duration



MITORY

NO
FISHING
FROM
BRIDGE

D...
SQUARE
PARK

This park was established in 1897 on
by the city. In 1918, landscape ar-
chitects designed the park, in-
creased and expanded the park, in-
struction began the construction
the public in the winter of 1919
during the American Civil War.
In 1919, the city of 1875, in
response, Richard Morris, mayor
dedicated all the land 20th cen-
tury in 1919, which was
the

HAYWIRE

The character's Attribute is unstable. Whenever the character encounters a specific substance or condition, the Attribute fluctuates wildly and cannot be easily controlled. Depending on the specific Attribute, it may go Haywire automatically or only if the character activates its use. For example, the Attribute may cease to function, or only operate at its maximum effectiveness, temporarily increase or decrease several Levels of effectiveness, apply its power in reverse, etc. The unpredictable effects are at the discretion of the Game Master each time the Attribute goes Haywire, though the change to the Attribute is temporary. Since Haywire is a Limiter, the Attribute's bizarre effects will cause difficulty for the character, but should not impact the character in needlessly cruel ways.

- | | |
|---------------|--|
| 1 Assignment | The substance or condition is rare (meteor rock, ginger, eucalyptus, hurricanes), and the fluctuation lasts for one to several rounds. |
| 2 Assignments | The substance or condition is uncommon (gold, cinnamon, bamboo, storms), and the fluctuation lasts for one minute or dramatic scene. |
| 3 Assignments | The substance or condition is common (lead, pepper, maple tree, rain), and the fluctuation lasts for one to several hours. |

IGNORE

The Attribute does not register a specific substance (such as wood, metal, lead, marble, etc.), a specific colour (such as yellow, blue, green, etc.), or a specific condition (such as one emotion, shape, number, environment, etc.) – which is known as the “aspect”. The Attribute cannot detect objects, characters, or situations exhibiting traits of that aspect, and does not function against them. For example, a Weapon with Ignore: Joy does not work against targets who are happy. Similarly, an Ignore: Green Limiter assigned to the Transmute Attribute indicates that green objects are effectively invisible to the transmute ability and are thus not affected.

The Ignore Limiter is typically only assigned to Attributes that affect or sense items directly, such as Mind Control, Teleport, Transmute, Weapons, etc. Many Attributes (such as Flight, Healing, Superspeed, etc.) affect the character or their surroundings rather than an aspect, and consequently the Ignore Limiter cannot apply. The GM and players should work together to establish the parameters of Ignore and ensure the concepts are reasonable and balanced for the game.

- | | |
|---------------|--|
| 1 Assignment | The substance, colour, or condition plays a rare role in the game. Examples include marble stone, a specific shade of yellow, paranoia, pentagrams, etc. |
| 2 Assignments | The substance, colour, or condition plays an uncommon role in the game. Examples include wood, teal, jealousy, numbers divisible by 10, etc. |
| 3 Assignments | The substance, colour, or condition plays a common role in the game. Examples include metal, blue, fear, circles, etc. |

REVERSED MODIFIERS

Enhancements and Limiters normally only apply to Attributes. Gaming groups that enjoy pushing the boundaries of what is possible in systems may consider reversing these modifiers and applying them to Defects as well. Enhancements can act as Limiters and decrease the Defect's effective functioning baseline by 1 Assignment. Conversely, Limiters can act as Enhancements and increase the Defect's effective functioning by 1 Assignment. Not every modifier is appropriate for every Defect, of course, and so groups must consider each situation carefully.

For example, one assignment of the Area Limiter to the -4 Point “moderate” Ism Defect could indicate that the discrimination the character receives also impacts nearby allies in a 3-metre radius. This Limiter decreases the effective Defect from “moderate” to “slight” – but still returns the 4 Points associated with “moderate”. Another example: adding a Delay Enhancement to the Marked Defect could indicate a mark that appears after a certain period of time, and thus is more obvious once it finally manifests (eg. from easy to difficult to conceal).

SHOCK VALUE

For games in which the GM and players want damage to have more realistic effects, characters should also calculate an additional Derived Value (see BESM4, page 169) called Shock Value. If a character suffers an amount of damage equal to or greater than their Shock Value from a single attack or other trauma, there is a danger that the character will be stunned or knocked out, or suffer a serious injury. For more information on the application of Shock Value and damage, see page 68.

Your character's Shock Value is equal to their normal maximum Health Points divided by 5. Increase Shock Value by +10 for each assignment of the Combat Technique (Hardboiled) Attribute (page 6). Shock Value cannot exceed one-half the character's normal maximum Health Point total.

SANITY POINTS

For gritty horror games and paranormal/occult adventures that explore the ephemeral nature of reality and humanity, characters should also calculate an additional Derived Value (see BESM4, page 169) called Sanity Points.

Sanity Points represent a character's relationship with reality and conscious understanding of the greater world. Traumatic situations that befall a character can subtract from their current number of Sanity Points, as can revelations that strain the fabric of a character's perceived existence. Once a character's Sanity Points fall to 5 or below, their grasp on lucidity and rationality begins to falter as their mind slips into eventual madness.

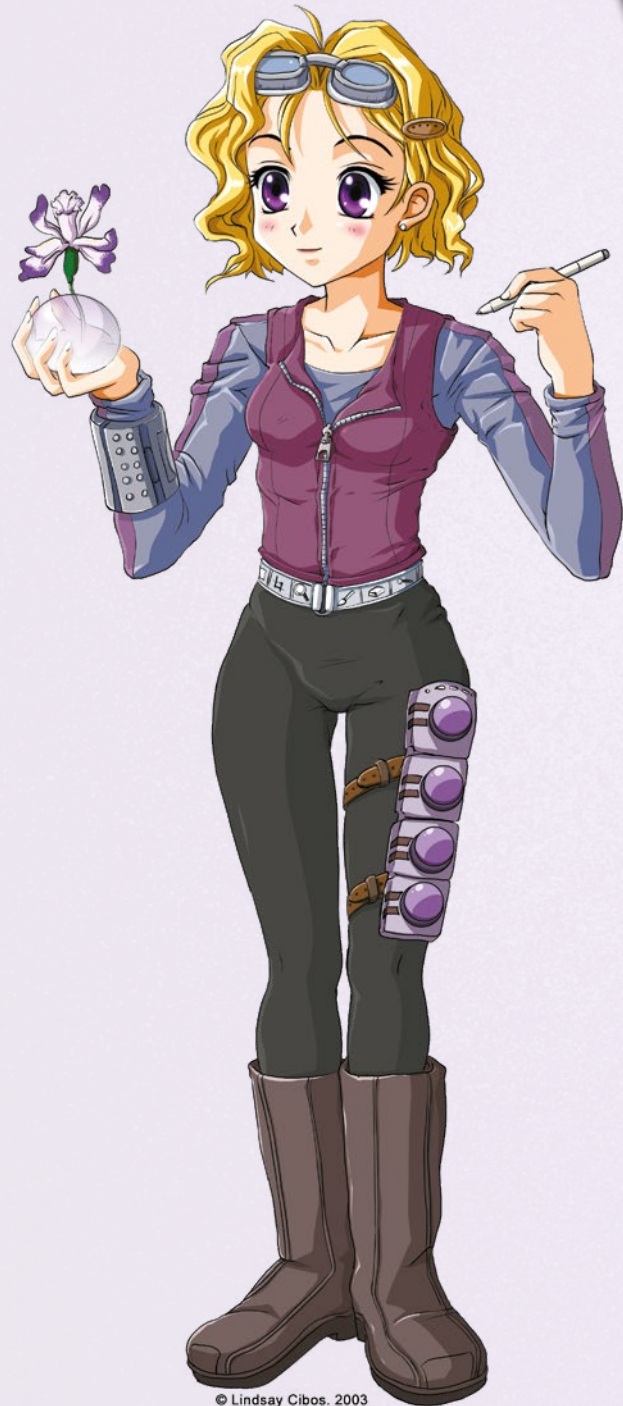
Your character's base number of Sanity Points is equal to the sum of the Mind Stat and Soul Stat. Increase Sanity Points by +2 for every Level of the Unassailable Attribute (page 9). Reduce Sanity Points by -2 for every -1 Rank of the Unsettled Defect (page 11).

► SANITY ROLLS

Whenever a character is confronted by a traumatic experience or otherwise perceives an odd event that challenges their understanding of reality, the GM may ask for a Sanity roll. Similar to a Stat roll, the success of a Sanity roll is determined by rolling two dice and then adding the average (rounded down) of the character's Mind and Soul Stats. The result is the total roll, which is compared to a Target Number (see BESM4; page 177) to determine if the task was successful.

CONSIDERATION FOR SKILLS

The GM may allow certain individual Skills presented in BESM Extras (page 20) to apply to the Sanity roll when appropriate – such as the Cultural Arts, Occult, or Religion Skills, depending on the potential traumatic encounter – which parallels the game mechanics of a Skill roll (BESM4, page 179).



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PAGE
15

1

SANITY ROLLS

Magnitude of Trauma	Target Number (TN)	Sanity Point Reduction With Failure	Situational Examples
Insufficiently Traumatic	Below 12	–	A frightening event, but not one that challenges reality
Mildly Traumatic	12	0	Slight phobia; a terrifying encounter that induces fight-or-flight
Moderately Traumatic	15	1	Moderate phobia; discovering a dead body; shocking knowledge
Majorly Traumatic	18	2	Major phobia; witnessing horrific violence; forbidden knowledge
Severely Traumatic	21	3	Encountering minor demon; frightening paranormal event
Catastrophically Traumatic	24	4	Encountering major demon; experiencing soul possession

SANITY SPIRALS

Sanity Points Remaining	Suggested Game Effects
5	Minor hallucinations; mild paranoia
4	Minor obstacles on all dice rolls
3	Major hallucinations; major paranoia
2	Major obstacles on all dice rolls
1	Dissociation; loss of ability to speak
0	Catatonic; broken mind

SETTING THE TARGET NUMBER

GMs should assign Target Numbers for Sanity rolls based on how traumatic the situation would be for the character. Consult Table-01: Sanity Rolls (page 15) when determining the appropriate Target Numbers. Encounters with TNs less than 12 are typically not sufficiently traumatic to require a Sanity roll.

CONSEQUENCES OF FAILURE

A successful Sanity roll produces no effect, indicating that the character has processed and come to terms with their confronted trauma. A failed roll may cause the character to freeze, attack wildly, or run away (a traditional fight-or-flight response), and may also reduce the character's current number of Sanity Points by 0-4 as indicated in Table-01: Sanity Rolls.

REPEATED EXPOSURE

Characters can become desensitised to shocking and traumatic situations with repeated exposure, as they adjust to their personal realities and the horrors of the world. Subsequent similar encounters that require a Sanity roll – such as witnessing a second gruesome murder or facing (yet another) summoned demon – are made at one rank lower on the Target Number scale. For example, a severely traumatic event has a TN 21 the first time, with highly similar subsequent events reducing to TN 18 then TN 15 then TN 12. Horrific trauma that is sufficiently different than earlier encounters still requires a Sanity roll with normal Target Numbers, though.

► SANITY EFFECTS

Once a character's Sanity Points are reduced to 5 or lower, their mind starts fracturing from the traumatic pressure and their hold on reality begins to slip away. Table-02: Sanity Spirals presents suggested game effects through which a character suffers at low Sanity Point values. Since many of the effects of sanity loss are not strictly defined, role-playing opportunities abound for

the players and GMs as the character tries to navigate their altered reality. Characters that reach zero Sanity Points are effectively unplayable, since they do not interact with the world meaningfully.

► RECOVERING SANITY POINTS

Sanity Points do not normally recover on their own without intervention on behalf of the character, which helps them understand and come to terms with their experienced trauma. Situations that might increase a character's Sanity Points by 1 or 2 ranks can include:

- » Therapeutic counselling
- » Reassurance/attention from a friend or loved one
- » Self-guided healing, which may include reading, research, meditation, reframing, reflection, etc.
- » Mind-altering interference (such as Mind Control; see BESM4, page 108)
- » Supernatural healing or other paranormal powers
- » Divine or otherworldly intervention
- » Pharmaceuticals, both legal and illicit
- » Surgical procedures

STATS OF ZERO

It is sometimes appropriate for BESM characters (usually NPCs) to have Stats of zero, or effectively no Stat. For example, the gaming group may decide that a ghost should have a 0 Body Stat, a zombie should have a 0 Mind Stat, and a robot have a 0 Soul Stat (see Artificial Intelligences, page 93, for more detail on AIs). It's important to consider how zero or no Stat value impacts Derived Values and dice roll calculations.

For Stats that are so low they are effectively zero – such as a mindless creature – it's usually best to count the Stat as a zero. Consequently, a zombie with Body 6, Mind 0, and Soul 0 would have a Combat Value of 2 (since $6 + 0 + 0 \div 3 = 2$).

For Stats that could be considered missing instead of simply really low – such as for ghosts with 0 Body Stat and for AIs with 0 Soul Stat – Derived Values ignore the contribution of the missing Stat. For example, a ghost character with no Body, Mind 8, and Soul 4 would have a Combat Value of 6 (since $8 + 4 \div 2 = 6$). The missing Body Stat is ignored completely and not counted as 0.

TEMPLATE MODIFICATION MATH

Sometimes a Race, Class, or Size Template mostly fits your character concept, but there are a couple of aspects that don't quite align with your vision. Perhaps you want a tiny character who's stronger than normal humans, but the Rank -2 Tiny Size Template (BESM4, page 35) indicates otherwise. Conversely, you might envision a catperson character that was cruelly declawed as a child, yet the Nekojin Race Template (BESM4, page 46) has both the Features and Weapon Attributes that include claw abilities. Fortunately, the math of modifying Templates is easy to apply to nearly any character you can create, as indicated below.

DELETING ATTRIBUTES RETURNS POINTS

If a player wants to delete certain Attributes from a Template, simply do not include the Point costs in the Template total. For example, the Nekojin Template is reduced from 10 Points to 7 Points by removing the Retractable Claws Feature (reducing the Attribute from Level 2 to 1) and eliminating the Weapon Attribute.

YOU CAN BUY OFF DEFECTS

Players can also eliminate Template Defects for their characters by paying the additional Point cost to buy off the disadvantage. For example, applying the Dark Elf Template (BESM4, page 39) to an underworld elf that has lived on the surface world for so long that they have become accustomed to sunlight costs 23 Points instead of the normal 20 Points – once the Rank 1 Sensory Impairment Defect (which was at -3 Points) is removed.

ADDING ATTRIBUTES CANCELS DEFECTS

Furthermore, Attributes considered the opposite of specific Defects can be added to cancel the disadvantage along the positive/negative spectrum, with any leftover Attributes applying as normal.

For example, lifting capacity and muscle-powered damage for a Rank -2 Tiny Size Template returns 16 Points, since both are lower than for a medium-sized character. These two size-related Defects are effectively the opposite of four Levels of the Superstrength Attribute (also 16 Points). Consequently, assigning six Levels of Superstrength (24 Points) to a tiny-sized character results in the cancellation of two Unique Defects (-20 Strength Damage and +25 Lifting Capacity) – nullifying four Levels of Superstrength – with the character gaining the remaining Superstrength Level 2 (costing 8 Points). The modified strong Tiny Template thus costs a total of 4 Character Points instead of returning 20 Character Points (since the base of $-20 + 24$ new = 4).

ADDING DEFECTS CANCELS ATTRIBUTES

The converse to the above rule is also true, with Defects nullifying their opposite Attribute counterparts. For example, assigning 3 Ranks of the Fragile Defect to a Dwarf Template (BESM4, page 40) that normally has Level 2 Tough results in a modified Template with no Tough Attribute and a -1 Point Fragile Defect (and a net -10 Health Points). The total final modified Dwarf Race Template cost is 12 instead of 15 Points.

APPLIES TO ADVANCEMENT AS WELL

Although this section is about modifying Templates, these same rules apply when adding Attributes or Defects through advancement (see BESM4, page 303).





CHAPTER 2

SKILLS

BEYOND SKILL GROUPS

This section is provided as an alternative to the Skill Groups Attribute (BESM4, page 120), since some players and Game Masters may prefer a more granular option that reduces bundling of acquired knowledge and talent.

Your character's Skills represent their extensive training and experience in a particular field. Each Skill can be thought of as a sub-Attribute with certain special rules applying to them. A character does not need to have any Skills, but they can be very useful during adventures, and are a good way to distinguish the character (especially in lower-powered games).

Instead of the Skill Groups Attribute, assign the Skills Attribute (page 8) to your character during their initial creation or subsequent advancement to acquire one or more Skills at various Ranks.

The different Skills are divided into Ranks from 1 through 6, but may optionally go higher with GM permission. Increasing the value of a Skill by one Rank requires 1-3 Skill Points (provided by the Skills Attribute) depending on the Skill.

The higher the Skill Rank, the better your character is and the broader their knowledge within the field. Characters with high Stats can be exceptionally proficient within a field even without high Skill Ranks, though; they are considered "naturals." Characters typically have a couple of Levels of the Skills Attribute and thus only have a few specific Skills assigned. In a lower-powered Sub-Human or Human level game – such as one focussed on ordinary high school students – characters might not have any Skills assigned at all, or perhaps just a single Rank in a general Skill like Domestic Arts, Gaming, Sports, Writing, or Visual Arts.

SKILL RANKS

Skills are normally limited to six Ranks, with each Rank providing a +1 bonus on Skill rolls to succeed in a task governed by that Skill (BESM4, page 179).

Ranks 1 and 2 indicate a developing talent, or moderate training or practice with that Skill. For example, Medical Rank 1 or 2 represents the sort of experience that a typical nurse, paramedic, or young family doctor might possess. Similarly, a low-ranking army officer (lieutenant or captain) would probably have Military Sciences at Rank 1 or 2. Rank 1 can also represent the "end result" of a graduate or post-graduate degree.

Ranks 3 and 4 indicate considerable experience with a particular Skill. For example, Medical Rank 3 or 4 represents the talents that a hospital surgeon or a family doctor with years of practice will have. Similarly, a seasoned knight who has lead several successful campaigns might have Military Sciences at Rank 3 or 4.

Rank 5 and 6 indicate a true expert in a particular Skill. For example, Medical Rank 5 or 6 would represent a doctor who is renowned as a life saver and hero. Similarly, a decorated colonel or general field commander would have Military Sciences at Rank 5 or 6.

- Rank 1 Developing – The character is gaining proficiency with the Skill through regular application
- Rank 2 Trained – The character has moderate training and practice with the Skill
- Rank 3 Expert – The character has significant training and practice with the Skill
- Rank 4 Veteran – The character has extensive training and practice with the Skill
- Rank 5 Master – The character has exhaustive training and practice with the Skill
- Rank 6 Grand Master – The character has unparalleled ability and knowledge with the Skill

Higher Ranks beyond Rank 6 are potentially possible (see Genius Skills, page 20) but relative expertise and depth of knowledge can often be better represented by the difference in Stats and Attributes. For example, two police officers may both be expert detectives (each with Police Sciences Rank 5), but the superior officer may also have higher Stats or related Attributes.

CASUAL SKILL EXPOSURE

No Skill Ranks are needed to indicate casual expertise within a specific field. For example, someone who simply drives a car on their way to work or has passed an introductory first aid course would not require Driving Rank 1 or Medical Rank 1. Similarly, a junior member of a criminal street gang may know a thing or two about breaking and entering, but probably lacks the ongoing training and experience to require Burglary Rank 1. Also, a student who has taken a high school or even undergraduate university course probably doesn't have a Skill Rank in that associated field. That is, unless they were particularly interested in the course material or had a particular affinity for it.

INFORMAL EDUCATION

Conversely, a character may have high Skill Ranks without any formal training, because they have used the Skill in daily life for many years (such as a brawny farm worker having the Powerlifting Skill). Characters should rarely possess Skill Ranks above Rank 4, since this achievement reflects an incredibly high degree of proficiency. A character with a Skill Rank of 5 or 6 is widely regarded as one of the best in their field.

► GENIUS SKILLS

A Skill Rank beyond the usual Rank 6 limit is considered a “Genius Skill” that represents an unusual mastery in that field. For example, a mechanical genius character might have the Mechanic Skill at Rank 8. The GM may thus allow characters or NPCs to have Genius Skills if their background supports it. A character with a Genius Skill might even have the Hounded Defect (BESM4, page 158) to represent their fame and recognition. It is strongly recommended that genius Skill Ranks in BESM never exceed Level 12.

► SKILL SPECIALISATIONS

A character can optionally select one Specialisation for each Skill, such as bowyer/fletcher, blacksmithy, carpentry, enchanting objects, leatherworking, metalworking, plumbing, pottery, tailoring, or woodworking for the Artisan Skill. This single Specialisation comes with the Skill at no extra Skill Point cost. The character may acquire additional Specialisations for a particular Skill at a cost of 1 extra Skill Point. Additionally, gaming groups could also Specialisation rules to the BESM Skill Groups Attribute (BESM4, page 120), if desired.

Each Skill entry herein suggests several Specialisation options, though alternate ones can be assigned instead with GM permission.

SPECIALISATION BENEFITS

When the character makes a Skill roll (BESM4, page 179) that is influenced by their specific matching Specialisation, a minor edge (BESM4, page 182) is applied to the roll. If the roll was already receiving a minor edge for some reason, the benefit increases to a major edge (see Multiple Edges and Obstacles, page 50).

SKILL ENTRIES

Each Skill has its own description, which indicates possible game effects and the Stat that is usually most relevant to the Skill’s use, should a Skill roll be needed. Rules for using Skills in play are identical to those for Skill Groups and are described in BESM4, page 179.

The Skill Point cost per Rank for each Skill is dependent on its anticipated general utility in the game. There are three classes of Skills, with different costs (from 1 to 3 Skill Points/Rank):

- » Framework Skills costs 1 Point/Rank, and only occasionally have a major impact on an adventure, but are important for a character’s background.
- » Adventure Skills costs 2 Points/Rank, and are often used in many sessions.
- » Genre Skills costs 3 Points/Rank, and are vital to the focus of many storylines.

The Multi-Genre Skill category reflects the default Rank cost for typical action-oriented adventures. Table-03: Genre Skill Costs provides alternative costs for games that focus on a particular genre such as romance or law enforcement, where certain Skills are more or less important than the default multi-genre cost assumption.

DESIGNING NEW SKILLS

If you need to create a new Skill for your character to expand beyond that which is presented here, simply determine if the new Skill would best be described as a Framework Skill, Adventure Skill, or Genre Skill. Once you’ve determine the cost of the Skill, select an appropriate Specialisation that applies to your character. New Skills must be approved by the Game Master, of course.



ACROBATICS

Multi-Genre Cost: 3 Points/Level

Relevant Stat: Body

Specialisations: Balance, Flexibility, Jumps, Tumbling

The ability to perform feats of agility with minimal chance for injury. Includes jumping, flipping, contorting, and reacting quickly.

ANIMAL TRAINING

Multi-Genre Cost: 2 Points/Level

Relevant Stat: Soul

Specialisations: Any single animal such as bears, dogs, dolphins, horses, raccoons, etc.

The ability to teach and train animals with an intellect above that of instinctive insects. An animal usually has a Mind Stat of 1-2.

ARCHITECTURE

Multi-Genre Cost: 1 Point/Level

Relevant Stat: Mind

Specialisations: Aquatic, Bridges, Fortifications, Small Buildings, Skyscrapers

Knowledge of construction methods, architectural drafting, etc. A successful use of this Skill can also find weak points in constructions or help in locating old structural plans.

AREA KNOWLEDGE

Multi-Genre Cost: 2 Points/Level

Relevant Stat: Mind

Specialisations: One specific locale (city, forest, sea, desert, mountain) within the area

Knowledge of the geography and people of a single area (choose one area) and a specific locale within it. The smaller the area, the more detailed and extensive the character's knowledge. This Skill may be assigned multiple times to indicate knowledge of several areas.

ARTISAN

Multi-Genre Cost: 1 Point/Level

Relevant Stat: Average of Body and Soul

Specialisations: Bowyer / Fletcher, Blacksmithy, Carpentry, Enchanting Objects, Leatherworking, Metalworking, Plumbing, Pottery, Tailoring, Woodworking

This Skill represents a character's ability to work with a variety of materials to repair or produce useful or aesthetically pleasing objects (not electronic or mechanical).

BIOLOGICAL SCIENCES

Multi-Genre Cost: 2 Points/Level

Relevant Stat: Mind

Specialisations: Astrobiology, Bacteria/Viruses, Bioengineering, Botany, Genetics, Physiology, Zoology

This diverse field covers scientific knowledge of how living things survive, thrive, and function.

BOATING

Multi-Genre Cost: 2 Points/Level

Relevant Stat: Average of Body and Mind

Specialisations: Hovercraft, Hydrofoils, Large Ships, Small Boats, Submarines

The ability to safely operate a watercraft.

BURGLARY

Multi-Genre Cost: 2 Points/Level

Relevant Stat: Body or Mind

Specialisations: Breaking-and-Entering, Disarming Physical Traps, Hot-Wiring, Safe Cracking

The ability to open locks, quietly cut glass, hot-wire car ignitions, etc. The ability does not cover disarming electronic security systems, which is handled by Electronics (Security) Skill.

BUSINESS

Multi-Genre Cost: 1 Point/Level

Relevant Stat: Mind

Specialisations: Accounting, Administration, Economics, Executive, Fraud, Government, Management, Marketing, Negotiating, Sales

The ability to organise, run, and understand part or all of a business organisation (including governments, non-profits, and association). This Skill is also useful for locating new employees.

CIVILISATION

Multi-Genre Cost: 2 Points/Level

Relevant Stat: Mind

Specialisations: One Specific Culture or Population

This reflects knowledge of the history, religion, ethics, social structure, and lifestyle of a distinct culture or population. Select one civilisation culture for each Skill Level – one of which will also be the focus or Specialisation of the knowledge.



CLIMBING

Multi-Genre Cost: 2 Points/Level

Relevant Stat: Body

Specialisations: Natural Surfaces, Poles, Ropes,
Vegetation, Walls

The ability to scale vertical surfaces with or without the use of dedicated climbing equipment.

COMPUTERS

Multi-Genre Cost: 2 Points/Level

Relevant Stat: Mind

Specialisations: Artificial Intelligence, Cryptography,
Databases, Electronic Warfare,
Intrusion/Security, Networks,
Programming

Practical and theoretical knowledge of computer systems and their general use. Computer engineering (hardware) is covered by Electronics.

CONTROLLED BREATHING

Multi-Genre Cost: 1 Point/Level

Relevant Stat: Body or Soul

Specialisations: Calm, Cyclic Breathing, Holding
Breath, Slow Heart Rate

The ability to control respiratory functions in order to maximise breathing efficiency or to perform tricks such as “playing dead.”

CULTURAL ARTS

Multi-Genre Cost: 1 Point/Level

Relevant Stat: Mind

Specialisations: Gastronomy, History, Literature,
Mythology, Nobility, Philosophy, Rare
Object Appraisal, Urban Legends

Knowledge of aspects of human culture (or another species' culture).

DEMOLITIONS

Multi-Genre Cost: 2 Points/Level

Relevant Stat: Body or Mind

Specialisations: Artificial Structures, Bomb Disposal,
Natural Structures, Safe Cracking,
Underwater

The ability to set explosive charges without getting hurt in the process or inflicting undesired collateral damage. It is also used for deactivating explosives set by someone else.

DISGUISE

Multi-Genre Cost: 2 Points/Level

Relevant Stat: Body, Mind, or Soul

Specialisations: Costume, Impersonation, Make-up,
Prosthetics

The ability to change one's personal appearance in an attempt to deceive others.

DOMESTIC ARTS

Multi-Genre Cost: 1 Point/Level

Relevant Stat: Mind or Soul

Specialisations: Childrearing, Cleaning, Cooking,
Decorating, Gardening, Home
Budgeting

The ability to efficiently and effectively organise and run a domestic household.

DRIVING

Multi-Genre Cost: 2 Points/Level

Relevant Stat: Body or Mind

Specialisations: Armoured Fighting Vehicle (tanks,
APCs, etc.), Bicycle, Big Rig (large
tractor/trailer trucks), Bus, Car, Giant
Robot, Motorcycle, Small Truck (vans,
pick-ups, hi-cubes), Teamster (Draft
Animals), Walker

The ability to operate a powered ground vehicle. Skill checks are only necessary in difficult situations such as performing vehicular stunts, avoiding hazards, etc.

ELECTRONICS

Multi-Genre Cost: 2 Points/Level

Relevant Stat: Mind

Specialisations: Communications, Computers,
Consumer Electronics, Robotics,
Security, Sensors

The ability to maintain, repair, build, modify (and at high Levels, design) electronic equipment.

EMPATHY

Multi-Genre Cost: 1 Point/Level

Relevant Stat: Soul

Specialisations: Body Language, Calming, Interpreting
Words, Intuition, Lie Detection,
Listening

The ability to understand, detect, and interpret the emotional state of people nearby, without having their experiences communicated explicitly.

ENGINEERING

Multi-Genre Cost: 2 Points/Level

Relevant Stat: Mind

Specialisations: Aerospace, Agricultural, Biomedical, Chemical, Civil, Computer, Electrical, Environmental, Mechanical, Mining

The use of scientific principals and experimental data to design and build equipment, structures, and other useful devices.

ENVIRONMENTAL SCIENCES

Multi-Genre Cost: 1 Point/Level

Relevant Stat: Mind

Specialisations: Climatology, Ecology, Geology, Geography, Geophysics, Hydrology, Meteorology, Oceanography

These scientific fields focus on the environment, with particular regard to the historical and current activities of sentient beings and their important impact on biodiversity and sustainability.

ETIQUETTE

Multi-Genre Cost: 1 Point/Level

Relevant Stat: Mind

Specialisations: Alien, Lower Class, Middle Class, Upper Class

The knowledge of the customary codes for polite, proper, and inoffensive behaviour in social settings.

FORGERY

Multi-Genre Cost: 1 Point/Level

Relevant Stat: Mind

Specialisations: Artwork, Electronic Documents, Financial Notes, Handwriting, Paper Documents, Physical Objects

The ability to realistically counterfeit documents and papers. This Skill can be used in conjunction with the Computers Skill.

GAMING

Multi-Genre Cost: 1 Point/Level

Relevant Stat: Mind or Soul (Body for some video games)

Specialisations: Board Games, Card Games, Computer Games, Gambling, Military Simulations, Role-Playing Games

The ability to comprehend and play various games and simulations well.

INTERROGATION

Multi-Genre Cost: 2 Points/Level

Relevant Stat: Mind or Soul

Specialisations: Business, Drugs, Physical, Psychological, Spiritual

The ability to convince someone to provide specific information against their will. Interrogation can also be used to help withhold such information when being questioned by an enemy.

INTIMIDATION

Multi-Genre Cost: 2 Points/Level

Relevant Stat: Body, Mind, or Soul

Specialisations: Business, Emotional, Political, Physical, Spiritual, Street

The ability to convincingly project a “tough guy” image. A successful check means someone witnessing your performance is convinced you mean any threats you make. How they react after that will depend on how tough they are themselves in relation to the kind of threat you present – they may respond with respect, fear, hatred, or amusement.

LANGUAGES

Multi-Genre Cost: 1 Point/Level

Relevant Stat: Mind

Specialisations: Any one language, Braille, Code Language, Lip Reading, Sign Language

The Languages Skill can be used instead of the Features Attribute (BESM4, page 92) to represent familiarity with additional dialects or functional communication methods.

Reflects an aptitude for languages and their historical usage. Additionally, a character will be able to speak and write: 1 (Level 1), 2 (Level 2), 3-4 (Level 3), 5-7 (Level 4), 8-11 (Level 5), or 12-16 (Level 6) foreign languages. Multiple Specialisations will be listed for Languages – the first is the character’s native language (a free Specialisation), while the others are foreign languages.

LAW

Multi-Genre Cost: 1 Point/Level

Relevant Stat: Mind

Specialisations: Civil, Criminal, Customs, Family, International, Political, Real Estate

Knowledge of legal procedure and practice. In addition to lawyers, many police officers, politicians, and even superbeings have the Law Skill at Level 1 or 2. All Specialisations, except International, are specific to one country or region only (for example, “American Criminal Law” or “Japanese Family Law”).

LEADERSHIP

Multi-Genre Cost: 1 Point/Level

Relevant Stat: Soul

Specialisations: Business, Co-operative, Political, Spiritual, Strategic, Transformational

The talent of having inspirational visions and goals, and communicating them effectively to others. The objective is to motivate and rally others to adopt and work towards those objectives as well.

LISTENING

Multi-Genre Cost: 2 Points/Level

Relevant Stat: Body or Soul

Specialisations: Background Noise, Discrimination, Eavesdropping, Spiritual

The ability to listen attentively or to perceive unusual or out of place noises.

MECHANICS

Multi-Genre Cost: 2 Points/Level

Relevant Stat: Mind (sometimes Body)

Specialisations: Aeronautical, Armourer, Automotive, Gunsmith, Locksmith, Nanotechnology, Traps

The ability to maintain, repair, or build mechanical and electro-mechanical devices. This also includes knowledge of tool use, welding, etc. Armourer applies to heavy vehicle-mounted weapons while Gunsmith covers personal weaponry. Use Artisan for archaic weapons.

MEDICAL

Multi-Genre Cost: 2 Points/Level

Relevant Stat: Mind (sometimes Body)

Specialisations: Chiropractic, Dentistry, Diagnosis, Emergency Response, Family Practice, Nursing, Obstetrics, Pathology, Pharmacy, Surgery, Veterinary

Knowledge of how to heal the body using a variety of techniques. A typical general practitioner would Specialise in Diagnosis, while most police officers or paramedics Specialise in Emergency Response.



TEMPLATES AND SKILLS

Many Race and Class Templates provided in the BESM RPG and its expansions use the Skill Group Attribute instead of individual Skills. To translate these Templates for use with Skills, reassign the total Character Points allocated in the combined Skill Group Attributes to the new Skills Attribute (page 8). Then, use the Skill Points provided to acquire one or more individual Skills that cover a similar range of knowledge and talent as the Template's original Skill Groups. This reassignment method maintains the same total Template Point cost, while simultaneously ensuring game balance.

MILITARY SCIENCES

Multi-Genre Cost: 2 Points/Level
 Relevant Stat: Mind
 Specialisations: Hardware Recognition, Intelligence Analysis, Logistics, Strategy, Tactics, Teamwork

The character has military-style tactical, staff, or leadership training. In addition, SWAT (or other tactical police units) often include individuals who pick up similar Skills (and often recruit ex-military personnel).

NATUROPATHY

Multi-Genre Cost: 1 Point/Level
 Relevant Stat: Mind or Soul
 Specialisations: Acupuncture, Aromatherapy, Herbalism, Homoeopathy, Massage Therapy, Reflexology

The knowledge of alternative medical practices that emphasise prevention, treatment, and optimal health by encouraging the body's self-healing process.

NAVIGATION

Multi-Genre Cost: 1 Point/Level
 Relevant Stat: Mind
 Specialisations: Air, Highway, Sea, Space, Undersea, Urban, Wilderness

The ability to read maps or use specialised navigation equipment (including electronic sensors, if appropriate to the setting). The Navigation Skill will help a character find the fastest/safest route to a destination. The commander of a large vessel is usually a skilled navigator, even if they have only slight knowledge of Boating or Piloting.

OCCULT

Multi-Genre Cost: 2 Points/Level
 Relevant Stat: Mind
 Specialisations: Astrology, Augury, Channelling, Dream Interpretation, Numerology, Rituals, Spellcraft, Spirits, Tarot, Voodoo, Witchcraft

Knowledge of the arcane and mystical arts, and their applications in both historical and modern society.

OCCUPATION

Multi-Genre Cost: 1 Point/Level
 Relevant Stat: Mind
 Specialisations: One Specific Occupation

The skills, talent, activities, and experience required to carry out one specific occupation that may have interdisciplinary applications not adequately addressed by an alternate single Skill.

PERFORMING ARTS

Multi-Genre Cost: 1 Point/Level
 Relevant Stat: Average of Body, Mind, and Soul
 Specialisations: Comedy, Dance, Drama, Musical Instrument, Public Speaking, Singing

The ability to perform well before an audience of any size and composition, and to evoke an emotional response through the art form.

PERSUASION

Multi-Genre Cost: 3 Points/Level
 Relevant Stat: Soul
 Specialisations: Bluffing, Bribery, Diplomacy, Emotional, Fast Talking, Hypnosis, Logic, Mediation, Rhetoric, Social Networking, Storytelling

The ability to convince people to see new perspectives, consider other alternatives, change their minds, make different decisions, and even modify their actions as a result of the persuasion.

PHYSICAL SCIENCES

Multi-Genre Cost: 2 Points/Level
 Relevant Stat: Mind
 Specialisations: Alchemy, Astronomy, Biochemistry, Chemistry, Mathematics, Physics

Scientific training in the way the physical realm functions and manifests itself as reality, including the necessary background knowledge concerning universal laws and constants.

PILOTING

Multi-Genre Cost: 2 Points/Level
Relevant Stat: Average of Body and Mind
Specialisations: Giant Robot, Heavy Airplane (usually multi-engine), Helicopter, Jet Fighter, Light Airplane (usually single-engine), Lighter than Air Craft, Spacecraft

The ability to operate atmospheric or space vehicles, as well as walking or transformable giant robots with familiar aircraft-style control layouts – even if such mecha are restricted to ground movement only. Skill checks are normally only necessary during play when performing an unusual manoeuvre, avoiding a hazard, piloting an unfamiliar aircraft, etc.

POISONS

Multi-Genre Cost: 1 Point/Level
Relevant Stat: Mind
Specialisations: Alien, Natural, Synthetic, Technological

The ability to recognise, concoct, apply, and neutralise a variety of poisons and toxins. For additional information on poisons, see page 89.

POLICE SCIENCES

Multi-Genre Cost: 2 Points/Level
Relevant Stat: Mind
Specialisations: Ballistics, Community Policing, Criminology, Forensics, International

This is the science and methodology behind detective work. Ballistics is the study of the wounds inflicted by projectiles; criminology focuses on studies of criminal behaviour and strategies; forensics covers evidence gathering (including hair-and-fibre, fingerprint and DNA-based identification techniques).

POWERLIFTING

Multi-Genre Cost: 2 Points/Level
Relevant Stat: Body
Specialisations: Bulky Objects, Free Weights, Humans, Moving Objects, Small Objects (Hand-Held)

The ability to perform feats of strength with minimal chance for injury. Includes lifting or pushing heavy objects, stopping objects in motion, and supporting large masses for extended periods of time. This Skill is independent of the Superstrength Attribute (BESM4, page 124), and does not reflect strength directly. Rather, it represents a character's efficiency and effectiveness of using the strength that they possess.

RELIGION

Multi-Genre Cost: 1 Point/Level
Relevant Stat: Mind or Soul
Specialisations: Academic, Dogma, Congregational, Context, Enlightenment, Guidance, Interpretation, Scripture

The understanding and knowledge concerning the nature of a god or gods, including ceremonies and rituals, ethical standards, and historical origins.

RIDING

Multi-Genre Cost: 1 Point/Level
Relevant Stat: Body, Mind or Soul
Specialisations: By species (Camel, Horse, Tiger, etc.)

This is the knowledge of how to care for a riding beast, how to saddle, mount, and dismount the animal, how to get it to perform difficult or dangerous manoeuvres safely and without balking, and how to best pace it for long-distance rides.

SEARCH

Multi-Genre Cost: 2 Points/Level
Relevant Stat: Mind
Specialisations: Compartments, Detail Work, Electronics, Irregularities

This Skill allows the character to find secret, hidden, or concealed objects.

SEDUCTION

Multi-Genre Cost: 2 Points/Level
Relevant Stat: Body or Soul
Specialisations: Emotional, Mental, Physical, Political, Social, Spiritual, Verbal

A character with this Skill is adept at exploiting their sex appeal. A successful Skill check will convince another person that the character is genuinely interested in them. Whether or not the subject responds will depend on their own romantic inclinations and sexual preferences.

SLEIGHT OF HAND

Multi-Genre Cost: 2 Points/Level
Relevant Stat: Body
Specialisations: Card Sharking, Lock Picking, Pick Pocketing, Stage Magic

A character with this Skill (also known as “prestidigitation”) has superior manual dexterity, greater than that suggested by their Body Stat. This includes the ability to perform “magic” tricks, palm small objects, cheat at cards, plant an item on someone, etc.

SOCIAL SCIENCES

Multi-Genre Cost: 1 Point/Level
 Relevant Stat: Mind
 Specialisations: Archaeology, Anthropology, Communication, Education, Politics, Psychology, Social Work, Sociology

Understanding of the way populations and individual people function in and contribute to society, as well as larger societal behavioural patterns.

SPORTS

Multi-Genre Cost: 1 Point/Level
 Relevant Stat: Body (sometimes Mind or Soul)
 Specialisations: One specific sport

The ability to play well with others in a team or individual sporting event with specialised rules, in a manner that minimises associated injury risks.

STEALTH

Multi-Genre Cost: 3 Points/Level
 Relevant Stat: Body (sometimes Mind)
 Specialisations: Camouflage, Concealment, Silent Movement

The ability to disguise objects or people so that they blend into their surroundings. This also includes the ability to conceal small objects on one's person and the ability to move silently.

STREET SENSE

Multi-Genre Cost: 2 Points/Level
 Relevant Stat: Mind or Soul
 Specialisations: Gang Activity, Influential Individuals, Territorial Divisions (all by region)

The knowledge of street activity within a particular urban region or city. This is a vital survival Skill for a person on the streets.

SURVIVAL

Multi-Genre Cost: 2 Points/Level
 Relevant Stat: Mind (sometimes Body)
 Specialisations: Aquatic, Arctic, Desert, Dimensional, Forest, Jungle, Mountain, Plains

The ability to find food and shelter in the outdoors, to avoid natural hazards, and to identify edible and useful wild plants and animals. This Skill is often a learned area of expertise for more advanced cultures, but a natural way of life for more primitive ones.

SWIMMING

Multi-Genre Cost: 1 Point/Level
 Relevant Stat: Body
 Specialisations: Aquabatics, Competition, Deep-Sea Diving, Free Diving, Recreational, Scuba, Snorkelling

The character is skilled at swimming or diving. The GM may assume that any character in a modern setting can swim even without this Skill. A swimmer can usually move at a speed equal to their Body Stat in kilometres per hour for short distances.

URBAN TRACKING

Multi-Genre Cost: 2 Points/Level
 Relevant Stat: Mind
 Specialisations: Academic, Corporate, Political, Residential, Underworld

Urban Tracking is the ability to "shadow" someone through an industrialised, populated area or, alternatively, to find certain people in a particular sub-culture or environment by asking the right questions.

VISUAL ARTS

Multi-Genre Cost: 1 Point/Level
 Relevant Stat: Body, Mind, or Soul (often an average)
 Specialisations: Animation, Carving, Drawing, Flower Arranging, Painting, Photography, Sculpting, Video

The ability to produce a work of fine or commercial art in a particular visual field.

WILDERNESS TRACKING

Multi-Genre Cost: 1 Point/Level
 Relevant Stat: Mind (sometimes Soul)
 Specialisations: Aquatic, Arctic, Desert, Forest, Jungle, Mountain, Plains

The ability to successfully trail or track someone or something while outdoors in a rural or wilderness setting.

WRITING

Multi-Genre Cost: 1 Point/Level
 Relevant Stat: Average of Mind and Soul
 Specialisations: Academic, Fiction, Journalistic, Poetic, Religious, Technical

The ability to communicate ideas or emotions in a written work, though a person without this Skill may still know how to read and write.



VARYING SKILL COSTS BY GENRE

The Point cost of a Skill is based on its utility in the game and not on the difficulty of learning the Skill. Otherwise, highly detailed and technical Skills (such as sciences and medical/engineering fields) would always be the most costly, regardless of their utility within the game. Table-03: Genre Skill Costs provides a list of Character Point costs for 30 popular gaming genres, settings, and themes, as well as a default multi-genre cost that represents an average for use in games where the genre or setting frequently changes.

For example, in a typical action-adventure setting, the action, scientific, and tech Skills are fairly costly; conversely, the humanistic, diplomatic, and business Skills are inexpensive. The reverse is true in a “slice of life” setting. Similarly, investigation and sleuthing Skills are costly in a detective setting, but inexpensive for adventures during the Age of Discovery.

Use Table-03 as a guideline for determining how much a particular Skill should be worth in your particular campaign. The 30 game genres provided aren't strictly defined and offer flexibility in interpretation, though their names likely evoke a strong understanding of their scopes for player groups. Of course, not every possible genre could be listed, and so consideration is necessary.

MODERN DAY CAMPAIGNS

Action Adventure, Animal Adventures, Classic Horror, Detective, Loony Cartoons, Romantic Comedy, Slice of Life, Spy Thriller, and Supernatural Occult

FANTASY CAMPAIGNS

Eco, High, Low, and Urban Fantasy

FUTURE CAMPAIGNS

Cyberpunk/Realitypunk, Hard SF, Mecha Drama, Post-Apocalyptic, Soft SF, Space Opera

HISTORICAL CAMPAIGNS

20th Century War, Age of Discovery, Age of Pirates, Age of Samurai, Ancient Mediterranean, Industrial Age, Middle Ages, Steampunk, Stone Age, and Wild West

► ADJUSTING SKILL COSTS

While some genres bring to mind certain campaign styles instantly, such as the “deniable assets” of a cyberpunk setting, alternate campaigns may require some Skill cost adjustments. For example, if the GM runs a cyberpunk campaign (using the Cyberpunk / Realitypunk Skill costs) with player characters taking the roles of law enforcement, the Skill costs for Law and Police Sciences may be raised to 3 Points/Level each.

ATTRIBUTE COST GENRE VARIATION

Although we present the option of varying individual Skill costs according to the primary genre of your game adventures, you are cautioned against undertaking similar Point cost modifications for Attributes. The relative costs of Stats, Attributes, Derived Values, and Defects are carefully balanced amongst all entries, and changing one cost independently may create unintended imbalances across a range of game mechanics. Skills do not share this problem, and thus their costs can be modified safely.

The Game Master should also adjust Point costs when blending multiple campaign themes. It is recommended that the GM uses the highest Point value from amongst the themes. This method will result in more Skills requiring a greater number of Points, and thus the GM could also reduce the costs of some less frequently used Skills. For example, when running a blended Supernatural Action Adventure campaign, the Occult Skill is probably best set at the higher 3 Points/Level cost (the Supernatural Occult campaign cost) to reflect its importance. Conversely, if the Artisan Skill will be used infrequently, it should be set at the lower 1 Point/Level cost (the Action Adventure campaign cost).

► REALLOCATING POINTS IN SKILLS

In some campaigns – especially in games that explore the full breadth of the BESM Multiverse setting (BESM4, page 308) – characters may end up travelling to another time or dimension. If this travel between realms results in a high-cost Skill becoming useless, the Game Master may allow the player to reallocate Character Points between different Skills during adventures, to reflect what the character has learned in the new land.

For example, if a 21st century investigator travels back in time to ancient China, their Driving and Area Knowledge Skills are pretty much useless. After several adventures and some rough cultural experiences, the Game Master could allow the character to trade those Skills for Levels in Civilisation (China) and Languages. If the character ever makes it back to their own time setting, they should be allowed to swap the Skills back after a period of readjustment.

3a

GENRE SKILL COSTS – MODERN DAY

Skill Name	DEFAULT Multi-Genre	Action Adventure	Animal Adventures	Classic Horror	Detective	Loony Cartoons	Romantic Comedy	Slice of Life	Spy Thriller	Supernatural Occult
Acrobatics	3	3	3	2	2	3	2	1	2	2
Animal Training	2	2	2	1	1	1	1	2	1	2
Architecture	1	1	2	1	1	1	1	1	1	2
Area Knowledge	2	2	3	2	3	2	2	2	2	2
Artisan	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	2	1	2
Biological Sciences	2	2	2	2	2	2	2	1	3	2
Boating	2	2	1	1	2	1	1	1	2	1
Burglary	2	2	2	2	3	2	2	1	2	1
Business	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	2	1	2
Civilisation	2	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	2	2
Climbing	2	2	2	2	2	2	2	1	2	1
Computers	2	3	1	3	3	3	2	2	3	2
Controlled Breathing	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	2
Cultural Arts	1	1	1	1	1	1	2	2	1	2
Demolitions	2	3	2	1	2	3	1	1	2	1
Disguise	2	2	2	2	2	3	2	2	3	2
Domestic Arts	1	1	1	1	1	2	3	3	1	1
Driving	2	3	1	2	3	2	2	2	2	2
Engineering	2	1	2	2	1	1	1	1	2	2
Environmental Sciences	1	1	1	1	2	1	2	1	2	2
Electronics	2	2	1	2	2	2	1	1	2	2
Empathy	1	1	2	2	2	1	3	3	1	3
Etiquette	1	1	1	1	1	1	2	2	1	1
Forgery	1	1	1	1	2	1	2	1	3	1
Gaming	1	1	1	1	1	2	1	1	1	1
Interrogation	2	2	2	2	3	2	2	1	2	2
Intimidation	2	3	2	3	2	2	2	1	2	3
Languages	1	1	1	2	1	1	1	2	1	3
Law	1	1	1	1	3	1	1	1	1	2
Leadership	1	2	2	2	2	1	2	1	2	3
Listening	2	1	3	2	2	2	2	1	2	2
Mechanics	2	2	1	1	2	1	1	2	2	2
Medical	2	2	2	2	2	1	1	2	2	2
Military Sciences	2	2	2	2	2	1	1	1	2	1
Naturopathy	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	2	1	3
Navigation	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1
Occult	2	1	1	3	1	1	1	1	2	3
Occupation	1	1	1	1	1	2	1	2	1	1
Performing Arts	1	1	2	1	2	2	2	2	1	2
Persuasion	3	3	2	1	2	2	3	2	3	2
Physical Sciences	2	1	1	1	2	2	1	1	2	2
Piloting	2	2	1	2	2	2	1	1	2	1
Poisons	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	2	1
Police Sciences	2	2	1	2	3	1	1	1	2	1
Powerlifting	2	3	2	2	2	3	1	1	2	1
Religion	1	1	1	3	1	1	1	1	2	3
Riding	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1
Search	2	2	2	2	3	1	1	2	3	2
Seduction	2	2	2	2	2	1	3	2	2	3
Sleight of Hand	2	2	2	2	2	2	2	2	2	2
Social Sciences	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	2
Sports	1	1	1	1	1	2	2	2	1	1
Stealth	3	2	3	2	2	2	2	2	3	2
Street Sense	2	2	1	2	3	2	2	2	3	2
Survival	2	2	3	2	2	2	1	1	2	2
Swimming	1	1	2	1	1	1	1	2	1	1
Urban Tracking	2	1	2	3	3	1	2	1	2	3
Visual Arts	1	1	1	1	1	1	2	2	1	1
Wilderness Tracking	1	1	2	1	1	1	1	1	1	1
Writing	1	1	1	1	1	1	2	2	1	2

3b

GENRE SKILL COSTS – FANTASY & FUTURE

Skill Name	Eco Fantasy	High Fantasy	Low Fantasy	Urban Fantasy	Cyberpunk Realitypunk	Hard SF	Mecha Drama	Post-Apocalyptic	Soft SF	Space Opera
Acrobatics	3	2	2	2	2	2	3	2	2	3
Animal Training	3	2	2	2	1	1	1	2	1	1
Architecture	1	1	1	1	2	1	1	2	1	1
Area Knowledge	2	2	2	3	2	1	2	3	1	3
Artisan	2	1	1	1	1	1	1	2	1	1
Biological Sciences	3	1	1	1	3	3	1	3	2	2
Boating	1	2	2	2	2	2	2	1	1	1
Burglary	2	2	2	2	2	1	2	2	2	2
Business	1	1	2	1	2	1	2	1	1	2
Civilisation	3	3	2	1	2	1	2	2	2	3
Climbing	2	2	2	2	2	1	1	2	2	1
Computers	—	—	—	2	3	3	3	2	2	2
Controlled Breathing	2	1	1	1	1	1	2	1	1	1
Cultural Arts	2	1	1	2	1	1	2	1	2	1
Demolitions	1	1	1	1	2	1	3	2	1	1
Disguise	1	2	2	2	2	1	1	1	1	3
Domestic Arts	1	1	2	1	1	1	1	2	2	1
Driving	—	—	—	2	2	2	3	2	2	2
Engineering	2	2	1	1	3	3	3	2	1	2
Environmental Sciences	3	2	1	1	2	3	2	3	2	2
Electronics	1	1	1	1	3	3	3	2	2	2
Empathy	3	2	2	2	2	1	2	3	2	2
Etiquette	2	2	1	1	1	1	2	1	1	1
Forgery	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1
Gaming	1	1	2	1	1	1	2	1	1	1
Interrogation	2	2	2	2	2	2	2	2	2	2
Intimidation	2	2	2	2	2	2	2	2	2	2
Languages	2	2	1	1	1	1	1	1	3	1
Law	1	1	1	1	2	1	1	1	1	1
Leadership	1	1	2	2	2	2	3	2	2	2
Listening	2	2	2	2	2	1	1	2	2	2
Mechanics	1	1	1	2	2	2	3	3	2	2
Medical	2	2	2	2	2	2	2	3	2	2
Military Sciences	2	3	2	1	2	2	3	2	2	2
Naturopathy	3	2	2	1	2	1	1	2	2	1
Navigation	2	2	2	1	1	2	3	2	2	3
Occult	3	3	2	3	1	1	1	1	1	1
Occupation	1	1	2	1	1	1	2	1	1	1
Performing Arts	1	1	1	2	1	1	1	1	1	1
Persuasion	2	2	2	2	2	2	2	2	2	3
Physical Sciences	2	1	1	1	1	3	2	2	2	2
Piloting	1	1	—	1	2	2	2	2	2	3
Poisons	2	2	2	1	1	1	1	1	1	1
Police Sciences	1	1	1	2	2	2	2	1	1	1
Powerlifting	1	2	2	2	2	2	1	1	1	2
Religion	2	2	2	2	1	1	1	1	1	2
Riding	2	2	2	1	1	1	1	2	1	1
Search	2	2	2	2	2	2	2	2	2	2
Seduction	2	2	2	2	2	2	3	2	3	2
Sleight of Hand	2	2	2	2	1	1	2	1	1	1
Social Sciences	2	1	1	1	1	2	2	2	3	1
Sports	1	1	1	1	1	1	2	1	1	2
Stealth	2	2	3	3	2	2	2	3	2	2
Street Sense	1	1	2	2	3	2	2	3	2	2
Survival	2	2	3	1	1	1	1	3	1	1
Swimming	2	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1
Urban Tracking	1	1	1	2	3	1	2	2	1	1
Visual Arts	2	1	1	2	1	1	1	1	1	1
Wilderness Tracking	2	2	2	1	1	1	1	2	1	1
Writing	2	1	1	2	1	1	1	1	1	1

3c

GENRE SKILL COSTS – HISTORICAL

Skill Name	20 th Century War	Age of Discovery	Age of Pirates	Age of Samurai	Ancient Mediterranean	Industrial Age	Middle Ages	Steampunk	Stone Age	Wild West
Acrobatics	1	1	2	3	2	1	2	2	1	2
Animal Training	1	2	1	2	2	1	2	1	2	3
Architecture	1	2	1	2	2	3	2	2	1	1
Area Knowledge	2	3	2	2	1	2	1	1	2	1
Artisan	1	2	2	2	2	2	2	2	2	2
Biological Sciences	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1
Boating	2	2	3	1	2	1	2	1	1	1
Burglary	2	1	3	2	2	1	2	2	1	2
Business	1	2	1	1	1	3	1	1	1	1
Civilisation	2	3	1	1	1	2	1	2	1	1
Climbing	2	1	3	1	1	1	1	2	2	1
Computers	2	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—
Controlled Breathing	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1
Cultural Arts	1	2	1	2	2	2	1	2	1	1
Demolitions	2	1	2	1	1	1	1	1	—	2
Disguise	2	1	2	2	2	1	2	2	1	2
Domestic Arts	1	2	2	2	1	2	2	2	3	2
Driving	3	1	1	1	1	1	1	3	2	1
Engineering	2	2	1	1	2	3	1	3	1	1
Environmental Sciences	1	2	1	1	2	2	1	1	1	1
Electronics	2	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—
Empathy	1	2	2	1	1	2	1	2	2	1
Etiquette	1	2	1	3	2	2	1	2	1	1
Forgery	1	1	2	1	1	2	1	1	1	1
Gaming	1	1	2	1	1	1	1	1	1	3
Interrogation	2	1	2	2	2	1	2	2	1	2
Intimidation	2	2	3	2	2	3	2	2	3	2
Languages	1	2	2	1	1	2	1	1	1	1
Law	1	1	1	1	2	2	1	1	1	2
Leadership	2	3	2	3	2	2	2	2	3	3
Listening	2	1	2	1	1	1	2	2	1	2
Mechanics	2	2	1	1	1	3	1	3	—	1
Medical	2	3	2	2	2	2	3	2	1	2
Military Sciences	3	2	2	2	2	1	2	2	1	2
Naturopathy	1	1	1	1	2	1	1	1	3	2
Navigation	2	2	3	2	2	2	2	2	2	2
Occult	1	1	1	2	1	1	2	2	2	2
Occupation	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1
Performing Arts	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	2	1	1
Persuasion	2	2	3	2	2	2	2	2	2	2
Physical Sciences	1	1	1	1	1	2	1	2	1	1
Piloting	3	—	—	—	—	—	—	3	—	—
Poisons	1	1	1	2	2	2	2	2	1	1
Police Sciences	1	1	—	—	—	1	—	1	—	1
Powerlifting	2	1	2	2	1	1	2	2	3	2
Religion	1	2	1	2	3	1	2	1	1	1
Riding	1	2	2	3	2	1	3	1	2	3
Search	2	2	3	2	2	2	2	2	2	2
Seduction	2	2	3	2	2	2	2	2	2	3
Sleight of Hand	2	1	2	1	1	1	1	1	1	2
Social Sciences	1	2	1	1	1	1	1	2	1	1
Sports	1	1	1	1	2	1	1	1	1	1
Stealth	2	2	2	2	2	1	2	2	2	2
Street Sense	2	1	2	2	2	2	3	1	1	2
Survival	2	2	3	2	2	2	2	2	3	2
Swimming	1	1	2	1	1	1	1	1	2	1
Urban Tracking	2	1	1	1	1	2	2	1	—	2
Visual Arts	1	1	1	1	1	2	1	2	1	1
Wilderness Tracking	2	2	3	2	2	1	2	2	3	2
Writing	1	2	1	1	1	2	1	2	1	1



CHAPTER 3 EXPANDED MECHANICS

ENHANCING YOUR RULES

This chapter goes into more detail regarding additional combat choices, and also provides enhanced rules that touch upon a variety of sections, including: edges and obstacles, pushing powers, hedging and morale for NPCs, social combat, and more. GMs may wish to use these rules to adjudicate situations that were not addressed in the core BESM rulebook, or to add a depth of opportunities if combat is an especially important part of campaign adventures.

Many of the expanded mechanics presented in this chapter interact with other parts of BESM Extras. For example, dice roll penalties for executing some of the new combat manoeuvres can be reduced or eliminated by assigning select new Combat Techniques (page 5). Chapter 4 provides a series of optional rules gaming groups can consider as well.

TACTICAL ACTIONS

A tactical action is an additional type of action manoeuvre that will directly aid an upcoming attack or defence roll. The other two types of actions are attack actions and general actions (BESM4, page 188). The three standard tactical actions are aim, wait for an opening, and total defence. Regardless of how many actions the character has each round from the Extra Actions Attribute, they can only perform one tactical action a round. The bonus for aim and wait for an opening are cumulative, though, if the same one is used for a second consecutive round.

AIM

A character who intends to make a ranged attack may deliberately take extra time to aim. If a character aims a ranged weapon at a particular target for an entire round – and does not move or defend during that period – the next ranged attack on that opponent the following round gains a minor edge on the attack roll. Aiming for a second consecutive round improves that benefit to a major edge instead.

If an aiming character chooses to make a defence roll, or suffers any damage before they can attack, the benefit of the aim is lost. The Extra Actions Attribute does not reduce the time a character must spend aiming.

WAIT FOR AN OPENING

An attacker who is at melee range may use a tactical action to study their foe, and wait for an opening instead of attacking. This works much like aim: the next melee attack on that opponent the following round gains a minor edge on the attack roll. Waiting for a second consecutive round improves that benefit to a major edge instead.

This action is especially useful if the character is planning a called shot (page 37). Unlike aiming a ranged weapon, though, the benefit gained while waiting for an opening is unaffected by defending, receiving damage, or moving normally during combat. The Extra Actions Attribute does not reduce the time a character must spend waiting for the opening.

TOTAL DEFENCE

A character who takes this defensive tactical action is concentrating completely on defence instead of attacking or engaging in another activity. They may still move normally, but may not take other attack or tactical actions – regardless how many actions they have each round – since the character is dodging and weaving, parrying frantically, or simply ducking and hiding. The character receives a major edge on all defence rolls made during the round that the character is concentrating on defence, and consequently the decision to use this action can be made anytime during a round before or on their Initiative. Total defence is a good tactic for someone who is retreating or perhaps buying time until allies arrive.

COMBAT MANOEUVRES

The following are particular manoeuvres that characters can perform in combat.

► READYING (HOLD ACTIONS)

The ready manoeuvre lets an attacker take an action later in the round, after the character's Initiative is over but before they start the next one. On their Initiative, the player specifies the action their character will take and the conditions under which the character will take it. Any time before the character's next Initiative, they may then take the readied action in response to that condition. The character's readied reaction occurs just before the action that triggers it. If the triggered action is part of an opponent's activities (for example, an attack or movement), the character's interrupts the opponent's action because it takes place beforehand. If still capable of doing so, the opponent continues their own action once the character completes the readied action.

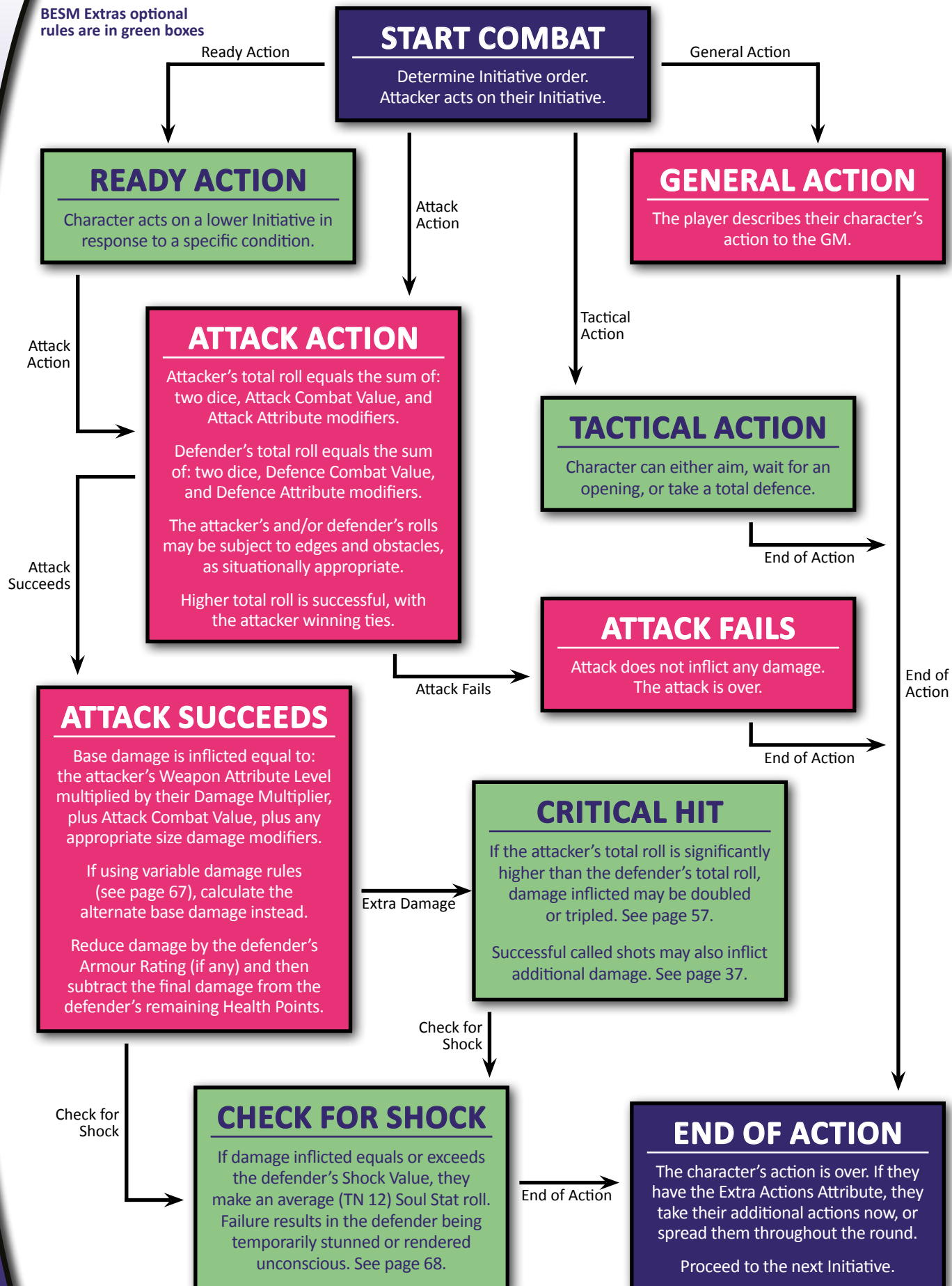
If the character comes to their next action and has not yet performed the readied action, the readied action is lost (though the character can ready the same action again, if desired). If the character takes the readied action in the next round before their regular Initiative, the character's Initiative count rises to that new point in the order of battle, and they do not get an additional regular action that round.

03: MECHANICS+

BESM Extras optional rules are in green boxes

EXPANDED MECHANICS

PAGE 36



INITIATIVE CONSEQUENCES OF READINGY

The holding character's Initiative result changes after a ready action. Since each character's Initiative is determined only once at the beginning of a combat, for the rest of the encounter, the Initiative result is the count on which the character took the readied action. The character would therefore act immediately ahead of their opponent should that action have triggered the character's readied action.

READYING EXAMPLE

Assume combat begins with three participants: a warrior, his thief companion, and a mage. After rolling Initiative, the results are thief 18, mage 12, warrior 10.

The thief acts first on 18, but decides to hold their action until they see what the mage will do. Consequently, at Initiative 18 nothing happens and the GM moves down the Initiative order. At Initiative 12, it's time for the mage to act – and, as expected, they begin waiving their hands towards the warrior and speaking an arcane language. Because the thief readied their action earlier, they can act just before the mage does. The thief throws a dagger at the mage at the beginning of Initiative 12 to interrupt the spellcasting and (after rolling dice) lands a successful hit. The damage breaks the mage's concentration and their spell fizzles.

In round two and later combat rounds until the battle ends, the thief and mage now both act on Initiative 12.

► ATTACKS WITH TWO WEAPONS

A character with a one-handed melee or ranged weapon in each hand may use both at once against the same target or two different targets on their Initiative (even if they do not have the Extra Actions Attribute) but with penalties to both rolls: minor obstacles when attacking the same target or major obstacles when attacking different targets. If a character has the Extra Actions Attribute, they can only use this manoeuvre with one attack each round and not additional attacks. Such attack roll penalties can be reduced with the Combat Technique (Two Weapons) Attribute (page 6).

► CALLED SHOTS

An attacking character may elect to suffer obstacles to their attack roll when attempting to hit a target in exchange for a called shot that provides some special advantage. For example, a called shot may reduce or bypass armour (by attacking a small, unarmoured spot) or strike a vital point (inflicting increased damage). These penalties can be reduced with the Combat Technique (Precise Aim) Attribute (page 6). Players must specify their chosen called shot before rolling the attack dice.

CALLED SHOT TO DISARM

A character may attempt to shoot or knock a weapon or object out of another person's hand instead of inflicting damage. If using a ranged attack, the roll suffers a major obstacle. If using a melee weapon or unarmed attack, the roll suffers a minor obstacle. If the attack hits, the target must make a difficult (TN 15) Body Stat roll to retain control of their weapon. If the Stat roll fails, the character successfully knocks away the weapon. If the Stat roll succeeds, the defender will suffer a major obstacle on their next action with that weapon (since it is off balance), but they still retain control of it.

CALLED SHOT TO REDUCE ARMOUR

Armour with the Gap Limiter (page 5) has thin or unprotected areas. An attack can be aimed at such a gap to either reduce the Armour's effectiveness by half (attacker suffers a minor obstacle on their roll) or ignore the Armour Rating completely (attacker suffers a major obstacle on their roll). If the attacker's Weapon also has the Penetrating Enhancement or Non-Penetrating Limiter assigned, those modifiers still apply as normal.

CALLED SHOT TO VITAL SPOT

A character attacking a living being can specify they are aiming for a vital spot (heart, brain, spine, etc.) rather than simply targeting the centre of mass. The attack roll suffers a major obstacle. If successful, the damage is not increased, but if any damage gets past the target area's Armour Rating, the Health Points lost as a result of this vital spot damage are doubled.

CALLED SHOT TO WEAK POINT

If the character knows their target has a Weak Point Defect (BESM4, page 167), a called shot can be made to hit it in combat. The penalty to the attack roll depends on the size of the Weak Point: a large spot (-6 Points) suffers a minor obstacle and a small spot (-4 Points) suffers a major obstacle. For a tiny spot (-2 Points), the attacker suffers a major obstacle and the defender also gains a minor edge on their defence roll.

CALLED SHOT TO SPECIFIC LOCATION

If the character for some reason wants to target a particular area on their opponent that isn't specifically a vital or weak spot (such as the shoulder or hip), the penalty to the attack roll is the same as for targetting a weak point (see above), and depends on the pinpointed area's size.

If a called shot to a specific location is made through an unopposed ranged attack roll (BESM4, page 189), the task's Target Number changes depending on the size of the target area: an unlikely task (TN 21) for a tiny spot, a challenging task (TN 18) for a small spot, or a difficult task (TN 15) for a large spot.





► MULTIPLE TARGETS WITH ONE ATTACK

When a character absolutely must take down a number of targets but they do not have enough Extra Actions to do so, the character may attempt to use one attack to strike multiple targets:

- » Two targets: the character suffers a minor obstacle on their attack roll
- » Three targets: the character suffers a major obstacle on their attack roll
- » Four targets: the character suffers a major obstacle on their attack roll, and the defenders each gain minor edges on their defence rolls
- » Five targets: the character suffers a major obstacle on their attack roll, and the defenders each gain major edges on their defence rolls

Characters cannot usually target more than five opponents with a single attack. Should the GM decide that it possible, though, use the edges and obstacles for five targets. These penalties can be reduced with the Combat Technique (Multiple Targets) Attribute (page 6).

The initiating character only makes one attack roll (not one per target), though each target makes their own defence roll to avoid damage.

► STRIKING TO WOUND

A character in combat can elect to reduce their delivered attack damage below the normal damage value to a minimum of 1 point (known as striking to wound). They may not attempt this manoeuvre with Weapons possessing the Area (unless also Selective), Autofire, or Spreading Enhancements, though.

► TOTAL ATTACK

A character can take this manoeuvre in conjunction with one single attack. It means they focus completely on an offensive action with no thought given to defence. The character suffers a major obstacle on all defence rolls made until their turn to act again next round, but also gains major edge on the single attack roll. If the character has the Extra Actions Attribute, all other attack actions in the same round are unmodified.

► SURPRISE ATTACK

Surprise attack situations – in which the target is completely unaware of the incoming attack, yet would otherwise be capable of defending had they known about the attack – are made as an Average task (TN 12) unopposed attack roll. A hidden sniper firing at a distant enemy would be an example of a surprise attack.

If the target is made aware of the incoming attack at the last moment, though – and thus the attack isn't a complete surprise – the attack roll is made as normal, but the defender suffers a minor or major obstacle on their defence roll, as the GM deems appropriate. Most melee attacks in which the attacker is hiding and suddenly jumps out at the target to surprise them would fall under this situation.

► TOUCHING A TARGET

Some Attributes simply require a character to touch their target. It is much easier to just touch a person than it is to physically strike them with enough force and skill to cause damage. Consequently, any character who is simply attempting to touch an opponent gains a minor edge on their attack roll. Touching a specific part of a target's body may also require a called shot (page 37), with those specific associated edges and obstacles applying to the rolls instead. This manoeuvre assumes the character is simply attempting to make physical contact with the target. If prolonged contact is required, the target must either be willing, or the character must grapple the target (see below).

GRAPPLING

Instead of striking to inflict damage in melee combat, a character can attempt to grab someone instead. This is a grappling attack, and a character must have at least one empty hand free. Grabbing a small, inanimate object not in an individual's Sphere of Control (page 45) does not usually require an action.

Resolve a grappling attempt like a normal unarmed attack, except that the person with the greater number of free hands (or manipulating appendages, for non-humans) gains a grappling advantage. "Free" means not holding weapons or other objects, or not otherwise incapacitated. In this case, the character with the advantage gains a minor edge to their attack or defence roll if they have one, two, or three more free hands, or a major edge if they have four or more free hands.

A successful grappling attack inflicts no damage, but the attacker can hold a grabbed character relatively stationary. The target suffers minor obstacles on all attack and defence rolls when performing other melee attacks or defences (including grabbing, biting, kneeling, etc.) or major obstacles when attempting to perform other tasks requiring freedom of movement, such as using hand-held equipment.

If the grabbed character is much stronger (or more agile, at the GM's discretion) than the opponent, though, their penalty is reduced – minor obstacles to no dice roll modifiers, or major obstacles to minor

obstacles – and the character can still move freely. Conversely, if the grabbed character is much weaker (or perhaps less agile), the penalties are increased – minor obstacles to major obstacles, and major obstacles to no rolls permitted.

A character is considered much stronger than an opponent if their Body Stat is at least 4 values higher or if the character possesses the Superstrength Attribute at a higher Level. For example, a weak teenager (Body Stat 2) has a significant disadvantage when grappling with a strong adult (Body Stat 6). Similarly, a medium-sized character (Size Rank 0) is greatly disadvantaged against one who is large-sized (Size Rank 1) or bigger.

It is, of course, possible for one character to grab an opponent who then grabs the character in return (this is what often happens when grappling).

► GRAPPLING MANOEUVRES

Once a character grabs an opponent, they can attempt a grappling special manoeuvre (lock, throw, or pin) as their next attack.

LOCK

Instead of attacking normally, a character who (on a previous attack) successfully grabbed their opponent can choke, crush, or strangle that foe. This attack automatically hits and inflicts normal unarmed damage.

THROW

Instead of attacking normally, a standing character who has already grabbed an opponent can hurl the foe to the ground. This is resolved as a normal unarmed attack. A successful hit releases the foe from the grapple, but inflicts an extra 5 points of damage, plus any additional falling damage (page 68) if the character was in a position to be thrown out a window, off a cliff, etc. If the attacker throws the opponent at another enemy, the target must make a successful defence roll or suffer equal damage as well.

PIN

A character who has grabbed someone may attempt to improve their hold during the next attack by completely immobilising the opponent in a pin. GMs may treat this manoeuvre the same as the first grab attack. If the attack succeeds and the opponent fails to defend, then the foe is pinned, usually under the weight of the attacker's body. Attackers may not attempt a pin if the opponent is much stronger (see earlier). Once a character pins an opponent, the target suffers a major obstacle on rolls when attempting to escape (see below). A pinned character cannot attack or defend.

► OTHER GRAPPLING EVENTS

In addition to attack manoeuvres, both people engaged in a grapple have a few more options.

BITING

Since biting does not require the use of hands, it is an effective tactic when a character has either grabbed or been grabbed by an opponent. Game Masters should treat this as a normal unarmed combat attack suffering a minor obstacle, unless the aggressor has a Weapon Attribute of some sort defined as a bite. In these instances, the minor obstacle may not apply.

ESCAPING

A grabbed character may attempt to struggle free. On the character's Initiative to act, they can attempt to escape instead of attack. This is an opposed roll, with each character making either a Body Stat roll or an attack roll, whichever is most advantageous for that character. The character with the highest total roll wins. If the grabbed character wins, they escape – and may also attack or take another action. If the characters tie, the grabbed character escapes, but forfeits their current action. If the grabbed character loses, they are immobilised and forfeits their next action that round, plus they suffer a major obstacle on any defence rolls later during that same round.

If a grabbed character chooses to attack the person who grabbed them (with appropriate penalties) and inflicts damage equal to or greater than five times their foe's Body Stat, they escape the grab automatically (since their opponent is suffering in pain) without having to make a specific attempt to do so.

GROUND FIGHTING

Fighters thrown to the ground or who are otherwise forced to fight from a prone position suffer minor obstacles while make all melee attack and melee defence rolls. Depending on the circumstances, the GM may require one general action for a character to rise up from a prone position.

DISARMING VIA GRAPPLING

A character can try grabbing an opponent's weapon (instead of the opponent's body) to wrench it free or knock it away. They suffer a minor obstacle when attempting this type of attack roll. This penalty is increased to major obstacle if the opponent is holding onto their weapon with two or more hands. A successful attack usually dislodges the weapon, but if the defender makes a difficult Body Stat roll (TN 15), they can instead maintain their grip and suffer minor obstacles when using the weapon for any reason until the end of their next action.



EXPANDED COMBAT MODIFIERS

These rules add extra combat modifiers both for special attack options such as called shots and for activities like movement.

MOVEMENT ATTACK PENALTIES

When a character is moving in combat, they may incur penalties to attack rolls (see Table-12, page 64). The penalty incurred depends on how quickly the character is moving relative to their maximum movement ability. Characters who are using a movement Attribute refer to the Movement Attribute column to determine their rate of movement.

If a character is running (or swimming/crawling slowly), they suffer a minor obstacle on attack rolls. This disadvantage increases to a major obstacle when sprinting (or swimming/crawling quickly). Characters who are walking or jogging do not incur penalties.

See BESM4, page 191, for details on movement.

FIRING FROM MOVING VEHICLES

Characters who are passengers inside a fast-moving vehicle fire their ranged weapons with a minor obstacle applied to their attack rolls. This penalty increases to a major obstacle if the character is also piloting or driving the vehicle while firing. These penalties can be reduced with the Combat Technique (Steady Hand) Attribute (page 6).

Many modern or high-tech mecha, tanks, etc. could have mounted stabilised weaponry or fire control systems that negate this penalty. This technology is represented by the vehicle possessing the Steady Hand Combat Technique.

FIRING WEAPONS WHILE MOUNTED

Mounted characters (on a horse, camel, giant eagle, etc.) fire their ranged weapons while moving with a major obstacle applied to their attack rolls. This penalty can be reduced with the Combat Technique (Steady Hand) Attribute (page 6).

ATTACKING MOVING TARGETS

Attempting to hit a target that is moving at exceptional speeds is very challenging. In these instances, the attacker suffers obstacles on their attack rolls and (at very high speeds) the defender may also receive edges to their defence rolls. See Table-12: Attack Roll Modifiers to apply the appropriate obstacles and edges. These penalties can be reduced with the Combat Technique (Dead Eye) Attribute (page 5).

COMBAT ROLL MODIFIERS

The GM may impose appropriate obstacles when the players make an attack roll. An attack action normally assumes characters are engaged in active combat – dodging enemy attacks, making quick strikes when the opportunity arises, moving about, etc. The GM should not apply penalties for this sort of normal combat-related activity. In circumstances where a character's aim or concentration seems likely impeded (such as shooting someone whom the character cannot clearly see, or attacking a foe while hanging upside down), the GM may assign obstacles to the attack roll. Likewise, in a stress-free situation (such as murdering an immobile victim, or target range shooting with nothing riding on the outcome), the GM can apply an edge to the roll or assume an automatic success – or perhaps even automatically allow a critical hit (page 57).

A number of possible attack roll obstacles (and sometimes simultaneous defence roll edges) are described on Table-11 and Table-12 (pages 63-65). The GM may adjust or ignore these modifiers if they prefer.

EXPANDED DEFENCE RULES

These rules add options for defence.

DEFENDING WITH A SHIELD

This rules section can be used as an alternate to the rules presented in the core book (BESM4, page 192).

Shields are primarily designed to deflect blows and turn them aside, whether these are actual shields or simply some other large, resistant object. Some larger shields (BESM4, page 212) have the Potent Enhancement, which provides the targeted character a minor edge (for Potent -1) or major edge (for Potent -2) when defending with a shield. Under these circumstances, the shield's Armour Rating does not reduce damage inflicted from a successful hit (since a success indicates that the shield deflection was bypassed). This is a default assumption: the attacker will always try to bypass a shield, and a defender will try to interpose the shield to block attacks.

If an attacker does not care about bypassing the shield, and prefers to strike it head on, the defender does not gain the associated edge on their defence roll – but instead receives the benefit of the shield's Armour Rating (the shield acts like the Armour Attribute in this instance). See BESM4, page 194, for details on how Armour Ratings reduce damage.

An attacker cannot attempt to strike a shield and also perform a called shot on the character directly, however. In order to successfully perform such a called shot, the attacker must attempt to bypass the shield as normal.

DEFENDING OTHERS

A character can defend a friend or ally against another's attack provided either the attacker or target is within reach. Defending others is difficult, though, and thus the character suffers a minor obstacle on their defence roll. Also, each attempt at defending others counts as one of the character's own defences, for purposes of defending against multiple attacks in a single round (see page 44). The decision to defend others may be made after the target has failed their own defence roll, but before any damage is resolved.

One special option is also available when defending others: throwing oneself in front of the attack. This noble act is also made with a minor edge to the defence roll – which cancels the minor obstacle described above – and thus results in no net roll modifier. If it succeeds, instead of stopping the attack, the defending character becomes the target automatically and suffers the appropriate attack damage.

DEFENDING AGAINST MULTIPLE ATTACKS

When defending against multiple attacks in a single round, each defence after the first one receives an obstacle on the defence roll: a minor obstacle on the second and third defence, and a major obstacle on the fourth and any latter defences. Even the greatest fighter may be overwhelmed if badly outnumbered! The penalty maxes out at major obstacles on defence rolls, though, since too many opponents may get in each other's way.

If a character has the Extra Defences Attribute (page 6), the penalties above only begin to accumulate after they have exhausted the additional defences. For example, a warrior with Extra Defences Level 2 will only receive minor obstacles on their fourth and fifth defence roll, and major obstacles starting on their sixth and subsequent defence rolls.

NO NEED TO DEFEND

If the target's total defence roll against an attack would still be successful even if the target only rolled as low as a 2 on the dice – in other words, the defender is either much better than the attacker, or the attacker rolled a very low number – the defence is automatic. The target does not “use up” their free defence when guarding against that attack, and thus it can be used against another attack later in the same round without incurring penalties associated with defending against multiple attacks (see above).

HEDGING DEFENCE ROLLS TO SET TN

To speed up combat, gaming groups could consider always having player characters and NPCs hedge all defence rolls (BESM4, page 182). This option sets a clear Target Number for the attacker before their dice are rolled, which reduces combat randomness by half.

In groups where the players prefer making their own defence rolls, this option may instead only be used when attacking NPCs (and thus saving the Game Master from ever making any defence rolls). Players do tend to love rolling dice, after all!

► USING ATTRIBUTES DEFENSIVELY

Just as characters can find imaginative ways to use their Attributes against opponents, they are just as likely to think of ways to use certain Attributes to defend themselves or others from harm during battle. For example, Attributes such as Portal, Teleportation, or Telekinesis can suddenly move someone out of the way of a foe; Change State could be defensively used to turn non-corporeal quickly; or the Weapon Attribute can be used to target an incoming offensive, effectively nullifying the attack to provide a defence.

Any such sudden use of an ability is simply treated as a defence roll. Thus, instead of dodging, the character uses teleportation and vanishes before the attack hits. The defence roll is used to determine whether or not the character activates the Attribute in time to avoid the attack, and not whether or not the Attribute activates at all (that would be the function of a separate activation Stat roll, should the GM decide one is necessary). If the character fails the defence, the Attribute may still activate after damage is delivered. The character defends themselves from attacks with Attributes exactly the same way all characters do – with a defence roll.

DEFENDING WITH AN OFFENSIVE NON-WEAPON ATTRIBUTE

By holding an action until attacked by an opponent (see Ready, page 35), a character can attempt to defend themselves with the offensive use of a non-Weapon Attribute that is used on others. To succeed, the character must activate the Attribute with an appropriate Stat roll (the target can make a Soul Stat roll to resist, as normal) and then also make a successful defence roll to time the effect properly.

For example, if a heroic character attacks a dastardly opponent who has a readied action remaining, the opponent might attempt to use their Teleportation Attribute to place a bystander between themselves and the character's ranged attack. The opponent must first make a successful Mind Stat roll to see if the Teleportation works. If the attempt is successful, and the bystander fails to resist with a Soul Stat roll, a defence roll determines if the opponent activates the Teleportation in time to interpose the unfortunate bystander in front of the attack and take the brunt of the weapon damage.

USING ATTRIBUTES IN COMBAT

In some situations, players will want to use various Attributes in inventive ways in the middle of a fight. The rules in this section outline the use of such Attributes during combat.

► OFFENSIVE USE OF NON-WEAPON ATTRIBUTES

Creative characters can use a number of seemingly inoffensive Attributes in very effective ways while engaged in battle. Weapon is obviously designed for offensive use against an opponent, but what about Teleportation? Could a character not teleport an opponent in front of a moving truck or simply out of a fight entirely?

For example, Exorcism, Dynamic Powers, Illusion, Metamorphosis, Mind Control, Nullify, Portal, Telekinesis, Telepathy, Teleport, Transmute, and Undetectable can be used against one person or their possessions (depending on the Attribute).

When a character wishes to use a normally inoffensive Attribute against an unwilling opponent, the character must take an attack action and make a successful opposed Stat roll using the relevant Stat for the Attribute. Otherwise, the target resists the Attribute's effects entirely. Other Attribute rules apply as normal.

SPHERE OF CONTROL

If a character attempts to offensively use a non-Weapon Attribute on an object within the sphere of control of another person, the target character is allowed to make a Soul Stat roll to resist the effect as though they were the target of the attack and not the object.

For example, a technomage who wished to teleport the bullets out of an opponent's gun would still be required to make a successful Mind Stat roll and the person holding the gun would be allowed a Soul Stat roll to resist the effect (ie. the gun is under their control).

Other common objects usually in a target's sphere of control include: the ground beneath the target, air around the target, objects the target holds or carries, Items to which the target assigned Character Points, etc. The GM determines what objects are under the defender's sphere of control, as dramatically appropriate.

AFFECTING GROUPS

When a non-Weapon Attribute is used offensively against a group of unwilling targets – which may require Enhancements, such as Targets, assigned to the Attribute – GMs may use one of two options for resolving the resistance roll.

When a large group of people attempt to resist the effect of an Attribute, the GM makes one roll, using the average Soul Stat value of the targets. Important characters (player characters or key NPCs) should be allowed to make individual rolls for themselves to prevent the more vulnerable citizens from dragging down the important characters' higher Stats. In this way, either all of the targets are affected by the Attribute (on a failed Soul Stat roll) or none are affected (on a successful roll).

Alternatively, the GM may wish to use one roll, which is used as the same roll for each character's roll. In this circumstance, characters with high Soul Stats within the group may successfully resist the effects of the Attribute while characters with low Soul Stats are affected, since the one roll is added to each target's individual Stats to determine their separate total rolls.

► ATTRIBUTE VS. ATTRIBUTE

When two characters pit their Attributes against each other, who wins? In most situations, it's the character with the higher Attribute Level. For example, an alien is attempting to make their get-away using the Flight Attribute. The pursuing Earth Patrol Protector grabs the alien and tries to hold them back and prevent them from flying away. The Protector has the Superstrength Attribute at Level 5 while the alien has Flight at Level 3. The Protector, therefore, is strong enough to prevent the alien from escaping.

If the two Attributes are close in Level (usually the same or differing by only one Level), the GM may request an opposed Stat roll to see who wins the contested action. Using the above example, if the alien's Flight Level was 4 instead of 3, the GM could request an opposed Body Stat roll. The character with the higher total roll wins the contest. For these situations, if the power levels are close, but not identical, the GM may award the slightly more powerful character with a minor edge on their opposed roll.

What if a character has two or more Attributes that can be used in the opposed Stat roll? What if the alien in the first example also has Superstrength at Level 4? In these situations, the GM could simply add the two relevant Attribute Levels together to determine who wins the opposed action. Thus, the alien has Flight at Level 3 and Superstrength at Level 4 for a total of 7 Levels – which is much higher than the hero's Superstrength Level of 5. The alien is therefore able to make their escape (possibly lifting the Earth Patrol Protector into the air as well, or simply breaking free of their hold, depending on the GM's discretion). Alternatively, the GM may decide that the more appropriate Attribute is dominant and award a minor or major edge "synergy bonus" to the character's roll to determine a victor.

OPPOSING ATTRIBUTE TYPES

When Attributes of similar power levels oppose, the GM may also consider the “Attribute type” – the context by which the abilities expresses its effect – which is different from its source of power (see BESM4, page 258). Continuing the earlier example, the alien’s Level 4 Flight may be powered by supertech (technology type) while the Protector’s Level 5 Superstrength may be fuelled by arcane energy (magic type). Consult Table-04 for a list of 40 of the more common Attribute types.

For such contested Attribute vs. Attribute dice rolls, types that are considered strong against an opponent type gains a minor edge, while types that are dominant over an opponent type gains a major edge. Table-04 indicates that a technology type is dominant over a magic type, and therefore the alien receives a major edge on its opposed Stat roll to determine if the Protector can prevent escape.

The presented list of types is not exhaustive. Gaming groups are encouraged to create their own types too, and identify other types against which they are strong or weak.

4

OPPOSING ATTRIBUTE TYPES

Attribute Type	Strong Against	Dominant Over	Weak Against	Dominated By
Air	Electric	Density	Chemical	Natural Forces
Animal	Insect	Sound	Dark	Sound
Blood	Earth	Psychic	Ice	Speed
Chaos	Chemical	Combat	Density	Time
Chemical	Air	Poison	Chaos	Health
Cold	Plant	Technology	Energy	Fire/Heat
Combat	Life	Health	Technology	Chaos
Cosmic	Spirit	Radiation	Divine	Magic
Dark	Animal	Emotion	Fae	Light
Death	Time	Life	Health	Emotion
Density	Chaos	Dimensional	Life	Air
Dimensional	Energy	Math	Math	Density
Divine	Cosmic	Infernal	Magic	Psychic
Earth	Infernal	Spirit	Blood	Plant
Electric	Water	Metal	Air	Spirit
Emotion	Willpower	Death	Psychic	Dark
Energy	Cold	Ice	Dimensional	Radiation
Fae	Dark	Speed	Willpower	Metal
Fire/Heat	Ice	Cold	Insect	Water
Health	Death	Chemical	Light	Combat
Ice	Blood	Water	Fire/Heat	Energy
Infernal	Magic	Light	Earth	Divine
Insect	Fire/Heat	Time	Animal	Willpower
Life	Density	Willpower	Combat	Death
Light	Health	Dark	Natural Forces	Infernal
Magic	Divine	Cosmic	Infernal	Technology
Math	Dimensional	Natural Forces	Radiation	Dimensional
Metal	Radiation	Fae	Sound	Electric
Natural Forces	Light	Air	Time	Math
Plant	Speed	Earth	Cold	Poison
Poison	Technology	Plant	Water	Chemical
Psychic	Emotion	Divine	Spirit	Blood
Radiation	Math	Energy	Metal	Cosmic
Sound	Metal	Animal	Speed	Animal
Speed	Sound	Blood	Plant	Fae
Spirit	Psychic	Electric	Cosmic	Earth
Technology	Combat	Magic	Poison	Cold
Time	Natural Forces	Chaos	Death	Insect
Water	Poison	Fire/Heat	Electric	Ice
Willpower	Fae	Insect	Emotion	Life



► DYNAMIC POWERS VS. NORMAL ATTRIBUTES

What happens when a character with Dynamic Powers uses their abilities to counteract an opponent's Attribute? For example, is a character with Dynamic Powers at Level 4 powerful enough to prevent a character with Superstrength at Level 6 from lifting a bulldozer?

Since Dynamic Powers allows a character to create any Attribute effect (within their realm of influence), the character can counteract most Attributes through a multitude of ways. In the bulldozer example, this could include using telekinesis to push down on the bulldozer; changing the molecular composition of the bulldozer to make it heavier; etc. When Dynamic Powers is used to generate an Attribute's effects, the GM simply compares the Level of the Dynamic Powers Attribute with the opponent's Attribute Level as normal (see Attribute vs. Attribute, page 45). In the example above, the character with Level 4 Dynamic Powers is not powerful enough to prevent the character with Level 6 Superstrength from lifting the bulldozer.

One exception to this guideline is if the character's realm of influence allows them to effectively negate the opponent's Attribute through some Dynamic Powers application of the Nullify Attribute (BESM4, page 110). In this case, the character may simply reduce the opponent's Attribute Level to ensure that they are no longer capable of accomplishing the desired task. For our example, a bulldozer masses approximately 10 tonnes. Thus, Superstrength Level 6 is just barely strong enough to lift the bulldozer. If a character with Dynamic Powers (Magic) casts a Nullify spell to drain the target's Superstrength, they would only require Dynamic Powers at Level 1. Since the target's Superstrength would be reduced to Level 5 – below what is required to lift the bulldozer – the target could not lift it.

Of course, players being players, other creative uses of Dynamic Powers can also result in that Attribute's use effectively counteracting the Attributes of other characters ... even at comparatively lower Levels!

► PUSHING YOUR POWERS

To encourage players to develop their characters through role-playing, anime and manga characters may push themselves beyond their normal abilities, sometimes exerting their Attributes beyond their normal limits and other times pushing them in ways they have never done before.

Any time the character wishes to push their Attributes, the player spends one unused Advancement Point and attempts a relevant Stat roll against an average task (TN 12), while suffering a minor obstacle on the roll. If the roll is successful, the character has

pushed their abilities beyond their normal limits, which could include: increasing an Attribute's effect by 1 Level, accomplishing a new, yet related power with an Attribute, or whatever else the GM deems appropriate. At the GM's discretion, the character may spend more than one Advancement Point to push an Attribute even further, such as by 2 or more Levels. The spent Advancement Point counts toward the cost of purchasing the new Attribute.

For example, if a character successfully uses Superspeed to vibrate through a wall, they could assign the Advancement Point to the future acquisition of the Change State Attribute. If the roll fails, the character would have failed in the attempt and may suffer some sort of mishap, such as taking damage. After all, pushing yourself can be risky! Even if the character fails to push an ability, the Advancement Point is still allocated to the new Attribute Level; even a failure can teach a character something, even if its only what not to do the next time.

Though characters can normally only push their Attributes, GMs may allow characters to push their Stats as well under special circumstances (with the Advancement Point allocated to a future Stat increase). Additionally, if a character attempts to repeatedly push their Attributes in the same way – such as that extremely fast character pushing their Superspeed Attribute to accelerate their metabolism and induce regenerative healing – the GM may remove the minor obstacle (or even turn it into a minor or major edge) after each successful attempt until enough Advancement Points are spent to fully acquire the new Attribute or Attribute Level. This continuously increasing dice roll bonus represents the stunt becoming easier as the character gets used to pushing their abilities in specific ways.

BORROWING FUTURE POINTS

If the character doesn't have any unused Advancement Points available to spend on pushing powers, the GM may allow them to take a loan against Advancement Points that will be allocated to the character at some time in the future. Whether the GM decides to also charge interest on the Point loan is at their discretion.

FREE ONE-TIME PUSHES

Rather than requiring the allocation of Advancement Points towards future Attribute acquisitions, the GM may allow characters to get away with pushing their powers for rare and one-time dramatic situations without Points costs.

Alternatively, rather than giving the characters free rides, the GM may categorise pushing powers as a type of dramatic feat (BESM4, page 195) that burns Energy Points. In these situations, the recommended cost is 40 Energy Points for normal pushes or 80 Energy Points for extraordinary pushes.

► NPC HEDGING

Though even Game Masters enjoy rolling dice, they may also wish to speed up task resolution when NPCs are involved. This can apply during combats between the player characters and NPCs, or during other unopposed tasks that the NPCs attempt. Resolving tasks becomes much more efficient and speedy when the NPCs use hedging on all their rolls (generating a value of 7) instead of needing the GM to roll dice.

► COMBINED ATTACKS

Sometimes, characters will find themselves facing an extremely tough opponent whose protective Armour or Force Field is tough enough to prevent the characters from inflicting harm. In these situations, characters will often co-ordinate their attacks, attempting to strike the same point at the same time in the hopes of overwhelming the target's defences. The target's Armour Rating is subsequently deducted from the combined total damage of the attack, rather than applying to each individual attack damage separately.

When combining attacks, each character must hold their action (Readying, page 35) until the slowest character's Initiative (or later). Every character then makes their own attack rolls individually, which is made unopposed against an average task (TN 12), rather than opposed by a defence roll as usual. If two or three characters are combining their attacks, each of the character's attack rolls suffer a minor obstacle. This increases to a major obstacle if four or more characters are combining attacks.

If a character's attack is successful, they determine how much damage is inflicted by the attack normally. All successful attackers then combine their damage values into one total, and this amount will be inflicted upon the target – as if from one single, powerful attack – if the target's defence roll fails.

The target of a successful combined attack may avoid all damage from the attackers' group effort with a single defence roll – also unopposed, but against a difficult task (TN 15). The defender's Defence Combat Value can include any relevant modifiers to the attack situation, such as the Ranged Defence Attribute bonus when defending against a combined ranged attack, or Enemy Defence Attribute bonus if the combined attackers match the identified opponent type. If two or three opponents made successful combined attack rolls, the target's defence roll suffers a minor obstacle. This increases to a major obstacle if four or more opponents made successful combined attack rolls. The target consequently avoids all damage from the combined attack with a single successful defence roll.

COMBINED WEAPON ENHANCEMENTS

The combined attacking Weapons may individually have one or more Enhancements assigned that could affect the outcome of a joined attack. For example, if one attacker with a Homing Weapon joins with other attackers who only have regular ranged Weapons, how does the single Homing Enhancement affect the combined attack?

Unless every Weapon combining in the attack has the same Enhancement, the Weapon benefits do not carry over to the individual combined attack rolls. For the above example, the character with the Homing Weapon ignores its effects for their attack roll since not all Weapons have it assigned. If every Weapon did have the Homing Enhancement assigned, though, the benefits may be applied to the individual combined attack as well (which provides a minor or major edge on every character's unopposed combined attack roll).

Conversely, Weapon Limiters typically apply to each individual combined attack roll – even if not all the attackers involved have the same Limiter assigned.

STACKING ATTRIBUTES

Several Attributes provide similar functions in different ways, with their benefits stacking on top of each other. For example, a character with Level 2 Attack Mastery and Level 3 Ranged Attack only gains a +2 bonus to their Attack Combat Value for most attack forms (from the Attack Mastery), yet the Attribute effects stacks to a +8 bonus for the specified type of ranged attack (+2 for Attack Mastery plus +6 for Ranged Attack).

When the same Attribute is assigned more than once, the effects are usually applied separately. For example, a character with two distinct Connected Attributes – representing their affiliation with two different organisations – gains independent benefits from each Attribute.

In other instances, two or more assignments of the same Attribute may stack under specific circumstances. For example, Enemy Attack: Blood Relatives at Level 2 and Enemy Attack: Demons at Level 3 would normally produce a Level 5 benefit (+10 to Attack Combat Value) if a particular enemy was both a demon and a blood relative.

The GM and players should establish in advance whether the effects of similar or the same Attributes stack or are considered independently.

MULTIPLE EDGES AND OBSTACLES

The mechanics for both minor and major edges and obstacles are outlined well in the core book (BESM4, page 182). Applying some of the optional rules in BESM Extras – such as tactical actions and expanded game mechanics – may result in situations where more than one edge and obstacle could apply. For these situations, consider the following guidelines:

TWO MINORS EQUAL A MAJOR

Situations that call for two minor edges or two minor obstacles can be replaced by one major edge or obstacle instead.

OPPOSITES CANCEL EACH OTHER

If both a minor edge and a minor obstacle apply to the same roll, the modifiers cancel each other and the dice roll is made as normal. The same situations applies to major edges and major obstacles.

OPPOSITE MINOR REDUCES A MAJOR

If a major obstacle is applied to the same roll as a minor edge, the major obstacle is reduced to a minor obstacle and the minor edge is cancelled. Of course, the converse is also true. This situation is an application of the first two guidelines combined.

OPPOSED ROLLS MAY TAKE SPILLOVER

For opposed rolls (such as in combat), modification that goes beyond a major obstacle or edge can apply a reverse modifier to the opponent's roll. For example, if an attacker gains both a major edge and a minor edge to their roll, only the major edge applies and instead a minor obstacle is applied to the opposing roll (the defender, in this example). Simply max out one roll at a major edge or obstacle and apply any secondary modifiers to the opposing roll as the opposite effect.

MULTIPLE EDGES CAN ALLOW REROLLS

As an alternate to the earlier spillover rule, each minor edge applied to a roll that already benefits from a major edge is converted to one optional immediate reroll instead. Similarly, an

additional major edge converts to up to two optional rerolls. Just like for the Mulligan Attribute (BESM4, page 109), all dice must be rerolled should that option be carried out, and not just selected undesirable dice values.

MAXING OUT AT MAJOR IS FINE

It's also a reasonable alternative to ignore any modifiers that would exceed a major edge or obstacle – regardless of the number of modifiers that apply.

EXCEEDING TWO DICE A POSSIBILITY

Finally, your group may wish to turn every minor edge or obstacle into one extra die rolled and every major into two dice, which is added to the two dice that are normally rolled. For example, if two minor and two major edges would apply to a single roll, instead the player would roll a total of eight dice – the two normal dice, plus one for each of the two minors, plus two for each of the two majors – and then generate a final dice roll total using the highest two dice values (or lowest two values for obstacles instead of edges). In these rare situations, be sure to first apply the earlier guidelines that cancel edges and obstacles on the same roll.



MORALE FOR NPCs

Although players are nearly always the sole arbiters concerning their characters' actions, NPCs under the guidance of the Game Master may instead be subject to the will of the dice. This is particularly true during combat encounters, since NPCs may flee from battle or surrender to their opponents – especially if their side is suffering casualties in combat, or their side is generally not performing well (particularly after their leader has fallen). In these situations, the GM may ask the players to make a morale roll for their allies (or may make the roll themselves, when appropriate), which is a variation on a Stat roll (BESM4, page 179). In most circumstances, an average difficulty (TN 12) applies when checking for morale.

SOUL STAT FOR MORALE CHECKS

There are compelling reasons to use the Soul Stat when making morale rolls, since it represents willpower, determination, and spirit. In specific situations, alternate Stats may be more appropriate – or an average of two or three Stats could be used – though the base choice should be the Soul Stat.

Only significant NPCs check morale individually. Hordes of combatants, such as an army of monsters or mob of angry villagers, use an average Soul Stat for the entire group and check morale as a single, large unit.

► WHEN TO CHECK FOR MORALE

Individual NPCs, as well as groups of combatants fighting together, should make morale rolls during critical combat situations. The situations that would trigger the need to check morale vary whether the NPC is fighting alone or a group is battling as part of a larger combat force. Suggested times to check morale are listed below:

NPC IS FIGHTING ALONE

- » The NPC first suffers combat damage
- » NPC is reduced to 50% of their normal Health Point maximum
- » NPC fails a Stat roll relating to their Shock Value (page 14)

GROUP OF COMBATANTS ARE BATTLING

- » First significant death within the group
- » Death or capture of the group's leader or commander
- » First use of an opponent's terrifying Weapon or special ability
- » Cumulative reduction of the group's forces by 50% through injury, death, or other incapacitation

► MODIFIERS TO MORALE ROLLS

Edges and obstacles can apply to morale rolls for both individual NPCs as well as larger combat forces. Suggested circumstances include:

- » Minor edge if the combat group is larger or more powerful than their opponent's group; minor obstacle if it is smaller
- » Minor edge if the combat group or individual is currently winning the battle; minor obstacle if losing
- » Minor obstacle if the combat group is treated poorly or receives low pay/rewards; major obstacle if group is treated terribly or receives no pay/rewards
- » Minor or major edge, as appropriate, if the combat group or individual is defending something important to them (such as children or loved one, a home, or an important element for survival)
- » Minor or major edge, as appropriate, if the personal consequences for failure in battle or for fleeing/surrendering are severe (such as torturous punishment from a malicious demon lord that oversees the battling monster horde)
- » Major edge if the opponent was seen previously refusing to accept an offer of surrender, and then struck down the surrendering individual or group

► CONSEQUENCES OF FAILURE

A successful morale roll results in no effect, indicating that the individual NPC or large fighting force has the fortitude to continue the battle. Should the morale roll fail, the individual or group will freeze, retreat, flee, or surrender, as most appropriate for the combat situation. For example, a mob of lowly monsters will likely break and flee in random, unorganised directions upon failing a morale check. Conversely, a well-disciplined army of elite soldiers may negotiate favourable terms of surrender should they fail a morale roll.

PLAYER CHARACTER MORALE

Player characters do not make morale checks. Instead, the GM describes the battle environment in narrative detail, which helps evoke appropriate role-playing emotions. Through these interactions, the players will both comprehend and feel the stresses under which their characters operate.

MASS COMBAT

BESM was designed as a role-playing game – not a miniatures game, nor war game, nor board game. Although the system provides a mechanistic framework to handle skirmish-level conflicts between characters, much of the drama and flavour that accompanies combat is rooted in descriptive role-playing elements. Large-scale battles between armies is certainly an important aspect of many anime and manga adventures, and this section explores several options that gaming groups can use as appropriate.

► NARRATIVE DECISIONS

The easiest way to address mass combat is to relegate it to the larger storyline of the campaign. The GM guides the pacing of the adventure to focus on the important player character-NPC combat interactions – such as dramatic sword fights or wizard battles between leaders of opposing armies – and then determines the outcome of the larger mass battles as best fits the story. The GM describes in detail the combat flow and outcome on the battlefield without any need for dice rolls or a game mechanics system. This descriptive method of resolving mass combat is quick, decisive, and impactful, which is perhaps ideal for story-driven adventures but may be unsatisfying for groups that prefer more mechanistic crunch to their military encounters.

► ONE-ROLL RESOLUTION

Large combats can alternatively be resolved with a single roll between participants of the opposing armies that takes numerous factors into account that would reasonably influence a large-scale battle. Examine the following considerations that would oversee mass combat with one efficient roll.

WHICH ARMY HAS....

- » Fighters with higher combined Combat Values (both Attack and Defence)?
- » Fighters with higher average Health Points?
- » More soldiers amongst its ranks?
- » Better weapons, armour, and support equipment?
- » The terrain or fortification advantage?
- » More fighters capable of making ranged attacks?
- » More mounted/cavalry units?
- » Access to better or more powerful special abilities (such as magic, psionics, technology, etc.)?
- » Relevant secret knowledge or advanced preparation before the battle that can influence the outcome?
- » Player characters or NPCs leaders that significantly impact the battle in an army's favour?

TOTAL COMBAT ROLL MODIFIERS

For each of these 10 categories that can influence the mass battle, the GM determines the advantage that one army has over its opponent.

No Advantage: the armies are approximately equal and therefore neither army gains a combat roll modifier

Significant Advantage: one army slightly outmatches its opponent in the category, and thus gains a minor edge on its mass combat roll

Overwhelming Advantage: one army unquestionably outmatches its opponent in the category, and thus gains a major edge on its mass combat roll

For each army, total the number of minor and major edges it gains on its respective combat rolls. Then using the guidelines for multiple edges and obstacles (page 50), cancel out the opposed edges from each army until only one army has any remaining combat roll modifiers. As indicated on page 50, spillover edges beyond one major edge allows dice rerolls.

For example, assume a mass battle has erupted on Ikaris between a tribe of magical elves and an invading band of mecha pilots players, who mistakenly believe they are simply playing in the Ikarion VR game. The elves have enlisted the player characters as allies to repel the VR gamers.

Before combat begins, the GM talks with the players to understand their actions and roles in the coming mass battle. They then examine the 10 categories that may influence the combat outcome, determining which army has the advantage in each category. The tally gains the elves two minor edges and two major edges, and the mecha pilots four major edges (the armies are tied in two categories). After converting the elves' two minor edges to the equivalent of one major edge, and then cancelling three major edges on each side, the final combat modifier results in one major edge for the dominant mecha pilot army.

FINAL OPPOSED ROLL

The outcome of the mass combat is determined by one opposed roll made by the commanders or leaders for each army. Each roll adds together the leaders':

Attack Combat Value + Defence Combat Value + military or comparable Skill Level + dice roll

Any edges gain by the dominant army are applied to the opposed roll. The army with the greater total roll is victorious, with ties rerolled or resolved otherwise.

The player character general has an ACV 8, DCV 6, and Military Skill Group Level 2. If they roll an 8 on two dice, the elves' final mass combat roll total equals 24 and is compared to the mecha pilot leader's combat roll (remembering to apply a major edge to the roll).

USING MULTIPLE ROLLS INSTEAD

If the GM wants to prolong the drama of a mass battle scene and perhaps turn it into the focus of an entire game session, they can instead require one army to win two, three, or more opposed combat rolls. Between each roll, the GM should allow the players to influence the narrative of the combat story by describing the mid-battle scene and the opportunities for meaningful character interactions that arise.

► FLOW OF COMBAT TIME

Unlike regular skirmish-level conflict that operates within a timeframe of 3-4 second combat rounds, mass combat unfolds across a much larger time scale. Each application of mass battle is different and there isn't a set rule to indicate precisely how long a combat lasts. The GM is encouraged to select a reasonable time scale for the battle, which considers the size of the armies on the field (dozens? hundreds? thousands? more?) as well as the scope of their conflict (minor conflict, major battle, or epic campaign?). Suggested time scales include:

- » Hours for small battles of minor scope
- » Days for small battles of major scope
- » Weeks for large battles of minor scope
- » Months for large battles of major scope
- » Seasons for epic battles of major scope
- » Years for legendary battles of primal scope

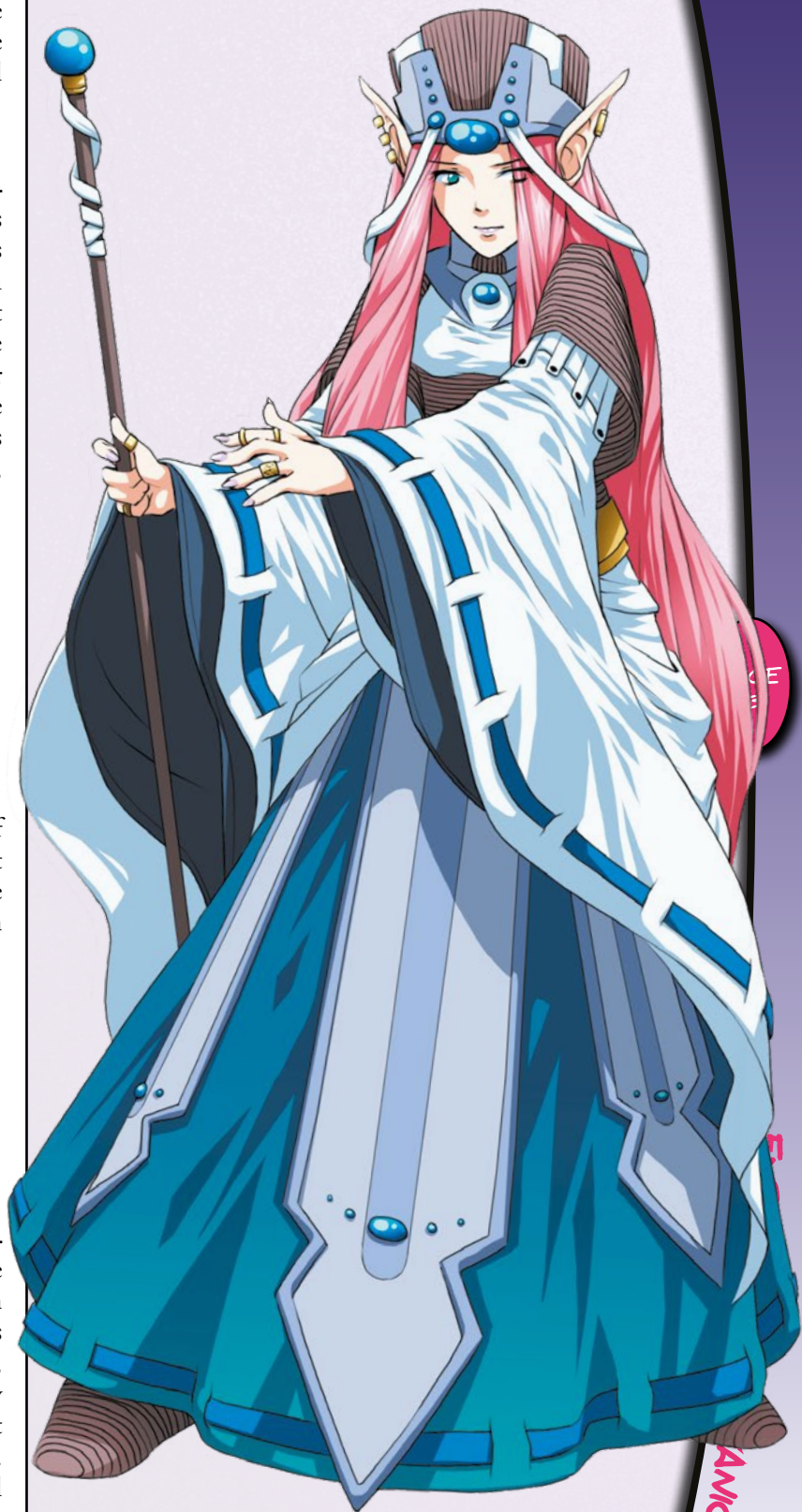
IMPACT OF COMBAT SUCCESS MARGIN

The GM may also decide to have the margin of success during the armies' opposed combat rolls impact the length of time that the mass battle endures. The margin of success (see page 58) is the difference between the winning army's and defeated army's total rolls.

- » **Slight Success:** battle drags on dramatically
- » **Moderate Success:** time increased considerably
- » **Significant Success:** time scale as anticipated
- » **Major Success:** time decreased considerably
- » **Extreme Success:** battle ends quickly

► MULTIPLE ARMIES

These mass engagement rules were written for the typical combat with two opposing armies, but they can be extrapolated for battles waged on multiple fronts between numerous armies as well. In these situations, the GM can either determine the results of each army pairing separately (ie. like a round-robin tournament style), or can examine the 10 categories across all armies. They can determine the modifiers that impact the total combat rolls for each individual army, and then have each army make one roll to determine the victor.



SOCIAL COMBAT

In many RPGs, social interactions are resolved either through role-playing or by making one or more relevant skill rolls (using skill types like diplomacy, subterfuge, charm, bluff, etc.). These techniques also apply in BESM games and are well suited for many different types and styles of adventures. Should your gaming group desire a more mechanistic approach to social interactions, this section provides guidelines for social combat. Role-playing interactions are still a vital component of social combat, of course – the guidelines presented here serve as a companion to the role-playing dynamics.

► SOCIAL DERIVED VALUES

The rules for social combat require characters to have a few new Derived Values (BESM4, page 169).

SOCIAL COMBAT VALUE

Since the talent that a character has for witty societal engagements is dependant both on their mental agility and force of will, their Social Combat Value is the average of a character's Mind and Soul Stats.

SOCIETY POINTS

A character also has a social analogue to Health Points known as Society Points. A character's base Society Points is equal to their Social Combat Value.

► THE SOCIAL BATTLEFIELD

Once one player character or NPC decides to engage in social combat with another person, a battle of charm and wit begins. If the opponent decides to ignore the social aggressor or otherwise not engage in such combat, the instigator automatically wins (see page 55).

Once the social sparring begins, the GM should consider the following categories to determine which social combatant has the upper hand in each of them.

WHICH CHARACTER HAS....

- » More societal privilege?
- » A higher Body Stat value?
- » More Features (Appearance) Attribute assignments?
- » Greater wealth or valuable assets?
- » A higher Connected Attribute relevant to the combat?
- » The greater number of nearby supportive allies?
- » The moral high ground in that social situation?
- » Fewer combined public social and physical Defects?
- » Access to better or more powerful special abilities (such as magic, psionics, technology, etc.)?
- » Relevant secret knowledge or advanced preparation before the sparring that can influence the outcome?

TOTAL SOCIAL ROLL MODIFIERS

For each of these 10 categories that can influence the social combat, the GM determines the advantage that one participant has over their opponent.

No Advantage: the characters are approximately equal and therefore neither gains a combat roll modifier

Significant Advantage: one participant slightly outmatches their opponent in the category, and thus gains a minor edge on their social combat roll

Overwhelming Advantage: one participant unquestionably outmatches their opponent in the category, and thus gains a major edge on their social combat roll

For each character, total the number of minor and major edges they gain on their respective social combat rolls. Then using the guidelines for multiple edges and obstacles (page 50), cancel out the opposed edges from each character until only one participant has any remaining combat roll modifiers. As indicated on page 50, spillover edges beyond one major edge allows dice rerolls.

For example, one of the player characters – a human starhunter who now shepherds plasma birds through the Orb Radiant for the Xyd – approaches their smuggler NPC nemesis at a fancy GTA cocktail party on Cathedral. The character is intent on publicly embarrassing the smuggler by highlighting recent contract failures while freighting contraband. With a drink in hand for dramatic support, the insults fly and social combat between the two participants begins.

As the player and GM role-play the confrontation and exchange barbs on behalf of their characters, the GM examines the 10 categories that may influence the social combat outcome and determines which participant has the advantage in each category. The comparison breaks down as follows:

The starhunter is more physically impressive, gaining minor edges for both Body Stat and Appearance, plus a major edge for having the moral high ground. The smuggler is better Connected throughout the GTA (major edge), has an abundance of allies nearby at the cocktail party (major edge), and has slightly more wealth (minor edge). In the other four categories, the combatants are roughly equal.

After converting the starhunter's two minor edges to the equivalent of one major edge, and then cancelling two major edges on each side, the final social combat modifier results in one minor edge for the smuggler.

OPPOSED SOCIAL COMBAT ROLLS

Once the net edge advantage for the participants has been determined, they both make an opposed social combat roll. Each roll adds together the characters':

Social Combat Value + relevant Skill Level + dice roll

Any edges gained by the dominant character are applied to the opposed roll. The participant with the greater total combat roll damages their opponent's Society Points, with ties rerolled or resolved otherwise.

The player character starhunter has a Social Combat Value of 5, and Social Skill Group at Level 3. If they roll a 10 on two dice, their final social combat roll total equals 18 and is compared to the smuggler's social combat roll. The smuggler has a 7 Social Combat Value but no relevant social Skills. After applying the minor edge, the dice produce a result of 5 – generating a final social combat roll total of 12. The starhunter's initial social combat attack was on point with a significant margin of success (+6).

► SOCIAL DAMAGE

A successful social combat engagement inflicts damage that is deducted from the target's current remaining Society Point total. The number of points deducted depends on the margin of success of the victor's social attack roll, as outlined in Table-05.

Since the starhunter scored a significant margin of success (+6), the smuggler's Society Points are reduced by 3 and thus drop from 7 to 4.

► MULTIPLE SOCIAL ROUNDS

After the first social combat round, sparring typically continues over multiple additional rounds until one participant's Society Points is reduced to zero or below. This provides excellent role-playing opportunities between combat rounds, as participating player characters and NPCs exchange barbs and describe the battle narrative to set the scene.

Normally, attempting to exit the combat early by ignoring the opponent or otherwise not engaging with the aggressor immediately drops the exiting character's Society Points to zero. Once social combat begins, withdrawing without losing face is extremely difficult.

Should both participants mutually decide to not engage in any further rounds of social combat – perhaps due to a distraction, time limit on their interaction, mercy on behalf of the dominant social assailant, etc. – the battle ends immediately and the characters' current Society Point totals remain as they are.

FLOW OF SOCIAL TIME

Unlike regular physical conflict that operates over 3–4 second rounds, social combat typically unfolds across slightly larger timeframes to provide opportunities for substantial sparring engagements. Depending on the circumstances of the conflict, social combat rounds can range in length from 30 seconds to an hour or more.

5

SOCIAL DAMAGE

Margin of Success	Margin Description	Damage Inflicted
1-2	Slight Success	1
3-5	Moderate Success	2
6-11	Significant Success	3
12-17	Major Success	4
18+	Extreme Success	5

► SOCIAL DEFEAT

Once a character's Society Points drop to zero in social combat, they have been defeated in the war of words and suffer an outcome appropriate to the situation. This can include: a loss of face and humiliation, bypassed business opportunities, shame and embarrassment, obstacles on future rolls (Stat, Skill, and/or combat), reduced social standing, gain of a temporary social Defect, and more.

BENEFITS TO THE VICTOR

The victor of the social combat may conversely gain benefits from defeating their opponent, including: new business opportunities, temporary edges on future rolls (Stat, Skill, and/or combat), enhanced social standing, rising romantic opportunities, and more. The GM should work with any impacted player characters to determine an appropriate reward for a social victory.

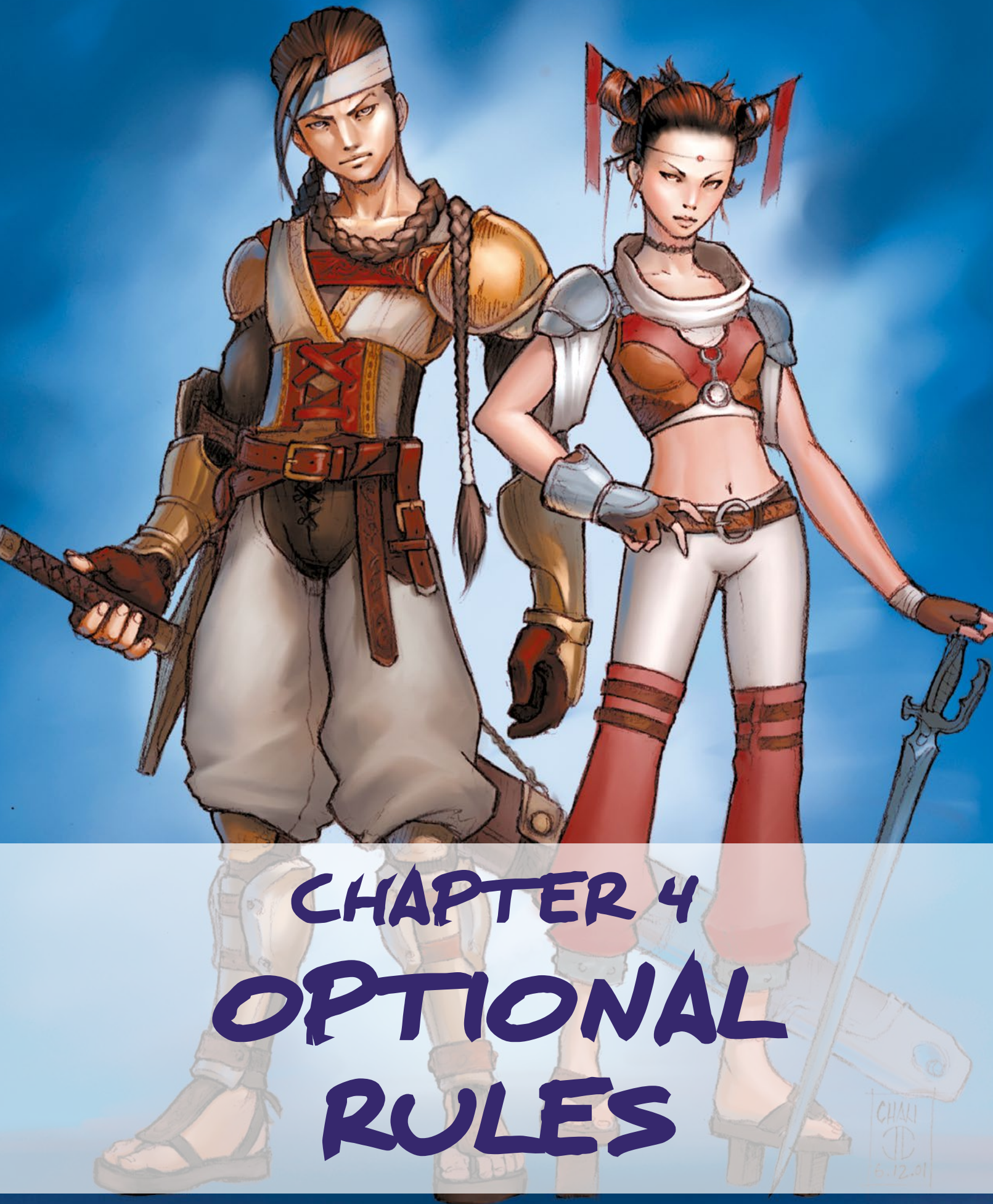
► MULTIPLE COMBATANTS

These social combat rules were written for sparring matches between two individuals, but they can be modified to guide social battles waged between several participants as well. In these situations, the GM can either determine the results of character pairing separately (ie. two characters face off against each other directly, like a round-robin tournament style), or can examine the 10 categories across all social combatants. The GM determines the modifiers that impact the total social combat rolls for each participant after comparison with all others, and then have each character make a social combat roll.

The character with the highest total roll wins that particular social combat round. Each other participant has lost, and each suffers Society Point damage according to their compared roll margins versus the round victor.

► SOCIAL RECOVERY

Society Points are normally returned to characters at the rate of one per hour. This regeneration rate can be modified by favourable or unfortunate circumstances, as appropriate for the adventure narrative.



CHAPTER 4

OPTIONAL

RULES

CHALI
6.12.01

04: OPTIONAL RULES

CHANGING THE BASE

One of the primary philosophies foremost in our thoughts during the creation of BESM Fourth Edition was a desire to keep the core rules simple and straightforward, and universal in their application. There were already a plethora of intriguing character choices presented to players – Attributes, Enhancements, Limiters, Defects, and Templates – and we didn't want to add too many more. This necessitated the exclusion of several alternative costing preferences and expanded combat options that we viewed as too diverse and complex (or “crunchy”) to make the cut for the core rules.

Fortunately, we had already planned to collect these optional rules into BESM Extras, and thus still had the opportunity to make them available for your anime and manga adventures. Use what you like from this chapter, modify these ideas as appropriate for your gaming group, and discard what you don't like.

CRITICAL HITS

In some instances, the attacker's strike is so powerful or overwhelming that it delivers damage greater than its normal maximum amount – known as a critical hit. If the attacker's total roll is significantly higher than the defender's total roll, the attacker scores a critical hit.

If the attacker's roll exceeds the defender's roll by at least 12 (a major margin of success), the final damage delivered is doubled. If the attacker's roll exceeds the defender's roll by at least 18 (an extreme margin of success), the final damage is tripled instead.

The defender's Armour Rating reduces the inflicted damage after the multiplying effect of a critical hit is considered. Additionally, the Health Points lost due to a called shot to vitals (page 37) are doubled after the critical hit multiplying effect – which can increase the Health Point loss to 4x or 6x the normal damage!

UNOPPOSED CRITICAL HITS

Against an unconscious or restrained opponent (an unopposed attack roll; see BESM4, page 189), the final attack damage is doubled with a significant margin of success (exceeding by at least 6) and tripled with a major margin of success (exceeding by at least 12).

IGNORE SIZE MODIFIERS

The ranged attack and defence modifiers for Size Templates (BESM4, page 32) are ignored when determining whether an attack is a critical hit or not. That is, the required margins of success (12+, or 18+) must be achieved without considering the Ranged Attack or Defence Attributes, or Inept Attack or Defence Defects, that are associated with Size Templates.

For example, a huge hydra (Size Rank 2) has a -4 penalty to hit with ranged weapons (-2 Points of Inept Attack: Ranged) and a -4 penalty to defend against ranged weapons (-2 Points of Inept Defence: Ranged). If a human warrior is attacking the hydra with a bow, the warrior must score 4 higher than a major margin of success to inflict double damage ($12 + 4 = 16$ or more) or 4 higher than an extreme margin of success to inflict triple damage ($18 + 4 = 22$ or more). The warrior does

not benefit from the hydra's size-related Inept Defence Defect when determining critical hits. Similarly, if the hydra fights back with a ranged breath weapon, it only needs to score 4 lower than a major margin of success to inflict double damage ($12 - 4 = 8$ or more) or 4 lower than an extreme margin of success to inflict triple damage ($18 - 4 = 14$ or more). The dragon's chance of scoring a critical hit is not penalised by its size-related Inept Attack Defect.

ALTERNATIVE CRITICAL: NATURAL 12

Rather than using difference between the attacker's and defender's total rolls to determine whether a critical hit occurs, the GM and players may collectively decide that any attack dice roll of 12 (showing two 6s) results in a critical hit.

CRITICAL FAILURES

If you are applying the rules for critical hits in your game, you may also want to consider a framework for critical failures. After all, some anime and manga attacks attempts are so wildly ineffective that they actually cause harm to the aggressor!

If the attacker's total roll is significantly lower than the defender's total roll, the result is a critical failure (alternatively known as a critical fumble). If the attacker's roll is lower than the defender's roll by at least 12 (a major margin of failure), the GM applies one of the consequences in Table-06: Critical Failure – either by selecting one that they believe best reflects the circumstances, or by rolling two dice to randomly choose one. If the attacker's roll is lower than the defender's roll by at least 18 (an extreme margin of failure), two consequences are applied instead.

ALTERNATIVE FUMBLE: NATURAL 2

Rather than using difference between the attacker's and defender's total rolls to determine whether a critical failure occurs, the GM and players may collectively decide that any attack dice roll of 2 (showing two 1s) results in a critical failure.

6

CRITICAL FAILURE

Dice Roll	Critical Failure Description
2	Character overextends their reach and rips their clothing in a provocative location
3	Character loses focus in combat and drops to Initiative 1 for the remainder of the battle
4	Character overexerts themselves and pulls a muscle, suffering a minor obstacle on all Body Stat rolls during the next 24 hours
5	Character is off balance and suffers a major obstacle on all defence rolls until their Initiative next round
6	Character stumbles and twists their ankle, cutting their movement speed in half until they rest for several hours or are otherwise healed
7	Character drops their weapon
8	Character's grip on their weapon weakens and they suffer a major obstacle on all attack rolls during the next round
9	Character hits a nearby solid surface and damages or breaks their weapon
10	Character hits a nearby ally instead, inflicting half damage
11	Character hits themselves instead, inflicting half damage
12	Character trips and falls, giving an opponent attacking the character a major edge on attack rolls until character uses an action to stand

7

MARGIN OF SUCCESS

Roll Result vs. Target	Margin of Success
Roll exceeds target by 18+	Extreme success
Roll exceeds target by 12-17	Major success
Roll exceeds target by 6-11	Significant success
Roll exceeds target by 3-5	Moderate success
Roll exceeds target by 1-2	Slight success
Roll equals target	Tie or slim success
Roll misses target by 1-2	Slight failure
Roll misses target by 3-5	Moderate failure
Roll misses target by 6-11	Significant failure
Roll misses target by 12-17	Major failure
Roll misses target by 18+	Extreme failure

MARGIN OF SUCCESS

Most dice rolls in the core BESM rules produce binary results: success or failure. Sometimes it can be useful to the GM and players to know the degree or margin of success or failure as well. If the task was successfully completed, how successful was it? Conversely, if the task failed, how severe was the failure? The greater the difference between the character's dice roll and the Target Number (opposed roll, for contested actions), the greater the margin of success or failure, as listed in Table-07.

KNOCKBACK

Blunt kinetic attacks (such as punches, kicks, or blunt melee weapons) and Weapon Attributes with the Knockback Enhancement (see page 10) inflict Knockback upon a successful hit. Lacerating attacks such as a slash from a sword or a piercing spear do not normally inflict Knockback. The target is knocked back one metre for each point of base damage delivered, before adding the attacker's Attack Combat Value (unless the character has the Enhanced Knockback Combat Technique, page 5). This Knockback distance is reduced by the target's Body Stat, in metres. Additionally, the Immovable Attribute (page 7) and Force Fields without the Impacting Limiter (page 7) reduce Knockback.

KNOCKBACK IMPACT DAMAGE

Characters who are knocked back usually tumble along the ground or sail through the air but do not suffer any additional damage. When a character is knocked back into an object, however, they suffer 1 point of impact damage for each metre of Knockback, up to a maximum of five times the Armour Rating of the object into which they are knocked (see Breaking Items, BESM4, page 223).

OTHER KNOCKBACK EFFECTS

If a character is knocked high into the air, off a building, or some other similar situation, additional damage may be suffered when the character falls to the ground. The Special Movement (Cat-Like) Attribute and perhaps an appropriate Skill roll can mitigate such damage (GM's discretion).

If a character is knocked up into the air (ie. the attack direction pointed up), reduce their Knockback distance by half. The character falls back to the ground and suffers full damage from the fall. A character that falls to the ground as a result of Knockback only suffers damage from the fall (see Table-13: Impact Damage, page 68), not the Knockback impact damage outlined earlier.

Additionally, if the character is currently flying and is knocked back a great distance, the GM can determine if they are able to recover their senses soon enough to regain their flying control before colliding with an obstacle. The GM may require a successful average (TN 12) Body or Mind Stat check for a character to accomplish this if the attack was particularly powerful or the character's flight control was precarious.

GMs may, however, alter any of these guidelines to reflect specific situations or game styles, as appropriate. For example, a GM may decide that a character who is walloped by a hulking beast and knocked back 80 metres before coming to a skidding stop on the pavement will still suffer some damage (perhaps equal to one-tenth the Knockback distance), even if they do not collide with a building or object.

SIMPLE KNOCKBACK

Although the base calculation for Knockback is straightforward – ignoring the Enhanced Knockback Combat Technique, Immovable Attribute, and Force Fields with the Impacting Limiter – some Game Masters may prefer a more qualitative approach. Simply using the guideline that targets of powerful attacks are knocked back dramatically appropriate distances can eliminate an extra calculation and make action-packed combats proceed more quickly and smoothly. This simple Knockback will usually not have any direct character effect – other than moving the target out of melee combat range – but the situation might call for additional damage (such as being knocked off a tall building). GMs that use this narrative approach to Knockback should ensure the players do not assign the Combat Technique (Enhanced Knockback), Immovable, or Force Field (with Impacting Limiter) Attributes to their characters.

RANGE PENALTIES

To reflect a more realistic portrayal of ranged combat (BESM4, page 190) engagements, optional attack roll penalties may apply when Weapons with the Range Enhancement exceeding two assignments target opponents at the extremes of their maximum ranges.

Effective Range: this is up to one-fifth the Weapon's maximum range. If a target is within effective range, no modifiers apply to the attack rolls.

Intermediate Range: this is between one-fifth and one-half the Weapon's maximum range. Attacks rolls at this distance suffer a minor obstacle.

Remote Range: this is between intermediate range up to the Weapon's maximum range. Attacks rolls at this distance suffer a major obstacle.

8

RANGE PENALTIES

Rank	Effective Range	Intermediate Range	Remote Range
1	—	—	—
2	—	—	—
3	Up to 20 m	20 - 50 m	50 - 100 m
4	Up to 200 m	200 - 500 m	500 m - 1 km
5	Up to 2 km	2 - 5 km	5 - 10 km
6	Up to 20 km	20 - 50 km	50 - 100 km
7	Up to 200 km	200 - 500 km	500 - 1,000 km
8	Up to 2k km	2k - 5k km	5k - 10k km
9	Up to 20k km	20k - 50k km	50k - 100k km
10	Up to 200k km	200k - 500k km	500k - 1M km
	No Modifier	Minor Obstacle	Major Obstacle

While some Weapons can technically be fired out to even longer ranges that slightly exceed their Range Enhancement distances (at GM discretion), accuracy is often exceptionally poor. Consequently, opponents should also gain a major edge on their defence rolls in these situations.

Table-08: Range Penalties indicates distance category increments for the Range Enhancement assignments at Rank 3 and above (no penalties apply for Range Ranks 1 and 2). Attack roll penalties associated with firing Weapons at intermediate and remote ranges stack with other attack penalties as appropriate, though they are reduced for characters that possess the Far Shot Combat Technique (page 6).

EXTRA RANGED DAMAGE

In games using variable damage options (page 67), the GM may allow ranged attacks that target opponents within the Weapon's effective range to inflict additional damage. When calculating the variable damage for such ranged attacks, move the damage category up one rank – though damage inflicted can never exceed the most impactful rank.

For example, if modifying the Damage Multiplier based on a secondary damage roll, a roll of 9-10 would normally indicate a +1 Damage Multiplier bonus for the attack. If the target was within the Weapon's effective range, though, the attack would instead gain a +2 Damage Multiplier – which is one category up, and applied to secondary damage rolls of 11-12. Similarly, if modifying the total final damage – rather than the Damage Multiplier – based on a secondary damage roll (keeping this specific example showing a roll of 9-10), the damage would be at 150% instead of 125%, which once again is one category up.

ALTERNATE STAT COSTS

Stats normally cost a flat 2 Character Points for each value assigned, but there are several alternative costing options you can use in your game instead. Table-09: Alternate Stat Costs provides a summary of these cost options for each Stat value.

It's important to keep in mind that changing Stat costs may unbalance the rest of character creation assumptions slightly, since the Level costs of Attributes and Defects were assigned with the 2/Stat costs in mind.

FIBONACCI COST

In this scenario, the cost for Stat Values follows the famous Fibonacci sequence. Value 1 costs 0 Points and value 2 costs 1 Point. Then the cost of each subsequent value is calculated by adding together the costs of the two previous numbers, creating the following costing sequence: 0, 1, 1, 2, 3, 5, 8, 13, 21, 34, 55, and 89. Using this costing sequence makes low-level Stats cost significantly less than the normal cost, mid-level Stats cost approximately the same, and high-level Stats cost significantly more – especially Stats of 11 and 12.

FREE, THEN FIVE

To create a scenario where low-level characters are the norm and more powerful characters are costly, Stat Values of 1 through 4 can be assigned for free. Values of 5 and higher cost 5 Character Points each instead of only 2. This alternative results in Stat values up to 7 costing approximately the same or less than the normal cost, with Stat values 8 and above costing more.

BRACKET COSTS

Stats could cost varying amounts in brackets, with Stat values 1-3 costing 1 Point each, values 4-6 costing 3 each, 7-9 costing 5 each, and values 10-12 costing 7 each. These brackets encourage low- to mid-ranged Stats (costing the same or less than the normal costs), while raising the costs and discouraging higher Stat values.

TRIPLE OVER BENCHMARKS

Stats could also cost the normal 2 per value when they are at or below the maximum benchmark values for your campaign's power level (see Table-02: Character Benchmarks, BESM4, page 24), but cost triple the amount at 6 Points for each value above the benchmarks.

► ALTERNATE ATTRIBUTE COSTS

The Level cost of BESM Attributes normally remain constant, regardless of the campaign power level (see BESM4, page 22). Optionally, players and the GM could jointly agree that the cost of the Attributes would be tripled if their Levels exceed the recommended benchmarks for your assigned power level (see BESM4, page 24). In this circumstance, the benchmarks are not ceilings that restrict character options, but rather are costing thresholds to manage high-Level Attributes.

For example, Attributes in a human-powered game (25-49 Character Points) are at their normal per Level cost for Levels 1-3, while Attributes in a heroic-powered game (74-99 Character Points) are at their normal per Level cost for Levels 1-5. This cost would be tripled when assigning Attributes at Levels 4+ in human-powered games or at Levels 6+ in heroic-powered games.

9

ALTERNATE STAT COSTS

Stat Value	BESM DEFAULT		FIBONACCI COST		FREE, THEN FIVE		BRACKET COSTS	
	Value Cost	Summed Cost	Value Cost	Summed Cost	Value Cost	Summed Cost	Value Cost	Summed Cost
1	2	2	0	0	0	0	1	1
2	2	4	1	1	0	0	1	2
3	2	6	1	2	0	0	1	3
4	2	8	2	4	0	0	3	6
5	2	10	3	7	5	5	3	9
6	2	12	5	12	5	10	3	12
7	2	14	8	20	5	15	5	17
8	2	16	13	33	5	20	5	22
9	2	18	21	54	5	25	5	27
10	2	20	34	88	5	30	7	34
11	2	22	55	143	5	35	7	41
12	2	24	89	232	5	40	7	48

FIXED ATTRIBUTE AND DEFECT LEVELS

Rather than each player being assigned a specific number of Character Points with which to create their character (according to the game's power levels; see BESM4, page 22) they could instead be provided with a set of Level guidelines to assist in ability allocation to their characters. Consequently, players would construct their character ideas from a specific number of Level 1 Attributes, a different number of Level 2 Attributes, etc. The selection of which specific Attributes are assigned would be up to the individual players, with restrictions or guidelines proved by the GM as desired. When considering the impact of Enhancements and Limiters, the Level allocations would apply to the actual Attribute Levels and not their effective Levels.

This alternate character building process may result in a lack of Character Point balance between characters, – since the Level cost varies between Attributes – but does speed up their creation since it removes the need for tracking Character Point allocations in detail. The selection of Defects could follow a similar procedure as well, with fewer concerns about Character Point balance – since the range of Points returned between different Defects is small. Table-10 provides suggestions for fixed Attribute and Defect Level assignments at each of the eight campaign power levels.

For example, in a heroic power level game, a player would assign to their character seven Attributes (two at Level 1, two at Level 2, two at Level 3, and 1 at Level 5 – regardless of their per Level costs) plus four Defects (two at 1 rank assignment, one at 2 rank assignments, and one at 3 rank assignments – regardless whether they are lesser, greater, or serious Defects).

PLAYER RETCON

Retroactive continuity, or “retcon”, can be a helpful role-playing device in which established plots or actions in a game are changed or ignored for the betterment of the unfolding adventure. With GM permission, players can expend Energy Points to alter the story plot details in some way.

MINOR PLOT CHANGES

By expending 10 Energy Points, a player can make a minor change to the adventure, which allows for a slight alteration in the game environment that works in their character's favour. Examples of minor changes include: finding a weapon conveniently located under a table, modifying an NPC's reaction to the character's activities, gaining a sudden burst of inspiration (ie. a GM hint), etc.

MAJOR PLOT CHANGES

Alternatively, a player can burn 50 Energy Points from their character to change drastically an action or event that occurred in the game ... and can retell the plot from a new perspective!

Example: The heroic characters return to their pastoral village after a successful quest to reclaim the sacred Moloch Diamond from the hands of the demonic invaders from Bazaroth. As they emerge from the forest surrounding their home, they discover that the entire village has been burned to the ground and all the citizens with it! Rebecca – the player assuming the role of young Maerlin, the blacksmith's feisty daughter – previously invested significant role-playing time and emotion establishing a romantic relationship with a young fellow named Robin, one of the local farmer's sons. Not wanting that engaging

10

FIXED ATTRIBUTE / DEFECT ASSIGNMENTS

Power Level	NUMBER OF ATTRIBUTES AT INDICATED LEVEL										NUMBER OF DEFECTS AT INDICATED RANK		
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	1	2	3
Sub-Human	2	1									1	1	
Human	2	1	1								1	2	
Adventurer	2	2	1	1							1	1	1
Heroic	2	2	2		1						2	1	1
Mythical	2	2	2	1		1					2	2	1
Superhuman	3	2	2	1	1			1			2	2	1
Superpowered	4	3	2	2	1				1		2	2	2
Godlike	4	3	2	2	1	1		1		1	2	2	2

BESM DX: VARIABLE DICE

In 2002-2003, BESM's underlying Tri-Stat System evolved from using only six-sided dice (d6) to ten-sided dice (d10) with the publication of the superhero RPG, *Silver Age Sentinels*. Other Tri-Stat games further diversified the dice used to d12 (*The Authority RPG*) and d8. The logical conclusion led to the publication of a universal Tri-Stat dX game, where "dX" represented any dice size – from d4 (low-powered, sub-human games) through d20 (god-like powered games).

WHY DX EXISTED

The dX variations – where the dice size shifted according to the power level of the adventures – was needed in the original roll-under system to alter the probabilities of achieving success for the range of character aptitudes. For example, a Stat of 4 has always represented the adult human average. In Tri-Stat dX, to succeed in a Stat-related task, the player must roll their character's Stat or lower on two dice. In a superhero game that uses d10, the probability of rolling 4 or less is only 6%, which is not very likely. This is a desired result, though, since average humans shouldn't often succeed in tasks that are considered normal for a superhero game. In a human-level game that uses d6, though, the probability increases to 17%. Again, this percentage matches the desired result since an average human should have a reasonable, not minuscule, chance of succeeding in a game where above-average humans are the normal player characters. Thus, changing the size of the dice in Tri-Stat dX was an easy way to scale the game to the correct power level (and thus success frequency) for the players characters.

AN OUTDATED LEGACY

This dX trend was rendered unnecessary when the Tri-Stat System and BESM switched from a roll-low and roll-under system to its current roll-high implementation. Now that task resolution is additive – that is, adding the dice roll result to the character's Stat value and Skill Group Level – the power level of any game can be accommodated equally well. Furthermore, characters of wildly different power levels can interact using the same system and its two six-sided dice with ease, with high-Stat individuals gaining a natural and significant advantage over those with lower Stats.

In short, Tri-Stat dX is dead. **Long live 2d6 BESM!**

role-playing relationship to come to an end, Rebecca expends 50 of Maerlin's Energy Points and declares that Robin was actually saved from the disaster when he took refuge from the marauders in the cellar of the mill, saving six young children playing nearby when the fires began. The Game Master takes their cues from Rebecca and runs with this unexpected turn of events. Robin describes to the characters the vicious and unprovoked attack against the village and provides enough detail that the characters have suspicions who is behind this cowardly attack. The campaign continues as the characters seek revenge and retribution!

DYNAMIC INITIATIVE

In the BESM core rules, Initiative regulates the order in which the characters act each combat round. It is checked only once at the beginning of the combat scene – before any character has a chance to act – and remains constant for the entire fight. Some game groups may prefer a more unpredictable and dynamic action order that varies more frequently, though.

To accommodate this preference, Initiative could instead be determined at the beginning of each combat round instead of just once each battle. Otherwise, all the normal Initiative rules and modifiers apply.

► SPREADING EXTRA ACTIONS ACROSS INITIATIVE

Characters with the Extra Actions Attribute (BESM4, page 92) normally take all of their additional actions on the character's single Initiative (BESM4, page 188). The GM and players could collectively decide to spread the actions roughly evenly over the character's Initiative range instead.

For example, if a character had the Extra Actions Attribute at Level 2 (three actions total) and rolled an Initiative of 18, they would take action on Initiative numbers 18, 12, and 6 – evenly spread out between their rolled Initiative number of 18 and zero. This option has the advantage that it spreads actions over the combat round – keeping the pace moving quickly and other players constantly engaged – but it requires that the players pay closer attention to the descending Initiative numbers as each round progresses.

This alternative way of spacing actions throughout the combat round instead of bunching them all at once can also be incorporated into dynamic Initiative rolls that are performed at the beginning of each round.

ABSOLUTES IN BESM

Sometimes, players want to design characters in absolute terms in ways that BESM was not designed to function as an effects-based system. Consider the following player requests, for example:

- » “I want my character’s attack to cut through any armour, regardless of how tough it is.”
- » “My character should be able to imitate any ability, no matter how powerful.”
- » “My character is so accurate with guns that they never miss their target.”
- » “My character’s force field always stops all damage.”

In all of the above examples, the players are asking for absolute dominion over an Attribute that is designed on a scale. For example, the Penetrating Weapon Enhancement (BESM4, page 140) can bypass 10 Armour Ratings for each assignment, but does not overwhelm a fixed percentage of armour (such as 100%). Similarly, the Force Field Attribute (BESM4, page 94) stops 10 damage per Level rather than negating all damage.

To accommodate these requests, the player can either assign Attributes at incredibly high Levels to effectively mimic absolutes or can work with the Game Master to create Unique Attributes that functions outside the normal scale.

HIGH LEVELS

Though it would break the character Level benchmarks (see BESM4, page 24) and be quite costly, assigning Attributes and Enhancements at high levels can mimic absolutes. For example, assigning the Penetrating Enhancement 10 times means the Weapon can cut through a 100 Armour Rating – not quite “cut through any armour”, but pretty close. Similarly Force Field Level 15 stops 150 damage – not quite “stops all damage”, but it can stop a Tomahawk missile.

CREATE A UNIQUE ATTRIBUTE

The GM may allow the player to create a Unique Attribute to represent an absolute effect instead. For example, a Unique Attribute “Never Misses” might cost 10, 15, or 20 Character Points and ensures the character always hits when firing ranged weapons. This solution is more elegant than assigning outrageously high Attribute Levels, but bends the BESM rules in a way they weren’t meant to go (and could create game balance issues).

11

DEFENCE ROLL MODIFIERS

PAGE 63

Defender is in the Following Combat Situations	Defence Roll
Using a total attack action	Major Obstacle
Using a total defence action	Major Edge
Surprised and unaware of the incoming attack	Cannot Defend
Surprised and made aware of the incoming attack at the last moment	Minor or Major Obstacle
Using a shield with one assignment of the Potent Enhancement	Minor Edge
Using a shield with two assignments of the Potent Enhancement	Major Edge
Taking cover – partially concealed (bush, rocks, fog, etc.)	Minor Edge
Taking cover – mostly concealed (tree, building, smoke, etc.)	Major Edge
Defending against a second or third attack in the same round	Minor Obstacle
Defending against a fourth or later attack in the same round	Major Obstacle
Has the Extra Defences Attribute	Reduce Obstacle for each Level
Using a defence action to protect a nearby ally	Minor Obstacle
Attacker is invisible (using the Undetectable: Sight Attribute)	Minor Obstacle
Health Points have been reduced to less than half their original value	Minor Obstacle
Health Points have been reduced to less than the character’s Shock Value	Major Obstacle
Defending against a successful combined attack from two or three opponents	Minor Obstacle
Defending against a successful combined attack from four or more opponents	Major Obstacle
Defender knows they are being attacked by an Inconspicuous Weapon	Minor Obstacle
Defender is attacked by a Weapon with the Quake Enhancement	Major Edge
Defender is attacked by a Weapon with the Spreading Enhancement	Major Obstacle
Victim of a Tangle Weapon is attempting movement-related activities	Major Obstacle

ATTACK ROLL MODIFIERS

Attacker is in the Following Combat Situations

Attacker is in the Following Combat Situations	Attack Roll	Defence Roll
Has aimed a ranged weapon for one round	Minor Edge	
Has aimed a ranged weapon for two or more rounds	Major Edge	
In melee range, and has been waiting for an opening for one round	Minor Edge	
In melee range, and has been waiting for an opening for two or more rounds	Major Edge	
Attacking the same target with two weapons at once	Minor Obstacle	
Attacking two different targets with two weapons at once	Major Obstacle	
Only attempting to touch the target	Minor Edge	
Throwing an unbalanced melee weapon	Major Obstacle	
In melee combat against an opponent who is Undetectable to sight	Minor Obstacle	
In ranged combat against opponent who is Undetectable to sight	Major Obstacle	

Attacker is Attempting a Called Shot

Attacker is Attempting a Called Shot	Attack Roll	Defence Roll
To disarm using a melee attack	Minor Obstacle	
To disarm using a ranged attack	Major Obstacle	
To reduce armour by half	Minor Obstacle	
To bypass armour completely	Major Obstacle	
Targetting a vital spot	Major Obstacle	
Targetting a large Weak Point or large specific location	Minor Obstacle	
Targetting a small Weak Point or small specific location	Major Obstacle	
Targetting a tiny Weak Point or tiny specific location	Major Obstacle	Minor Edge

Attacker is Using One Attack Against Multiple Targets

Attacker is Using One Attack Against Multiple Targets	Attack Roll	Defence Roll
Two targets	Minor Obstacle	
Three targets	Major Obstacle	
Four targets	Major Obstacle	Minor Edge
Five targets (or possibly more)	Major Obstacle	Major Edge

Attacker is Moving

Attacker is Moving	Attack Roll	Defence Roll
Walking or jogging speed (up to 1.5 kph x Body Stat)	No Modifier	
Running speed (2 kph x Body Stat)	Minor Obstacle	
Sprinting speed (4-5 kph x Body Stat)	Major Obstacle	
Swimming or crawling slowly (0.5 kph x Body Stat)	Minor Obstacle	
Swimming or crawling quickly (1 kph x Body Stat)	Major Obstacle	
Making a ranged attack while a passenger in a fast-moving vehicle	Minor Obstacle	
Making a ranged attack while driving a fast-moving vehicle	Major Obstacle	
Making a ranged attack while mounted and moving	Major Obstacle	

Target is Moving

Target is Moving	Attack Roll	Defence Roll
Up to 50 kph	No Modifier	
50-100 kph	Minor Obstacle	
100-250 kph	Major Obstacle	
250-1,000 kph	Major Obstacle	Minor Edge
Faster than 1,000 kph	Major Obstacle	Major Edge

ATTACK ROLL MODIFIERS

Modifiers Involving Weapon Enhancements and Limiters	Attack Roll	Defence Roll
One assignment of the Accurate Enhancement	Minor Edge	
Two assignments of the Accurate Enhancement	Major Edge	
One assignment of the Inaccurate Limiter	Minor Obstacle	
Two assignments of the Inaccurate Limiter	Major Obstacle	
One assignment of the Homing Enhancement	Minor Edge	
Two assignments of the Homing Enhancement	Major Edge	
One assignment of the Flexible Enhancement for special manoeuvres	Major Obstacle	
Two assignments of the Flexible Enhancement for special manoeuvres	Minor Obstacle	
Three assignments of the Flexible Enhancement for special manoeuvres	No Modifier	
Using the Indirect Enhancement to target an opponent	Minor Obstacle	
Attacking the projectile from a Weapon with the Stoppable Limiter	Major Obstacle	

Attacker is Making a Ranged Attack	Attack Roll	Defence Roll
Within the Weapon's effective range	No Modifier	
Within the Weapon's intermediate range	Minor Obstacle	
Within Weapon's remote range	Major Obstacle	

Target is Concealed, Obscured, or Invisible	Attack Roll	Defence Roll
Within melee range and partially concealed or obscured	Minor Obstacle	
Within melee range and mostly concealed or obscured	Major Obstacle	
Beyond melee range and partially concealed or obscured	Major Obstacle	
Beyond melee range and mostly concealed or obscured	Major Obstacle	Minor Edge
Has Undetectable: Sight, but gives away position – melee range	Minor Obstacle	
Has Undetectable: Sight, but gives away position – beyond melee range	Major Obstacle	

Attacker is Combining Attacks with Others	Attack Roll	Defence Roll
Two or three characters are combining	Minor Obstacle	
Four or more characters are combining	Major Obstacle	

Character is in the Following Grappling Situations	Attack or Defence Roll
Has one, two, or three more free hands than their opponent	Minor Edge
Has four or more free hands than their opponent	Major Edge
Has been successfully grabbed and is trying to attack or defend	Minor Obstacle
Has been successfully grabbed and is making a non-attack action	Major Obstacle
Is much stronger than their opponent	Reduce Grappling Obstacles
Is much weaker than their opponent	Increase Obstacle
Is grabbing or has been grabbed and attempts to bite	Minor Obstacle
Is fighting from the ground or from prone position	Minor Obstacle
Is disarming opponent who is holding their weapon with one hand	Minor Obstacle
Is disarming opponent who is holding their weapon with two+ hands	Major Obstacle



CHAPTER 5 EXPLORING DAMAGE

05: EXPLORING DAMAGE

EXAMINING THE PAIN

When most people think of character damage in a role-playing adventure, injuries that are inflicted through combat probably come to mind. Such base damage guidelines are fully addressed in the BESM core rulebook (BESM4, page 193). Of course, there are numerous ways a body can be injured outside of combat as well, and this chapter thoughtfully explores impact damage from crashing and falling, as well as different forms of environmental damage.

To provide alternatives to the standard fixed damage rules in BESM, Chapter 5 also includes a variety of ways that attack damage can be modified to increase variety and unpredictability in combat. Finally, guidelines on the next few pages also examine the roll that shock, unconsciousness, pain, executions, and cinematic recovery can have on your game.

VARIABLE DAMAGE OPTIONS

Some Game Masters and players may prefer variable attack damage, rather than having damage that is always a fixed value for specific attacks – which is the default way damage is delivered in BESM. Six options are presented herein, grouped into two categories: Modifying the Damage Multiplier and Modifying the Total Damage. If the game uses critical hit rules as well (page 57), they apply as normal.

► MODIFYING THE DAMAGE MULTIPLIER

Every character has a fixed Damage Multiplier (see BESM4, page 171). Alternative damage options increase or decrease that value for a successful attack as follows:

BASED ON MARGIN OF SUCCESS

The attacker's Damage Multiplier varies according to the attack's margin of success – the difference between the total attack roll and the total defence roll:

- » -1 Damage Multiplier for a 0 margin of success
- » no change to the Damage Multiplier for a slight margin of success (1 or 2)
- » +1 Damage Multiplier for a moderate margin of success (3, 4, or 5)
- » +2 Damage Multiplier for an significant margin of success (6 or more)

BASED ON ATTACK ROLL

The attacker's Damage Multiplier varies according to the result of the attack roll – the actual dice value:

- » -2 Damage Multiplier for an attack roll of 2-3
- » -1 Damage Multiplier for an attack roll of 4-5
- » no change to the Damage Multiplier for an attack roll of 6-8
- » +1 Damage Multiplier for an attack roll of 9-10
- » +2 Damage Multiplier for an attack roll of 11-12

BASED ON SECOND DAMAGE ROLL

To determine damage, a second dice roll is made after a successful attack. The attacker's Damage Multiplier varies according to the result of the second damage roll:

- » -2 Damage Multiplier for a damage roll of 2-3
- » -1 Damage Multiplier for a damage roll of 4-5
- » no change to the Damage Multiplier for a damage roll of 6-8
- » +1 Damage Multiplier for a damage roll of 9-10
- » +2 Damage Multiplier for a damage roll of 11-12

► MODIFYING THE TOTAL DAMAGE

The total damage inflicted by a successful attack may be modified directly as well, by determining a percentage of damage (rounded down). For example, if an attack delivers 24 damage total, a result of 25% of that damage equals 6 ($24 \times 25\%$); a result of 100% of that damage equals 24 ($24 \times 100\%$); a result of 150% of that damage equals 36 ($24 \times 150\%$); etc. These alternative damage options increase or decrease the total damage as follows:

BASED ON MARGIN OF SUCCESS

The attacker's total damage varies according to the attack's margin of success – the difference between the total attack roll and the total defence roll:

- » 50% for a 0 margin of success
- » 100% for a slight margin of success (1 or 2)
- » 125% for a moderate margin of success (3, 4, or 5)
- » 150% for an significant margin of success (6 or more)

BASED ON ATTACK ROLL

The attacker's total damage varies according to the result of the attack roll – the actual dice value:

- » 25% for an attack roll of 2-3
- » 50% for an attack roll of 4-5
- » 100% for an attack roll of 6-8
- » 125% for an attack roll of 9-10
- » 150% for an attack roll of 11-12

BASED ON SECOND DAMAGE ROLL

To determine damage, a second dice roll is made after a successful attack. The attacker's total damage varies according to the result of the second damage roll:

- » 25% for a damage roll of 2-3
- » 50% for a damage roll of 4-5
- » 100% for a damage roll of 6-8
- » 125% for a damage roll of 9-10
- » 150% for a damage roll of 11-12

NON-COMBAT DAMAGE

Non-combat damage occurs from accidents or disasters such as crashes or environmental hazards. Depending on the cause of the injury, Armour Ratings may not protect. For example, body armour might help against a rock fall, but not against drowning.

► IMPACT DAMAGE

Damage may result from vehicle crashes, falls, avalanches, collapsing buildings, and similar hazards (see Table-13: Impact Damage). Subtract any Armour Rating when appropriate, and deduct the remaining damage from the character's Health Points.

CRASHING

During the course of an adventure, a character's vehicle or mount may accidentally (or deliberately) crash into objects along the road, in the sky, in or on water, or in space. GMs should assess whatever damage they deem appropriate upon both the vehicle and occupants in a crash. The Armour and Force Field Attributes may protect against this damage at the GM's discretion. Similar damage can be applied to a character who jumps or is pushed from a speeding vehicle, or is struck by one.

Table-13: Impact Damage (right column) assists the GM in determining the damage for hitting the ground, water, a building, or some other immovable object based on how fast the vehicle (or object, in the case of a mass striking a character) was moving during that round. If a speed falls between two damage values, use the greater of the two.

FALLING

A character who falls a great distance will suffer damage depending on the height they plummeted. At the GM's discretion, they may also make an appropriate Body-based Skill roll with success halving the sustained damage to indicate a proper break fall. The Armour and Force Field Attributes may protect against this damage (again, at GM's discretion).

13**IMPACT DAMAGE**

Speed	Falling Distance	Damage
< 10 kph	Less than 2 metres	no damage
10 kph	2 to 3 metres	10
20 kph	4 to 6 metres	20
30 kph	7 to 9 metres	30
50 kph	10 to 29 metres	40
100 kph	30 to 49 metres	60
250 kph	50 to 99 metres	80
500 kph	100 to 149 metres	100
1,000 kph	150 to 499 metres	120
2,000 kph	500 metres or more	150
Each Doubling		additional + 50 damage

EXPANDED INJURY RULES

These rules add realism to the game, but also increase complexity. They are certainly suitable for dramatic and heroic games, since it is a common genre element for a hero to be knocked out by a relatively minor blow – only to wake up a few minutes later, captured but otherwise largely uninjured. Likewise, many famous anime heroes have risked (or even succumbed to) blood loss while performing heroic actions or simply talking to their loved ones after a battle. These rules have been designed with that sort of drama in mind.

Since they do add some extra book keeping, though, GMs who want a fast-playing game should not use them – especially if their players are happy simply to role-play reactions to injury.

SHOCK

If a character suffers more damage from a single attack than their Shock Value (page 14), they must make an average (TN 12) Soul Stat roll. If the damage exceeds twice the target's Shock Value, they must make a challenging (TN 18) Soul Stat roll.

If the character fails their roll by a margin equal to their Soul Stat or less, the character is shocked and stunned, reeling from the blow or other injury. They will let go of anything held, and if precariously balanced (such as on a ledge) they may fall. It takes a general action to recover from being stunned. Until the character recovers, they can do nothing except defend.

If the character fails by a margin greater than their Soul Stat, the character is immediately rendered unconscious. Without intervention, the character will remain unconscious for a number of rounds equal to 8 minus the character's Body Stat (minimum 1 round).

KNOCKOUT

If a character fails their Soul Stat roll by any margin during a Shock roll (as above), and the damage inflicted is Stun damage (BESM4, page 141), the character is immediately rendered unconscious. Without intervention, the character will remain unconscious for a number of rounds equal to 8 minus the character's Body Stat (minimum 1 round). Characters suffering Stun damage from an attacker possessing the Blackout Combat Technique (page 5) suffers a minor obstacle to their Soul Stat roll during such Shock checks.

SERIOUS INJURY

A character that suffers more damage than their Shock Value from an attack that inflicts serious internal or external trauma (such as the damage from a bullet, grenade fragment, car accident, etc.) has taken a serious injury – whether the character successfully makes the associated Soul Stat roll or not. A character who suffers a serious injury loses 1 additional Health Point every round (or every minute, if out of combat) until given successful healing or first aid (often requiring an appropriate Skill roll). Just stopping the bleeding through first aid is not enough, however – it only slows the loss of Health Points. A seriously injured character that has undergone successful first aid will lose 1 Health Point every 10 minutes instead until they undergo successful surgery. Thus, a character who is badly hurt might die because of shock and internal injuries before they can be stabilised. A character may suffer multiple serious injuries; if so, each must be treated separately, and Health Point losses are cumulative.

WOUND DIFFICULTY PENALTIES

The Game Master may wish to assign difficulty penalties to characters who have been badly injured. When the character's Health Points are reduced to half their original total, all their rolls suffer minor obstacles. These roll penalties increase major obstacles should the character drop below one-fifth their Health Point maximum.

CATASTROPHIC DAMAGE

If a character loses as many or more Health Points as their normal base Health Points from a single injury, they must make an average Soul Stat roll (TN 12). If this roll fails, the character dies immediately (or is dying, at the GM's option), even if their Health Points have not yet reached the negative value death threshold (see BESM4, page 194).

If an Item suffers a similar fate, it is automatically destroyed unless it's in the owning character's sphere of control (see page 45). In this circumstance, the character may make an average Soul Stat roll (TN 12) to prevent the Item's destruction.

EXECUTIONS IN BESM

Some players and GMs believe its important that a game system allows for one shot kills of restrained foes. Here's the way BESM approaches this topic.

SHORT RESOLUTION

The fast way to handle this is to use a rule that states "if a character targets an opponent who is unconscious, restrained, or otherwise unable to defend themselves, the target is automatically killed." This guideline works well for a variety of campaigns.

LONG RESOLUTION

Even if you don't use the above resolution, the current game mechanics make such executions easy to do. Since the target is restrained or unconscious, the attacker is making an unopposed attack roll against a Target Number of 0 (BESM4, page 189). If the attacker aims or waits for an opening for two rounds (major edge; page 35), makes a total attack (major edge; page 40), and makes a called shot to a vital spot (major obstacle; page 37), the net attack roll gains a major edge and any Health Points lost are doubled. If the character has an Attack Combat Value of 6 and hedges for a value of 9 (BESM4, page 182), the total roll result is 15 and the margin of success is 15 (remember, TN 0) – a critical hit! Since the target is restrained or unconscious, final critical hit attack damage is tripled with the major margin of success of 15 (page 57).

A medium pistol (effective Weapon Level 3) in the hands of an attacker with a Damage Multiplier of 5 will inflict a total of 90 damage:

Level 3 Weapon x 5 Multiplier = 15 damage

15 damage x 3 for critical hit = 45 damage

45 damage x 2 for vital spot = 90 damage

90 damage will kill an average person with 40 Health Points, dropping them to -50 Health Points. Even if the target is exceptionally tough and has more than 90 Health Points, 90 damage likely exceeds twice the target's Shock Value and will thus force them to make a challenging (TN 18) Soul Stat roll (page 68). Success is unlikely, which causes the target to go into shock and succumb from Health Point loss from a serious injury (page 69). And even if a single attack won't kill a nigh-invincible target, unloading an entire clip into their body certainly will!

CONCLUSION

One-shot executions are indeed possible in BESM if you want a more deadly game. How you choose to resolve the conflict is up to you.

LETHAL TO STUN DAMAGE

Weapons with the Stun Enhancement (see BESM4, page 141) and unarmed strikes only inflict nonlethal stun damage. As dramatically appropriate, the GM may allow characters to suffer a major obstacle on their attack rolls to ensure their normal Weapon attacks inflict stun damage as well, instead of regular lethal damage.

► ENVIRONMENTAL DAMAGE

Characters can suffer damage from the surrounding environment, or attacks from enemies not covered by the Weapon Attribute. Since the conditions under which this damage is inflicted varies greatly between scenes, strict damage values cannot be listed for each event. See Deprivation (page 90) for alternate damage rules, too.

The entries in this section should help GMs and players determine the appropriate damage range inflicted, but are only general guidelines. The important question to ask when determining damage is “how quickly do I think an average human would be knocked unconscious or die under this condition?” An average human has 40 Health Points and will thus fall unconscious at 0 Health Points (40 damage) and typically die at -40 Health Points (80 damage).

ACIDIC/BASIC CHEMICALS

Acids (such as sulphuric, hydrofluoric, and hydrochloric) and bases (such as sodium hydroxide, bleach, and potassium hydroxide) cover a wide range of chemical concoctions that cause severe damage or burning to skin and organ tissue – even sometimes penetrating to the bone! Most laboratory chemical exposure is limited in scope, causing localised damage that will scar flesh but is unlikely to kill a human. Full-body exposure to chemicals or complete immersion in a chemical vat can cause extreme burning and kill within several rounds. Since many chemicals are viscous, they will stick to the body and continue to burn until washed away thoroughly. Particularly nasty chemicals will penetrate deeply into the body quickly and destroy living tissue within.

An average chemical exposure localised to a small area will inflict 2 points of damage each round until washed away, with maximum damage capped at 10-20 points. Extreme exposure will inflict 5-40 points of damage each round, depending on the chemical strength.

COLD

Under normal circumstances, a human body can survive in cold environments for long periods (ie. hours) before severe damage (including frostbite – the freezing of body tissue) or death occurs. Damage will depend on the air temperature: for every 10 °C below 0 °C, the character receives 1 point of damage every 10

minutes. For example, a character exposed to -40 °C temperatures will suffer 4 points of damage every 10 minutes, or 24 points an hour. Strong wind-chill factors can double or triple this damage, while warm clothing can reduce it significantly or eliminate it.

Exposure to cold liquids will result in even greater damage: for every 10 °C below 0 °C, the character receives 2 points of damage every round. For example, characters will suffer the following damage each round of exposure: 36 in liquid oxygen (-183 °C), 40 in liquid nitrogen (-196 °C), 50 in liquid hydrogen (-253 °C), 52 in liquid helium (-269 °C).

ELECTRICITY

The voltage and current of an electric shock varies greatly, from common household outlets, to high tension wires, to powerful lightning strikes. The damage is directly related to the amount of electricity that flows through the character's body, and thus grounded characters (with good connections to the Earth) will take 5 times more damage than insulated characters (with a weak or no connection to the Earth). Approximate damage inflicted each round (insulated/grounded): residential current 1/5; average commercial current 5/25; strong commercial current 10/50; and lightning strike 10-20/50-100.

FIRE

Like acid/base damage, fire can burn and scar a character's skin very quickly, but death is only likely after long exposure. The damage values listed in this section relates only to heat damage, either through direct skin contact or heated air. Secondary damage, such as smoke inhalation or lack of oxygen, can inflict additional damage – sometimes exceeding the heat damage. Small fires with localised damage can rarely exceed 40 damage total. Approximate damage inflicted each round: candle flame (2); small fire (4); medium fire (8); large fire (12); blazing inferno (20).

OXYGEN DEPRIVATION

The body's lungs, heart, and brain need a constant supply of air (specifically, oxygen) to continue functioning. Should that supply be removed, the body will quickly die. A character can hold their breath, without suffering damage, for approximately 10-20 seconds (3-6 rounds) multiplied by their Body Stat. After that point, the body will be starved for oxygen and the character will suffer damage. Should the character's lungs fill with a gas or liquid other than air, such as water or chemicals, they will not only be deprived of oxygen, but also cannot breath again until the offending substance is removed. For each round of oxygen deprivation, the character will receive 1 points of damage. This damage is increased to 1/second if another liquid or gas enters the character's lungs as well.

PRESSURE

The human body can withstand a wide range of pressures (often measured in “atmospheres”), but bones will break and lungs will collapse under extreme conditions. The amount of pressure applied to the body is difficult to intuitively estimate unless the character is underwater: pressure increases about one atmosphere for every 10 metres of water depth. Characters do not suffer any significant pressure damage up to 10 atmospheres, provided the pressure is gradually increased and its not a sudden shock. Additional atmospheres of pressure inflict 1 point of damage each round. For example, at 400 metres underwater (40 atmospheres), a character will suffer 30 points of damage each round (40-10=30).

RADIATION

Harmful radiation, such as that emitted by nuclear reactors and radioactive chemicals, causes extreme damage to the human body. The majority of the damage inflicted by nuclear bombs at or near ground zero results from heat and shock wave rather than the nuclear fallout. Exposure to extreme radiation has very little immediate effect upon a character. Within hours or days, however, the cellular damage becomes painfully clear; humans will usually die within a week as the body shuts down. Low levels of radiation exposure will eventually cause radiation sickness, cancer, and death, but these effects can take months or years to develop.

VACUUM

A vacuum is a low-pressure area with little or no air to breathe, such as the vast infinite of space. In anime and manga reality, the following damage can be experienced by a character in a vacuum: unconsciousness, frozen eyeballs, frostbite, boiling blood, and even exploding limbs. In partial vacuums, such as those artificially created in Earth laboratories, characters suffer 2-5 points of damage each round. In near-complete vacuums, such as outer space, characters suffer 5-10 points of damage each round.

► PAIN AND HEALTH POINTS

Health Points have been abstracted in BESM and are normally only decreased as a result of Weapon attacks, environmental damage, and special non-combat situations. It's also possible to inflict Health Point damage that results from bodily pain due to less obvious injuries, such as pinched nerves, overexertion, suboptimal organ function, and more.

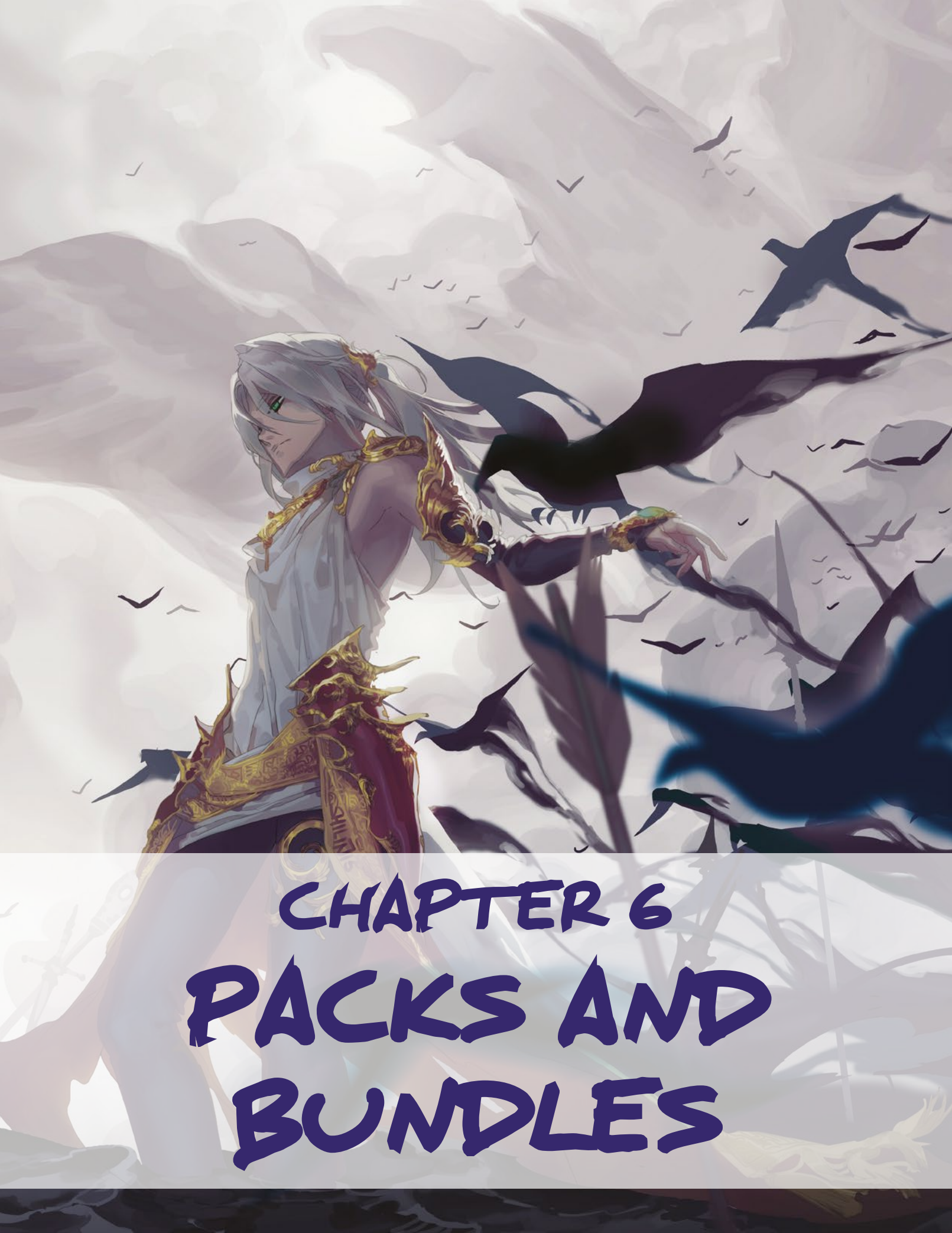
The amount of Health Point damage that the pain inflicts each hour depends on its severity, ranging from 1-5 for minor pain to 6-10 for major pain to 11-20 for excruciating pain. Pain damage usually recovers at the stun damage rate (see BESM4, page 195) but under some circumstances may be treated as normal damage.

► ENHANCED RECOVERY

In more cinematic and less realistic games, the rate of recovering Health Points and Energy Points (BESM4, page 195) may proceed too slowly. The GM and players may jointly decide to increase the recovery rates to hourly instead of daily (for Health Points) or quarter-hourly instead of hourly (for Energy Points).

For Weapons with two assignments of the Incurable Enhancement (BESM4, page 137), the natural healing rate slows to a daily rate instead of a weekly rate when using this enhanced recovery rule.





CHAPTER 6 PACKS AND BUNDLES

06: PACKS & BUNDLES

POWER PACKS

Power Packs are collections of Limiters and Enhancements that players assign to their character's Attributes to reflect the parameters under which the Attributes function. Power Packs are often associated with paranormal origins – divine, magical, psionic, supernatural, etc. – though they can also represent technological or racial background details. Individual Power Packs usually reflect one of the character's single sources of power (BESM4, page 258).

Six distinct Power Packs are detailed in this section – Crystalist, Divine, Psi, Ritualist, Shamanist, Wizardry – though players and GMs are encouraged to develop their own named collection of Limiters and Enhancements to best suit their needs. As normal for BESM, the number printed immediately after the Limiter or Enhancement name indicates how many times it is assigned to the Attribute in the Power Pack.

WIDE APPLICATION VS. ENHANCEMENTS

Though Power Packs can include both Enhancements and Limiters, the examples provided only include the Potent Enhancement – Area, Duration, Range, and Targets are conspicuously absent. This purposeful choice maintains a universal application of the Power Packs, since not all Attributes can have the standard Enhancements applied (see BESM4, Table-11: Allowable Enhancements, page 146). For example, the Area Enhancement cannot apply to the Plant Control Attribute, since the Attribute Level itself determines the area of effect. Similarly, the Range Enhancement cannot apply to Dimension Walk because it is incompatible with how the Attribute functions. Of course, players can also add Enhancements to custom Power Packs if the addition better aligns with their character concept.

MODIFYING POWER PACKS

The number of assignments of specific Limiters (and Potent Enhancement) included in each Power Pack can be raised or lowered to better match a specific vision for the Attribute's use. For example, the Psi Power Pack includes one assignment of the Deplete Limiter, indicating that the Attribute burns 10 Energy Points for each use (for those with immediate effects) or 10 Energy Points for each minute of use (for those with ongoing effects). To instead indicate that Attributes associated with this Power Pack are exceptionally draining on the character, the Deplete Limiter could alternatively be assigned three times – now burning 30 Energy Points for immediate effects or 20 Energy Points/round for ongoing effects. This modification consequently changes the related Attribute's effective Levels by +8 instead of +6.

MODERATING WITH POTENT

Assigning a collection of Limiters to an Attribute may quickly escalate its effective Level beyond a desired outcome. To rein in a Power Pack's application on an Attribute's effective Level, consider adding multiple assignments of the Potent Enhancement (BESM4, page 146), as demonstrated in the Divine, Ritualist, and Wizardry Power Packs.

RECORDING POWER PACKS

Using Power Packs makes recording and reading character sheets easier, since there's less information to include for each Attribute entry. For example, a druid with 1 Level of the Control Environment (Darkness) Attribute with Limiters associated with the Shamanist Power Pack (effective Level 5) could have this entry recorded in two different ways on their character sheet – with the second Power Pack entry being more succinct.

- 1 (5) Control Environment: Darkness
(Emotional +2; Environmental +1; Imbue +1)
- 1 (5) Control Environment: Darkness
(Shamanist +4)



CRYSTALIST

Right – The Crystallist Power Pack is typically assigned to Attributes that tap into the vibrations and resonance of natural crystals and grant the mystic the power to transform, absorb, amplify, and transmit their universal forces. Natural energy is everywhere, and crystals are the perfect conduit between dimensions and harmonic realities. This Power Pack is appropriate for empaths, mystics, occultists, spiritual leaders, thaumaturgists, and woke practitioners.

Power Pack: Crystallist +5

Delay +1 (A few minutes before Attribute takes effect)

Detectable +1 (Crystals glow, resonate vibrations)

Equipment +1 (Requires various crystals)

Unpredictable +2 (Difficult Stat roll – TN 15)

DIVINE

Page 53 – The Divine Power Pack is typically assigned to Attributes that are granted to the character by a greater being or higher power. The character typically prays to, or otherwise calls upon, the divine being in times of need. If the being deems the character worthy of attention, it intervenes on the character's behalf by providing access to supernatural abilities. This Power Pack is appropriate for clerics, priests, shrine maidens, and exorcists ... but can also be renamed "Infernal" should the granting being have demonic rather than divine origins.

Power Pack: Divine +2

Activation +1 (Pray for one round)

Charges +2 (Can only be used three times a day)

Detectable +1 (Character glows in divine light)

Potent -3 (Minor edge on Stat rolls, plus 1 re-roll)

Unique Restriction +1 (Character must keep faith)

PSI

Page 90 – The Psi Power Pack is typically assigned to Attributes that are powered by the character's raw psychic energy. Through intense concentration alone, the character can channel their thoughts into waves of reality that can have a potent effect on the physical world. This Power Pack is appropriate for psionics, extraterrestrials, psychics, and demons.

Power Pack: Psi +6

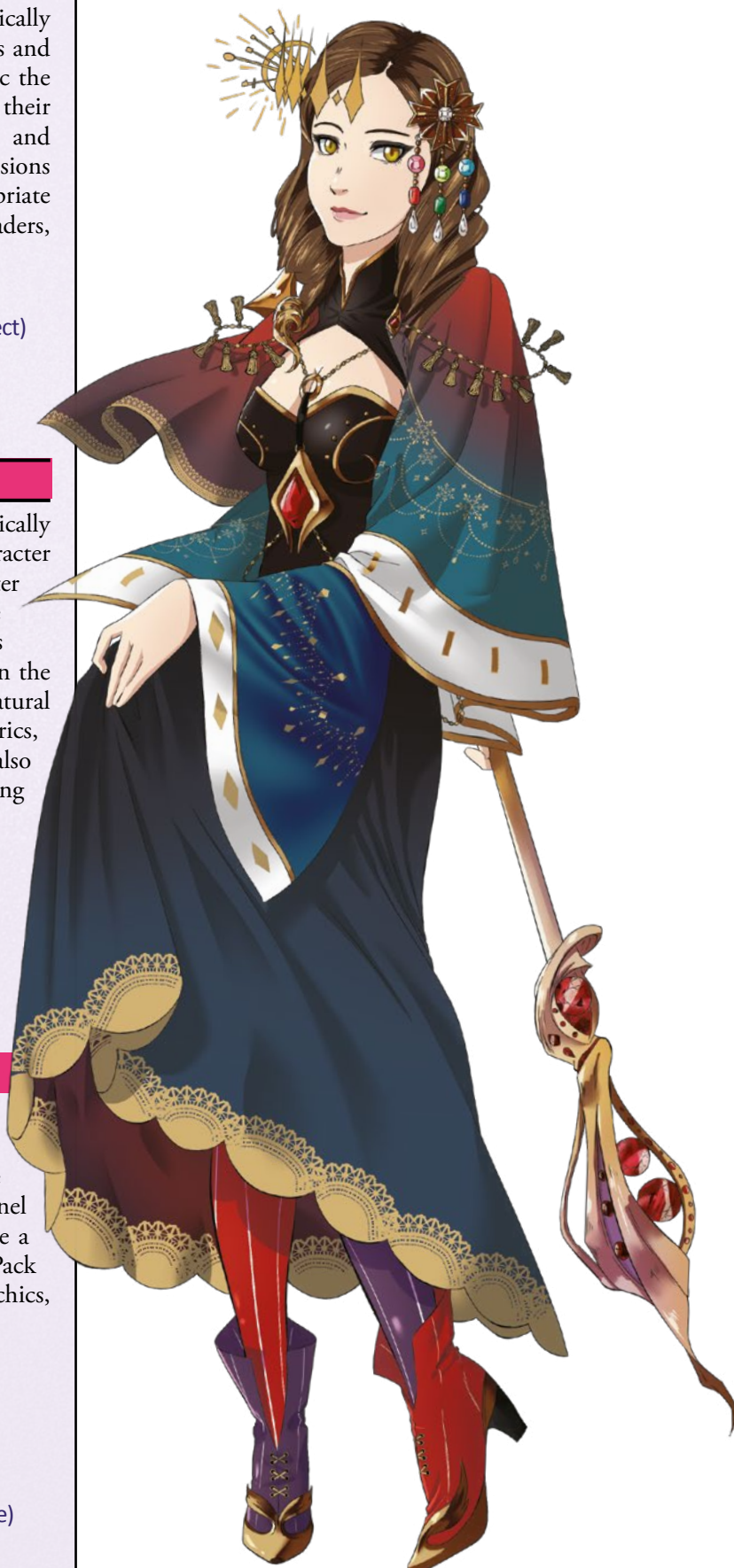
Backlash +1 (If roll fails by margin of 6 or more)

Concentration +2 (No fighting or complex actions)

Deplete +1 (-10 Energy Points or -10/minute)

Detectable +1 (Psionic detection)

Recovery +1 (Wait 1 minute for every minute of use)



RITUALIST

Page 25 – The Ritualist Power Pack is typically assigned to powerful, high-Level Attributes that involve painstakingly specific preparation before the power manifests. Such rituals require several assistants and distinct tools to complete, and carry a very real probability of disastrous consequences should it not be performed with care and precision. This Power Pack is appropriate for necromancers, blood mages, conjurers, and demonologists.

Power Pack: Ritualist +7

Activation +3 (Prepare for 1 hour)

Assisted +2 (Requires 2-10 helpers)

Backlash +2 (If roll fails by a margin of 3 or more)

Concentration +1 (Cannot engage in combat)

Equipment +1 (Requires portable accessories)

Potent -2 (Major edge on Stat rolls)

SHAMANIST

Page 71 – The Shamanist Power Pack is typically assigned to Attributes that are powered by forces of nature and the internal balance within the character. Abilities can only manifest when the character is emotionally invested in the current events, and they primarily benefit a friend or companion rather than the character directly. This Power Pack is appropriate for shamans, medicine gurus, druids, and spiritualists.

Power Pack: Shamanist +4

Emotional +2 (Strong emotional involvement)

Environmental +1 (Native or natural environment)

Imbue +1 (Up to five companions may benefit)

WIZARDRY

Right – The Wizardry Power Pack is typically assigned to Attributes that may best be described as spells or enchantments, and typically involve memorisation of arcane phrases and precise movements (often recorded in an ancient tome of magic). Most spells also require material components to work as well, which are consumed in the casting. This Power Pack is appropriate for wizards, spellslingers, sorcerers, and magical girls.

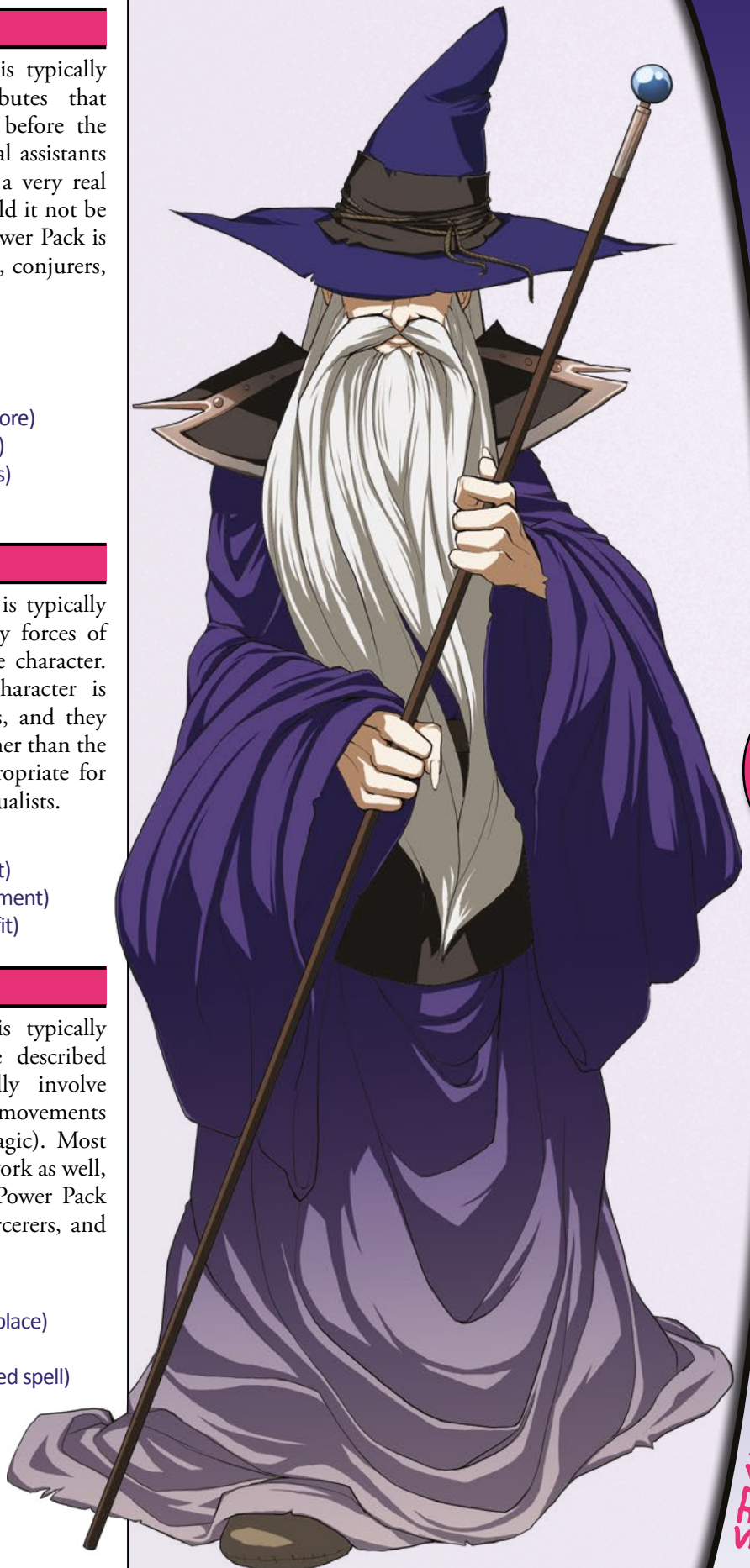
Power Pack: Wizardry +3

Consumable +1 (The spell focus is easy to replace)

Deplete +2 (-20 Energy Points or -5/round)

Detectable +1 (Loud chanting or calling named spell)

Potent -1 (Minor edge on Stat rolls)



POWER BUNDLES

Since BESM is both a point-based and effects-based game system, the core rules don't present a spectrum of pre-built powers or spells from which you can choose and assign to your character. The breadth of ability options is thus nearly unlimited, which is an incredible advantage when building customised characters – but also presents challenges when you simply desire easy choices from which you can quickly select.

Power Bundles are BESM Extra's answer to the traditional spell or ability lists that are presented in other power-based RPGs such as Dungeons & Dragons. They are divided into six traditions – conjuration, evocation, perception, spirit, technology, and transformation – though gaming groups are encouraged to develop their own unique traditions to best suit their game campaign. Power Bundles are pre-built collections of Attributes (with attached Enhancements and Limiters) that provide specific described abilities to characters. Most of these 60 Power Bundles are appropriate for assigning into Items as well.

Power Bundles can effortlessly be assigned during character creation or advancement as a collection of Attributes. They can also be used as temporary spell-like effects gained through the application of Dynamic Powers or Power Flux (see BESM4, page 89 and 113). Power Bundles can work with Power Packs as well (page 73), though players must watch for Limiter duplications.

As per BESM conventions, an Attribute Level in parentheses is its effective Level (see BESM4, page 76).

CONJURATION BUNDLES

The Conjuration tradition involves the temporary summoning of creatures, objects, and energies from other dimensions and realities.

ASTRAL BREAK

This bundle imbues a weapon for one minute with a divine ward that protects the wielder from other magical Weapon attacks. The weapon can also then affect incorporeal and insubstantial targets.

Attribute	Level	Notes, Enhancements, Limiters
Unaffected	4 (3)	Magic; All Weapons -1
Weapon	9 (3)	Duration -4; Multidimensional -1; Penetrating -2; Unique: Weapon must be imbued into an Item +1
Total Cost: 26 Points		

CHEER SQUAD

With preparation, the character summons a squad of enthusiastic astral apparitions to support their allies.

Attribute	Level	Notes, Enhancements, Limiters
Inspire	1 (3)	Activation +2
Total Cost: 2 Points		

CLONE COMMAND

The character can recreate living beings with tissue taken from an original. The tissue must be fresh or preserved in some way – burned or otherwise damaged pieces will not work. During the process, the character enchants a gem that acts as a control device when worn by the clone. After one day, the clone disintegrates. If the original target is built from more than 80 Character Points, their Stats, Attributes, and Defects are represented proportionately in the clone.

Attribute	Level	Notes, Enhancements, Limiters
Companion	8	Duration -3; Concentration +1; Dependent: Reincarnation +1; Equipment: Control Gem +1
Reincarnation 3 (5)		Consumable: Tissue Sample +2
Total Cost: 38 Points		

DARK MIST

A harmless black mist wraith fills the immediate area for up to one hour, blocking light and vision. Wind and sunlight disperse the darkness as if it were any other fog.

Attribute	Level	Notes, Enhancements, Limiters
Control Environment	1	Darkness; Duration -2; Environmental: No Wind/Sunlight +2
Total Cost: 1 Point		

FAE LEVITATION

The character summons dozens of tiny wind faeries to gently lift and carry them through the air.

Attribute	Level	Notes, Enhancements, Limiters
Telekinesis	1 (3)	Activation +1; Unique: Self Only +1
Total Cost: 4 Points		

GIGA SLAY

The character conjures a gate to the Realm of Nightmares and calls upon dark powers to unleash an unimaginable destructive force. The backlash for missing the target is quite severe (as determined by the player and GM).

Attribute	Level	Notes, Enhancements, Limiters
Weapon	10 (11)	Area -3; Range -4; Activation +2; Backlash +2; Unpredictable +2
Total Cost: 20 Points		

PAIN EATER

A summoned wispy, ethereal air elemental with a huge mouth wraps around the character's body and eats incoming kinetic attack energy. The elemental then pushes a soothing regenerating essence into the character, which both heals them and boosts their Energy Points.

Attribute	Level	Notes, Enhancements, Limiters
Absorption	1 (2)	Energy Points; Detectable: Sight of elemental presence +1
Regeneration	1 (2)	Dependent: Absorption +1
Total Cost: 10 Points		

PIT OF DESPAIR

The character can conjure a jet-black oval portal to a terrifying demon world and place it as a trap for unsuspecting wanderers. Anyone merely touching the portal will be transported across dimensions to a literal hellscape unless they make a successful average (TN 12) Soul Stat roll, until they return one day later. Once triggered, the trap disappears.

Attribute	Level	Notes, Enhancements, Limiters
Portal	3 (1)	Home World A to Demon World; Duration -3; Dependent: Weapon +1
Weapon	3 (-1)	Contact -2; Multidimensional -1; Trap -1
Total Cost: 12 Points		

PLANAR BREATH

The character summons an extraplanar entity inside their lungs to process toxins and provide clean, breathable air in otherwise hostile conditions (such as in an oxygen depleted zone or underwater).

Attribute	Level	Notes, Enhancements, Limiters
Resilient	6 (3)	Airborne toxins, lack of air, underwater; All Complete -3
Total Cost: 12 Points		

SHRIEK WEB

The character conjures a web of delicate, nearly invisible threads that lay waiting as a trap for an unfortunate victim. Once contacted, the threads ensnares the target and emits a loud ongoing shrieking sound that will alert anyone or anything nearby.

Attribute	Level	Notes, Enhancements, Limiters
Weapon	5 (-1)	Area -1; Contagious -1; Tangle -4; Trap -1; Unique: Shrieking -1; Activation +1; Delay +1
Total Cost: 10 Points		

EVOCATION BUNDLES

The Evocation tradition empowers the character to manipulate paranormal energies and create impressive effects. Many forms of elemental control fall under the domain of this tradition.

BINDING WIND

A tremendous swirling wind flies forth from the character's outstretched palm, buffeting all in its path. With a successful opposed Mind Stat roll the character can pick up a target and deposit it anywhere within a 10-metre radius. Alternatively, the character may choose to hold a target in place briefly.

Attribute	Level	Notes, Enhancements, Limiters
Telekinesis	3	Range -2; Concentration +1; Focussed: Sentient Beings +1
Total Cost: 12 Points		

BURST ORBS

Numerous small balls of fire explode around the targets. Though the spell does minimal damage, it looks impressive and is useful for scaring enemies.

Attribute	Level	Notes, Enhancements, Limiters
Weapon	7 (1)	Enervation -1; Flare -1; Range -2; Spreading -4; Non-Penetrating +2
Total Cost: 14 Points		

FIREBALL

The character shoots a ball of enormous fire towards their target. The fireball doesn't fly quickly, though, and thus affords the target or others nearby an opportunity to counteract it.

Attribute	Level	Notes, Enhancements, Limiters
Weapon	10 (5)	Area -2; Continuing -2; Range -3; Activation +1; Stoppable +1
Total Cost: 20 Points		

FREEZE CRYSTAL

Chilling tendrils of fog rises from the ground in a selected location. All enemies caught within the fog's reach who do not successfully defend are briefly encased in ice.

Attribute	Level	Notes, Enhancements, Limiters
Weapon	6 (-1)	Area -1; Duration -2; Range -2; Selective -1; Incapacitating: Encased in Ice -2; Activation +1
Total Cost: 12 Points		





06: PACKS & BUNDLES

GLOBE WING

The character forms a protective sphere of wind around themselves, which they can then use to fly slowly. The sphere is extendable, allowing the character to take others with them as well.

Attribute	Level	Notes, Enhancements, Limiters
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Flight	1 (2)	Dependent: Force Field +1
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Force Field	4 (3)	Area -1
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Total Cost: 19 Points

EARTH PART

When the character repeatedly slams their fist into the ground, they can create a large fracture that parts the earth to allow passage.

Attribute	Level	Notes, Enhancements, Limiters
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Tunnelling	4 (5)	Detectable: Booming sounds +1
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Total Cost: 4 Points

INTUMESCENT WALL

Creates a force field against fire-based attacks, diverting the flames to either side of the character and then harmlessly dissipating them. The character may include others nearby in the field of protection.

Attribute	Level	Notes, Enhancements, Limiters
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Force Field	2 (3)	Area -1; Unique: Against Fire Attacks +2
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Total Cost: 8 Points

LANCE OF LIGHT

A bright red beam of light shoots forth from the character's outstretched arms, which can strike a target unconscious.

Attribute	Level	Notes, Enhancements, Limiters
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Weapon	5 (0)	Incapacitating: Unconscious -4; Range -2; Hands +1
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Total Cost: 10 Points

SEARING WHIP

Creates a long whip of pure light that can either entangle foes or slash them repeatedly. Unfortunately, nearby allies may be accidentally singed by the flailing whip as well.

Attribute	Level	Notes, Enhancements, Limiters
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Weapon	7 (3)	Autofire -3; Flexible -1; Muscle -1; Reach -1; Backblast +1; Non-Penetrating +1
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Total Cost: 14 Points

SHOCK VOLT

A bolt of lightning arcs forth from the character, inflicting massive damage to anyone it strikes – especially to targets wearing metal armour.

Attribute	Level	Notes, Enhancements, Limiters
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Weapon	6 (4)	Penetrating -2; Range -2; Activation +1; Unique: Penetrating applies to metal Armour only +1
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Total Cost: 12 Points

PERCEPTION BUNDLES

The Perception tradition grants the character perception of, and power over, aspects of both the physical and metaphysical worlds that yet remain undetectable by normal individuals.

AQUA SPRINT

The character is so finely aware of water surface tension properties that they can sprint (and only sprint) across lakes, rivers, ponds, and similar bodies of water for short periods – typically, no more than one minute.

Attribute	Level	Notes, Enhancements, Limiters
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Water Speed	1 (2)	Maximum +1
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Total Cost: 1 Point

AROMA NOISE

Loud, background static noise and an acrid rotting smell surround the character in a 10-metre spherical radius, making it difficult for anyone to effectively use their sense of hearing or smell to detect anything else. The character must make a concentrated effort to dampen the effect.

Attribute	Level	Notes, Enhancements, Limiters
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Sensory Block	2	Hearing, Smell; Area -2; Detectable: Hearing and Smell +1; Semi-Permanent +1
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Total Cost: 2 Points

FEAR ITSELF

If the character can successfully pick up on a target's surface thoughts, they can create a large convincingly horrific and realistic illusion in the target's mind that physically induces pain and despair.

Attribute	Level	Notes, Enhancements, Limiters
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Illusion	6 (3)	Extra Senses: Five Senses -4; Dependent: Telepathy +1
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Telepathy	1	Range -1; Unique: Read fear only +1
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Weapon	6 (2)	Enervation -1; Range -1; Psychic -4; Dependent: Illusion +1; Toxic +1
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Total Cost: 21 Points

06: PACKS & BUNDLES

FLOW FRACTURE

The character can perceive and temporarily counteract nearby magical effects of moderate power. This bundle is useful for interrupting curses, mind-control spells, and other long-lasting magic effects.

Attribute	Level	Notes, Enhancements, Limiters
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Nullify	6 (3)	Magic; Multiple Attributes -2; Range -1
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Sixth Sense	1	Magic
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Total Cost:	31 Points
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INTERSPATIAL SLIDE

Even with rudimentary knowledge of atomic structures and composition, the character has a strong intuitive perception of the vast emptiness of matter, and can slide their own atoms between those of seemingly solid objects – including physical Weapons.

Attribute	Level	Notes, Enhancements, Limiters
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Change State	4 (6)	Quick Change -1; Maximum +3
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Total Cost:	12 Points
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LONG EYE

This clairvoyance bundle allows the character to see at a great distance, as well as into the past. The scrying must be done through a high-quality focus, such as a crystal ball, a mirror of flawless glass, or a pool of pure water. The basic Long Eye gives visual clairvoyance only, though the character may change the Supersense to something different if desired (such as hearing or magical detection, or a different special sense technique).

Attribute	Level	Notes, Enhancements, Limiters
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Cognition	1 (3)	Postcognition; Dependent: Supersense +1; Unique: Only beyond 1 km range +1
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Supersense	2 (5)	Clairvoyant Sight; Activation +2; Equipment: Quality Scrying Glass +1
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Total Cost:	4 Points
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PLACEBIC TOUCH

Proving the adage “mind over matter”, the character can create small projections of medical devices, equipment, and procedures that can actually provide minor healing to people and creatures – provided they aren’t too smart to ignore the placebo effect.

Attribute	Level	Notes, Enhancements, Limiters
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Healing	1 (2)	Dependent: Projection
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Projection	1 (2)	Unique: Target’s Mind Stat must be 8 or less +1
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Total Cost:	4 Points
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PRECISE STEPS

The character is usually highly perceptive concerning their own body’s movement relationship with its surroundings, which gives them incredible balance and movement agility, as well as a talent to avoid leaving tracks ... at least, most of the time.

Attribute	Level	Notes, Enhancements, Limiters
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Special Movement	2 (4)	Balance, Cat-Like, Light-Footed, Untrackable; Unpredictable +2
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Total Cost:	2 Points
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RUNIC CLOAK

The character can dampen the auras of up to a dozen magical artefacts at once, hiding them from scrying and other detection.

Attribute	Level	Notes, Enhancements, Limiters
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Undetectable	3 (1)	Magical Detection; Targets -3; Unique: Magic Items only +1
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Total Cost:	6 Points
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TONGUE TONGUE

The character’s sense of taste is so refined and precise that they have an extreme awareness of nearly everything and everyone around them. Often this is very awkward for the character using Tongue Tongue, though.

Attribute	Level	Notes, Enhancements, Limiters
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Heightened Awareness	3 (4)	Dependent: Heightened Sense
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Heightened Senses	1	Taste
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Total Cost:	4 Points
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BUNDLE STAT ROLLS

As normal in BESM, Stat rolls are only required when using Attributes as determined by the GM or indicated in the Attribute description. These same conditions apply for Power Bundles as well. When several Attributes comprise a Power Bundle, though, there may be confusion regarding which Stat roll may be required. The GM has three options to consider, all of which are equally appropriate:

1. Require one Stat roll – based on the most difficult requirement for the character.
2. Require one Stat roll – roughly averaging all the required stat rolls for the bundled Attributes.
3. Require multiple Stat rolls – each bundled Attribute require their own successful roll.



SPIRIT BUNDLES

The Spirit tradition is concerned with exploring and manipulating the boundaries between life, death, and aspects that comprise the self. These bundles often evoke powers that only affect unnatural creatures.

BAN LASHING

With preparation, the character can exorcise malevolent spirits and other unnatural dimensional entities from a target's body by drawing lashing wards on a target's flesh.

Attribute	Level	Notes, Enhancements, Limiters
Exorcism	1 (4)	Activation +2; Detectable: Visual wards +1

Total Cost: 1 Point

BLAZING LIGHT

A bright flash of light briefly pulses from the target's body. The searing light is extremely painful to all unnatural creatures, such as the undead, demonic entities, and created abominations. A successful attack roll with this light Weapon will inflict double damage unless the target makes a difficult (TN 15) Body Stat roll, in which case damage is only one-fifth normal.

Attribute	Level	Notes, Enhancements, Limiters
Weapon	6 (2)	Blight -2; Multidimensional -1; Range -2; Exclusive: Unnatural Beings +1

Total Cost: 12 Points

MIND SPIKE

The character emits a blast of mental fire, which can burn away a target's cognitive capacity without harming their body.

Attribute	Level	Notes, Enhancements, Limiters
Weapon	5 (-1)	Drain: Mind -2; Insidious -3; Range -1

Total Cost: 10 Points

PUPPET STRINGS

With a successful opposed Mind Stat roll, the character can gain moderate control of any sentient humanoid for up to one week. The target will obey most orders while under this compulsion, including commands to attack their own allies.

Attribute	Level	Notes, Enhancements, Limiters
Mind Control	12 (4)	Duration -4; Range -5; Broad Category: Humans and sapient beings +1

Total Cost: 60 Points

PURIFY PULSE

While the bundle merely calms humans, undead souls and spirits in the area must make a successful average (TN 12) Soul Stat check or be banished to the Spirit Realm for a day. The initiating character requires at least four other sentient beings to lend their emotional and spiritual support.

Attribute	Level	Notes, Enhancements, Limiters
Mind Control	5 (1)	Area -3; Targets -3; Broad Category: Humans and sapient beings +1; Unique: Calming only +1
Portal	8 (1)	Spirit Realm; Area -3; Duration -3; Range -3; Target -5; Activation +1; Assisted +2; Dependent: Mind Control +1; Unique: Undead Targets +3

Total Cost: 41 Points

RAY BLAZE

This bundle only affects unnatural creatures, such as undead and demonic entities. The nearby target is engulfed in a coruscating burst of blue and white light, which sears their physical body.

Attribute	Level	Notes, Enhancements, Limiters
Weapon	8	Range -2; Activation +1; Exclusive: Unnatural Beings +1

Total Cost: 16 Points

SCORCHING SOUL

The character's force of will is so commanding that, through touch alone, they can extend their soul's natural vibrational energies into the bodies of their opponents to inflict physical damage.

Attribute	Level	Notes, Enhancements, Limiters
Weapon	5 (2)	Aura -1; Insidious -3; Toxic +1

Total Cost: 10 Points

SHADOW SNAP

The character throws a dagger or other small piercing weapon at their target's shadow. Upon a successful hit, the target's feet are stuck to the ground. The spell can be broken by shining bright light on the shadow, which banishes it and thus releases the target.

Attribute	Level	Notes, Enhancements, Limiters
Weapon	1 (0)	Linked: Any piercing weapon thrown at target's shadow -1; Tangle -1; Unique: Tangle only affected by bright light +1

Total Cost: 2 Points

06: PACKS & BUNDLES

SLEEP

A character needs merely touch their opponent to put them into a deep sleep. Even loud noises won't typically awaken the victim for an hour.

Attribute	Level	Notes, Enhancements, Limiters
Weapon	11 (-1)	Duration -5; Incapacitating: Unconscious -4; Insidious -3

Total Cost: 22 Points

SOULFUL BLAST

Balls of blue light shoot from the character's hand that impact both the victim's physical body and their soul.

Attribute	Level	Notes, Enhancements, Limiters
Weapon	5 (2)	Drain Soul -1; Range -2

Total Cost: 10 Points

TECHNOLOGY BUNDLES

The Technology tradition blends together biological, physical, and technical sciences to unlock powerful abilities that may seem magical to the uninitiated.

BOOSTERS

Black market gene therapy has provided the character with the ability to move, act, and perceive the surrounding environment at a tremendous pace. Once activated, though, the character can't moderate their movement well and seems to always be going all out.

Attribute	Level	Notes, Enhancements, Limiters
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Extra Actions 1 (2) Dependent: Superspeed +1

Superspeed 1 (2) Maximum +1

Total Cost: 7 Points

CELLULAR SAUNA

Implanted tiny steam engines distributed throughout the character's skin and internal organs act as partial thermal regulators, providing a consistent amount of heat to their cells. As a result, the character is immune to chilling environments below room temperature. The engines require the character to consume tremendous volumes of water or other liquid to function, though.

Attribute	Level	Notes, Enhancements, Limiters
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Immunity 3 (4) Cold; Consumable: Water +1

Total Cost: 9 Points

CYBERSTRENGTH

Faster, stronger, and more resilient – the character's cybernetically enhanced arm and leg muscles provide numerous amazing benefits.

Attribute	Level	Notes, Enhancements, Limiters
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Armour 1 (2) Localised: Arms and Legs +1

Augmented 2 Body Stat

Combat Technique 2 Brutal, Lethal Blow

Special Movement 1 Fast

Superstrength 2 (3) Localised: Arms and Legs +1

Total Cost: 17 Points



06: PACKS & BUNDLES

DERMAL STITCH

Genetic recombination has granted the character the ability to not only regenerate wounds – though the process is painful – but also detect injuries within others who are nearby.

Attribute	Level	Notes, Enhancements, Limiters
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Regeneration	1 (2)	Unique: Usage inflicts pain +1
Sixth Sense	1	Physical injury in others

Total Cost: 6 Points

NANOMIMICRY

Nanites flowing through the character's bloodstream can scan (through contact) any target's technological enhancements. They can then recombine in precise ways to imitate those abilities within the character for up to ten minutes. After use, the nanites require a short recharge period before reactivation.

Attribute	Level	Notes, Enhancements, Limiters
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Mimic	6 (4)	Technology; All Powers -2; Duration -1; Recovery +1
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Total Cost: 12 Points

IDENTI-SCREEN

Tiny projectors implanted across the character's dermis can project onto their body any one of five discreet alternate identities. The projectors can't be obscured with clothing, though, which limits effective full-body use to the character's naked form only.

Attribute	Level	Notes, Enhancements, Limiters
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Alternate Identity	3 (5)	Detectable: Touch +1; Unique: Naked form only +1
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Total Cost: 3 Points

NEURAL EMP

Dangerous electronic amplifiers implanted along the character's spinal column. Once activated, they can emit short-range disrupter pulses that briefly disrupt or weaken technology in the immediate area.

Attribute	Level	Notes, Enhancements, Limiters
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Nullify	5 (2)	Technology; Area -1; Multiple Attributes -2; Targets -4; Activation +1; Backlash +2; Detectable: Electronic Signature +1
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Total Cost: 25 Points

ORGANOBIONICS

With carbon fibre ligaments and nanopolymer joint enhancements, the character's legs have been transformed into highly reactive and powerful assets. That is, unless the upgrades decide to temporarily glitch and refuse to activate properly.

Attribute	Level	Notes, Enhancements, Limiters
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Defence Mastery	1 (2)	Dependent: Jumping +1
Jumping	1 (2)	Unpredictable +1

Total Cost: 2 Points

WEEFEE HACK

The character's brain has been modified to include a small wireless receiver that can access nearby technology and their connected networks. Using the receiver requires intense concentration and can be both disorienting and nauseating.

Attribute	Level	Notes, Enhancements, Limiters
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Data Access	2 (9)	Concentration +3; Detectable: Digital Fingerprint +1; Recovery +2; Unique: Nauseating +1
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Total Cost: 4 Points

TARGETTING

The character's corneal implants provide enhanced targetting vectors against opponents outside melee range, allowing for even more accurate attacks with scoped long guns.

Attribute	Level	Notes, Enhancements, Limiters
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Combat Technique	2	Far Shot, Precise Aim
Ranged Attack	3	Scoped Long Guns

Total Cost: 5 Points

TRANSFORMATION BUNDLES

The Transformation tradition can alter aspects of the character's own physical composition, and also change those of a target character, item, or environment.

ANGER BULK

When furious, the character's body increases in size and mass, moving up two Size Templates for up to ten minutes. Unfortunately, their clothes lack emotional depth and thus don't transform with them.

Attribute	Level	Notes, Enhancements, Limiters
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Size Change	1 (2)	Duration -1; Emotional: Very angry +2
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Total Cost: 10 Points

06: PACKS & BUNDLES

AQUA CREATE

A jet of water rises from the ground at the target point, soaking anything nearby. After one hour, the water reverts back to earth.

Attribute	Level	Notes, Enhancements, Limiters
Transmute	2 (1)	Area -1; Duration -2; Resize -1; Range -1; Activation +1; Unique: Earth to Water +3

Total Cost: 6 Points

CONDENSED AWESOMENESS

The character can eliminate space between their atomic structures for up to one hour to reduce themselves by four Size Templates, but their ability only functions as an all-or-nothing effect. Oddly, the character still runs at their normal-sized speed even when small.

Attribute	Level	Notes, Enhancements, Limiters
Size Change	3 (4)	Duration -2; Maximum +2; Unique: Naked form only +1
Special Movement	3 (4)	Fast 4; Dependent: Size Change +1

Total Cost: 33 Points

DIGGER SPEAR

Whenever the character is anxious or fearful, they can command sharp spires of rock to thrust from the ground – which can also impale whomever or whatever is nearby.

Attribute	Level	Notes, Enhancements, Limiters
Telekinesis	2 (5)	Emotional: Anxiety/Fear +1; Focused: Earth +1; Unique: Rudimentary Manipulation Only +1
Weapon	6 (2)	Area -2; Penetrating -1; Range -2; Dependent: Telekinesis +1

Total Cost: 20 Points

FLORA FUNNEL

The character has a special relationship with natural vegetation – trees, grass, flowers, and other plants – that allows them to meld into their cellular structure. Once inside the plant, the character can quickly navigate the complex vegetation network to effectively translocate themselves to other plants in far-away destinations, in the precise location that they need to be (but may not always want to be).



06: PACKS & BUNDLES

Attribute	Level	Notes, Enhancements, Limiters
Special Movement	1 (2)	Untrackable, Zen Direction; Dependent: Teleport +1
Teleport	1 (6)	Activation +2; Delay +1; Environmental: From plant to plant only +2

Total Cost: 4 Points

GHASTLY GRANTING

Once the character changes into an incorporeal state, they can pass through a willing target's body and grant them access to any and all of the character's Attributes for up to one minute or dramatic scene.

Attribute	Level	Notes, Enhancements, Limiters
Change State	4 (5)	Unique: Naked form only +1
Transfer	4 (3)	All Attributes -2; Dependent: Change State +1

Total Cost: 24 Points

MAGMA MORPHOSIS

The character can transform a large mass of rock, earth, or sand into molten lava for 10 minutes before it reverts back into its original composition.

Attribute	Level	Notes, Enhancements, Limiters
Transmute	4 (1)	Area -2; Duration -1; Resize -1; Range -2; Unique: Earth to Lava +3

Total Cost: 12 Points

PLANT STRIKE

With mastery over plants in their surrounding area, the character can manipulate their growth and movement and lash out at unsuspecting opponents.

Attribute	Level	Notes, Enhancements, Limiters
Plant Control	4 (3)	Duration -1
Weapon	6 (2)	Flexible -3; Irritant -1; Tangle -2; Dependent: Plant Control +1; Non-Penetrating +1

Total Cost: 16 Points

ROCK ARMOUR

The character can manipulate the nearby ground to surround themselves in a thin layer of earth and rock, which acts as an effective suit of armour.

Attribute	Level	Notes, Enhancements, Limiters
Armour	1 (4)	Dependent: Telekinesis +1; Detectable: Sight +1; Unique: Limited movement speed and flexibility +1
Telekinesis	1 (2)	Focussed: Earth +1

Total Cost: 6 Points

SKIN WRAP

The character can stretch their limbs and torso to entangle and squeeze their opponents in unarmed combat. If the character's body isn't sufficiently ready, though, they may suffer some stretching damage.

Attribute	Level	Notes, Enhancements, Limiters
Combat Technique	2 (3)	Brutal, Lethal Blow, Lightning Reflexes; Dependent: Elasticity +1
Elasticity	3 (4)	Backlash +1
Weapon	4 (3)	Flexible -1; Reach -1; Dependent: Elasticity +1

Total Cost: 13 Points

BUNDLES AS DYNAMIC EFFECTS

As mentioned earlier, Power Bundles can be used as temporary spell-like effects gained through the application of Dynamic Powers or Power Flux. Their use fits into the guidelines presented in the core book (BESM4, page 259) as follows:

WITH DYNAMIC POWERS

The Level total of all Attributes in the Power Bundle counts towards the "twice the Dynamic Powers Level" guideline. Furthermore, the maximum Level limit for Attributes within the Power Bundle (equal to the Dynamic Powers Level) still applies. For most Attributes, the effective Level is considered towards these maximums, though the GM may prefer to use the actual levels in some situations.

WITH POWER FLUX

Power Bundles with Power Flux is a straightforward application, with the listed Total Cost counting against the Flux Points provided by the character's Power Flux Level.

MODIFYING BUNDLES

Since Power Bundles are only suggested collections of Attributes to make gameplay easier for players, modifying the Attributes within the Power Bundles to fit a character's Dynamic Powers or Power Flux range is encouraged.

For example, if a character with Level 3 Power Flux (granting 15 Flux Points) wants to use the Plant Strike Power Bundle, they can reduce the Level of Plant Control down from 4 to 3 to reduce the total cost from 16 to 15 Points. Similarly, a character with only Level 2 Dynamic Powers can still access the Targetting Power Bundle by first reducing its included Ranged Attack Attribute Level from 3 to 2.



CHAPTER 7
ADVENTURING
ELEMENTS

ADDING CAMPAIGN COLOUR

You may have created the most wonderful character imaginable, but their greatness has no impact unless they get out into the world for an adventure.

This chapter explores situations and topics that may appear during a role-playing adventure. First, we provide details on health challenges that characters may encounter during a BESM game, such as poison, disease, and deprivation from life-sustaining necessities. Threat Scores are up next, which provides a way that Game Masters can determine the appropriate power level for the character group's NPC opponents. We then discuss incorporating high-powered characters and artificial intelligences into the game, followed by multiple pages of firearm and vehicle details and customisations. Finally, we talk about rewarding players with engagement bonuses, and include a "How Do I?..." section of miscellaneous topics.

POISONS

A character may be poisoned in several ways, such as damage from a poisoned weapon, touching contact poison, consuming poisoned food or drink, etc. Poisons are designed as Weapons (BESM4, page 132), with most having the Blight Enhancement to represent a chance of resistance and Toxic Limiter.

One dose of poison smeared on a weapon or other object affects just a single target. A poisoned object retains its venom until the weapon scores a hit or the object is touched (unless the poison is wiped off before a target comes in contact with it). A poisoned object exposed to the elements may suffer a degradation of the poison's strength, depending on the circumstances; in some situations, the poison remains potent.

Poisons can be divided into four categories according to the method by which their effect is delivered:

CONTACT

Weapon with Blight and Contact Enhancements, and Toxic (1 assignment) Limiter. Merely touching this type of poison necessitates a Body Stat roll. It can be actively delivered via a weapon or a touch attack. An armoured character may be poisoned if the poison can be delivered to bare skin. Even if a target has sufficient Armour to avoid taking any damage from the attack (such as an animal's tough hide), the poison may still affect it. An object can also be smeared with contact poison as part of a trap. Contact poisons have the same effects if ingested unless otherwise noted.

INGESTED

Weapon with Blight Enhancement and Ingest and Toxic (1 assignment) Limiter. The poison is often applied to food or drink that the target must then consume. This may be done in advance, or the poison may be slipped into the target's food at the last minute in some cases.

INHALED

Weapon with Area and Blight Enhancements, and Toxic (2 assignments) Limiter. Inhaled poisons are usually the result of noxious and toxic fumes. They may

be the result of natural hazards (such as swamps or in mines) or mixed through chemistry or alchemy. When man-made, they may be used as a siege weapon to "smoke" an enemy out. Each target within the affected area must make a Body Stat roll.

INJURY

Weapon with Blight Enhancement and Toxic (1 assignment) Limiter. This poison must be delivered through a wound. If a target has sufficient armour to avoid taking any damage from the attack, the poison has no effect. Traps that cause damage from weapons, needles, etc. sometimes use injury poisons. Poisons that cause damage through injury can also function as an ingested poison unless otherwise noted.

► TREATING POISON

If a healer or skilled practitioner is able to diagnose the poison, that character may make an appropriate Skill roll with a Target Number equal to that associated with the poison's Blight Enhancement in order to halt the toxin's effects – TN 12 for 1 assignment; TN 15 for 2 assignments; or TN 18 for 3 assignments.

DISEASE

Although diseases often play a background narrative role in game adventures – rather than an active, player-centric event – they are handled in much the same way as poisons, especially if the diseases are intentionally weaponised. Communicable diseases can be passed through direct or indirect contact.

DIRECT CONTACT

This type of transmission includes person-to-person contact – through direct skin contact or the exchange of bodily fluids – or through the spray of droplets from coughing, sneezing, and even speaking.

INDIRECT CONTACT

Infectious diseases can also spread indirectly through the air (inhaled) and other mechanism, such as on contaminated objects (contact), in food or drink (ingest), and through animal-to-person (injury).

GENETIC DISEASES

Though commonly called “genetic diseases”, “genetic disorders” is more accurate terminology to classify abnormalities that are formed in the genome. Such disorders are often passed to children through their parents’ genes, or caused by genetic mutations or phenotype alterations. Unlike poisons and regular diseases, genetic disorders are not usually associated with the Weapon Attribute; rather, the expressed disadvantages are best represented by various Defects (BESM4, page 155).

DEPRIVATION

Deprivation is the lack of life-sustaining essentials, such as food, sleep, rest, shelter, water, and air. It results in a deterioration of the character’s health and in some situations can eventually be fatal. But unlike normal damage, deprivation is often easily reversed provided it has not gone too far (it is usually considered to be Stun damage; see BESM4, page 141).

The appropriate Features or Resilient Attribute may prevent specific deprivations from occurring. Otherwise, a character suffering deprivation loses one Health Point every interval, as described in Table-14. All deprivation-incurred Health Point loss is considered incurable and will not recover until the deprivation is ended. For example, a character cannot regain Health Points lost due to hunger without eating (or being fed, if they are too weak to do so), nor regain those lost from freezing water until they are rescued from that icy lake.

For deprivation Health Point loss due to cold and lack of oxygen, these damage values present an alternate, simpler rule to those provided under the Environmental Damage section (page 70). The Game Master can decide which rule they prefer to use.

14

DEPRIVATION

Type of Deprivation	Health Point Loss Interval
Starvation	1 per 8 hours
Hunger (minimal food)	1 per day
Total Dehydration	1 per 2 hours
Partial Dehydration	1 per 8 hours
Overheating	1 per 4 hours
Freezing Cold	1 per hour
Freezing Water	1 per minute
Suffocation	1 per round
Drowning	1 per second



THREAT SCORES FOR OPPONENTS

One of the most difficult aspects facing the GM in many role-playing games is presenting opposition NPCs that are scaled appropriately for the group. Too strong, and the player characters will be outmatched and the players will become frustrated. Too weak, and the adventures risk becoming pedestrian, boring, and routine. This challenge is magnified in BESM since it is a diverse, open-ended, point-based system that allows for near-endless possibilities for both player characters and NPCs.

BESM Extras presents the new concept of Threat Scores to assist GMs in the creation and presentation of NPC opponents. An individual's or group's Threat Score is a measure of how much of a challenge they will present to the player characters during a typical adventure, which considers both combat and non-combat situations. The higher the opponent's Threat Score, the more challenging they will be for the player characters. With many varied ability options, it's impossible to develop one flawless set of never-fail guidelines that are applicable in all situations, but this series of benchmarks for GM consideration will help.

THE POWER LEVEL SPECTRUM

Power levels range across a Character Point spectrum, as outlined in Table-01 from the core rules (see BESM4, page 22): sub-human (0-24); human (25-49); adventurer (50-74); heroic (75-99); mythical (100-149); superhuman (150-199); superpowered (200-249); and godlike (250+). Rather than addressing specific Point totals, Threat Scores are ranked in these power levels.

The terminology for Threat Scores involves "moving up" and "moving down" this spectrum. Moving up refers to the next power level with an increasing Point total. For example, moving up from heroic refers to the mythical level. Conversely, moving down indicates the reverse.

Threat Scores cannot be lower than the bottom of the spectrum (sub-human), nor higher than top of the spectrum (godlike). Threat Score modifications beyond these ranges have no effect and are ignored.

THE BASELINE THREAT SCORE

Players being players – with their boundless creativity and seemingly endless ways to manipulate their character's current situation to their advantage – their characters are more effective against evenly matched opponents. Consequently, the base Threat Score for a single opponent for one player character is one move up the power level. For example, the Threat Score for one player character at human power level is one NPC opponent at the adventurer power level.

► ADJUSTING THE BASELINE

The GM should then consider the following factors to determine the final Threat Score of the individual or group opponent.

MOVE UP FOR THESE CONDITIONS:

- » Two to four characters
- » Five to seven characters (two moves up)
- » Eight or more characters (three moves up)
- » Characters have game values that exceed benchmarks from the BESM core rules (BESM4, page 24)
- » Characters usually have a significant location/setting advantage against opponents

MOVE DOWN FOR THESE CONDITIONS:

- » Two to four opponents
- » Five to seven opponents (two moves down)
- » Eight or more opponents (three moves down)
- » Opponents usually have a significant location/setting advantage against characters
- » Opponents have game values that exceed benchmarks from the BESM core rules (BESM4, page 24)
- » Opponents have been optimised for conflict with the characters

For example, the GM starts a new gaming campaign with player characters created from 60 Character Points (adventurer power level). Consequently, the baseline Threat Score would be the heroic power level – one move up from the character's power level.

The GM then modifies this baseline due to the following conditions: there are eight player characters (three moves up); the opponents are from another Prime World, giving the characters a home-territory advantage (move up); the opponents are two twin cyborg bounty hunters (move down); the cyborgs will have a few Attributes that exceed the recommended benchmarks (move down); and the cyborgs will be optimised to incapacitate and capture the characters (move down).

The power level spectrum is thus moved up by four and down by three, giving a net movement total of one move up from the heroic power level baseline. The appropriate Threat Score for the twin cyborgs is calculated as the mythical power level, and consequently the GM creates each of the two cyborgs from 100-149 Character Points.

The eight 60 Point player characters should roughly be an equal match for the two 125 Point NPC opponents.

GOING BIG

Characters with powers that register off the charts is certainly a common trope in anime and manga series. Game Mastering adventures at the superhuman, superpowered, or godlike power levels can be extremely challenging, since the scope and capacity of what the characters can do may be both vast and diverse. GMs and players should give some consideration to the topics raised in this section to provide additional perspective on character choices when going big with BESM.

STATS BEYOND 12

Stats of 12 in BESM reflect the maximum normal human potential (see BESM4, page 72), and are typically high enough to handle most character concepts. The benchmarks for high-level characters does allow for Stats above 12 (see BESM4, Table-02, page 24), which range from “above human achievement” at value 13, through “extremely powerful superhuman ability” at value 17, and extending to “maximum achievement in the universe” at value 20. Stats above 20 should never be necessary and can be considered a hard limit.

PLANETARY POWERS

If a character can cover an entire planet when using their Attributes, extremely high levels of the Area, Range, and/or Targets Enhancements may be required. For example, a God of Storms character that can control violent weather across the entire planet Earth (the Control Environment Attribute) would also need 8 assignments of the Area Enhancement (to encompass a 10,000 km radius planetary area; see page 12). Similarly, a powerful demonic sorcerer that can infect the thoughts of everyone on Earth simultaneously with simple, non-aggressive suggestions (the Mind Control Attribute Level 2) would not only require 8 assignments of the Range Enhancement (to cover the distance and reach everyone on Earth) but also a whopping 30 assignments of the Targets Enhancement (capping out at 10 billion people). Those power levels are clearly outside the range of what most gaming groups would consider “normal”.

THREATENING OPPONENTS

The guidelines for generating opponent Threat Scores (page 91) somewhat falls apart at the superpowered and godlike power levels. It can be extremely tricky to ensure opponents are tough enough to challenge the characters, but not so tough that they'll never be overcome. As an alternative suggestion, threatening opponents should be created from 50-100 more Character Points than the player characters, and there should be approximately half as many opponents as there are players. For example, a gaming group of six 300-Point godlike characters would reasonably be challenged by three 400-Point enemies.

MANY ROLLS BECOME IRRELEVANT

As suggested in a core rules sidebar (see BESM4, page 180), players do not need to roll dice when their characters' actions are routine or are of trivial difficulty compared to the character's abilities. In a game with exceptionally powerful characters, most actions will fall into these categories and thus rolling dice becomes less important to determine outcomes. Furthermore, since the 2-12 result range of dice gives a smaller variability compared to Stat Values and Skill Group Levels at the higher end of the power level spectrum, the choice to hedge rolls (see BESM4, page 182) may become a more enticing option than rolling dice.

NARRATIVE CAN REPLACE GAMING

Advancing the adventure story through descriptive narrative is often an attractive option for gaming groups in high-powered BESM games. By elevating the abilities of player characters above common game mechanics with impactful narrative instead of dice rolls, the epic scope of the characters is reinforced. A gaming group could spend a long while slogging through a large-scale combat, or a quick description could move the narrative along better and make for more impactful storytelling:

GM: “You emerge from the temple and see dozens of furious goblin minions racing towards you with swords ready to strike. What do you do?”

Player: “I’ll draw my ancestral blade and race down the stairs to meet them head on. I’ll show them why people call me the Blue Thunder of Neo-Tokyo!”

GM: “After a few effortless minutes, dozens of dead goblins lie at your feet as you wipe their blood from your blade and resheath it. Where are you going next?”

Player: “Onward towards the university to confront the necromancer and retrieve the artefact!”

PLAYER VS. CHARACTER ABILITY

There is a problem that exists in nearly all RPGs, but is particularly exacerbated at the highest power levels: player vs. character ability and knowledge. It can be challenging when enforcing that characters have a different skill and ability set than their players, since the actions of the characters are usually dictated by their players. The GM must use both the BESM rules and a keen sense of dramatic flair when helping adjudicate circumstances that present a conflict between player and character talents. For example when a character wants to seduce a mark, yet the player knows nothing about seduction, the GM needs to fall back on a social rule set to resolve the action.

With the scale of action being so much bigger and the breadth of knowledge and ability being so much wider at the superpowered and godlike power levels, the GM and players should lean heavily on good storytelling to help keep the action flowing and players engaged.

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCES

Although most anime and manga game adventures feature humans, humanoids, and other organic, carbon-based lifeforms as the central characters, mechanical life – artificial intelligences, or AI – may certainly be possible or even common in a setting with sufficiently advanced technology. BESM game mechanics can accommodate AIs, of course, with specific implementation tailored to the theme and tone of the adventures. Consider the following options to integrate AI into your game.

► REGULAR CHARACTERS

The mechanical/digital life of AI doesn't need to be substantially different than biological life of regular characters – especially in an effects-based game like BESM. In such scenarios, AI are treated like all other characters with the same three Stats, same Derived Values, and same bodily effects for damage and healing. Background details can identify the source of AI abilities (such as self-healing metal frames that are analogous to biological characters recovering Health Points), and Attributes and Defects can provide additional features unique to the status of the AI. The Giant Living Robot Race Template (BESM4, page 41) provides an excellent example of AI treated as a normal character, with the Resilience Attribute reflecting the non-biological nature of the cybernetic body.

► LACKING A SOUL

Alternatively, AI can be similar to their biological counterparts with one notable exception: artificial lifeforms do not have a soul and consequently do not have a Soul Stat. This isn't exactly the same as having a zero Soul, though; rather, the character's Soul Stat does not exist. Consequently, Derived Values ignore the consideration of the Soul Stat, meaning that the character's Combat Value is equal to the average of only Body and Mind Stats, and Health Points are equal to 10 times the character's Body Stat instead. When making Stat rolls, the character's Mind Stat often replaces their Soul Stat as required.

Handling AI this way requires additional effort on behalf of the player and GM when considering the absence of a Soul Stat, though most game mechanics remain largely unchanged.

► ONLY A MIND

Some NPC AI do not exist as regular characters but as thinking digital minds within a computer or other structure. For example, an AI may form the core

operating system of a space station and function as its caretaker, but the AI does not exist outside the station structure. Such AI are best designed as Items that can have Mind Stat assignments at its normal Stat cost of 2 Points/Value. Remember that the Mind Stat doesn't just reflect raw knowledge and volume of data; it also represents critical thinking, strategic decision making, and rational thought. For such AI, the Item's base Combat Value is equal to its Mind Stat, which may be modified through Attributes and Defects as though the AI was a character.

► OTHER CONSIDERATIONS

In most other aspects, an AI is treated as an Item and not a character. For example, the AI doesn't calculate Health Points as a Derived Value but instead as an Item, which means the AI's Health Points are equal to the structure's Armour Rating (see BESM4, page 197). The presence or lack of Stats doesn't influence this value.



FIREARMS

A standard 21st-century gun is a weapon designed to use the expanding gasses produced by a chemical propellant to fire a solid projectile accurately over a distance. In most modern firearms, the ammunition consists of a solid projectile (usually a lead or lead alloy bullet) loaded into a larger gilding metal (brass) cartridge case that contains a powder which acts as a propellant when ignited. At the base of the case is a primer, a tiny explosive charge.

Guns are often described in terms of calibre – for example, a .38 calibre pistol or a 7.62mm rifle. Calibre is the diameter of the inside of a weapon's barrel (the bore) and thus a measure of how large a bullet it fires. Calibre is given in either fractions of an inch (for many older American firearms) or in millimetres (for example, 9mm) for most other designs. Calibre is also used to measure the size of a bullet and designate the ammunition that can be fired ("a .45 bullet"). However, ammunition with the same calibre can be very different. For example, a cartridge for a rifle is usually much longer than a pistol, with this extra length packing in more propellant, allowing the bullet to travel faster and hit harder. Thus, a .223 rifle bullet does more damage than a .45 pistol.

Different types of ammunition with the same calibre are distinguished from one another in various ways: by original manufacturer (such as .45 ACP for Automatic Colt Pistol), by user (7.62mm NATO) or by following the calibre with the cartridge case length (5.56mm x 45mm). Often the same cartridge can go by different names. Thus, .308 Winchester, as used in the M14 and FN-FAL battle rifles (and many hunting rifles) is also known as 7.62mm NATO and 7.62mm X 51mm. As its longer cartridge case indicates, it is more powerful than 7.62mm x 39mm Russian (used in the AK-47 assault rifle).

A gun consists of two major parts: the barrel and the receiver. The receiver is the mechanical part of a gun. It "receives" a cartridge from a magazine, loads it into the firing chamber, and holds it in place until the shooter pulls the trigger. This activates a hammer, which drives a firing pin into the base of the cartridge. This sets off the primer, which in turn ignites the propellant in the cartridge. The propellant burns very rapidly, producing expanding gasses that force the bullet out of the cartridge and down the gas-tight gun barrel and out of the weapon.

The longer the gun barrel, the higher a velocity a given bullet can reach. Gun barrels are usually rifled, with grooves inside engineered to make a bullet spin, for accuracy. An exception to this are shotguns, in which

rifling is not used, as they are designed to fire cartridges containing multiple small pellets rather than bullets.

When a gun fires, it produces recoil. Guns normally have a pistol grip, shoulder stock, or both to control recoil and steady the user's aim. A gun with a shoulder stock is sometimes called a "long gun" to distinguish it from a hand gun, which has only a pistol grip. Guns with both a shoulder stock and pistol grip are sometimes called "assault-style" weapons – a contentious term on the political landscape – after the visually distinctive feature of military assault rifles.

Once a modern gun fires, it is necessary to reload ("chamber") another cartridge. Exactly how a gun's receiver does this is referred to as the "action" of the weapon.

In a revolver-action weapon, the cartridges are stored in a rotating cylinder in the centre of the receiver, which usually holds about six cartridges. After each is fired, the action of pulling the trigger rotates the cylinder, bringing another cartridge into line with the gun's hammer, ready to fire. When all the revolver's cartridges are fired, the cylinder is swung open, old cartridges are extracted and new cartridges manually inserted. (Older "single-action" revolvers require manually cocking the hammer between each shot.)

In bolt-action, lever-action, or pump-action guns, individual bullets are held in an internal tube or fixed magazine attached to the weapon, holding 5-10 cartridges. The user must work a lever, bolt, or pump between each shot to eject the empty cartridge and load (chamber) a new one.

In a semi-automatic (or "auto-loading") weapon, cartridges are typically stored in a detachable spring-loaded box magazine, holding anywhere from 5 to 50 cartridges. The receiver taps either the energy of the recoil or gas produced by the firing and uses it to work a mechanism that automatically ejects the empty cartridge and loads a new one, allowing the user to fire each time the trigger is pulled. After a magazine is empty, it can be quickly ejected and a new full magazine inserted, allowing fast reloading. An empty magazine can also be refilled one bullet at a time.

A fully-automatic weapon (a machine gun) works the same way as a semi-automatic, but fires continuously as long as the trigger is held down, until the magazine is out of ammunition. Most fully automatic weapons use box magazines, but some larger machine guns use a drum or a belt of linked cartridges instead. A majority of fully automatic weapons (with the exception of large machine guns) are "selective-fire," allowing the weapon to be switched from fully to semi-automatic action.

Single shot action weapons hold only one round of ammunition at a time; after the loaded round is fired, the casing (if any) must be ejected and a new round manually loaded. Weapons of this type often have a “break-down” mechanism; at the flick of a lever, the barrel flips down from the receiver, ejecting the spent shell to allow a new round to be inserted into the firing chamber. Sporting guns (with or without multiple barrels), and guns firing extremely large, powerful ammunition, often have this action type.

Most guns have some sort of safety feature (either a switch or decocking lever) that prevents the gun being fired when the safety is on. Anyone who fails to “safe” their weapon (or unload it) before holstering it risks having it go off by accident if the character falls or bumps the gun.

Guns can take a fair bit of abuse and still work, but all guns should be stripped down and cleaned periodically to reduce the chance of a malfunction.

FIREARM LAWS

The laws regulating firearms are important for characters across a wide spectrum. Criminals will wish to know what they and their rivals can carry without being busted – and what they can make a profit smuggling. Cops can use gun violations as a tool to crack down on their adversaries, while bounty hunters and private detectives will wish to know what they can legally carry without breaking the law. Regular citizens who own firearms need to be aware of local regulations and Federal laws as well.

This section is a rough guide to firearm laws in the United States, Canada, and Japan, and also serves as examples of different levels of gun regulation. Most other nations are usually more restrictive than the United States but less so than Japan. Note that some nations may have strict gun laws on paper, but very lax enforcement due to corruption, lack of money for policing, or the breakdown of civil order.

Law enforcement agencies and the military are exempt from most of the legal restrictions described below, although local regulations may limit the weapons to which police departments have access. Obsolete antiques (generally pre-1898 “black powder” firearms or weapons using ammunition that is no longer available) and unserviceable weapons are also largely exempt from rules, provided it is difficult to bring them back into a working condition. In the United States, the term “DEWAT” (deactivated war trophy) refers to an unserviceable military weapon in private hands.

► GUN LAWS IN THE UNITED STATES OF AMERICA

The United States is one of the easiest places in the world to legally acquire firearms. There are approximately 400 million guns under civilian American ownership – more than one for each American. In a typical year, 30-40,000 people in the US are killed by firearms.

Gun ownership is subject to federal, state and local legislation. The Bureau of Alcohol, Tobacco, Firearms and Explosives (ATF), part of the Department of Justice, enforces federal firearms laws. Violations of federal firearms laws can result in up to 10 years imprisonment and fines up to \$500,000. Under federal law, the use of a firearm in a violent or drug-trafficking crime is punishable by a mandatory prison sentence of 1 to 20 years. Someone convicted of using a machine gun, silenced weapon, or destructive device during a violent or drug-related crime faces mandatory life imprisonment. In federal law, there are two main classes of firearms and accessories: Title 1 weapons and Title 2 (“NFA”) weapons.

TITLE 1 WEAPONS

“Title 1” weapons are the basic civilian firearms: rifles, shotguns, and handguns. The term “Title 1” comes from a section of the Gun Control Act. Title 1 weapons can be purchased in gun shops, at gun shows, or (sometimes) through the mail, provided this does not violate state or local laws.

Unlike many other countries, it is not necessary to have a federal permit or license to own a rifle or shotgun, nor is any federal permit needed to own a pistol. However, it is illegal for gun dealers to sell firearms or ammunition to minors (under 18), and only shotguns, rifles, or their ammunition can be sold to people under age 21. It is also against the law to sell guns or ammunition to anyone who has been convicted of serious crimes (a year or more in jail, any drug offence), is a fugitive from justice, a drug addict or mental patient, a non-citizen, dishonourably discharged from the military, or who is under a restraining order meant to deter stalking or domestic violence. Firearms are also restricted by federal law from being carried into some areas, such as federal buildings, court houses, and aboard commercial aircraft.

The Brady Handgun Violence Prevention Act (Brady Bill) requires a five-day waiting period before picking up a handgun after purchasing it. This permits time for a background check (to prevent selling guns to a felon, minor, fugitive, etc.) and allows a “cooling down” period so someone does not purchase a gun on the spur of the moment and then use it. The National Instant Criminal Background Check System (NICS) launched in 1998 offers a much faster check option.

Individual states have passed their own laws further regulating certain Title 1 firearms, especially pistols. Individuals transporting guns across state lines will need to be aware of the differences in state law. These differing laws also provide a ready market for gun smugglers, and help explain why illegal guns are often readily available in states that have more restrictive gun legislation than those which do not. The state or local laws that regulate “concealed carry” of firearms are most relevant to BESM characters. In some states, it is illegal to carry a concealed, loaded firearm (there may be some exemptions for individuals that require one for their occupation, such as a security guard). Guns being transported on foot or by vehicle must be unloaded and kept in a case. In other states, there are either no such restrictions, or concealed carry is allowed if the owner has a (relatively easy to acquire) state or county-issued concealed carry permit. A concealed carry permit usually requires a police background check and passing a short gun-safety course.

All guns manufactured must be marked with an individual serial number. Filing off the serial number is illegal (and can also damage the gun if done carelessly).

TITLE 2 (“NFA”) WEAPONS

“Title 2” weapons and accessories are those that are regulated by the National Firearms Act (NFA) of 1968. (The name comes from title 2 of the Act). They are also called “class 3” weapons, after the class 3 Special Occupational Taxpayer license that a gun dealer should have to sell them. NFA weapons include all machine guns, shotguns with shortened or sawed-off barrels, silencers, and destructive devices. This latter category includes weapons such as explosive hand grenades, Molotov cocktails, and poison gas, as well as heavy weapons such as cannons, mortars, grenade launchers, recoilless rifles, and rocket launchers. Devices such as flare guns are not included. Oddly, flame throwers are not regulated either, but they aren’t exactly easy to obtain.

The regulations restricting Title 1 weapons apply to Title 2 weapons. In addition, all Title 2 weapons must be federally registered. In order to buy a Title 2 weapon, the sale must first be approved by the ATF, which collects a tax (usually about \$200) on each purchase. The seller must also pay a tax if they are not a registered “class 3” dealer. The buyer must be 21 or over, and must fill in and send off a ATF form 4. This requires a passport photo and an indication why the weapon is being purchased (usually “collector”). The prospective buyer must be fingerprinted at local police or sheriff’s office, and the officer must sign a statement certifying that the purchaser is not wanted. The dealer will then collect the \$200 tax and mail the paperwork off to the ATF, which does its own background check. After two or three months, the authorization for the sale will

arrive and the gun can be picked up from the dealer. The owner is required to keep close tabs on it (not lend it out, etc.). They may not transfer it to another person without going through a similar procedure, or transport it across state lines without telling the ATF.

As long as the weapon is properly registered, the tax paid and the appropriate paperwork is filed, federal law does not prohibit a private citizen from owning a machine gun, silencer, or similar device. However, many NFA weapons are prohibited by individual states. In particular, machine guns are either banned outright or very heavily regulated in numerous states. The ATF will not approve sales or purchases where they would violate state legislation.

The laws regulating destructive devices (poison gas, anti-tank missiles, etc.) are stricter, and in general, private citizens will not be able to acquire them unless they have an appropriate license to make these sorts of things for the government or foreign export.

DEALING IN GUNS

Dealing in guns and ammunition or shipping them across state lines requires a Federal Firearms License (FFL), which involves an application to the ATF and a small fee. The license is good for approximately three years before it has to be renewed. The application takes weeks to process, including at least a cursory background check or phone interview. A Federal Firearms License enables its holder to purchase guns and ammunitions from manufacturers at dealer-discounted rates or (sometimes) by mail, and is usually needed to work as a gunsmith. However, the reason not every gun owner jumps at this opportunity is that having an FFL also requires the holder to specify a place of business where the firearms or ammunition are kept, and to permit ATF agents to make unannounced inspections, without a warrant, during its hours. Some states also require additional licenses for gun and ammunition dealers.

A dealer must document each sale, recording the details on a federal form, which identifies the purchaser (some sort of ID is required, usually proof of residence in the state and a driver’s license) and also records the make, model, and serial number of the firearm. However, this information is not sent to the ATF. It is simply kept in the gun shop’s records, and it is up to the ATF to come by and examine them if they wish to trace a particular gun used in a crime (identified by its serial number) back to its original buyer. Sales to an individual of multiple handguns within a five-day period require dealer notification to ATF (who will often choose to investigate) although this is done by mail. The reason the ATF are interested in multiple handgun sales is that it might indicate someone who is buying guns for illegal resale (to minors, criminals, etc.). Such “straw man” sales (where one person buys a gun

for someone not supposed to have it) are a major source of illegal weapons. Violations of dealer record keeping requirements are punishable by a financial penalty and one year's imprisonment.

Becoming a dealer in Title 2 "NFA" firearms such as machine guns is more difficult. Any FFL holder can deal in individual machine guns provided their state has not made this illegal, but they must pay an additional tax on each such weapon. To get around this, the gun dealer must become a "Class 3 SOT Dealer" which costs an additional fee per year, and requires a more stringent background check than a normal license requires. Normally such a license will only be available to someone who supplies law enforcement or the military.

Becoming a dealer in destructive devices (explosives, grenades, rocket launchers, etc.) requires a separate "Category 10" Federal Firearms License. This costs thousands per year and is normally only granted to companies who are supplying the government.

► GUN LAWS IN CANADA

Firearm ownership is more restrictive in Canada than in the United States, but it is legal to own some kinds of guns in Canada. Despite these restrictions, there is likely more than two million gun owners in Canada, and from 10-20 million civilian guns (exact estimates vary). About 1 in 3 rural Canadian homes have a gun, but less than 1 in 15 urban homes. Approximately 150-300 people are killed in Canada every year from gun fire.

Violating Canadian gun control regulations (such as carrying a pistol without a proper permit) may lead to a 5-year prison term. More severe violations, such as gun smuggling, will mean at least a 10-year sentence. Someone who is convicted of using a firearm during a crime can expect to have 1-14 years added to their sentence (at least 3 years if a repeat offence). It is estimated that the vast majority of illegal handguns in Canada are imported from the US.

RIFLE AND SHOTGUN OWNERSHIP

In Canada, only weapons equivalent to US "Title 1" weapons are available at all. Machine guns, AP bullets, and destructive devices are completely illegal for private ownership or sale. Any prospective gun owner must possess a firearms acquisition certificate. In order to obtain one, an applicant must be an adult citizen, must pass a full-day firearms safety course, fill in a detailed questionnaire (and in some provinces, multiple letters of reference from appropriate individuals, such as one's employer, police officers, doctors or lawyers), and undergo a police background check. A person may fail a background check if they are mentally unstable, have a criminal background, are an illegal immigrant, or have a history of drug, spousal, or alcohol abuse.

If the firearms acquisition certificate is granted, the recipient is authorised to purchase shotguns or rifles and their ammunition. Semi-automatic rifles and shotguns are limited to a five-round magazine. Americans entering the country may bring rifles or shotguns with them for hunting or competition, if they declare them at the border and they obey this restriction.

PISTOL OWNERSHIP

Getting a handgun in Canada is more difficult. The applicant must have a firearms acquisition certificate. They may then apply for a pistol permit, and must specify the reason the handgun is needed. Valid reasons are:

- » To protect one's life – but only if the applicant can show that police protection would be inadequate and their life is in serious danger. This is rarely granted.
- » For one's occupation. This permit is only granted to individuals who are security guards working for appropriate companies.
- » As a collector. This allows the user to have the pistol at home, but they may not carry or move it except under very severe restrictions (in a locked box, for example), and restrictions are placed on use and display of it.
- » For target shooting. Again, this does not permit the user to carry it in public, except in a locked box, and they must belong to a registered shooting club.

Handguns are limited to 10-round magazine, and snub-nosed weapons are illegal. Visitors entering the country may not bring handguns with them.

► GUN LAWS IN JAPAN

Firearm laws in Japan are even more restrictive than Canada's, let alone those of the United States. Gun legislation falls under the Firearms and Sword Control Act. It recognises civilian gun ownership as valid for only two purposes: sports competition shooting and hunting. In sharp contrast to the United States, self-defence is not considered a justifiable reason for firearm ownership.

There are only about 200,000 legally owned guns estimated to be in private hands in Japan. Illegal possession of firearms is punished by 1-10 years in prison. Getting caught using a gun during a crime means 3 years to life in prison, with similar penalties for arms smuggling. Under 10 and up to a couple dozen people are killed in Japan each year by firearms, and a couple of hundred people are arrested for gun crimes. A few thousand illegal guns are seized annually, mostly in incidents related to organised criminal gangs. The rarity of guns drives up prices on the black market. An illegal revolver or auto pistol can sell for as much as one million yen (more than \$9,000 US dollars), or 10-20 times the price of a black market pistol in the US.



RIFLE AND SHOTGUN OWNERSHIP

Ownership of a sporting or hunting weapon requires a license. To get one, the applicant must attend a short safety lecture at their neighbourhood police station, pass a safety examination, and register for the license (which is good for three years).

This is only the start of the procedure, however, and only qualifies the applicant to purchase air rifles, and air pistols. To own an actual firearm, the would-be gun owner must be over 20 (or 18, if they have the support of an official sports organisation). The procedure depends on the type of firearm.

A permit for a shotgun requires additional paperwork be submitted to the police, along with passing a (fairly easy) shooting examination and an exhaustive background check. All of this takes a few months. As usual, individuals with a history of mental illness, criminal records, drug addiction, or alcohol problems will be denied a license.

A permit for a rifle requires the same process, with the additional requirement of membership in the National Rifle Association of Japan plus a more difficult skill certification examination. The purchase of a large calibre (medium or heavy) rifle is only permitted if the applicant has either owned a light rifle for at least a year or has owned a shotgun for at least 10 years.

Each individual firearm purchase requires a preliminary visit to the gun shop to select the weapon, and then another month's wait while the gun store sends out paperwork to the police. An individual permit is needed for each weapon. After picking up the permit, the gun can finally be taken out of the store. Within two weeks of the initial purchase, the newly-bought gun must then be taken to a police station for a final inspection. Purchase of ammunition requires additional paperwork and police permission. A gun owner is required to keep their weapon in a secure, locked cabinet. Firearms must also be taken to the police station once a year for an annual inspection.

PISTOL OWNERSHIP

A license for a pistol (for sports shooting only) is very difficult to get. The would-be license-holder must have passed an air pistol test and gain an excellent score in safety and marksmanship. Moreover, the pistol is not licensed for concealed carry, and must be transported in a sealed case when going to or from a competition – and stored at a police station for safekeeping when not in use. The odds of meeting a citizen with a legally registered pistol are extremely low.

CUSTOMISING FIREARMS

These firearm options can be added to different types of weapons to enhance performance or otherwise alter them. Most options are considered Features or Gear (BESM4, page 92 or 95), and are perhaps naked Enhancements (BESM4, page 197). Some options are instead considered mundane – their advantages and disadvantages effectively cancel – and thus they do not count as a Feature.

Options for weapons are classed as either accessories or modification. A modification is a change to the weapon that reflects a particular factory model or extensive after-market customisation. This requires an appropriate Skill Group or Skill to install, and may require several hours or more. An accessory is something that can be easily attached or removed from the weapon within a few seconds to several minutes. Weapon options are assumed to be available for any class of weapon unless otherwise noted.

ACCURISED

Option Type: Modification
Represented By: Accurate Enhancement

The weapon has been specially modified (custom grips, better aligned sights, polygonal rifling, heavier barrel, etc.) to improve its accuracy. This is typical of target pistols and competition or sniper rifles. This modification grants a minor edge on attack rolls when firing single shots, but no bonus if used with autofire. An accurised weapon must be in excellent condition with its sights precisely aligned, and will lose its bonus if knocked about, dropped, or otherwise mistreated.

BAYONET

Option Type: Accessory
Represented By: Spear or Knife Weapon

The weapon is fitted with a lug to accept a bayonet – a spike-shaped protrusion used for stabbing. When attached, the weapon is a bit more awkward, but it can be used in melee combat as a spear. When detached (requires one round), the bayonet is also usable as a knife. A bayonet is available for any rifle, assault rifle, or battle rifle.

BIPOD ATTACHMENT

Option Type: Accessory
Represented By: Accurate Enhancement and Unique Limiter: Must remain still

When the bipod is unfolded, the weapon is treated as if it has the Accurate Enhancement (cumulative with any other Accurate bonuses) and a Unique Limiter:

Attacker must remain still. The weapon must be fired at rest with the shooter lying prone behind it. Folding or unfolding the bipod usually requires one round. A bipod is available for any rifle, assault rifle, or battle rifle.

BRASS CATCHER

Option Type: Accessory
Represented By: Feature

This attachment collects cartridges as they are fired out of the weapon, and thus either saves them for hand-loading or prevents any incriminating ballistics evidence from being left behind. A weapon cannot be holstered if it has a brass catcher attached. A brass catcher is available for any rifle, assault rifle, battle rifle, or submachine gun.

BRIEFCASE-FIRING

Option Type: Accessory
Represented By: Unique Enhancement: Concealed and Inaccurate Limiter

The weapon is designed to be concealed in and fired from a briefcase or attaché case without removing it, using a hidden trigger in the case handle. The weapon must be either an autoloading pistol, machine pistol, or a submachine gun. The weapon is Inaccurate when fired from within a brief case, suffering a minor obstacle on the attack roll. The gun can usually be unclamped from the case and used normally (takes one-two rounds). GMs may use similar rules for umbrella guns or other disguised weaponry.

BUMP STOCK

Option Type: Accessory
Represented By: Autofire Enhancement and Inaccurate Limiter

This alternate gun stock is designed to make bump firing easier, using the recoil of each shot to activate the trigger for the next shot rapidly. The stock allows semi-automatic firearms to more closely imitate the firing rate of fully automatic weapons – but the gun is still considered semi-automatic. Bump stocks are now illegal in the US and many other jurisdictions around the world.

CARBINE-FORMAT

Option Type: Mundane Modification
Represented By: Unique Limiter: Less Damage

The weapon has a shorter barrel and stock. The attacker's Damage Multiplier is reduced by one when using carbine-format weapons, but allows the weapon to be concealed more easily as if it were a submachine gun. A carbine-format weapon is available for any light, medium, or heavy rifle, or any assault or battle rifle.

FLASH SUPPRESSOR

Option Type: Accessory
 Represented By: Unique Enhancement: Less Visible at Night

The hot gasses produced when a bullet is fired are quite visible at night. A flash suppressor is a long device that can be attached to the end of a weapon, masking this signature. A weapon with a flash suppressor attached cannot be concealed. A flash suppressor is not available for a heavy weapons.

FLASHLIGHT ATTACHMENT

Option Type: Mundane Accessory
 Represented By: –

This attachment allows any weapon to be used with a flashlight, and permits illumination of targets at short range so that they can be targetted by attackers without any penalties for darkness. Of course, someone using a flashlight at night can also be seen at a greater distance.

FOLDING STOCK

Option Type: Modification
 Represented By: Inaccurate Limiter

When folded, a weapon is handier and more concealable. Unfortunately, a weapon with this feature also suffers from the Inaccurate Defect (suffering a minor obstacle on the attack roll) when firing at targets at remote ranges – exceeding half its maximum distance (page 59). It requires one action to fold or unfold the stock. This feature can be assigned to any rifle, shotgun, or submachine gun.

LASER SIGHT

Option Type: Accessory
 Represented By: Accurate Enhancement x2 and Detectable: Sight Limiter

A laser sight projects a small, bright dot of laser light exactly where the Weapon is pointing, which helps the attacker determine whether or not they are on target. In game terms, the attacker receives a major edge on attack rolls in situations where they can see the laser dot on the target (usually within short range unless combined with a scope). Laser sights with an infrared beam (visible only to people with night vision scopes or goggles) are also available. This customisation was provided in the core book as an adventuring gear Item (BESM4, page 221).

NIGHT VISION SCOPE

Option Type: Accessory
 Represented By: Accurate Enhancement and Unique Enhancement: Functions in Dark

This scope uses thermal imaging or light intensification technology to “turn night into day”.

This functions exactly like a regular scope (BESM4; page 222) with the Accurate Enhancement, except that it also eliminates any attack penalties for darkness.

SAWED-OFF BARREL

Option Type: Modification
 Represented By: Accurate Enhancement and Unique Limiter: Reduced Damage at Range

This modification is for shotguns only. Sawing off the barrel of a shotgun means that it is more easily concealed, but it also has a shorter range. A sawed-off shotgun can be concealed as if it were a submachine gun. At very short ranges (Range 0-1; 3 metres or less) it has a wider spread of pellets (providing the Accurate enhancement), but the attacker's Damage Multiplier is reduced by one at distances beyond Range 1.

SCOPE

Option Type: Accessory
 Represented By: Accurate Enhancement

A telescopic sight mounted atop the Weapon increases the minor edge the shooter normally receives on attack rolls when taking the aim tactical action (page 35) to a major edge. Aiming for a second consecutive round also allows the shooter to re-roll if the attack roll result is undesirable. This bonus only applies to targets at least 10 metres away (Range 2+). Scopes are available for all guns. This customisation was provided in the core book as an adventuring gear Item (BESM4, page 222).

SNUB-NOSE

Option Type: Mundane Modification
 Represented By: Inaccurate Limiter and Unique Limiter: Reduced Damage at Range

A snub-nose is a shorter-barrel versions of any autoloading pistol, revolver, or machine pistol. The weapon is Inaccurate firing at any distance greater than Range 1 (3 metres), suffering a minor obstacle on the attack roll. It also inflicts less damage at these ranges (attacker's Damage Multiplier is reduced by one), but is substantially easier to conceal.

SILENCER

Option Type: Accessory
 Represented By: Unique Enhancement: Quiet Firing

A silencer, or more technically, a sound-suppressor is a tube that attaches to the weapons barrel and reduces the noise the weapon makes while firing. Silencers are restricted or illegal in most jurisdictions, as their use implies espionage or assassination. A silenced weapon cannot usually be heard at a range of greater than Range 1 (3 metres) unless a nearby character makes a successful Body Stat roll or otherwise has enhanced

hearing or awareness. Autoloading pistols, machine pistols, submachine guns, and rifles may be fitted with silencers. A silenced weapon cannot be concealed or holstered until the silencer is removed, which requires one round.

SPEED RIG

Option Type: Accessory
Represented By: Combat Technique: Lightning Reflexes 2

A speed rig is a special holster that allows a character easier access to their weapon. In game terms, it provides the character with two assignments of the Lightning Reflexes Combat Technique for the specific holstered weapon. Speed Rigs can be purchased for autoloading pistols, revolvers, and machine pistols, but could also apply to a trick spring-loaded holster for knives and other such small weapons.

TRIGGER LOCK

Option Type: Mundane Modification
Represented By: Unique Enhancement: Requires Unlocking and Activation Limiter

An integral lock that prevents the gun from being used without the right key or combination. It takes an extra round to unlock the gun before it can be ready to fire. In some areas, trigger locks may be required by law on some or all firearms.

TYPES OF AMMUNITION

Characters normally have access to ammunition of whatever type they need for their Weapons. Standard ammunition for pistols, revolvers, rifles, and machine guns is a lead bullet (or “ball” in military parlance). Standard ammunition for shotguns is shot. The upgraded ammo detailed in this section may provide benefits that are best addressed with Weapon Enhancements or Limiters, or with the Features, Gear, or Item Attribute as appropriate for the adventure.

ARMOUR PIERCING (AP)

This is a bullet specifically designed to punch through Armour, using a steel or tungsten core rather than jacketed lead. Some brands of AP ammo are Teflon-coated, but contrary to myth, the coating on AP bullets has nothing to do with the armour-piercing qualities – it simply helps protect the rifling inside the gun from the tougher material from which the bullet is made. Weapons using AP bullets are assigned the Penetrating (Armour) Enhancement. This reduces the Weapon’s effective Level, which reflects how AP bullets are somewhat less lethal against flesh and thus inflict less damage. These bullets are available for auto-loading pistols, machine guns, shotguns, revolvers, and rifles.

AP pistol or revolver ammunition (“cop killer bullets”) is illegal in many jurisdictions.

BIRD SHOT

The statistics given for shotguns assume they are using buckshot, which is the usual combat load. If using birdshot (with a greater number of smaller pellets), add the Accurate Enhancement to represent the greater chance to hit and associated damage reduction from smaller pellets. Birdshot is only available for shotguns.

BLANKS

A blank is a cartridge without the bullet that also has a reduced powder load. A blank normally does not deliver any damage when fired, but if the gun’s muzzle is directly in contact with someone, the hot gasses expelled can still be dangerous or fatal. When a character is using a blank-firing gun in combat, the gun is treated as if it is firing a rubber bullet, but range is limited to melee range. Blanks are available for auto-loading pistols, machine guns, revolvers, rifles, and shotguns.

HOLLOW POINT (HP)

This is a bullet designed to expand after entering a target, therefore doing greater damage. Hollow Point bullets are known by various trade names, and include bullets described as “expanding”, “dumdum”, or pre-fragmented rounds such as “safety slugs”. HP ammo is standard issue in many police departments, since the rounds are better at stopping targets and are less likely to pierce walls and injure bystanders on the other side. The Hague Convention prohibits HP bullets for military use in international conflicts. Hollow Point bullets have less armour-penetrating power and assigns the Non-Penetrating Limiter to the Weapon, which increases its effective Level and increases damage inflicted to the body (the bullets “mushroom” inside living tissue). HP bullets are available for auto-loading pistols, machine guns, revolvers, and rifles.

RUBBER

These are bullets encased in rubber or plastic, which are designed to be less lethal. A Weapon using rubber bullets suffers from the Non-Penetrating Limiter and gains the Stun Enhancement, for no net change in the Weapon’s effective Level. Rubber bullets are available for auto-loading pistols, machine guns, revolvers and rifles, and for shotguns firing slug ammunition.

SHOTGUN SLUGS

A shotgun can fire big bullets instead of shot. Police will often use slugs to stop cars or blow open barricades. When using slugs, a shotgun loses both the Spreading Enhancement and the Non-Penetrating Limiter. Slugs are available for shotguns only.

INCENDIARY SHELLS

Special shells are also available for shotguns that contain phosphorous chemicals, which converts the shotgun into an improvised flamethrower. The Weapon gains three assignments of the Continuing Enhancement. It also suffers from two assignments of the Unreliable Limiter if used again before the gun can be carefully cleaned, since the ammunition tends to foul the gun after use. Incendiary shells are available for shotguns only.



VEHICLES

If a vehicle is being pursued, a classic tactic is to execute a dangerous manoeuvre, such as flying through a subway tunnel in a helicopter, or weaving through a crowded street on a motorcycle. In game terms, the player describes the manoeuvre their character attempts, and makes an appropriate Skill roll (against a Target Number set by the GM) – perhaps with an obstacle on the roll to reflect the move's outrageousness. Failure usually results in a crash or accident with damage delivered to the vehicle and perhaps the driver (see Crashing, page 68). If the character succeeds, the pursuing vehicle may also attempt the manoeuvre, or may break off the chase.

GMs can use the same technique to help slower vehicles (or characters on foot) catch faster ones during chases. If the pursuing character zips through a dangerous short cut, leaps from building to building, or otherwise attempts something clever, they can make up significant distance with a successful Skill roll. If the character fails the roll, the GM should describe some sort of hazard and allow them to make a second Stat or Skill roll to avoid a complete disaster. For example, if a pedestrian steps into the street in front of the character's car, a successful Skill roll means that the driver swerves in time and crashes into a nearby fruit stand; failing can result in an injured or dead pedestrian.

On a lengthier chase, a successful Skill roll related to navigation or area knowledge could allow the character to think of a clever short cut, while a failure could trap the character in a traffic jam or similar delay. The GM can apply edges or obstacles based on how well the character knows the area and how detailed the player describes the tactics their character is using.

One useful technique involves the GM keeping a general mental note of relative distances (in metres or km) between combatants or important objectives. For example, if the encounter begins with a couple of SWAT vans 300 metres away from a criminal's getaway car, and in the first combat round the vans race forward 100 metres, then the opponents are now 200 metres from each other. If one vehicle is chasing another, and is 10 kph faster, it will close the distance by roughly 10 metres every round. GMs should not worry about exact speeds and distances – a general idea of the overall distances should be sufficient to avoid a bookkeeping nightmare. See Character Movement (BESM4, page 191) for more detailed speed and distance information.

► WILD STUNTS

The GM should permit characters to attempt all manner of crazy stunts with vehicles, with at least some chance of success. Examples can include tilting a car sideways to drive on two wheels in order to get through a narrow opening, crashing through an anti-vehicle barricade, jumping across a gap, performing handstands on a motorbike, driving a car or cycle up a ramp and into the trailer of a moving rig, flying a plane through a tunnel, etc.

The easiest way to handle these stunts is for the GM set a difficult task (TN 15) for the actions, and apply edges or obstacles to the character's roll as appropriate. The GM should decide in advance what will happen if the character completely fails (usually receiving damage, spinning off the road, or a risk of hitting another vehicle, building, or pedestrian), and then leave it up to the player whether or not to risk the attempt. The penalty for failure will usually be a crash of some sort.

CUSTOMISING VEHICLES

Options can be added to different types of vehicles to enhance performance or give them additional capabilities. Such accessories are noted as a mundane option (no Character Point cost), a Feature, or an Item with indicated Attributes.

Note that Engine Rebuild, Turbocharger, and Big Engine have approximately the same effect in game terms, but a super-fast vehicle may have all three options assigned.

AIRFOILS

Feature

An aerodynamic feature (airdams, spoilers, etc.) that improves traction by increasing the downward force on a car. The driver gains a minor edge on appropriate Skill rolls at speeds over 100 kph. Airfoils are available for any automobile.

ARMOUR

Item with Armour Attribute with Unique Limiter

The vehicle is retro-fitted with armoured panels, Kevlar inserts, and bullet proof glass on the windows. The extra weight reduces top speed by 25 kph (a Unique Limiter) but provides two Level of Armour (Armour Rating +10; actual Armour Level 1). Armour is available for any vehicle except an ultra-light aircraft.

BIG ENGINE

Feature

An uprated engine, such as a big V8 in a passenger car, or a V12 in a sports car. The engine can differentiate an ordinary passenger car from a luxury model, or a basic sports car from a racer. A big engine adds 25 kph to the top speed of any vehicle.

BURGLAR ALARM

Feature

If a door, trunk, or window is opened without the proper key, an alarm will sound to alert (and annoy) everyone in the vicinity. Defeating the alarm requires an appropriate Mind-based Skill roll, with a failed roll potentially activating it instead. Alarms are available for autos, light airplanes, helicopters or oversized ground vehicles.

CITIZEN'S BAND (CB) RADIO

Mundane

With a range of a few kilometres, truckers favour CBs for exchanging information on road conditions, speed traps, and general gossip. Unlike a personal smartphone, a CB broadcasts to everyone in the area; it's not useful for private communication, but is great for distress calls in a limited area. A similar option can be taken for taxi dispatcher radios. A CB radio can be installed in any vehicle.

CONVERTIBLE TOP

Mundane

The vehicle with this option has a removable or retractable plastic, fibreglass, or fabric top. Removing the top gives a better view and nice breeze, but also means that the driver and passengers are now partially exposed and are at the mercy of the weather. Exposed occupants are also completely unprotected from overhead attacks and can be attacked more easily from front, side, or rear (see Localised Limiter, BESM4, page 151). On the plus side, occupants can also fire out of the vehicle without any difficulty, and jump in or out more easily. This feature is available for autos; recreational speed boats and most offshore racers automatically possess this option.

DOOR MOUNT

Mundane

This option is a post and bracket for mounting a light or heavy machine gun out a helicopter's or van's open side door. The mount itself is mundane; an attached heavy weapon is usually an Item.

ELECTRIC VEHICLE (EV)

Mundane

Powered by a large battery pack instead of an internal combustion engine, electric vehicles typically have instant torque (very quick starts) and run quietly, but can't yet match the traditional extended travel distance or top speeds of standard cars. Energy storage technology is a rapidly changing industry, though, so reaching those benchmarks might not be that far away. EVs can either be fully electric plug-ins or electric-gas hybrids. Most smaller vehicles can have an electric power source, and as battery storage technology develops, larger vehicles can transition over as well.

EMERGENCY LIGHTS AND SIREN

Feature

Any vehicle can be fitted with a noisy siren and flashing lights that will attract the attention of everyone nearby in an emergency. This option can also provide a powerful spot search light.

ENGINE REBUILD

Feature

A rebuild is major custom upgrade to the engine, rather than just simply increasing its size. In a car, this may involve removing and completely cleaning the existing system (including "hot tanking" the engine block in a chemical bath to remove grime), then adding various modifications (known as "blueprinting"). Other engine "buzz-words" include forged dome pistons, tunable fuel injection, strengthened rods and bearings, adjustable or hot cam socket, tubular headers, custom intake manifolds, big valves, and a bored-out throttle body (you can even make up your own words, too!). This option adds 25 kph to the top speed of any vehicle.

GLOBAL POSITIONING SYSTEM (GPS)

Mundane

This option uses satellite systems to provide precise navigational coordinators, which (at least theoretically) prevents the vehicle from becoming lost. A GPS can be added to any vehicle.

HIDDEN CARGO SPACE

Feature

This space is used in vehicles that are designed to smuggle goods across borders or past highway patrols. Up to 10% of the vehicle's cargo capacity can be considered "hidden" under fake panels and bogus fixtures. Hidden space can be added to any vehicle with some extra capacity.

IMPROVED BRAKES

Feature

This option includes high quality brakes, drag chutes, or spiked tires that allow the vehicle to stop faster than normal. The driver gains a minor edge on appropriate Skill rolls on any manoeuvre where sudden, sharp deceleration is important. Improved brakes can be added to any ground-based vehicle.

IMPROVED SHOCKS

Feature

Some vehicles have high quality or adjustable shock absorbers or springs. The driver gains a minor edge on appropriate Skill rolls in any circumstance where the suspension is important (such as crossing over obstacles).

LUXURIOUS DECOR

Feature

Luxurious furnishings can include a mini-bar, mini-fridge, kitchenette, chemical toilet, bunk bed, upgraded fabrics, etc. For larger furnishings (kitchenette, bunks, etc.) each one added also requires replacing one or two seats, depending on the size. Furnishings can be added to any vehicle with a Size Rank 2 or more.

MODERN VEHICLE TECH SUITE

Feature

These electronic gadgets include small TV sets, positioning cameras, GPS, wireless accessories, sound system, etc. Any single piece of technology can be considered mundane, but taken together they are a Feature. A tech suite can be added to any vehicle, provided the size seems reasonable.

MANUAL TRANSMISSION

Mundane

There are two types of transmissions for internal combustion engines: manual and automatic. An automatic transmission is assumed to be standard issue for automobiles (but not other vehicles), and means that the gear mechanism changes by itself. In a manual transmission, the driver must shift the gears on their own, usually with a stick and the clutch pedal. For automobiles, a manual transmission burdens the driver with a minor obstacle on relevant Skill rolls at speeds below 80 kph when they are trying to do something else while they drive, such as shoot a gun. If a vehicle with an automatic transmission and one with a manual transmission are competing in a race, though, the GM should give a driver who has both an appropriate Skill and a manual transmission vehicle a minor edge on Skill rolls to reflect the greater speed control the manual transmission provides.

NITROUS OXIDE TANK**Feature**

This option adds a nitrous oxide tank and push-button injection system. Nitrous oxide (also known as laughing gas) can be injected into the engine, which releases more free oxygen and improves cylinder pressures and engine temperature. This action allows extra fuel to be burned in a more controlled fashion, resulting in a quick power boost for a short sprint. A single injection adds up to 50 kph to the vehicle's speed and a minor edge to Initiative rolls on the round it is used. Benefits that the nitrous provides can extend for up to five rounds before depleting the tank. Extensive use of this speed boost may impact the longevity of the engine. This performance enhancer is available for any vehicle except helicopters.

OFF-ROAD SUSPENSION**Feature**

A raised suspension and special tires allow the vehicle to drive cross-country at two-thirds of the on-road top speed (as determined by the Ground Speed Attribute). For airplanes, this option corresponds to Rough-Field Landing Gear that lets the aircraft land without a proper runway. Off-road suspension is available for any ground vehicle or light aircraft.

PINTLE MOUNT**Mundane**

A pintle mount is a bracket for mounting a light or heavy machine gun on the vehicle's roof or deck. The gunner must be exposed to fire the weapon. This mount is available for any ground vehicle with a convertible top or sun roof, any pickup truck or heavy truck with a flatbed cargo area, or any speed boat. The mount itself is mundane; an attached heavy weapon is usually an Item.

POLICE-BAND RADIO**Mundane**

This radio allows the driver to communicate on police and emergency frequencies. If the cops find one of these in a vehicle, they may be a little suspicious of the driver's motivations. This radio is available for any vehicle.

PONTOONS**Feature**

Pontoons allow an aircraft to land in, or take off from, water. The extra air drag reduces the aircraft's top speed by 25 kph. Pontoons are available for any helicopter or light airplane.

RADAR DETECTOR**Item with Supersense: Radar Level 3**

A detector can warn the driver if a police radar trap is within a couple of kilometres. Recent models also detect police laser scanners, or lidar. Although radar detectors are illegal in many jurisdictions, they are available for any vehicle.

ROCKET ENGINE**Item with Additional Movement Levels**

The vehicle is outfitted with a rocket engine (either replacing propellers for an airplane or as a booster rocket for ground vehicles). The engine drastically increases the speed of the vehicle by an additional 100 kph. Additionally, for ground based vehicles, the driver suffers major obstacle on all Skill checks related to vehicle operation while the rocket booster is activated.

ROTATING LICENSE PLATE**Feature**

With a flick of a switch, the license plate can flip to reveal an alternative identity for a vehicle. This is an illegal modification that is available for any auto or oversized ground vehicle.

SIDECAR**Item with Capacity Level 1**

Sidecars are attached to motorcycles, which allows an extra person to ride along. This option reduces the top speed by 10 kph. A motorbike sidecar requires 3-5 rounds to attach or detach.

SLICK TIRES**Mundane**

A vehicle may be outfitted with flat racing tires (no grooves) for better traction. Slicks provide a minor edge on appropriate Skill rolls on smooth, dry tracks. They unfortunately have a poor grip on wet roads, though, and impose a minor obstacle on appropriate Skill rolls during inclement weather conditions. Slicks are available for any ground vehicle.

SMOKE SCREEN**Item with Sensory Block Level 2: Infrared and Sight**

This option releases smoke behind the vehicle, obscuring view in a cloud approximately 5 meters in radius. The screen will last for 1-6 rounds depending on the wind. At the GM's option, a character caught in a smoke screen might be required to make a successful Skill check to avoid an accident if the smoke obscured oncoming traffic, obstacles, or a bend in the road. A fully charged smoke screen is good for three rounds of use, and is available for nearly any ground vehicle.

SPECIAL TIRES OR PUNCTURE-RESISTANT

Mundane

Tires may be designed with various special abilities. These include solid puncture-resistant tires that run while flat or special snow tires. Any ground based vehicle can be equipped with special tires.

STRETCHERS AND MEDICAL EQUIPMENT

Feature

This option differentiates ambulances from regular vehicles. Each stretcher replaces two seats for passenger capacity purposes. Medical equipment can be added to any van or utility helicopter.

STRIPPED

Mundane

These vehicles are carefully stripped down to improve their power-to-weight ratio. In a car, this might mean removing glass from side windows (replacing them with nets), taking out the headlights, stripping out the doors (the driver will now climb through the window), modifying the seats, and otherwise removing items that are required for regular driving but unnecessary or unsafe for a high-speed race. Stripping a vehicle will add 25 kph to its top speed if the vehicle is still “street legal” or 50 kph if enough stuff is removed so that the vehicle cannot meet minimum safety standards. All vehicles, except an ultra-light, can be stripped.

SUN ROOF

Mundane

A sun roof is an open hatch in the top of the vehicle. Characters who lean out the opening can be attacked, but receive a benefit for partial cover. A sun roof is available for any auto or oversized ground vehicle.

SUPERCHARGER

Feature (2 slots)

A supercharger is designed to increase an engine's power. The supercharger uses a belt-and-pulley mechanism linked to an engine's crankshaft. It functions by forcing extra air and fuel into the engine's combustion chambers. A supercharger adds 25 kph to top speed and the extra acceleration provides a minor edge to Initiative rolls. Superchargers are available for any vehicle except a helicopter or ultra-light.

TOW WINCH

Mundane

A winch allows the vehicle to tow other vehicles of equal or smaller size (similar to pulling a trailer – see Trailer, below). A winch is available for any pickup truck or oversized ground vehicle.

TRAILER

Item with Capacity Level 2-4

A trailer lets the vehicle tow extra cargo. A typical trailer is designed for a car or van and can hold a half-tonne (for a car-sized trailer) or 1-2 tonnes (for a larger trailer). The vehicle's top speed will be reduced by 25 kph and it will suffer a minor/major obstacle on Initiative rolls while towing a small/large trailer. Trailers can be added to any auto or oversized vehicle.

TURBOCHARGER

Feature

This device uses the engine's exhaust stream to drive an air compressor (“fan”), which increases the engine's power output. This extra power adds 25 kph to top speed, but there is no extra Initiative bonus, due to “turbo lag” – the delay it takes for the turbocharger to respond. Turbochargers are available for any vehicle except a helicopter or ultra-light.

ENGAGEMENT BONUS

A great way to encourage on-going participation with the campaign adventures is to offer players an engagement Character Point bonus for their contributions. Every player can participate in these engagements, since they are not dependent on any single talent or ability. Of course, engagements are best when shared with the entire gaming group. The number of bonus Points you assign to players who provide engagements should depend on the amount of work, effort, and/or resources devoted to the task. These Points should not exceed the rate of Advancement Points you award, however. Players that undertake several engagements should earn additional bonus Points as appropriate. Some engagements, such as a diary or game log, require regular participation that aligns with the game sessions; others, such as a character sketch or special engagement, may be single efforts. Several players may wish to rotate responsibility for regular engagements.

A non-exhaustive list of example engagements include:

FIRST-PERSON DIARY

The player recounts the events of each session in a first-person narrative.

GAME LOG

The player records an ongoing third-person narrative description of each session's events.

CHARACTER SKETCH

The player draws one or more pictures of the player characters, NPCs, or scenes from the adventures.



CAMPAIGN MANGA

The player creates a manga related to the campaign characters and events. A manga is an ideal engagement for several players, with each person responsible for one part: pencils, inks, writing, colouring, layout/typesetting, etc.

VIDEO PRESENTATION

The player directs and records a short film of a scene from the adventures, or perhaps some interesting background information. Many players can contribute to an engagement of this scope.

SOCIAL MEDIA UPDATING

The player is responsible for maintaining and updating a social media presence for the campaign, which may be done through a private Facebook group, website, or other platform.

MUNCHIES

A player who has more money than time could provide snacks and/or drinks for the gaming group. This engagement can easily be rotated amongst several players to avoid too much financial burden on just one.

SPECIAL ENGAGEMENT

The nature of an engagement is only limited by the players' imaginations. Players could sculpt images of the characters, provide props for the game, organise special events for the group ... the options are limitless!

HOW DO I?...

Although much of the content in BESM and BESM Extras is straight-forward and easy-to-understand, inevitably some questions will arise from players looking to achieve a particular effect. This section addresses a few such questions, but is not intended to exhaustively answer all questions that may arise.

CONVERT MONEY TO POINTS

In a multi-genre universal game like BESM, it's impossible to set an exact framework conversion of money into Character Points since the selected adventure setting is critical to any such conversion. Consequently, the Wealth Attribute is often difficult to navigate in a game when the question "why don't I just buy it?" arises. If you absolutely need some sort of rough conversion guidance in your game, try this: characters can spend money on Item Character Points following the Fibonacci sequence (page 60), but starting at 1 and multiplied by 1000. So the first Character Point costs \$1,000, the second Point costs \$1,000 (\$2K for 2 Points), the third Point costs \$2,000 (\$4K for 3 Points), the fourth Point costs \$3,000 (\$7K for 4 Points), etc.

CONVERT CHARACTERS TO BESM FROM OTHER ROLE-PLAYING GAMES

This is a huge question with a very long and multi-threaded answer, but here's a short summary:

Emulate the feel of the character rather than the specific powers and abilities. Start with their Stats to establish a baseline and then look at their abilities and talents that make them stand out from other characters. Convert these abilities to BESM Attributes and Defects, again remembering to focus on the overall feeling for the character so you can capture their style and personality instead of obsessing over the correct math. It won't be an easy process but you should be able to create a close approximation that you'll be happy to play.

If those "other RPGs" are earlier editions of BESM or Tri-Stat System games, the same guidelines apply. Read the sidebar in BESM4, page 307, for extra context.

DAMAGE A TARGET WITH AN IMPROVISED WEAPON

Smashing an opponent with a stop sign, baseball bat, steel pipe, or a rock is not substantially different than using one of the blunt Weapons listed in the core book (see BESM4, Table-17, page 204), like a club or mace. Such improvised tools are normally considered Level 1-3 Weapons, and may have the Muscle and/or Stun Enhancements (page 138/141) as appropriate. Larger thrown weapons, such as a school bus or building, fall under the "Rock or Object" category in Table-17.

INSTANTLY KILL A TARGET

There are several ways to have one-attack kills. If the character's Weapon inflicts more than 40-50 damage, it will be enough to eliminate most targets with a single hit. Otherwise, a combination of waiting for an opening, called shot to a vital spot, and critical hit rules should achieve the desired result. See the sidebar about Executions (page 69) for a detailed example of this.

INTERRUPT AN OPPONENT'S ATTACK

Taking a readying manoeuvre (page 35) allows a character to hold their action to instead respond to the later activities of an opponent.

KNOCK OUT A TARGET

A target may be rendered unconscious when inflicting damage exceeding their Shock Value (page 14). This is made easier with Stun damage (BESM4, page 141) and using the Blackout Combat Technique (page 5). See page 69 for additional suggestions.

USE AN ATTRIBUTE TO AVOID AN ATTACK

Chapter 3: Expanded Mechanics details situations in which characters can use Attributes creatively to both attack and defend (page 45).

MAKE NEW IN-GAME ITEMS

Some characters may be proficient at crafting Items during the game adventures, whether it's a blacksmith making Weapons, a tech genius making gadgets, a wizard making potions, etc. The actual construction of an Item is best handled through appropriate Skill rolls, as appropriate for the specific creation. If a character wishes to create a new permanent Item that they will use regularly, it should be acquired through the allocation of Advancement Points (BESM4, page 303). Construction of temporary Items for single use during an adventure is usually not a problem, provided the Item isn't too powerful or unbalanced for the story. Such Items may even fall under the guidelines for pushing a character's powers (page 48).

MODIFY AN ATTRIBUTE IN A WAY THAT ISN'T COVERED IN THE RULES

BESM presents a comprehensive game system, but it obviously can't anticipate every possible ability a player may want to assign to their character. Unique Enhancements and Unique Limiters are an ideal way to nudge an existing Attribute to more closely align with the player's vision. For character aspects that are more individualised, creating a Unique Attribute or Unique Defect may be the most efficient solution instead.

STREAMLINE COMBAT (ROLL FEWER DICE)

The best way to make combat flow more quickly (especially for larger gaming groups) is to use the hedging rules from the core book (BESM4, page 182). Rather than rolling dice, players can simply assign a value of 7 as their roll. This hedging technique can be used for rolls outside combat as well. Additionally, streamlining combat probably means sticking to the core combat rules instead of adding on the BESM Extras optional and expanded rules from Chapters 1-5.

USE D10S INSTEAD OF D6S

There's no strong reason why you can't use any dice size of choice for your BESM games if you don't fancy six-sided dice – though the choice to change dice is largely unnecessary (see the Variable Dice sidebar on page 62 for an explanation). Gaming groups may run into small math variability issues using d10s, though, since the 2d6 dice spread is purposefully aligned with the typical 1-12 range for Stats. Consider this a cautionary tale of dice swaps, but not a strong condemnation of it.

HANDLE WEAPON ITEMS WITH FOUR ASSIGNMENTS OF THE AMMO LIMITER

Characters that have allocated Points to a Weapon Item with 4x Ammo (ie. destroyed after a single use) cannot lose those Points simply because the Item is gone. Characters should either be able to acquire replacements

(such as restocking grenades at their headquarters) or can reclaim those Points to spend elsewhere.

USE MAGIC WITHOUT A DEFINED MAGIC ATTRIBUTE

Magic isn't an ability or effect or Attribute, but an expression of how an Attribute functions. We refer to this as a source of power and address it in the core book (BESM4, page 258). Magic isn't any different than technology or psionics or divine powers or natural racial abilities – it makes up the "how" or "why" of the Attributes rather than the "what". Consequently, any Attribute can be considered "magic".

For a dynamic application of magic that uses spells and spell-like effects, see the Dynamic Powers and Power Flux Attributes, as well as the BESM Extras' section on Power Bundles in Chapter 6 (page 76).

IMITATE SPELLCASTING FROM OTHER POPULAR FANTASY RPGS

There are two aspects to this question. The first involves spell components and other descriptors, and the second involves spell slots per character level.

Regarding spell components and descriptors, BESM Extras addresses this with Power Packs (page 73). Specifically, the type of requirements from other fantasy RPGs align with BESM Limiters as follows:

- » Casting Time = Activation Limiter
- » Concentration = Concentration Limiter
- » Focus = Equipment Limiter
- » Material = Consumable Limiter
- » Memorisation requirement = Unique Limiter
- » Somatic = Detectable (Sight) Limiter
- » Verbal = Detectable (Hearing) Limiter

For spell slots/level, this can't translate precisely since BESM is not a levelling system. The circumstances concerning levelling – only a specific total number of spell uses per day – can best be represented through one or more of the following Limiters:

- » Charges, to cap how many times the Attribute/spell can be used each day
- » Deplete, to drain the character of Energy Points – which further limits the number of uses
- » Maximum, to mimic the differentiation between high-level and low-level spells
- » Recovery, as yet another alternative to limiting the amount of time an Attribute can be used

In short, using BESM to imitate spellcasting in other popular fantasy RPGs isn't impossible, but there also isn't an easy way to match the process exactly.



CHAPTER 8 ITEMS AND WEAPONS

08: ITEMS & WEAPONS

GEAR, MECHA, DEVICES & MORE

Chapter 10 of the BESM core book provides a comprehensive array of Weapons and Armour Items with which you can equip characters across a variety of adventure genres. It also presents a limited selection of other useful Items, ranging from protective devices, to mecha and vehicles, to adventuring gear. This chapter expands your choices substantially, and includes game stats and brief descriptions for over 70 Items across six different categories. The listed game stats for each Item can easily be modified up or down to suit your campaign power level and the players' visions for their characters.

Items that have only a single use (such as potions or exploding Weapons) are not normally acquired with Character Points unless they are regularly replaced throughout the story, such as a cleric replacing healing potions at their temple or a soldier replacing grenades at the army base once they are used. This guideline helps maintain Character Point balance.

ADVENTURING GEAR

Characters need useful and entertaining gear while exploring the world on their daring adventures. Don't let the word "gear" fool you though, since many of these entries are quite powerful and are normally acquired through the Item Attribute.

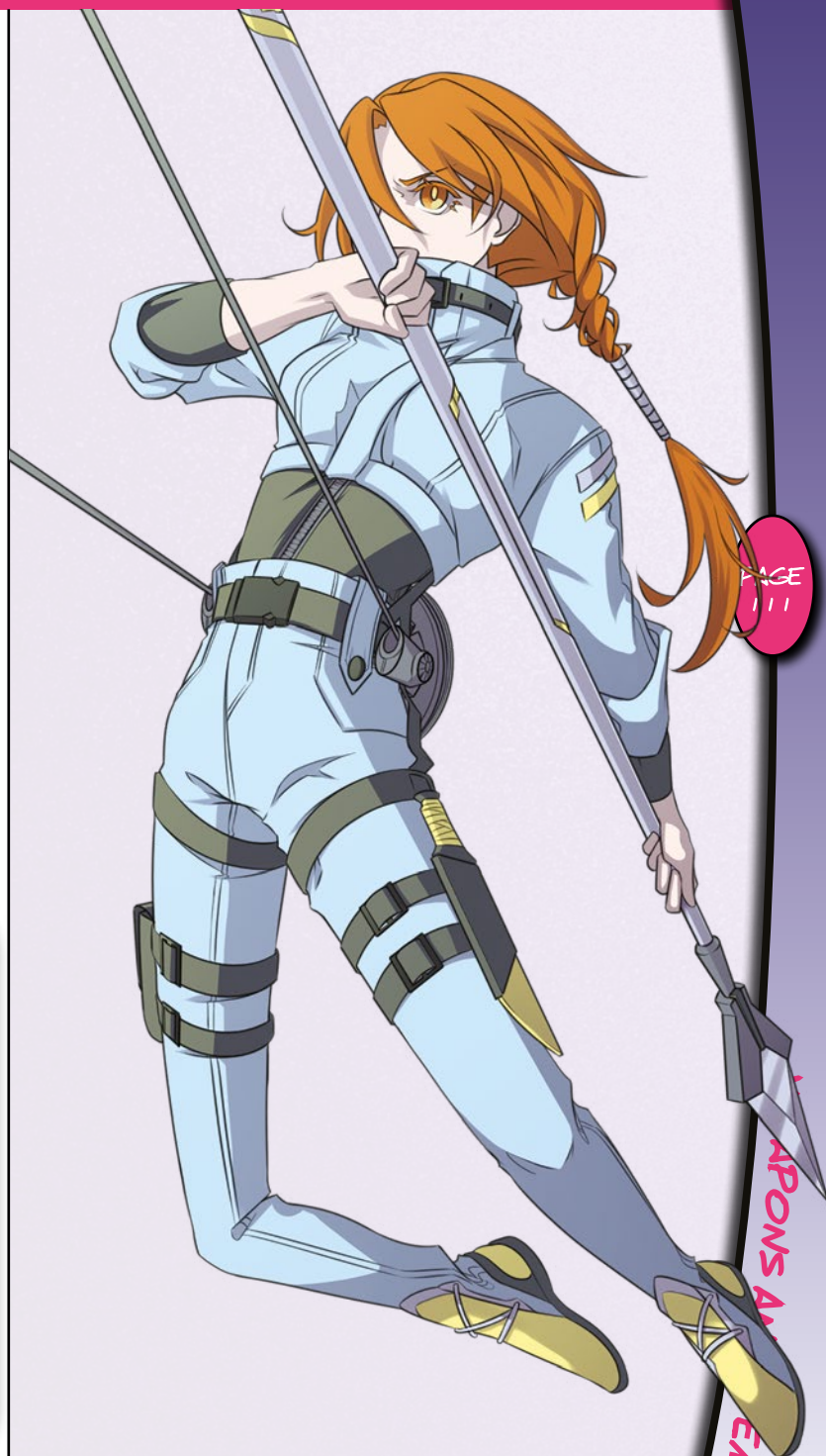
► 3D MANOEUVRING GEAR

This harness is worn over clothing by elite combat rangers to provide exceptional movement capabilities during wilderness and urban battles. The harness alternatively shoots out and reels in grappling hooks using compressed air, which helps propel the character along all three axes of aerial movement. Exhaust jets are distributed along the harness to provide additional momentum and help stabilise the character's movements.

To function properly, the harness requires structures onto which the grappling hooks can temporarily attach – buildings, trees, rock formations, flying vehicles, gigantic opponents, etc.

3D MANOEUVRING GEAR

LEVEL	POINTS	ATTRIBUTE
2	2	Combat Technique (Lethal Blow, Lightning Reflexes)
6	6	Special Movement (Balance, Cat-Like, Fast 2, Swinging, Wall Bouncing)
RANK	POINTS	DEFECT
1	-3	Special Requirement (Buildings, trees, or other tall structures for grappling hooks)
5	TOTAL (2 POINT ITEM)	



WEAPONS & ARMOUR

► **ANIMAL CONTROL FLUTE**

The character gains rudimentary mind control over nearby animals (up to 100 animals in a 100-metre radius) that hear the flute's musical notes.

ANIMAL CONTROL FLUTE

LEVEL	POINTS	ATTRIBUTE
9 (2)	45	Mind Control (Area -3; Targets -6; Broad: All non-sentient animals +1; Detectable: Sound +1)
45		TOTAL (22 POINT ITEM)

► **BAG OF HOLDING**

This classic adventuring staple appears to be a simple medium-sized cloth or leather satchel, but is actually a portal to a pocket dimension with a 10-metre radius. Consequently, hundreds or thousands of objects can be stored in the bag at the same time and transported with ease. The bag can detect which object the character wishes to retrieve when they reach inside, and ensures the desired object is easily accessible.

BAG OF HOLDING

LEVEL	POINTS	ATTRIBUTE
3	3	Pocket Dimension
1	1	Sixth Sense (Desired Objects in Bag)
4		TOTAL (2 POINT ITEM)

► **BELT OF GIANT STRENGTH**

The character gains incredible strength when they are wearing this belt. These Items have been known to take the form of a normal business suit belt or perhaps even that of a championship pro-wrestling belt – depending on the inclinations of the belt's crafter.

BELT OF GIANT STRENGTH

LEVEL	POINTS	ATTRIBUTE
4	16	Superstrength (2 Tonnes)
16		TOTAL (8 POINT ITEM)

► **DIMENSIONAL STORY BOOK**

This story book isn't just an engaging narrative that tells an imaginative tale of adventure – it is an actual two-way portal to another dimension somewhere in the anime multiverse! Why just read about such a faraway place when you can visit it instead? Variations of this Item may contain a trap that pulls the reader through the dimensional gate involuntarily.

DIMENSIONAL STORY BOOK

LEVEL	POINTS	ATTRIBUTE
2	4	Portal (To Specific Story Dimension and Back)
4		TOTAL (2 POINT ITEM)

► **DISTANCE QUILLS**

Though texting and instant messaging across the globe are everyday occurrences in worlds with modern-day technology, enchanted ink quills that perform the same function are marvellous creations in pre-industrial civilisations. The quills must be linked to one or more other similar quills to receive the sent messages. If a character writes a message on any parchment or surface using one of the quills, one or more of the linked quills will automatically and immediately transcribe the message on a nearby writing surface, if possible.

DISTANCE QUILLS

LEVEL	POINTS	ATTRIBUTE
8 (1)	8	Features (Instant messaging; Range -8; Equipment: one or more linked receiving quills +1)
8		TOTAL (4 POINT ITEM)

► **DIVINING ROD**

This Y-shaped wooden rod directs the holder to water sources it detects in the nearby area (within 100 metres).

DIVINING ROD

LEVEL	POINTS	ATTRIBUTE
4 (1)	4	Sixth Sense (Water; Area -3)
4		TOTAL (2 POINT ITEM)

► HACKING GEAR

This elite kit of electronic jacks, monitors, metres, and relays can help the character infiltrate, navigate, download, and modify nearly any globally connected computer system. Additionally, it grants the character control over vehicles and artificial beings (such as cyborgs and robots) with computerised functions plus it dampens other sources of electronic transmissions in the nearby vicinity (10-metre radius). In most societies, it is illegal to own such hacking gear.

HACKING GEAR

LEVEL	POINTS	ATTRIBUTE
9	18	Data Access (10,000 km)
1	1	Features (Comms, Data Recording and Backup)
4 (6)	20	Mind Control (Broad: Robots and Computerised Beings +1; Dependent: Data Access +1)
1	1	Sensory Block (Other Electronic Transmissions)
5 (6)	20	Telekinesis (Focussed: Computerised Vehicles +1)
60		TOTAL (30 POINT ITEM)

► LOVE POTION

Once a target drinks this love potion, they will seemingly fall in love with the first person they encounter and act accordingly to attract the attention of their heart's desire. The effects of the elixir last for up to one week unless broken earlier by special circumstances, as determined by the GM.

Assigning Character Points to this Item assumes that the potion is refilled or otherwise made available once again (instead of being destroyed after a single use).

LOVE POTION

LEVEL	POINTS	ATTRIBUTE
4 (5)	20	Mind Control (Duration -4; Broad: Humans +1; Ingest +1; Unique Limiter: Romantic emotions only, directed at first person target encounters +3)
20		TOTAL (10 POINT ITEM)

► MAGICAL CLOTH

If an object is wrapped in this fabric, it is rendered undetectable by magical, mental, and spiritual scrying.

MAGICAL CLOTH

LEVEL	POINTS	ATTRIBUTE
3	6	Undetectable (Magic, Mental, Spiritual)
6		TOTAL (3 POINT ITEM)

► MAGICAL ROPE

This majestic rope is extremely useful during many adventures. The weave is quite strong and tied knots are resilient under tremendous stress, yet they come undone easily with a simple tug when desired.

MAGICAL ROPE

LEVEL	POINTS	ATTRIBUTE
3 (4)	12	Superstrength (2 Tonnes; Object +1)
1	1	Unique Attribute (Knots are extremely resilient, yet untie easily and automatically on command)
13		TOTAL (6 POINT ITEM)

► MAP MOTH

Special moths are created or bred to seek out and fly to any nearby object, person, or concept the character desires. For example, a moth could locate a secret entrance to a castle, find a specific type of flower in the forest, fly to a missing child, or detect the largest source of evil in the city. The moth flutters to their destination slowly, allowing the character to follow along. Detection range is determined through allocation of Flux Points.

MAP MOTH

LEVEL	POINTS	ATTRIBUTE
1	10	Power Flux (Minor: Detection; Potent -1; Detectable: Sight +1)
10		TOTAL (5 POINT ITEM)

► MASTER KEY

The mysterious master key can unlock not only most physical and electronic locks, but also metaphysical ones as well, such as barriers between planes of existence, passwords, and sometimes even emotional locks.

MASTER KEY

LEVEL	POINTS	ATTRIBUTE
1	10	Dynamic Powers (Minor: Keys)
10		TOTAL (5 POINT ITEM)

► MENAGERIE BALL

This softball-sized hollow ball has a hinged opening that functions as a two-way portal to a city-sized, forested pocket dimension. The character can attempt to trap Neomorphs (see BESM4, page 227) and other creatures inside the ball for easy storage and transportation. On command, the character can selectively call forth a particular creature stored within the ball, ending its dimensional captivity early.

MENAGERIE BALL

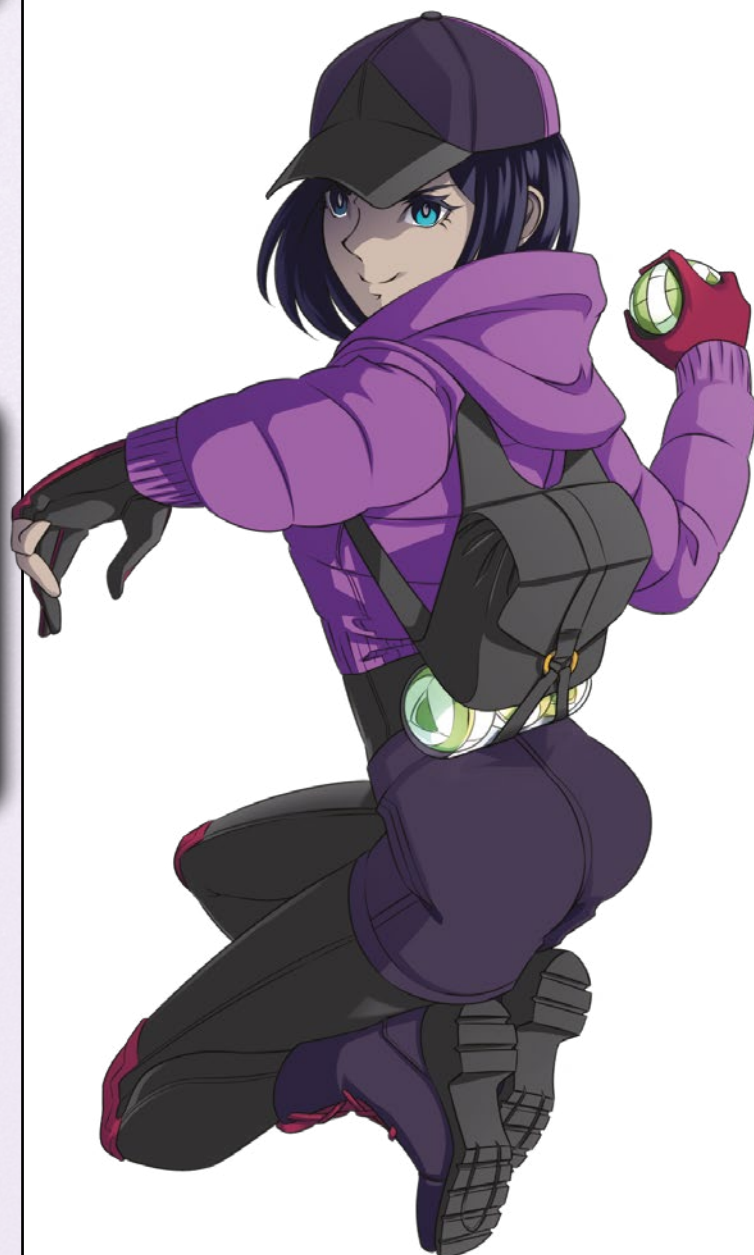
LEVEL	POINTS	ATTRIBUTE
6	6	Pocket Dimension
8 (2)	16	Portal (To Pocket Dimension and back; Duration -5; Unique Enhancement: Can selectively end the Duration early by summoning forth target -1)
22		TOTAL (11 POINT ITEM)

► PORTABLE HOLE

When a character needs to get to the other side of a wall, locked door, or other such barrier, nothing beats a portable hole for effectiveness. The hole resembles a foldable, paper-thin black circle that can be stretched from one to two metres in diameter. Once placed on a the side of a barrier, it creates a hole through and provides an immediate passage way for characters and objects to the other side. The maximum thickness of the barrier is limited to one metre, so the portable hole can't be used to pass through super-thick structures such as mountains, planets, or large bodies of water.

PORTABLE HOLE

LEVEL	POINTS	ATTRIBUTE
1	3	Teleport (Potent -1; Unique Limiter: Only walk 1 metre through hole on other side of wall or obstacle +1)
3		TOTAL (1 POINT ITEM)



► SCRYING MIRROR

Whether it's an actual mirror hanging in a sorcerer's chambers or a reflective pool of water in a sacred forest glade, the scrying mirror is a rare and powerful artefact. By peering into the mirror, the character can catch a glimpse of an object or person of desire to discern its approximate location and situation. The mirror can also reveal details about the past or future, though the visions displayed don't always reveal the complete or accurate story.

SCRYING MIRROR

LEVEL	POINTS	ATTRIBUTE
5 (6)	10	Cognition (Postcognition; up to 1 year into the past; Unpredictable +1)
3 (4)	6	Cognition (Precognition; up to 1 hour into the future; Unpredictable +1)
2	20	Power Flux (Minor: Detection)
36		TOTAL (18 POINT ITEM)

► SMART CLOAK

This sentient cloak communicates through gentle pulls and pushes of its fabric, but cannot speak. It provides some protection and facilitates specific changes in the character's environment (such as the colour or texture of objects, or exact computer passwords) by gently shifting between similar adjacent dimensions.

SMART CLOAK

VALUE	POINTS	STAT
5	10	Mind Stat
3	6	Soul Stat
VALUE	DERIVED VALUE	
4	Attack Combat Value	
4	Defence Combat Value	
5	Health Points	
5	Damage Multiplier	
LEVEL	POINTS	ATTRIBUTE
1	2	Armour (Armour Rating 5)
2	10	Dimension Walk
2	2	Heightened Awareness
30		TOTAL (15 POINT ITEM)

► SPY GEAR

This essential spy monitoring kit includes a variety of tiny, wearable recording, tracking, verifying, blocking, communicating, and detecting devices that a character in the trade will find helpful.

SPY GEAR

LEVEL	POINTS	ATTRIBUTE
3	3	Features (Auditory Discrimination, Comms, Data Recording and Backup, GPS, Identity Verifier, Keylogger, Medical Kit, Tool Kit, Tracking Bug)
5 (2)	5	Sensory Block (Cellular, Radar; Area -3)
3	3	Supersense (1 km; Infrared)
1	1	Supersense (10 m; X-Ray)
12		TOTAL (6 POINT ITEM)

► TRUE-SIGHT GLASSES

These fashionable eyeglasses allow the wearer to see through illusions and projections – technical, magical, or paranormal – to reveal the underlying truth.

TRUE-SIGHT GLASSES

LEVEL	POINTS	ATTRIBUTE
2	2	Sixth Sense (Truth Behind Illusions and Projections)
2		TOTAL (1 POINT ITEM)

► WINGED BOOTS

Small, feathered wings attached to the side of leather boots beat rapidly to lift the character into the sky at a pace approaching the speed of sound. Fortunately, they also provide protection against the cold at high altitudes.

WINGED BOOTS

LEVEL	POINTS	ATTRIBUTE
5	15	Flight
2	4	Resilient (Intense Cold, Lack of Air)
19		TOTAL (9 POINT ITEM)

DAILY DEVICES

Although they can be powerful in their own right, many objects created with the Item Attribute form part of daily life, and are not considered special or unique within that specific society.

► CLEANING DRONES

When tidying up around the house becomes too much of a chore, these flying cleaning drones can pick up the slack and handle the dirty work for you.

CLEANING DRONES

LEVEL	POINTS	ATTRIBUTE
1	1	Features (Basic AI, Cleaning Kit)
1	3	Flight
4		TOTAL (2 POINT ITEM)

► COMMUNICATION GEAR

This catch-all device can represent a wide variety of communication methods, from radio to internet wi-fi to subspace to magical relays.

COMMUNICATIONS GEAR

LEVEL	POINTS	ATTRIBUTE
1	1	Features (Comms)
1		TOTAL (0 POINT ITEM)

► EMERGENCY HOLODOCTOR

Though only a projection, the emergency holodocor can expertly monitor and diagnose medical conditions, and provide informed advice regarding treatment.

EMERGENCY HOLODOCTOR

LEVEL	POINTS	ATTRIBUTE
1	1	Features (Basic AI, Life Monitoring System)
1 (3)	3	Projection (Unique Limiter: Holodocor Form Only +2)
5 (6)	15	Skill Group (Scientific; Detectable: Sight and Sound +1)
19		TOTAL (9 POINT ITEM)

► FOOD REPLICATOR

When you need to create nutritious and tasty sustenance out of thin air for your family, starship crew, or wizard academy, the food replicator is an essential tool you can't live without.

FOOD REPLICATOR

LEVEL	POINTS	ATTRIBUTE
2 (1)	6	Transmute (Gaseous -2; Broad: Food +1)
6		TOTAL (3 POINT ITEM)

► IDENTITY CHANGER

This small device attaches to the character's body or clothes and projects an image over their body so that they can appear to be anyone else desired. The closer the projected identity is to the shape and form of the original character, the more likely it will be to fool casual observers.

IDENTITY CHANGER

LEVEL	POINTS	ATTRIBUTE
1 (2)	3	Projection (Potent -1; Unique Limiter: Only for projections that obscure identity +2)
3		TOTAL (1 POINT ITEM)

► MULTICORDER

The multicorder is a handheld device that can read and detect different aspects of the nearby environment – including whether lifeforms are present – as well as monitor the life signs of characters and creatures to generate optimal health profiles.

MULTICORDER

LEVEL	POINTS	ATTRIBUTE
2	2	Features (Basic AI, Comms, Data Recording and Backup, GPS, Life Monitoring System)
1	1	Supersense (Health Profile; 10 m)
3	3	Supersense (Lifeforms; 1 km)
6		TOTAL (3 POINT ITEM)

► SKILL PILLS - ACTION

Swallow one of these pills and for a full day you'll gain the knowledge and practical experience associated with one action Skill Group. You can create variations of these pills for other types of Skill Groups (Background or Field) at a reduced Point cost or for individual Skills (see page 19).

SKILL PILLS – ACTION

LEVEL	POINTS	ATTRIBUTE
8 (5)	24	Skill Group: Select one action group (Duration -3 [1 Day])
24		TOTAL (12 POINT ITEM)

► SYMBIOSIS FEED

Once society is connected to the global symbiosis feed, the collective memories of everyone are backed up forever on dynamic cloud servers and the power of worldwide consciousness is unlocked. Connected individuals can effortlessly share information, emotions, data, and memories with others (or review such details for themselves) since mind-to-mind linked communication is easily facilitated. Unfortunately, the feed has occasionally proven to be susceptible to hacking and infiltration by those with the talent and motivation to be societal disruptors.

SYMBIOSIS FEED

LEVEL	POINTS	ATTRIBUTE
3	3	Features (Comms, Data Recording and Backup, Eidetic Memory, GPS, Life Monitoring System, Lightning Calculator)
1 (4)	3	Telepathy (Specific: People who provide Feed access +3)
RANK	POINTS	DEFECT
1	-1	Unique Defect (Hackable)
5		TOTAL (2 POINT ITEM)

► TRACTOR BEAM

Tractor beams are usually installed on large space ships and stations, though smaller units are not uncommon on land vehicles and other structures. Once they lock onto a target, the tractor beam can either pull the target towards the beam origins or move it laterally; other more complex manipulations are not possible unless the tractor beam has been upgraded.

TRACTOR BEAM

LEVEL	POINTS	ATTRIBUTE
11 (8)	44	Telekinesis (Range -6; Unique Limiter: Pull object towards and lateral to beam only +3)
44		TOTAL (22 POINT ITEM)

► UNIVERSAL TRANSLATOR

Spacefaring societies often engage with species that speak different languages and thus were in need of a device that made communication easier. Scientists eventually developed a universal translator, which seamlessly provides audio translation of nearly any possible spoken language into the user's native tongue.

UNIVERSAL TRANSLATOR

LEVEL	POINTS	ATTRIBUTE
1	10	Power Flux (Minor: Languages)
10		TOTAL (5 POINT ITEM)

► WATER SHOES

Water shoes are useful accessories in remote island nations that allow the wearer to walk or run across any liquid surface as though it were as solid as land.

WATER SHOES

LEVEL	POINTS	ATTRIBUTE
2	2	Special Movement (Water-Walking 2)
2		TOTAL (1 POINT ITEM)

ITEMS OF POWER

In contrast to adventuring gear and devices that are commonplace in daily lives, some Items stand out as things of great and important power. These include magic artefacts, technological marvels, and paranormal accessories that may play an important role in your game.

► BINDING CONTRACT

Some magical contracts and oaths are sufficiently powerful that breaking them is nearly impossible.

BINDING CONTRACT

LEVEL	POINTS	ATTRIBUTE
1 (4)	5	Mind Control (Potent -4; Single: Only people under contract +4; Unique Limiter: Only enforce conditions of contract +3)
5		TOTAL (2 POINT ITEM)

► DECK OF MANY ANIMALS

This gorgeously illustrated deck of 50 tarot-sized cards depicts a different natural animal on each card. By withdrawing a card from the deck and focussing on its image, the character can summon up to 10 copies of the depicted animal nearly instantaneously. The card then bursts into flame and is destroyed. The animals can remain with the character for up to one month, after which time they will return to the natural habitat from which they were summoned (if not released earlier). A second animal summoning card may not be used until the previous animals are released or returned home.

DECK OF MANY ANIMALS

LEVEL	POINTS	ATTRIBUTE
1	2	Summon Creatures (Duration -5 [1 Month]; Supernatural -1; Consumable: One use per card only, then card is destroyed +3; Specific Category: 50 identified creatures painted on cards in a deck +2; Unique Limiter: one creature at a time +1)
2		TOTAL (1 POINT ITEM)

► ENERGY WELL

An energy well can be any fixed nexus point of mystical energy (with size up to 100-metres in radius), whether its origins are magical or divine or psychic. A character visiting the nexus point who taps into the well's raw energy reserve receives numerous enhancements: gains an immediate boost to their Soul Stat and Energy Point; benefits from its healing properties; heightens their perception; strengthens their mental defences; and increases their luck. Other than healed Health Points, the character loses all benefits once they leave the presence of the energy well.

ENERGY WELL

LEVEL	POINTS	ATTRIBUTE
2	4	Augmented (Soul)
6	6	Energised
4	4	Healing
2	2	Heightened Awareness
2	2	Mind Shield
1	1	Mulligan
RANK	POINTS	DEFECT
3	-9	Confined (100-metre radius)
10		TOTAL (5 POINT ITEM)

► LIQUIDSUIT

This form-fitting, elasticised body suit can stretch to accommodate a wide range of character sizes. It allows the wearer to transmute their body into a liquid form within a single round and back into regular form when desired. When concentrating while in liquid form, the character can move rapidly through other any other fluids such as rivers and lakes or even lava flows and reservoirs of chemicals – though the character potentially suffers environmental damage from such harsh surroundings.

LIQUIDSUIT

LEVEL	POINTS	ATTRIBUTE
1 (2)	3	Change State (Liquid; Activation +1)
1 (2)	1	Water Speed (30 kph; Potent -1; Concentration +1, Dependent: Change State +1)
4		TOTAL (2 POINT ITEM)

► MEMORY NEUTRALISER

If a character needs an individual or small crowd to forget their most recent experiences, the memory neutraliser is the right tool for the job. A quick pulse of light from the neutraliser can permanently erase the immediate short-term memory of up to two dozen targets within the surrounding three-metre radius area.

MEMORY NEUTRALISER

LEVEL	POINTS	ATTRIBUTE
6 (5)	30	Mind Control (Area -1; Targets -4; Broad Category: Humans +1; Unique Limiter: Erase short-term memory only +3)
30		TOTAL (15 POINT ITEM)

► PERCEPTION ENHANCER

While wearing this helmet, the character perceives the world around them in slow motion, allowing them to perform more actions in the same time span. Such additional actions can be used both during combat to attack and prepare, or for everyday life activities. This altered insight is taxing on the character's energy reserves, though, and can only be used for a short duration.

PERCEPTION ENHANCER

LEVEL	POINTS	ATTRIBUTE
1 (3)	4	Extra Actions (Deplete: 5 Energy Points/round +2)
4		TOTAL (2 POINT ITEM)

► PIXIE GLOVE

Once a character dons the sparkling pixie glove, they are reduced by 4 Size Ranks (medium-sized characters shrink to a pixie height of around 8 cm) and sprout tiny wings from their backs that grant the power of flight.

PIXIE GLOVE

LEVEL	POINTS	ATTRIBUTE
2	6	Flight (30 kph)
2 (4)	20	Size Change (-4 Size Ranks; Maximum +2)
26		TOTAL (13 POINT ITEM)

► PLASMA GEL

After slathering plasma gel over the character's skin, they can create mini singularities, or micro black holes. This grants localised control over gravitational forces, though the process is incredibly draining on the body.

PLASMA GEL

LEVEL	POINTS	ATTRIBUTE
6 (3)	60	Dynamic Powers (Major: Gravity -2; Area -1; Range -3; Deplete +3)
60		TOTAL (30 POINT ITEM)





► RING OF POWER

The Ring of Power is an ancient artefact that a dark demon lord forged during a terrible conflict on the Prime World of Bazaroth between its minions of evil and the invading champions of light. The nearly indestructable ring is a symbol of dominion over malevolent forces, and grants special infernal powers to the wearer, including a fearful aura, long life, heightened awareness of their surroundings, and invisibility on command. The ring also allows the wearer to see beyond the physical realm while invisible, perceiving beings that exist on alternate nearby dimensions.

All that incredible strength comes at a steep price, though. The Ring of Power is a cursed artefact, and wearing it for too long rots the mind and poisons the soul of the wearer. The character starts suspecting everyone around them, including their allies, of betrayal and nefarious motivation. The wearer's soul eventually succumbs to the stress, and the character forever turns into a formless wraith. Furthermore, the strong allure of the ring attracts the attention of dark powers, who all want to possess the ring for themselves and will hunt the wearer until they possess it.

The Ring of Power has one significant flaw: it can be destroyed should it ever be immersed in lava.

RING OF POWER

LEVEL	POINTS	ATTRIBUTE
8	8	Connected (Command over evil minions while possessing the ring)
1	1	Features (Longevity)
4	4	Heightened Awareness
4 (7)	12	Immunity (Nearly All Damage; Object +3)
5	5	Inspire
1	1	Sixth Sense (Extra-Planar Beings; Potent -1; Dependent: Undetectable +1)
2	4	Undetectable (Sight x2)
RANK	POINTS	DEFECT
3	-6	Cursed (Character falls into suspicion and eventually turns into a wraith with repeated use and exposure)
3	-6	Hounded (Dark powers who wish to possess the ring)
1	-1	Unique Defect (Can be destroyed by in lava)
22		TOTAL (11 POINT ITEM)

► SUMMONING KEYS

Once the character has come to a mutually beneficial contractual agreement with an entity Companion from a different dimension – the details of which are left to the player and Game Master – the character can use a linked key to summon the Companion as needed. There's no limit to the number of Companions with which the character has contracts. With the Power Flux Attribute at an effective Level 8 – equivalent to Level 10 Companion Attribute for 40 Flux Points – each Companion may be constructed from up to 100 Points. If two or more companions are summoned at the same time, the Flux Points are divided amongst the entities.

SUMMONING KEYS

LEVEL	POINTS	ATTRIBUTE
2 (8)	20	Power Flux (Minor: Dimensional Companions; Deplete +3; Unique Limiter: Must have existing contractual agreement with Companions to summon regularly +3)
20		TOTAL (10 POINT ITEM)

► TELEPORTATION POD NETWORK

A network of linked teleportation pods allows a character to instantly translocate from one pod to another – even crossing dimensional boundaries. The maximum teleporation range is 10,000 km, which is enough to cover most habitable planets entirely.

The physical design and appearance of the teleporation pods usually resonate with its creator's origins. Examples of pod designs include fireplaces, telephone booths, caves, clothing wardrobes, ring gates, pools of water, and more.

TELEPORTATION POD NETWORK

LEVEL	POINTS	ATTRIBUTE
8 (7)	24	Teleport (Targets -2; Unique Enhancement: Can traverse dimensional boundaries -2; Equipment: Existing Destination Pod +3)
24		TOTAL (12 POINT ITEM)

MECHA AND VEHICLES

Mecha are one of the mainstays of Japanese anime stories, and BESM makes creating vehicles, robots, space ships, external suits, water vessels, and team bases easy. To add autonomy to your mecha Item designs, read the BESM Extra rules on artificial intelligences (page 93). See the Designing Mecha sidebar (BESM4, page 215) concerning the Features available inside such creations.

AI SCIENCE STATION

VALUE POINTS STAT

13	28	Mind Stat
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VALUE DERIVED VALUE

13	Attack Combat Value
13	Defence Combat Value
90	Health Points
5	Damage Multiplier

LEVEL POINTS ATTRIBUTE

18	36	Armour (Armour Rating 90)
9	9	Capacity (500 people or 100K tonnes)
2	2	Features (Artificial Gravity, Comms, Tachyon Radio, Science Labs, Tools)
2	8	Force Field (Armour Rating 20)
11 (6)	22	Resilient (Intense Cold, Intense Heat, Lack of Air, Low Pressure, Radiation; All Complete -5; Mechanical Endurance)
1	1	Spaceflight (Up to 5,000 kph)
7 (8)	7	Supersense (100,000 km; Laser LIDAR; Detectable: Laser +1)
11 (8)	33	Teleport (100K km; Area -1; Targets -2)
18 (8)	18	Weapon: Mini Laser (Alternate Attack; Accurate -1; Range -9)
20 (10)	40	Weapon: Missile Defence (Area -4; Homing: Laser -1; Range -9; Stoppable +4)

RANK POINTS DEFECT

9	-18	Awkward Size (Size 9: Titanic – 800 metres)
2	-6	Special Requirement (Large Crew)

180 TOTAL (90 POINT ITEM)

► AI SCIENCE STATION

This example of a deep-space science outpost is well equipped for scientific and technical research by its 500 personnel. The station's build-in artificial intelligence offers access to a mind that is superior to any human, which assists in novel research and data analysis. Since space can be a dangerous place, though, researchers embedded both offensive and defensive capabilities into the science station to protect its crew and their mission.

► EXOSUIT

This mechanical hardsuit resembles a sleek metal space suit, with a clear polymer helmet and head-to-toe coverage. Its alloy construction makes it extremely resilient to damage and the power-assisted joints allows the character to lift heavy objects with ease.

EXOSUIT

LEVEL POINTS ATTRIBUTE

10	20	Armour (Armour Rating 50)
2	2	Features (Comms, Life Monitors, Tools)
8 (4)	16	Resilient (Intense Cold, Intense Heat, Lack of Air, Low Pressure; All Complete -4)
3	12	Superstrength (1 tonne)

50 TOTAL (25 POINT ITEM)

► GALAXY-CLASS DESTROYER

Aggressive spacefaring civilisations need a big stick when dealing with their enemies, and the galaxy-class destroyer is one of their biggest at over two kilometres in length. With a varied selection of powerful weapons (missiles, plasma cannons, and lasers), strong armour, and a projectile-based defensive grid that can halt nearly any incoming attack, this destroyer is built to brawl. The vessel has sleeping quarters, kitchen galleys, and recreation facilities for over one thousand soldiers – with nearly one hundred required at all times for operational readiness – plus massive cargo bays to host dozens of smaller vessels (such as the spacefury fighters on page 126). This destroyer class is designed for interplanetary patrols, requiring only a few days travel between nearby planets or a few weeks to reach the edges of a solar system. Variations on this design could include extrasolar faster-than-light travel, forcefields, atmospheric flight capacity, upgraded combat capabilities, and advanced supertech (such as teleporters, dimensional control, morphing abilities, organic self-healing construction, etc.).

GALAXY-CLASS DESTROYER

LEVEL	POINTS	ATTRIBUTE
20	40	Armour (Armour Rating 100)
11	11	Capacity (2,000 people or 400K tonnes)
2	2	Features (Artificial Gravity, Comms, Tachyon Radio, Tools)
2 (6)	6	Immunity (Defensive grid against projectiles; Charges +1; Detectable: Sight +1; Unpredictable +2)
11 (6)	22	Resilient (Intense Cold, Intense Heat, Lack of Air, Low Pressure, Radiation; All Complete -5; Mechanical Endurance)
3	3	Spaceflight (Average interplanetary)
6 (7)	6	Supersense (10K km; Laser LIDAR; Detectable: Laser +1)
31 (22)	62	Weapon: Missile Pods (Area -3; Helper -1; Homing: Laser -2; Range -6; Stoppable +3)
29 (19)	58	Weapon: Plasma Pulse Cannons (Autofire -3; Helper -1; Range -6)
18 (8)	36	Weapon: Laser Batteries (Accurate -2; Helper -1; Range -7)
RANK	POINTS	DEFECT
10	-20	Awkward Size (Size 10: Monumental - 2,000 metres)
2	-6	Special Requirement (Large Crew)
220		TOTAL (110 POINT ITEM)

► GRUB CARRIAGE

This luxurious and spacious carriage is reserved for use by elite nobles and their families. Rather than pulled by draft animals, four large grubs (each with a thick carapace) function as the wheels and provide propulsion. The grubs require frequent feeding to keep them happy and coax them into their ball shape, after which they attach themselves to the carriage wheel axles. The grubs are spiritually tied to the life force of the lands and emit a soothing regenerative aura that replenishes the exhausted Energy Points of anyone riding in or standing near the carriage. Additionally, the grubs extend a minor protective barrier around the minds and thoughts of the carriage passengers.

GRUB CARRIAGE

LEVEL	POINTS	ATTRIBUTE
2	4	Armour (Armour Rating 10)
3	3	Capacity (6 people or 1 tonne)
1	1	Features (Luxurious Decor)
1 (3)	1	Ground Speed (50 kph; Assisted: Wheel Grubs +1; Road-Bound +1)
1	1	Mind Shield
1	5	Regeneration (5 Energy Points/round)
RANK	POINTS	DEFECT
2	-4	Awkward Size (Size 2: Huge - 5 metres)
1	-3	Special Requirement (Frequent Grub Feeding)
8		TOTAL (4 POINT ITEM)

► LIFE RAFT

Emergency inflatable life rafts are standard safety equipment on larger yachts and aircrafts. They come folded into the size of a large suitcase for ease of storage and transport, inflating in seconds to full size when their cord is pulled. The raft is constructed from lightweight, yet durable, rubber that provides some puncture protection but isn't designed for harsh environments. Included telescoping oars allow the occupants to slowly paddle the raft, or it can be left to float and be carried by the water's current. Bright, flashing, emergency lights distributed around the raft aid in the characters' rescue.

LIFE RAFT

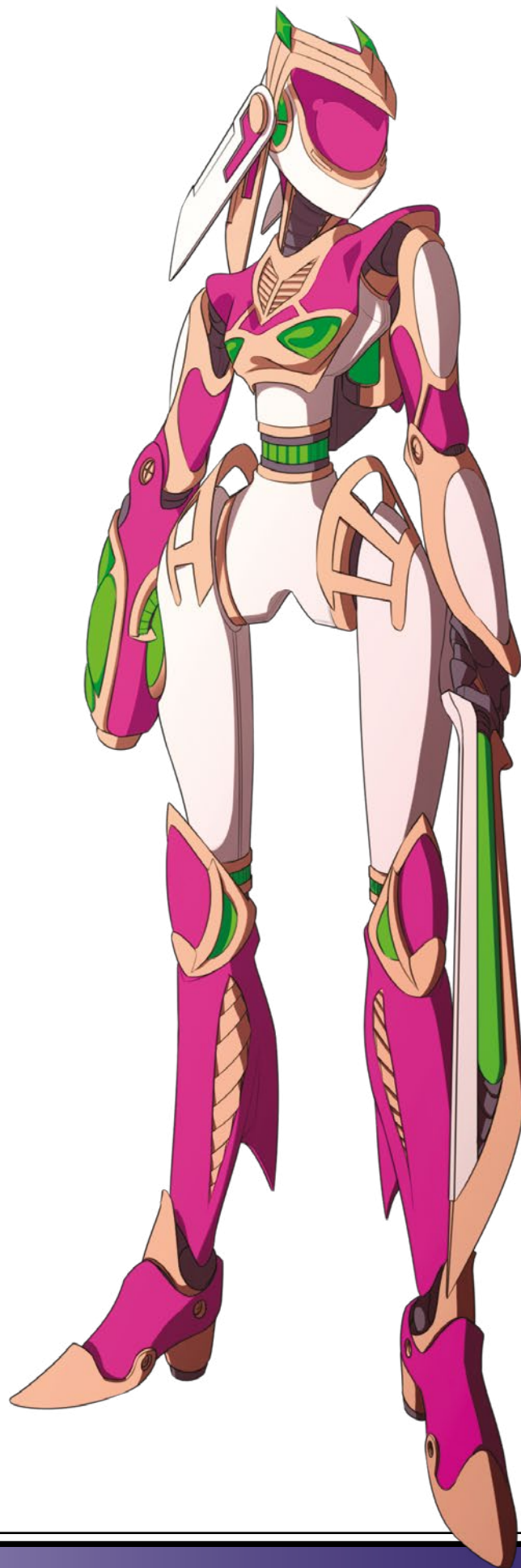
LEVEL	POINTS	ATTRIBUTE
1	2	Armour (Armour Rating 5)
4	4	Capacity (11 People or 2 Tonnes)
1	1	Features (Auto Inflatable; Emergency Lights)
1	1	Water Speed (3 kph; Potent -2; Assisted: Rowers +2)
RANK	POINTS	DEFECT
1	-2	Awkward Size (Size 1: Large - 3 metres)
6		TOTAL (3 POINT ITEM)

► **NUCLEAR SUBMARINE**

Though not as fast as their water surface counterparts, a deep-water, nuclear-powered military sub is sometimes the better tool for the job. The sub hosts a crew complement of nearly 200, with several dozen required at all times for effective operation and monitoring. Its infrared and sonar detection assist in both navigation and combat against enemy vessels. Torpedoes are its main offensive battery against submerged or surface targets (such as other subs, aircraft carriers, and naval destroyers); long-range missiles are the preferred choice for land and air targets. Assisting in its defence are sonar decoys that act as false targets for incoming torpedoes. The sub's enormous size and water propulsion mechanics make it difficult to perform manoeuvres quickly or elegantly.

NUCLEAR SUBMARINE

LEVEL	POINTS	ATTRIBUTE
8	16	Armour (Armour Rating 40)
8	8	Capacity (170 people or 50 tonnes)
2	2	Features (Comms, Escape Capsule, Modern Vehicle Tech Suite, Tools)
2	2	Ranged Defence (Torpedo Decoy)
5 (3)	10	Resilient (Intense Cold, High Pressure, All Complete -2; Mechanical Endurance)
4	4	Supersense (10 km; Infrared)
4 (5)	4	Supersense (50 km; Sonar; Detectable: Sonar +1)
1 (2)	1	Water Speed (30 kph; Potent -1; Delay +2)
40 (30)	80	Weapon: Missiles (Accurate -2; Area -4; Helper -1; Penetrating -6; Range -7; Activation +3; Assisted +2; Stoppable +4; Unreliable +1)
32 (23)	64	Weapon: Torpedos (Area -2; Helper -1; Penetrating -5; Range -6; Activation +1; Environmental +1; Stoppable +3)
RANK	POINTS	DEFECT
7	-14	Awkward Size (Size 7: Enormous - 180 metres)
2	-6	Special Requirement (Large Crew)
1	-1	Unique Defect (Poor Manoeuvrability)
170	TOTAL (85 POINT ITEM)	



► ROBOT GUARDIAN V

The five members of the world-protecting Guardian Sentai V (pronounced “vee”) team each have their own customised Guardian Mecha. Alpha is a encased motorcycle mecha with side-mounted submachine guns and resilience to heat. Beta through Epsilon include two aircraft, an exosuit, and a mini-tank. Each of the Guardian Mecha have the Merge Attribute Level 4, allowing them all to combine into the massively powerful Robot Guardian V (with 200 Character Points)!

RGV is a 15-metre-tall giant robot with seemingly impenetrable armour. It can run quickly, and also fly both in atmosphere and in the vacuum of space. RGV can lift massive objects, detect heat signatures at a distance, and block incoming radar and infrared signals. Three distinct weapons provide excellent offensive capabilities: a missile pack, a rotary cannon, and a huge sword of light.

When the world is in need of a protector, Robot Guardian V comes to the rescue!

ROBOT GUARDIAN V

LEVEL	POINTS	ATTRIBUTE
16	32	Armour (Armour Rating 80)
3	3	Capacity (6 people)
2	2	Features (Comms, Ejection Seat, Modern Tech Suite, Tools)
4	12	Flight (300 kph)
5	5	Ground Speed (250 kph)
10 (5)	20	Resilient (Intense Cold, Intense Heat, Lack of Air, Low Pressure, Radiation; All Complete -5)
2	2	Sensory Block (Infrared, Radar)
2	2	Spaceflight (100K kph)
4	4	Supersense (10 km; Infrared)
6	24	Superstrength (10 Tonnes)
17 (10)	34	Weapon: Missile Pack (Area -2; Helper -1; Homing: Radar -1; Range -4; Ammo +1)
20 (8)	40	Weapon: Rotary Cannon (Autofire -3; Helper -1; Penetrating -3; Range -3; Spreading -3; Ammo +1)
13 (9)	26	Weapon: Light Blade (Helper -1; Penetrating -2; Piercing -2; Hands +1)
RANK	POINTS	DEFECT
3	-6	Awkward Size (Size 3: Mammoth - 15 metres)
200		TOTAL (100 POINT ITEM)

GUARDIAN MECHA ALPHA

LEVEL	POINTS	ATTRIBUTE
4	8	Armour (Armour Rating 20)
1	1	Capacity (2 people)
2	2	Features (Comms, Modern Vehicle Tech Suite, Tools)
5 (6)	5	Ground Speed (500 kph; Detectable: Hearing +1)
4	16	Merge (Contribute 40 Points)
1	2	Resilient (Intense Heat)
2	2	Tough
8 (3)	16	Weapon: Submachine Guns (Autofire -3; Range -3; Hands +1)
RANK	POINTS	DEFECT
1	-2	Awkward Size (Size 1: Large - 4 metres)
50		TOTAL (25 POINT ITEM)

► SHINKANSEN

The shinkansen, or bullet train, is an extremely fast tracked vehicle with a total of eight cars that can carry 1400 passengers. Due to its slow acceleration to high speeds, shinkansen routes are usually between distant cities and rural destinations. Advanced variations on this train use magnetic levitation propulsion tech to run quietly at even faster speeds.

SHINKANSEN

LEVEL	POINTS	ATTRIBUTE
2	4	Armour (Armour Rating 10)
11	11	Capacity (1400 people or 350 tonnes)
1	1	Features (Comms, Modern Vehicle Tech Suite)
1 (6)	1	Ground Speed (500 kph; Detectable: Hearing +1; Equipment: Train Tracks +3; Unique Limiter: Slow acceleration to high speeds)
3	3	Tough
RANK	POINTS	DEFECT
8	-16	Awkward Size (Size 8: Monstrous - 400 metres)
4		TOTAL (2 POINT ITEM)

► **SPACEFURY**

The spacefury is an agile fighter spacecraft designed in an X configuration, with the cockpit located at the convergence point and the propulsion engines situated at the ends of the four X points. This design allows for dynamic 180-degree spins without undue G-forces on the pilot. The spacefury features both atmospheric and space flight capabilities, though squads of furies are usually transported on larger space carriers for long distances. Its plasma pulse cannons can pack a powerful punch against the hull armour of much larger ships.

SPACEFURY

LEVEL	POINTS	ATTRIBUTE
6	12	Armour (Armour Rating 30)
2	2	Features (Comms, Ejection Seat, Grappling Claw, Modern Vehicle Tech Suite, Tachyon Radio)
5 (6)	15	Flight (3,000 kph; Detectable: Hearing +1)
10 (5)	20	Resilient (Intense Cold, Intense Heat, Lack of Air, Low Pressure, Radiation; All Complete -5)
1	1	Spaceflight (Primitive Near-Planetary)
5 (6)	5	Supersense (1,000 km; Laser LIDAR; Detectable: Laser +1)
3	3	Tough
24 (16)	48	Weapon: Plasma Pulse Cannons (Autofire -3; Range -5)
RANK	POINTS	DEFECT
3	-6	Awkward Size (Size 3: Mammoth – 10 metres)
100		TOTAL (50 POINT ITEM)

► **TERRADIGGERS**

The terradigger design features a moderately sized cabin for up to 6 passengers attached to a massive rotating drill cone on the front. It can impressively bore through sand and packed earth at up to 3 kph, rocky ground at 1 kph, and solid rock at 300 metres per hour. The tunnel it leaves behind can either be made permanent or collapsed immediately behind the terradigger, depending on the drill setting. To resist the extreme pressure of the surrounding earth, the terradigger is constructed from durable metal alloys with reinforced plating along key locations. A low-powered mini-laser can be deployed when precise rock carving work is needed or the vehicle is under attack.

TERRADIGGER

LEVEL	POINTS	ATTRIBUTE
6	12	Armour (Armour Rating 30)
3	3	Capacity (6 people or 1 tonne)
2	2	Features (Comms, Depth Sensor, Direction Sense, Tools)
1 (2)	1	Ground Speed (25 kph; Detectable: Hearing +1)
2	4	Resilient (Intense Heat, Lack of Air)
5	5	Tough
5 (6)	5	Tunnelling (Detectable: Hearing and Vibrations +1)
7 (3)	14	Weapon: Mini Laser (Accurate -2; Range -2)
RANK	POINTS	DEFECT
3	-6	Awkward Size (Size 3: Mammoth – 15 metres)
40		TOTAL (20 POINT ITEM)

PROTECTIVE DEVICES

Personal protection devices comes in a wide variety of forms besides armour, since not all threats originate from impacting weapons. The capacity to avoid and heal damage (or even death) is an impressive advantage for adventuring characters, as is the ability to evade attacks, dull pain, conceal identities, move dynamically, and reroll unfavourable dice results.

ANIMAL MULTISUIT

LEVEL	POINTS	ATTRIBUTE
2	4	Armour (Armour Rating 10)
4	4	Features (Camouflage, Direction Sense, Gills, Heat Regulation, Long Tongue, Low-Light Vision, Mimic Sound, Nictitating Membrane, Perfect Pitch, Retractable Claws, Spacial Sense, Weather Sense, Webbed Feet)
2	2	Jumping (x10)
10		TOTAL (5 POINT ITEM)

► ANIMAL MULTISUIT

Once a character dons this enchanted form-fitting bodysuit, they gain numerous innate animal abilities, including armour, movement, weapons, perception, communication, defence, and survival.

► BULLET TIME TRENCH COAT

This full-length, black trench coat provides a unique defence against weapons that fire projectiles such as bullets or stones at the character. The coat harmlessly moves on its own to distort the character in a variety of anatomically difficult poses to avoid contact with the projectiles. To an observer, the character appears to be literally dodging bullets. The trench coat provides no protection against other attack forms, such as energy-based or mental attacks.

BULLET TIME TRENCH COAT

LEVEL	POINTS	ATTRIBUTE
5 (4)	10	Unaffected (All Projectile Weapons -1)
10		TOTAL (5 POINT ITEM)

► CLOAK OF DISPLACEMENT

This durable cloak casts an illusion of the character a short distance away from their actual position, which provides a bonus to their defence rolls.

CLOAK OF DISPLACEMENT

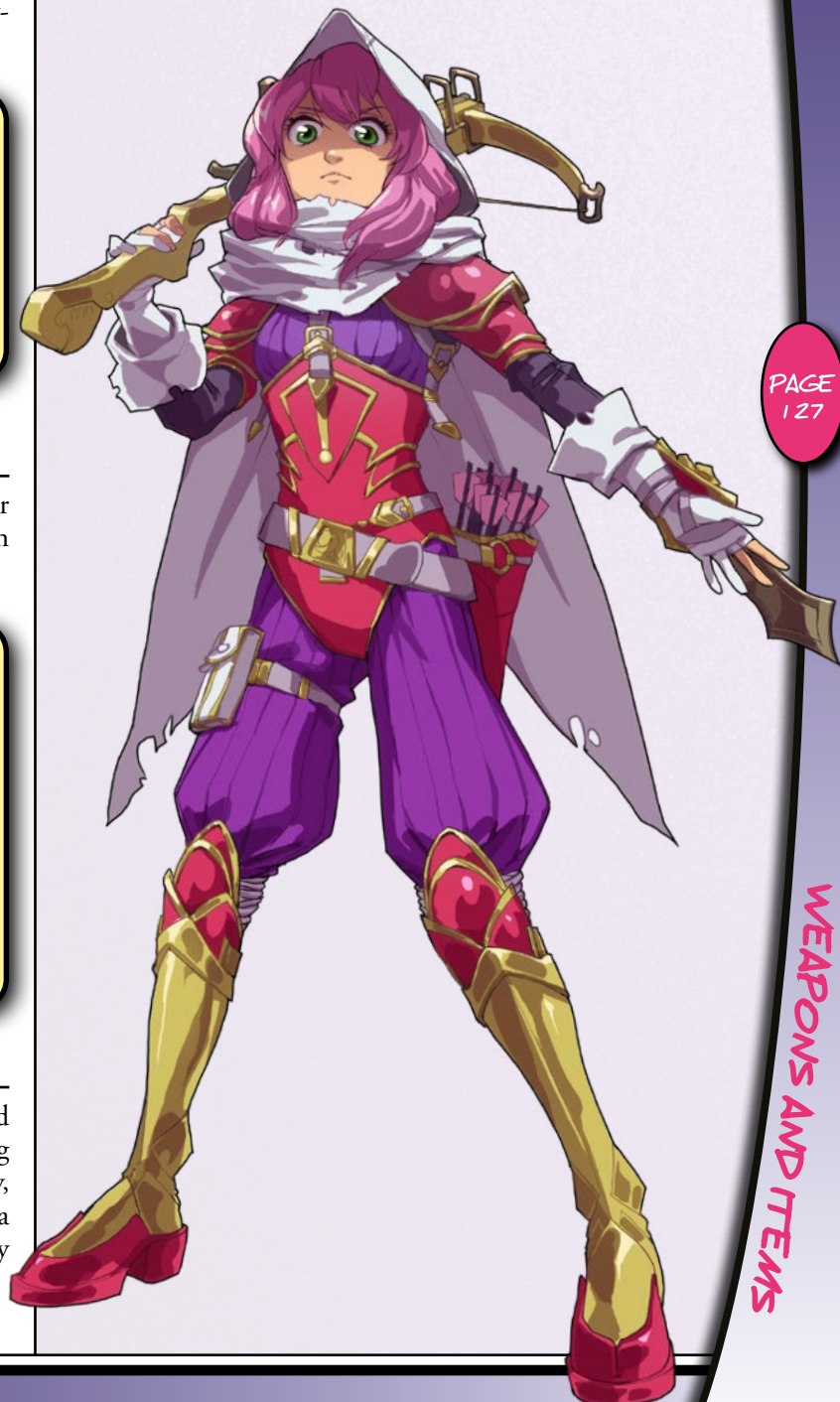
LEVEL	POINTS	ATTRIBUTE
2	2	Armour (Armour Rating 10)
3 (4)	3	Defence Mastery (Dependent: Illusion +1)
2 (3)	2	Illusion (Sight; Unique Limiter: Image of wearer only +1)
7		TOTAL (3 POINT ITEM)

► HEALING CHALICE

Scholars and mystics have long sought the sacred healing chalice, which promises long life and healing to those who drink water from its cup. Miraculously, pouring water from the chalice into the mouth of a deceased character will resurrect them nearly instantly (within one minute).

HEALING CHALICE

LEVEL	POINTS	ATTRIBUTE
10 (1)	10	Features (Longevity; Duration: Permanent -10; Equipment: Water to drink +1)
5 (6)	5	Healing (Equipment: Water to drink +1)
6	12	Reincarnation (Difficult to Stop -1; Equipment: Water to drink +1)
27		TOTAL (13 POINT ITEM)



► LUCKY RABBIT'S FOOT

The stories about a rabbit's foot being lucky are true! It also augments the possessing characters Soul Stat, too.

LUCKY RABBIT'S FOOT

LEVEL	POINTS	ATTRIBUTE
2	2	Augmented (Soul)
4	4	Mulligan
6		TOTAL (3 POINT ITEM)

► PAIN STIMS

When it's important to ignore the body's aches and pains so the character can focus on their task at hand, pain stims provide immediate relief. See Pain and Health Points (page 71) for additional details.

PAIN STIMS

LEVEL	POINTS	ATTRIBUTE
1	1	Unique Attribute (Eliminates pain temporarily and prevents Health Point loss from pain)
1		TOTAL (0 POINT ITEM)

► PERSONAL OFFENSIVE FIELD GENERATOR

This small device is worn on the character's clothing and can generate a resilient force field when activated. The field is sufficiently advanced that it will block incorporeal entities and attacks from bypassing it, and it can regenerate Levels of effectiveness when damaged. A character can also use the force field offensively to penetrate the weaker fields of nearby enemies, bypassing their Armour Ratings for unencumbered attacks.

PERSONAL OFFENSIVE FIELD GENERATOR

LEVEL	POINTS	ATTRIBUTE
6 (3)	24	Force Field (Armour Rating 30; Blocks Incorporeal -1; Field-Penetrating -1; Regenerating -1)
24		TOTAL (12 POINT ITEM)

► SCROLL OF RESURRECTION

A scroll of resurrection can bring back people and creatures from the dead within a day of activation.

SCROLL OF RESSURECTION

LEVEL	POINTS	ATTRIBUTE
4 (3)	8	Reincarnation (Difficult to Stop -1)
8		TOTAL (4 POINT ITEM)

► SHAED CLOAK

This beautiful and resistant cloak can disguise the wearer by transforming their appearance into any one of six pre-determined identities. It can also heal the wearer's injuries and render them invisible at a distance (adjacent people can perceive the wearer as normal).

SHAED CLOAK

LEVEL	POINTS	ATTRIBUTE
6	6	Alternate Identity (6 different shapes and designs)
2	4	Armour (Armour Rating 10)
2	2	Healing
1 (2)	2	Undetectable (Sight x2; Nonadjacent +1)
14		TOTAL (7 POINT ITEM)

► TINFOIL HAT

When folded into the proper geometric form, a tinfoil hat will protect the character from technological and mystical forces that attempt to invade their mind or body. Belief in the power of the tinfoil hat is essential, though, since its protective functions will not work at all unless the character has unwavering faith.

TINFOIL HAT

LEVEL	POINTS	ATTRIBUTE
2 (4)	4	Immutable (Emotional: Belief in the hat +2)
2 (4)	4	Mind Shield (Emotional: Belief in the hat +2)
8		TOTAL (4 POINT ITEM)



► WARDLING DRAGON

This magical dragon construct is infused with the character's soul to seemingly animate life. The primary protection function of the dragon is to absorb attack damage directed at the character and convert it to the same amount of Energy Points and Health Points; those Points are then transferred back to the character. Should the wardling drop to zero Health Points, it must be healed or repaired (like any damaged Item).

The dragon can fly and has sharp claws that can inflict minor damage should its master's life need protection in combat. The bond to the dragon heightens the precision of all the character's senses as well. While in proximity to the wardling, the character can dampen the effects of magical Attributes by two Levels. Additionally, they gain strong protection against the harmful effects of Attributes that have technological sources.

WARDLING DRAGON

VALUE POINTS STAT

6	12	Soul Stat
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VALUE DERIVED VALUE

6	Attack Combat Value
6	Defence Combat Value
40	Health Points
5	Damage Multiplier

LEVEL POINTS ATTRIBUTE

4	20	Absorption (Energy Points; Unique Enhancement: Dragon suffers damage but character receives Energy Point benefit -3; Imbue +3)
4	20	Absorption (Health Points; Unique Enhancement: Dragon suffers damage but character receives Health Point benefit -3; Imbue +3)
1	1	Combat Technique (Lethal Blow)
2	6	Flight (30 kph)
5	5	Heightened Senses (Hearing, Sight, Smell, Taste, Touch – all enhances sense precision, not distance)
4 (2)	20	Nullify (Magic; Multiple Attributes -2)
4	4	Tough
6 (3)	12	Unaffected (Technology; All Attributes -3)

100	TOTAL (50 POINT ITEM)
-----	-----------------------

WEAPONS

The Weapon Attribute provides more customisation options than any other, allowing for a seemingly endless number of possibilities. The example Weapons provided in this section present a variation of that Attribute on its own, or paired with others to create unique combinations.

► BEASTLY SPEAR

Only someone deemed worthy by the beastly spear can wield it properly through a special bonding. They gain the power of flight and cannot be tracked by demons while bonded. The weapon is optimised for combat against demons on any dimensional plane.

BEASTLY SPEAR

LEVEL	POINTS	ATTRIBUTE
2 (4)	6	Flight (Object +2)
18 (6)	36	Weapon: Spear (Accurate -2; Drain: Body -2; Homing: Demons -2; Multidimensional -1; Penetrating -2; Range -2; Targetted: Demons -2; Hands +1)
1	2	Undetectable (By Demons)
1	2	Unique Attribute (Bonds to one worthy individual)
46		TOTAL (23 POINT ITEM)

► BOOK OF DEATH

By writing the true name of a target on a page in this mysterious leather-bound book, the character can inflict an overwhelming amount of damage from anywhere on the planet. This powerful psychic attack damages instantaneously and bypasses all armour and force fields, affecting both physical and incorporeal targets. The extreme damage is fatal to all but the heartiest targets.

BOOK OF DEATH

LEVEL	POINTS	ATTRIBUTE
40 (25)	80	Weapon: Death's Caress (Accurate -2; Autofire -3; Indirect -1; Inconspicuous -3; Psychic -4; Range -8; Toxic +1; Unique Limiter: Single use requires the target's true name to be written in book +5)
80		TOTAL (40 POINT ITEM)

► EXPLOSIVE COLLAR

These collars are often placed around the necks of criminals to deter their escape and ensure compliance. If the wearer attempts to remove the collar, the powerful explosive within detonates instantly in a nasty explosion that usually ends in death. The collar can also be detonated through a remote controller when necessary.

EXPLOSIVE COLLAR

LEVEL	POINTS	ATTRIBUTE
15 (16)	30	Weapon: Explosion (Aura -1; Trap: Attempting to remove collar triggers detonation -1; Unique Enhancement: Can be activated by remote control -1; Ammo +4)
30		TOTAL (15 POINT ITEM)

► LEACHING WAND

This wand emits a short-ranged pulse towards a target that is effective at bypassing force fields. The pulse drains Health Points from the target and transfers them back to the attacker. Damage from the wand cannot be healed by Attributes and must be recovered naturally.

LEACHING WAND

LEVEL	POINTS	ATTRIBUTE
10 (2)	20	Weapon: Invading Pulse (Incurable -1; Piercing -2; Range -2; Vampiric -4; Toxic +1)
20		TOTAL (10 POINT ITEM)

► MINDEATER

This unadorned golden circlet allows the wearer to launch a beam of psychic energy at a target to drain their Mind Stat. Once infected, the target will automatically transfer this mind-draining effect to anyone they touch.

MINDEATER

LEVEL	POINTS	ATTRIBUTE
6 (-1)	12	Weapon: Infection (Contagious -2; Drain: Mind -2; Psychic -4; Toxic +1)
12		TOTAL (6 POINT ITEM)

► MOBIUS BLADE

The mystical mobius blade is a legendary weapon that augments the wielder's Body Stat to be faster, stronger, and more flexible. It also gives control over the character's stature, allowing them to grow by one or two Size Ranks (from medium to huge, for example) to an imposing height. While in possession of the sword, the character gains environmental domination over cold and humidity – a power infused within the blade during its forging over a thousand years ago in the blustery, wintry mountains.

On each combat stroke, the blade generates a powerful wind that can assault multiple targets (up to four) in melee range or at a distance (up to 10 metres). This attack can cross spacial boundaries as well to assault enemies in adjacent dimensional realms.

MOBIUS BLADE

LEVEL	POINTS	ATTRIBUTE
3	6	Augmented (Body Stat)
2	2	Control Environment (Cold, Humidity)
2	20	Size Change (+2 Size Ranks)
11 (5)	22	Weapon: Wind Stroke (Multidimensional -1; Range -2; Spreading -3)
50		TOTAL (25 POINT ITEM)



► MONOFILAMENT BLADE

This high-tech sword blade is practically invisible at a width of only one molecule. Anyone who merely touches the area above the hilt will be cut by the blade, which always inflicts maximum damage. The sword is difficult and dangerous to wield safely in combat and will damage the attacking character should they fail their attack roll by 3 or more.

MONOFILAMENT BLADE

LEVEL	POINTS	ATTRIBUTE
24 (20)	48	Weapon: Blade (Aura -1; Inconspicuous -3; Insidious -3; Backlash: Character suffers damage instead +2; Unique Limiter: Always inflicts maximum damage +1)
48	TOTAL (24 POINT ITEM)	

► ORBITAL LASERS

Usually placed in orbit around a planet or moon as part of a defence grid, these substantial laser pods can be operated by remote control or set to patrol autonomously with their basic artificial intelligence. The bright lasers are extremely accurate and can fire a 100-metre radius beam at a range up to 10,000 km, which completely bypasses a target's armour. The lasers consume a tremendous amount of energy when firing, limiting them to only six shots in a 24-hour period and requiring one minute to warm up before activation.

ORBITAL LASER

LEVEL	POINTS	ATTRIBUTE
1	1	Features (Basic AI, Remote Control)
40 (25)	80	Weapon: Laser (Accurate -2; Area -3, Flare -2; Insidious -3, Range -8; Activation +2, Charges +1)
1	1	Spaceflight (Up to 5,000 kph)
6 (7)	6	Supersense (10,000 km; Laser LIDAR; Detectable: Laser +1)
RANK	POINTS	DEFECT
4	-8	Awkward Size (Size 4: Gigantic – 25 metres)
80	TOTAL (40 POINT ITEM)	

► OZONE BOARD AND BLADE

The autoreturning ozone throwing blade is always paired with its hover board companion, since they symbiotically share the same power source and function together. The blade resembles a five-pointed throwing star with small laser knives protruding from each arm. The board is an agile flying platform that intuitively reads the character's movements and redirects accordingly. Together, these Items are formidable – and fun! – in a warrior's hands.

OZONE BOARD AND BLADE

LEVEL	POINTS	ATTRIBUTE
1	1	Features (Basic AI, Highly Manoeurable)
3 (4)	9	Flight (300 kph; Skim +1)
15 (5)	30	Weapon: Ozone Blade (Accurate -2; Autofire -3; Homing -2; Penetrating -1; Piercing -2; Range -3; Backlash +2; Dependent: Flight +1)
40	TOTAL (20 POINT ITEM)	



08: ITEMS & WEAPONS

► PAIN DOLL

This small doll serves as an effigy of the desired target, who can be anywhere on the planet or nearby dimensional plane. By poking the doll with needles and blades, pain and damage will be inflicted upon the target as well – unless that area poked is protected by a sufficiently high Armour Rating.

PAIN DOLL

LEVEL	POINTS	ATTRIBUTE
9 (2)	18	Weapon: Pain (Indirect -1; Multidimensional -1; Range -8; Exclusive: Target into whose likeness the doll was made +3)
18		TOTAL (9 POINT ITEM)

► SWORD OF DETECTION

While this sword is crafted, it is imbued with the imprint of one specific race or enemy identity. Thereafter, when the sword comes within 10 metres of the imprinted target, it glows with a bright blue light.

SWORD OF DETECTION

LEVEL	POINTS	ATTRIBUTE
1	1	Sixth Sense (Select One Race or Enemy; Potent -1; Detectable: Sight +1)
3	6	Weapon: Sword
7		TOTAL (3 POINT ITEM)

► THUNDER MACE

This unique weapon can only be wielded by someone the mace deems worthy. It gives the wielder control over darkness and storms, and can always return to the owner's grasp under its own power of flight. The mace can be used in melee combat or thrown up to 100 metres, offering two types of attack forms: a resounding smash that can pound an opponent and open a 5-metre fissure in the ground, and a lightning call from the sky that bypasses armour and can strike multiple targets hidden behind cover.

THUNDER MACE

LEVEL	POINTS	ATTRIBUTE
2	2	Control Environment (Darkness, Storms)
2 (5)	6	Flight (Object +2; Unique Limiter: Fly to owner only +1)
12 (7)	12	Weapon: Pounding Smash (Alternate Attack; Quake -2; Range -3)
14 (4)	28	Weapon: Call the Lightning (Indirect -1; Insidious -3; Range -3; Spreading -3)
1	2	Unique Attribute (Can only be used by someone worthy)
50		TOTAL (25 POINT ITEM)





CHAPTER 9

DICELESS BESM

THE STORY'S THE THING

BESM's origins from 1997 were inspired by designer Mark MacKinnon's favourite role-playing game, Amber Diceless, based on Roger Zelazny's evocative fantasy novel series and created by the late Erick Wujcik of Phage Press. Mark's goal was to create an anime game system with a core set of light and easy rules that didn't get in the way of the characterisation and role-playing. Consequently, it's only natural that BESM can be adapted relatively easily to also be played as a diceless (and fully randomnessless) game.

This section doesn't go into all the supporting advice and guidelines for actually running diceless BESM – which in itself could take an entire book (or two) to explore! – but rather briefly presents the accommodations and changes necessary to transition BESM from 2d6 to no dice. We provide the framework, but the application is up to you.

RESOLVING ACTIONS

Removing dice from BESM only impacts one aspect of the game: resolving actions. Such actions may be between characters and their environments, or between two or more characters (or groups) opposing one another. Since randomness does not play a role in character creation or damage delivery, all other mechanical and role-playing aspects remain relatively unchanged during the game adventures.

HEDGING ON ALL ROLLS

Rather than rolling dice as normal, all character actions – attacks, defences, Stat and Skill rolls, etc. – use the game's hedging rules (BESM4, page 182). That is, all dice rolls have an automatic result of 7, with edges and obstacles increasing or decreasing this result by 1 (for minor modifiers) or 2 (for major modifiers) as outlined in the rules.

For opposed rolls, the two hedging actions for both participants cancel each other. Consequently, only the other roll aspects are considered, such as Stats, Skills, Combat Values, and roll modifiers.

ONE ATTACK VALUE

Although having separate Attack and Defence Combat Values allow for specific differentiation in character concepts, many characters have similar values. For example, it is rare for a character to have ACV at 12 and DCV at 6. To make diceless combats easier – much easier! – players and GMs are encouraged to only use a single, unified Combat Value.

This means that modifying a character's Combat Value now costs the combined totals of modifying ACV and DCV separately. The Attack Mastery and Defence Mastery Attributes each cost 1 Point/Level and thus a combined "Combat Mastery" Attribute would cost 2 Points/Level – with each Level adding +1 to the character's Combat Value. Similarly, the two Ranged Attack and Ranged Defence Attributes at 1 Point/Level each would combine to create a new "Ranged Combat" Attribute costing 2 Points/Level and adding +2 to the character's Combat Value in the selected situations.

DICELESS COMBAT

Examine the following considerations that would oversee fast and efficient diceless combat:

- » There are no game rounds. A single, calculated total combat roll comparison determines the outcome of the entire battle between opponents.
- » Better attackers have the combat advantage.
- » Inflicting more damage gives an advantage.
- » Having more Health Points gives an advantage.
- » Having a form of damage resistance (ie. Armour Rating) gives an advantage.
- » Having extra attacks and defences gives an advantage.
- » Being able to re-roll dice gives an advantage.
- » Using personal Energy Point reserves to focus combat abilities gives an advantage.

CALCULATING A TOTAL COMBAT ROLL

So how would all these diverse parameters influence the execution of diceless combat? Each character's total combat roll is determined as follows (rounding down to calculate each modifier):

Combat Value (modified by Attributes as appropriate)

+1 for every 10 damage the attack inflicts (Weapon Level x Damage Multiplier + Size Damage Modifier – but do not add any contribution from Combat Value)

+1 for every 20 current Health Points

+2 for every Extra Action Attribute Level

+1 for every Mulligan Attribute re-roll applied to this specific combat (which must be stated in advance)

+1 for every 10 Energy Points the character expends in this combat (which must be stated in advance – see Dramatic Feats, BESM4, page 195)

+1/+2 for applicable minor/major edges

-1 for every 10 damage stopped by the target's Armour Rating, if it is likely applicable in this combat

-2 for every Extra Defences Attribute Level that the target possesses

-1/-2 for applicable minor/major obstacles

EXAMPLE CALCULATION

For this example, let's look at Heaven Witch Junko – a magical girl NPC from the BESM Dramatis Personae expansion. She has a Level 2 Weapon, a 6 Combat Value, 5 Damage Multiplier, 65 Health Points, 65 Energy Points, and Level 3 Mulligan (up to six re-rolls total).

Her baseline total combat roll when battling an opponent is calculated as follows:

6 for her Combat Value

+1 for inflicting 10 damage during their attack
(Weapon 2 x Damage Multiplier 5 = 10; $10 \div 10 = +1$)

+3 for 60 Health Points ($65 \div 20 = 3$ rounded)

+0 (No Extra Attacks)

=10

Junko can modify her base combat roll by +1 (to 11 total) if she uses one re-roll from the Mulligan Attribute, or +2 to +6 if she uses two to six re-rolls total. She can also increase her total roll by +1 for every 10 Energy Points she expends – up to a maximum of +6 for burning 60 Energy Points. Consequently, the maximum combat roll the Heaven Witch could have by pouring everything into it is 22 (10+6+6).

Junko's total combat roll – which will range from 10 to 22, depending on the choices she makes – is compared to her opponent's calculated total combat roll, and the highest value wins. Tied total rolls result in a stalemate, with neither combatant able to gain a significant advantage over their opponent (unless outside forces engage to tip the balance).

► DICELESS MARGIN OF SUCCESS

The margin of success between the victor's combat roll and their opponent's combat roll should be considered when determining other aspects of the battle, including the duration of combat, the allocation of damage, and other impacts concerning the final outcome. Table-15 provides suggested results that are intended to complement role-playing narratives between the GM and player (or between players, should intra-party conflict break out). Descriptive dialogue and character banter plays an important role in all BESM combats, but they takes on a crucial role in diceless adventures to increase story drama and player tension.

► INJURY CATEGORIES

Table-15 provides several injury examples at different margins of success. In the categories outlined below, the percent of damage is relative to the character's normal calculated Health Point maximum (rounded down). For the Heaven Witch Junko example, 10% equals 6 Health Points, 25% equals 16 Points, 50% equals 32 Points, etc.

LITTLE OR NO INJURY

The victor emerges from the combat practically unscathed. Health Point damage ranges from 0-10%.

MINOR INJURY

Health Point damage ranges from 10-25%.

SIGNIFICANT INJURY

Health Point damage ranges from 25-50%.

MAJOR INJURY

Health Point damage ranges from 50-75%.

CRITICAL INJURY

Health Point damage ranges from 75-100%.

90 POINTS

HEAVEN WITCH JUNKO (JUNE FUKURA)

Race Human
Occupation Magical Girl; Student
Home World Earth (Prime)
Habitat Japan, Earth
Height 140 cm (4' 9")
Mass 35 kg (77 lb)



HEAVEN WITCH JUNKO

Size Rank 0: Medium

VALUE	POINTS	STAT
5	10	Body Stat
5	10	Mind Stat
8	16	Soul Stat

VALUE	DERIVED VALUE
6	Attack Combat Value (Magical Ranged 10)
6	Defence Combat Value (Ranged 10)
65	Health Points
65	Energy Points
5	Damage Multiplier (Demons 9)

LEVEL	POINTS	ATTRIBUTE
1	1	Alternate Identity (June Fukura)
3	12	Companion (Itsuki, cat made of green wood; 30 Points)
2	2	Exorcism
2	2	Features (Animal Empathy, Appearance: Cute, Famous, Foreign Language: English)
2	6	Flight
2	2	Inspire
	7	Item (Weaver Wand; 14 Points)
3 (4)	9	Massive Damage (Targetted: Demons +1)
4	4	Mind Shield
3	3	Mulligan
2	2	Ranged Attacks (Magical Attacks)
2	2	Ranged Defence (Personal)
1	1	Sixth Sense (Demons)
1	3	Skill Group (Adventuring)
2	2	Skill Group (Occupation: Student)
1	2	Skill Group (Social)
		Weapon: Witch Bolt (Area -1; Drain: Soul -2; Range -2; Selective -1; Deplete +1; Hands +1; Non-Penetrating +2)

RANK	POINTS	DEFECT
1	-1	Easily Distracted (New anime and manga)
1	-1	Involuntary Change (Incantation)
2	-2	Nemesis (Devil Queen Ayana)
2	-4	Skeleton in the Closet (Secret Identity)
3	-6	Vulnerability (Bloom Vine)
90		TOTAL

► EXTRA CONSIDERATIONS

Though the diceless combat guidelines are easy to understand, gaming groups should also consider how specific details can impact battles.

ADVANCED DECLARATION OF MODIFIERS

The GM should decide how many Energy Points and Mulligan dice re-rolls the NPCs are expending during combat when battling player characters, before the character announces how many they are using.

AVOIDING FIGHTS TO THE END

Since small differences between opponents' total combat rolls indicate long battles, participants may take such opportunity to flee or use powers before they are defeated. The GM may consider giving participants the opportunity to spend additional Energy Points to change the course of battle or cut it shorter. Descriptive flavour is important to give all players the real understanding of what their characters are experiencing in combat.

INITIATIVE PLAYS A REDUCED ROLL

Although a character's Initiative value does not impact the calculation of a total combat roll, it can still factor into role-playing opportunities regarding surprise attacks (page 40) and activities at the beginning of battle.

MULTIPLE COMBAT PARTICIPANTS

A group of allies can attack as a single unit. Use the Combat Value of the most capable character, then use combined totals for damage, Health, extra attacks, etc.

WEAPONS AND ARMOUR RATINGS

A target's Armour Rating is part of the calculation of the total combat roll, but in some situations a participant's Weapon is too weak to inflict enough damage to overcome the Armour Rating. Compare Weapon stats for all participants against their opponents' Armour Ratings at the beginning of combat to determine if any damage will ever penetrate (remembering to consider the addition of each character's Combat Value in the calculation, like normal; see BESM4, page 193). If the damage is not enough, the protected target will not receive any damage regardless how the combat proceeds unless outside elements play a role.

SITUATIONAL NUMBERS

The GM will need to make decisions when the total combat roll calculations may vary according to specific situations. For example, if a character has Armour with the Optimised: Fire Limiter, should their Armour Rating be part of their roll calculation? Or should it not be included, since it depends on whether or not their opponent attacks with a fire-based Weapon? Similarly, does a character's Ranged Combat Attribute enter into the calculation if the combat would reasonably be fought through a combination of ranged and melee encounters?

For these situational conditions, the GM could provide partial consideration for such modifiers as appropriate. For example, if the GM estimates that half a battle would take place in ranged combat, they may allow half the Ranged Combat Attribute to be added to the total roll.

15

DICELESS COMBAT MARGIN OF SUCCESS

Victor's Margin Over Opponent	Margin of Success	Combat Duration	Impact of Combat
Equal roll results	Tie	Upwards of an hour or longer	Victor and opponent suffer minor injuries. Both realise they are well matched and can decide the best path forward.
Exceeds roll by 1-2	Slight success	Dozens of minutes	Victor and opponent suffer significant injuries. Victor can push for opponent's death but injuries increase to major.
Exceeds roll by 3-5	Moderate success	Several minutes	Victor suffers significant injuries. Opponent suffers major injuries; death unlikely unless opponent refuses to withdraw.
Exceeds roll by 6-11	Significant success	Approximately 1-2 minutes	Victor suffers minor injuries. Opponent suffers major injuries; death is a possible outcome without yielding or fleeing.
Exceeds roll by 12-17	Major success	Within 30 seconds	Victor suffers minor injuries. Opponent likely critically injured; their survival is in the victor's hands.
Exceeds roll by 18+	Extreme success	Several seconds	Victor dominates, suffering little or no injury. Opponent likely critically injured; their survival is in the victor's hands.

DICELESS EXAMPLE OF COMBAT

The example of combat in the core game (BESM4, page 184) has been rewritten to demonstrate how the same battle would be resolved using the diceless rules, using the participant values in the table at the bottom.

Two members of the Psychic Assault Corps – Julian (playing Kozoh, a weapons master) and Lynne (playing Sparks, an augmented tech genius) – just run into a small horde of Bazaroth demons on a spaceship in Earth's orbit. Rae, the Game Master, was setting the scene.

Julian: Kozoh rushes to attack, assuming that Sparks will back me up.

Lynne: You know I will!

Rae: (to James and Pete) Dr. Chaz and Hogarth, you may get a chance to influence things later because you're in another part of the ship, so hold tight for now. (to Julian and Lynne) Kozoh and Sparks, you charge ahead. Are you staying together to fight the same opponents, or splitting up?

Julian: (to Lynne) Sparks, can you handle the horde of lesser demons?

Lynne: Yup, they're mine. Let's break and charge.

Julian: I don't care about the stupid regular demons – my top priority is taking down the archfiend. I'm going to dodge between the horde, then launch a flying katana slice at the fiend.

Rae: You fly over the railing, zip past several demons, and catch archfiend Azok a little unaware. I'm going to grant you a minor edge during this combat. Julian, what is Kozoh's baseline combat roll?

Julian: My sword-modified Combat Value is 10. My katana is a Level 3 Weapon and my Damage Multiplier is 7, so that's 21 damage – or a +2 to the roll after dividing by 10. I'm undamaged, so my 80 Health Points divided by 20 gives me another +4. And you gave me a minor edge for +1. Added together, that's a final total of 17.

Rae: Are you spending any Energy Points in a Dramatic Feat to increase it?

Julian: Thanks for the reminder! I know how fast these archfiends are, so I'm not taking any chances. I'll dig into my reserves and burn 20 Energy Points for a +2 bonus; I'll keep some for later in case I need it. Now my final total combat roll is 19.

Rae: [calculates Azok's total combat roll as 17: 10 Combat Value + 2 for one-tenth Weapon damage + 3 for one-twentieth Health Points + 2 for Extra Actions Level 1. Azok doesn't expend Energy Points since it's overconfident in its ability to win. Kozoh has a slight margin success of 2.]

Rae: OK, thank you. How about Sparks?

Lynne: I've Power Fluxed my left hand into a nasty Level 3 Weapon machine pistol that has one assignment of the Spreading Enhancement, so I can attack two of the demons at once while I fight. Sadly, that's a major obstacle on my roll. How many are there coming for me?

Rae: You're up against six of them. Since you can fight two at once using Spreading, I'm going to consider it more like you're battling three opponents. You're severely outnumbered, but you know you're also a seasoned fighter. Calculate your baseline combat roll and then I'll describe how you and Kozoh are doing.

COMBAT PARTICIPANT GAME VALUES

Combat Participant	Modified Combat Value	Weapon Damage	Current Health Points	Extra Actions Level	Mulligan Level	Energy Points	Armour Rating
Kozoh	10	21	80	–	–	50	–
Sparks	9	18	60	–	1	80	–
Azok	10	22	70	1	–	60	20
Demons	5	10	40	–	–	30	–

Lynne: My gun-modified Combat Value is 9. Since my body is a Level 3 Weapon and my Damage Multiplier is 6, that's 18 damage – or a +1 to the roll after dividing by 10. I have 60 Health Points left divided by 20 gives me another +3. The major obstacle for Spreading knocks it down by -2, though. I know I'm severely outnumbered, so I'll use both my Level 1 Mulligan and burn 60 of my 80 Energy Points in a Dramatic Feat for a +8 bonus. Added it all together – that's a final total combat roll of 19.

Rae: [calculates the total combat roll for three demon opponents (three groups of two demons) to be 14: 5 for their highest Combat Value + 3 for three times one-tenth Weapon damage + 6 for three times one-twentieth Health Points. The demons are too inexperienced to expend Energy Points during a Dramatic Feat. Sparks has a moderate margin success of 5.]

Rae: (to Julian) Azok is a tough opponent, even though it takes it a while to mount a defence since you caught him off guard. You dance back and forth with Azok, swinging your katana deftly while it uses its brute strength and razor-sharp claws against you. You get in one good shot and slice it across its heavily armoured chest – but Azok merely smiles and wipes away the thin line of blue blood. It connects with a few claws and punches of its own, though you believe the advantage is yours. Anything in particular you are doing during the ongoing battle?

Julian: Do I know if the PAC radiotelepathy gear is still working?

Rae: It was last time you checked before the battle started. It should be fine, unless something has changed since then.

Julian: Can I quickly open a channel and talk to Dr. Chaz via radiotelepathy while holding off the attacks?

Rae: If the conversation is short, and if Azok lets you keep any teeth from his onslaught.

Julian: Wow, that's harsh. (to James) Chaz, are you there? We've encountered hostiles.

James: (as Doctor) Oh geez. What?

Julian: (as Kozoh) Dammit Doctor, we're fighting an archfiend and a small horde of demons. Do something! Why aren't you here?

James: Splitting up was Sparks's plan! Okay, we'll get there as soon as we can. Leave some for us! (to Rae) We get moving – now!

Rae: (to James) Got it. You'll be there soon, but not quite yet. (to Lynne) And Sparks, your machine pistols are blazing and your adrenaline is racing. The six demons are pushing you to your limit, clawing at your back, your legs, your chest. You dig deep within to calm your mind and focus your energies to keep them at a distance when you can. The pain is immense, but you got this. Where are you aiming your attacks?

Lynne: Head shots, of course. I don't know if their torso has much armour.

Rae: Again and again, your aim is true. You see a look of shock on the demons' faces as they get sprayed with hot lead.

Lynne: Can I kill them all?

Rae: They won't retreat with their archfiend nearby, yet you outmatch them. After several minutes the last one drops, riddled with holes. You follow and collapse to the ground, panting, having suffered significant injuries and 24 damage (40%).

Lynne: I'm exhausted. While on the ground, can I see how Kozoh is doing, though?

Rae: Azok and Kozoh seem closely matched and both of them are bleeding from dozens of gashes across their bodies. They fight on.

Lynne: I have to help him! I'll Power Flux my right hand into a powerful strobe light like I did when we took down that giant spider in the crypt last month. That's the Control Environment: Light Attribute. I'll try to blind everyone. I know Kozoh can fight blind, so that'll give him the advantage.

Rae: Smart thinking. Your hand quickly morphs into a powerful strobe and you pulse an intense flash of light. Everyone, including, Kozoh, is temporarily blinded.

Julian: I've trained for this for years, though! I'll go for a finishing blow against Azok.

Rae: You rush in for the kill and strike true, decapitating Azok. The battle would have gone longer without Sparks's help. You stand victorious, drenched in sweat and blood. The wounds inflict 40 damage (50%).

Rae: (to James and Pete) You finally arrive – but it's too late. You missed the carnage!

A

Absolutes in BESM	63
Absorption Attribute	5
Acceleration Limiter	12
Acidic/Basic Chemicals	70
Acrobatics Skill	21
Actions, Hold (Readying)	35
Actions, Resolving Diceless	135
Actions, Tactical	35
Adding Campaign Colour	89
Adjusting Skill Costs	30
Adjusting the Baseline, Threat Scores	91
Adventure Skills	9
Adventuring Elements, Chapter 7	88
Adventuring Gear	111
Affecting Groups	45
AI (Artificial Intelligences)	93
Aim	35
Aim, Precise, Combat Technique	6
Air-Tight, Enhancement, Force Field	7
Alternate Attacks, Weapon	10
Alternate Attribute Costs	60
Alternate Stat Costs	60
Alternate Stat Costs, Table-09	60
Alternative Critical: Natural 12	57
Alternative Fumble: Natural 2	57
Ammunition, Types	101
Animal Training Skill	21
Architecture Skill	21
Area Enhancement	12
Area Knowledge Skill	21
Armies, Multiple, Mass Combat	53
Armour Attribute	5
Armour, Reduce, Called Shot	37
Artificial Intelligences (AI)	93
Artisan Skill	21
Arts, Cultural, Skill	23
Arts, Domestic, Skill	23
Arts, Performing, Skill	26
Arts, Visual, Skill	28
Attack Roll Modifiers, Table-12	64
Attack, Movement Penalties	43
Attack, Multiple Targets with One	40
Attack, Rush, Combat Technique	6
Attack, Surprise	40
Attack, Total	40
Attacking Moving Targets	43
Attacks with Two Weapons	37
Attacks, Combined	49
Attacks, Defending Against Multiple	44
Attribute and Defect Levels, Fixed	61
Attribute Cost Genre Variation	30
Attribute Costs, Alternate	60
Attribute vs. Attribute	45
Attribute, Opposing Types	46
Attribute/Defect Assignments, Table-10	61
Attributes	5
Attributes, Offensive Use of Non-Weapon	45
Attributes, Using Defensively	44
Attributes, Using in Combat	45

B

Base, Changing the	57
Battlefield, Social	54
Benchmarks, Triple Costs Over	60
BESM dX: Variable Dice	62
Beyond Skill Groups	19
Biological Sciences Skill	21

Biting, Grappling	41
Blackout, Combat Technique	5
Blind, Enhancement, Teleport	9
Boating Skill	21
Bonus, Engagement	106
Borrowing Future Points	48
Bracket Costs, Stat	60
Breathing, Controlled Skill	23
Broadening Your Game	5
Bundle Stat Rolls	81
Bundles and Packs, Chapter 6	72
Bundles as Dynamic Effects	87
Bundles, Power	76
Burglary Skill	21
Business Skill	21

C

Called Shots	37
Campaign Colour, Adding	89
Campaigns, Varying Skill Costs	30
Canada, Gun Laws	97
Capped, Limiter, Absorption	5
Catastrophic Damage	69
Category, Injury	136
Changing the Base	57
Chapter 1: Core Game Framework	4
Chapter 2: Skills	18
Chapter 3: Expanded Mechanics	34
Chapter 4: Optional Rules	56
Chapter 5: Exploring Damage	66
Chapter 6: Packs and Bundles	72
Chapter 7: Adventuring Elements	88
Chapter 8: Items and Weapons	110
Chapter 9: Diceless BESM	134
Character vs. Player Ability	92
Civilisation Skill	21
Climbing Skill	23
Cold	70
Combat Flowchart	36
Combat Manoeuvres	35
Combat Modifiers, Consolidated	63
Combat Modifiers, Expanded	43
Combat Roll Modifiers	43
Combat Technique Attribute	5
Combat Value, Social	54
Combat, Diceless	135
Combat, Example of Diceless	138
Combat, Mass	52
Combat, Social	54
Combat, Using Attributes in	45
Combined Attacks	49
Computers Skill	23
Conjuration Power Bundles	76
Considerations, Extra Diceless	137
Consolidated Combat Modifiers	63
Contact Poisons	89
Contact, Disease	89
Control, Sphere of	45
Controlled Breathing Skill	23
Conversion Attribute	6
Core Game Framework, Chapter 1	4
Costs, Alternate Attribute	60
Costs, Alternate Stat	60
Costs, Skill, Varying by Genre	30
Costs, Skills	9
Crashing	68
Critical Failures	57
Critical Hits	57
Critical Strike, Combat Technique	5

Crystalist Power Pack	74
Cultural Arts Skill	23
Customising Firearms	99
Customising Vehicles	103

D

Daily Devices	116
Damage Multiplier, Modifying	67
Damage Total, Modifying	67
Damage, Catastrophic	69
Damage, Environmental	70
Damage, Exploring, Chapter 5	66
Damage, Extra Range	59
Damage, Impact	68
Damage, Non-Combat	68
Damage, Proportional, Limiter	8
Damage, Social	55
Damage, Variable Options	67
Dead Eye, Combat Technique	5
Defeat, Social	55
Defect and Attribute Levels, Fixed	61
Defects	11
Defence Roll Modifiers, Table-11	63
Defence Rolls, Hedging	44
Defence, Expanded Rules	43
Defence, Total	35
Defences, Extra, Attribute	6
Defending Against Multiple Attacks	44
Defending Others	44
Defending with a Shield	43
Defending with an Offensive Attribute	44
Defensive Use of Attributes	44
Demolitions Skill	23
Demure Defect	11
Deprivation	90
Deprivation, Oxygen	70
Derived Values, Social	54
Designing New Skills	20
Devices, Daily	116
Devices, Protective	126
Dice, Variable, BESM dX	62
Diceless BESM, Chapter 9	134
Diceless Combat	135
Diceless Combat Success Margin, Table-15	137
Diceless Example of Combat	138
Diceless Margin of Success	136
Difficulty Penalties, Wound	69
Direct Contact, Disease	89
Disarm, Called Shot	37
Disarming via Grappling	41
Disease	89
Disguise Skill	23
Divine Power Pack	74
Domestic Arts Skill	23
Driving Skill	23
Duration Enhancement	12
dX BESM: Variable Dice	62
Dynamic Effects, Bundles	87
Dynamic Initiative	62
Dynamic Powers vs. Normal Attributes	48

E

Edges and Obstacles, Multiple	50
Effective Game Duration	12
Effective Range	59
Electricity	70
Electronics Skill	23
Empathy Skill	23

Engagement Bonus.....	106
Engineering Skill.....	24
Enhanced Knockback, Combat Technique.....	5
Enhanced Recovery.....	71
Enhancements.....	12
Enhancing Your Rules.....	35
Environmental Damage.....	70
Environmental Sciences Skill.....	24
Escalate, Enhancement, Conversion.....	6
Escaping, Grappling.....	41
Etiquette Skill.....	24
Evocation Power Bundles.....	77
Examining the Pain.....	67
Example of Combat, Diceless.....	138
Executions in BESM.....	69
Expanded Combat Modifiers.....	43
Expanded Defence Rules.....	43
Expanded Injury Rules.....	68
Expanded Mechanics, Chapter 3.....	34
Exploring Damage, Chapter 5.....	66
Extra Actions, Spreading Initiative.....	62
Extra Defences Attribute.....	6
Extra Range Damage.....	59

F

Failure, Consequences of Morale.....	51
Failures, Critical.....	57
Falling.....	68
Fantasy/Future Genre Skill Costs, Table-03b.....	32
Fantasy Campaigns.....	30
Far Shot, Combat Technique.....	6
Fibonacci Cost, Stat.....	60
Fighting, Ground, Grappling.....	41
Fire.....	70
Firearms.....	94
Firearms, Customising.....	99
Firing from Moving Vehicles.....	43
Firing Weapons While Mounted.....	43
Fixed Attribute and Defect Levels.....	61
Flow of Combat Time, Mass Combat.....	53
Flow of Social Time.....	55
Flowchart, Combat.....	36
Force Field Attribute.....	7
Forgery Skill.....	24
Framework Skills.....	9
Future Campaigns.....	30

G

Game, Broadening Your.....	5
Gaming Skill.....	24
Gap, Limiter, Armour.....	5
Gear, Adventuring.....	111
Genetic Diseases.....	90
Genius Skills.....	20
Genre Skills.....	9
Genre, Varying Attribute Costs.....	30
Genre, Varying Skill Costs.....	30
Going Big.....	92
Grappling.....	40
Grappling and Disarming.....	41
Ground Fighting, Grappling.....	41
Group, Limiter, Plant Control.....	8
Groups, Affecting.....	45
Groups, Skill, Beyond.....	19
Gun Laws in Canada.....	97
Gun Laws in Japan.....	97
Gun Laws in the United States.....	95

H

Hardboiled, Combat Technique.....	6
Haywire Limiter.....	14
Healing, No, Defect.....	11
Health Points and Pain.....	71
Hedging Defence Rolls.....	44
Hedging, NPC.....	49
Historical Campaigns.....	30
Historical Genre Skill Costs, Table-03c.....	33
Hits, Critical.....	57
Hold Actions (Readying).....	35
How Do I?.....	108

I-J

Ignore Limiter.....	14
Immovable Attribute.....	7
Impact Damage.....	68
Impact Damage, Knockback.....	58
Impact Damage, Table-13.....	68
Impacting, Limiter, Force Field.....	7
Indirect Contact, Disease.....	89
Influence, Sphere of (see Sphere of Control) ...	45
Ingested Poisons.....	89
Inhaled Poisons.....	89
Initiative Consequences of Readying.....	37
Initiative, Dynamic.....	62
Injury Categories.....	136
Injury Poisons.....	89
Injury, Expanded Rules.....	68
Injury, Serious.....	69
Intelligences, Artificial (AI).....	93
Intermediate Range.....	59
Interrogation Skill.....	24
Intimidation Skill.....	24
Items and Weapons, Chapter 8.....	110
Items of Power.....	118
Japan, Gun Laws.....	97

K-L

Knockback.....	58
Knockback Effects.....	58
Knockback, Enhanced, Combat Technique.....	5
Knockback, Enhancement, Weapon.....	10
Knockback, Simple.....	59
Knockout.....	69
Knowledge, Area, Skill.....	21
Languages Skill.....	24
Law Skill.....	24
Leadership Skill.....	25
Limiters.....	12
Listening Skill.....	25
Location, Specific, Called Shot.....	37
Lock, Grappling.....	41

M

Manoeuvres, Combat.....	35
Manoeuvres, Grappling.....	41
Margin of Success.....	58
Margin of Success, Diceless.....	136
Margin of Success, Diceless, Table-15.....	137
Margin of Success, Table-07.....	58
Mass Combat.....	52
Math, Template Modification.....	17
Mecha and Vehicles.....	122
Mechanics Skill.....	25
Mechanics, Expanded, Chapter 3.....	34
Medical Skill.....	25

Merge Attribute.....	8
Military Sciences Skill.....	26
Modern Day Campaigns.....	30
Modern Genre Skill Costs, Table-03a.....	31
Modification Math, Template.....	17
Modifiers to Morale Checks.....	51
Modifiers, Combat Roll.....	43
Modifiers, Consolidated Combat.....	63
Modifiers, Expanded Combat.....	43
Modifiers, Mass Combat.....	52
Modifiers, Reversed.....	14
Modifiers, Social Combat.....	54
Modifying Power Packs.....	73
Modifying the Damage Multiplier.....	67
Modifying the Total Damage.....	67
Morale for NPCs.....	51
Morale, Player Character.....	51
Mounted, Firing Weapons While.....	43
Movement Attack Penalties.....	43
Moving Targets, Attacking.....	43
Moving Vehicles, Firing from.....	43
Multiple Armies, Mass Combat.....	53
Multiple Attacks, Defending Against.....	44
Multiple Combatants, Social Combat.....	55
Multiple Edges and Obstacles.....	49
Multiple Rolls, Mass Combat.....	53
Multiple Targets with One Attack.....	40
Multiple Targets, Combat Technique.....	6

N-O

Natural 12, Alternative Critical.....	57
Natural 2, Alternative Fumble.....	57
Naturopathy Skill.....	26
Navigation Skill.....	26
No Healing Defect.....	11
No Need to Defend.....	44
Non-Combat Damage.....	68
Normal Attributes vs. Dynamic Powers.....	48
NPC Hedging.....	49
NPC Morale.....	51
Obstacles and Edges, Multiple.....	50
Occult Skill.....	26
Occupation Skill.....	26
Offensive Non-Weapon Attribute, Defending.....	44
Offensive Use of Non-Weapon Attributes.....	45
Opening, Waiting.....	35
Opponent, Threat Scores.....	91
Opposing Attribute Types.....	46
Optional Rules, Chapter 4.....	56
Options, Variable Damage.....	67
Others, Defending.....	44
Oxygen Deprivation.....	70

P-Q

Packs and Bundles, Chapter 6.....	72
Packs, Power.....	73
Pain and Health Points.....	71
Pain, Examining the.....	67
Penalties, Range.....	59
Penalties, Wound Difficulty.....	69
Perception Power Bundles.....	80
Performing Arts Skill.....	26
Persuasion Skill.....	26
Physical Sciences Skill.....	26
Physical vs. Social Defects.....	11
Piloting Skill.....	27
Pin, Grappling.....	41
Planetary Powers.....	92

Plant Control Attribute	8
Player Character Morale	51
Player vs. Character Ability	92
Points, Sanity	15
Points, Society	54
Poisons	89
Poisons Skill	27
Police Sciences Skill	27
Power Bundles	76
Power Flux Attribute	8
Power Packs	73
Power, Items of	118
Powerlifting Skill	27
Powers, Pushing Your	48
Precise Aim, Combat Technique	6
Pressure	71
Proportional Damage, Limiter, Merge	8
Protective Devices	126
Psi Power Pack	74
Pushing Your Powers	48

R

Radiation	71
Range Damage, Extra	59
Range Enhancement	12
Range Penalties	59
Range Penalties, Table-08	59
Ranks, Skill	19
Readying (Hold Actions)	35
Readying, Initiative Consequences	37
Reallocating Points in Skills	30
Recording Power Packs	73
Recovering Sanity Points	16
Recovery, Enhanced	71
Recovery, Social	55
Reduce Armour, Called Shot	37
Religion Skill	27
Remote Range	59
Resolution, One-Roll, Mass Combat	52
Resolving Diceless Actions	135
Reversed Modifiers	14
Riding Skill	27
Ritualist Power Pack	75
Roll, Combat Modifiers	43
Rolls, Bundle Stat	81
Rolls, Sanity	15
Rules, Enhancing Your	35
Rules, Expanded Defence	43
Rules, Optional, Chapter 4	56
Rush Attack, Combat Technique	6

S

Sanity Effects	16
Sanity Points	15
Sanity Points, Recovering	16
Sanity Rolls	15
Sanity Rolls, Table-01	15
Sanity Spirals, Table-02	16
Sciences, Biological, Skill	21
Sciences, Environmental, Skill	24
Sciences, Physical, Skill	26
Sciences, Police, Skill	27
Sciences, Social, Skill	28
Search Skill	27
Seduction Skill	27
Sense, Street, Skill	28
Serious Injury	69
Shamanist Power Pack	75

Shield, Defending with	43
Shock	68
Shock Value	14
Shots, Called	37
Simple Knockback	59
Skill Costs	9
Skill Costs, Varying by Genre	30
Skill Flux, Limiter, Power Flux	8
Skill Groups, Beyond	19
Skill Points, Reallocation	30
Skill Ranks	19
Skill Specialisations	20
Skills and Templates	26
Skills Attribute	8
Skills vs. Groups	9
Skills, Chapter 2	18
Skills, Designing New	20
Skills, Genius	20
Sleight of Hand Skill	27
Social Battlefield	54
Social Combat	54
Social Combat Value	54
Social Damage	55
Social Defeat	55
Social Derived Values	54
Social Mastery Attribute	9
Social Recovery	55
Social Sciences Skill	28
Social vs. Physical Defects	11
Society Points	54
Specialisations, Skill	20
Species, Limiter, Plant Control	8
Specific Location, Called Shot	37
Sphere of Control	45
Spirit Power Bundles	83
Sports Skill	28
Spreading Extra Actions Across Initiative	62
Stat Costs, Alternate	60
Stats Beyond 12	92
Stats of Zero	16
Steady Hand, Combat Technique	6
Stealth Skill	28
Street Sense Skill	28
Strike, Critical, Combat Technique	5
Striking to Wound	40
Stunts, Wild	103
Success, Margin, Table-07	58
Surprise Attack	40
Survival Skill	28
Swimming Skill	28
Synergistic, Enhancement, Absorption	5

T-U

Table-01: Sanity Rolls	15
Table-02: Sanity Spirals	16
Table-03a: Genre Skill Costs – Modern	31
Table-03b: Genre Skill Costs – Fantasy/Future	32
Table-03c: Genre Skill Costs – Historical	33
Table-04: Opposing Attribute Types	46
Table-05: Social Damage	55
Table-06: Critical Failure	58
Table-07: Margin of Success	58
Table-08: Range Penalties	59
Table-09: Alternate Stat Costs	60
Table-10: Attribute/Defect Assignments	61
Table-11: Defence Roll Modifiers	63
Table-12: Attack Roll Modifiers	64
Table-13: Impact Damage	68
Table-14: Deprivation	90

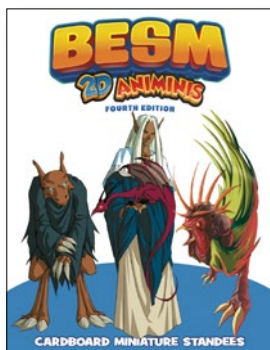
Table-15: Diceless Margin of Success	137
Tactical Actions	35
Target, Touching	40
Targets Enhancement	12
Targets, Attacking Moving	43
Targets, Multiple, Combat Technique	6
Targets, Multiple, with One Attack	40
Technology Power Bundles	84
Teleport Attribute	9
Template Modification Math	17
Templates and Skills	26
Threat Scores for Opponents	91
Throw, Grappling	41
Total Attack	40
Total Defence	35
Touching a Target	40
Tracking, Urban, Skill	28
Tracking, Wilderness, Skill	28
Training, Animal, Skill	21
Transformation Power Bundles	85
Treating Poison	89
Two Weapons, Attacks with	37
Two Weapons, Combat Technique	6
Types of Ammunition	101
Types, Opposing Attributes	46
Unassailable Attribute	9
United States, Gun Laws	95
Unsettled Defect	11
Urban Tracking Skill	28
Using Attributes Defensively	44
Using Attributes in Combat	45



Vacuum	71
Value, Shock	14
Variable Damage Options	67
Variable Dice, BESM dX	62
Varying Skill Costs by Genre	30
Vehicles	102
Vehicles and Mecha	122
Vehicles, Customising	103
Vehicles, Firing from Moving	43
Visual Arts Skill	28
Vital Spot, Called Shot	37

W-Z

Waiting for an Opening	35
Weak Point, Called Shot	37
Weapon Attribute	10
Weapons	130
Weapons and Items, Chapter 8	110
Weapons, Attacks with Two	37
Weapons, Firing While Mounted	43
Weapons, Two, Combat Technique	6
Wild Stunts	103
Wilderness Tracking Skill	28
Wizardry Power Pack	75
Wound Difficulty Penalties	69
Wound, Striking to	40
Writing Skill	28
Zero, Stats of	16



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